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Introductory Note

Over the years it has often been suggested to me that there is a need for an Arabic grammar that will enable readers of English to learn enough Arabic to be able to read the Qur'ān in its original language. This book attempts to fill that gap.

In its 40 lessons the book covers all the important points of the grammar of Quranic Arabic—though not every point, as there are some problems of Qur'ānic grammar that the grammarians, Arab and non-Arab alike, have never solved. Like grammarians in the past, I have occasionally taken a sentence somewhat out of context or changed a case-ending so that a phrase can stand alone. Without these minor and traditional pedagogic liberties, examples of some grammatical points would be very scarce. This is hardly surprising, given the relatively small size of the text of the Qur'ān. Nevertheless, Quranic examples are used in most places in the explanatory material, and all the exercises consist of Quranic quotations. The three topics in which I had to use most non-Quranic examples were the numerals, relative sentences and exceptive sentences. Here I have used a number of non-Quranic examples to help me to provide a full explanation. Elsewhere such examples are rare.

I have tried, wherever possible, to show the grammar of the Qur'ān within the broader framework of Arabic as defined by the classical grammarians and also that of later Arabic. For most of the book this is a relatively straightforward task, even though the language of the Qur'ān predates that of classical Arabic and though it contains a range of expressions and constructions that are not normally found in later texts (unless, of course, they crop up in a Qur'ānic quotation). For the greater part of the book the reader may be assured that there is relatively little difference between Qur'ānic and later Arabic, except in vocabulary. However, the topics covered in the last five lessons

show greater or lesser variation from later developments. In particular, conditional sentences became, for a time at least, more uniform than those we find in the Qur'ān—and more recently they have become less so.

Though some of those who use this book will be familiar with Arabic script, many others will not be. For the latter the exercises of the first five lessons have transliterations to help them to master Arabic script thoroughly. A certain amount of transliteration is used throughout the rest of the book, particularly when it helps the grammatical explanations to run smoothly.

The text of the Qur'ān referred to throughout this book is that of the Egyptian standard edition, first issued in 1342/1923 and revised in 1381/1960 and subsequently. There are, however, certain problems. First, the style of writing used in the standard edition is somewhat ornate, and it also looks decidedly archaic in comparison with the printing norms of the period when it first appeared. Secondly, in more recent times the move to computer type-setting of Arabic has somewhat reduced the options that used to be available with hot metal type-setting. The result is that the Arabic printed in this book lacks the ornate and calligraphic touches of the standard edition, though there is the consolation that it is slightly easier to read. However, two attempts have been made to provide something of the feel of the standard edition. The first is the intermittent use of short *alif* (see p. 3), and the second is the use of the archaic spellings of a handful of common words (see p. 4).

Grammatical terms, largely English but sometimes Arabic, are used throughout the book. For those not familiar with grammatical terminology there is a glossary of technical terms (pp.290–295), which may be of some help, even though explanations of grammatical terms are always turgid.

It is assumed that most readers will be studying alone, and it is to them that the following remarks are addressed. (Those fortunate enough to have teachers will find that the teachers will have plenty of their own guidance to offer.) Each lesson consists of three parts: (a) exposition of a number of grammatical topics. Each piece

of grammar should be mastered before moving on to the next. Particular attention should be paid to understanding the examples given in a section. The grammatical sections are followed by (b) the Vocabulary for that lesson. The vocabularies are intended to be read from right to left. In the first 7 lessons the first column contains the singular form of nouns, together with pronouns, adverbs, prepositions, etc.; the second column contains such plurals as are needed; and the third column has the English translation. From Lesson 8 onwards there is a further column of Arabic to allow the Perfect, Imperfect and Verbal Noun (*masḍar*) forms to be printed together. In Vocabularies 15–40 the Perfects of derived forms are preceded by a number (e.g. 2) to show which derived form is involved. There is also a General Vocabulary, which puts together all the words in Vocabularies 1–40 in Arabic alphabetical order. This is to enable a reader who has forgotten a word to look it up without having to remember which lesson it was first used in.

Every attempt should be made to become familiar with the words in a lesson's vocabulary before the reader moves on to (c) the exercise for that lesson. One can then test one's absorption of the lesson by tackling the exercise. Some of the sentences will turn out to be less straightforward than they might at first appear. This is often because they are without a wider context. Each exercise should be attempted in the first place without reference to the Key. If readers find that they still have problems, they should turn to the Key, and look at the sentence and its translation together. Once the sentences in an exercise are understood, the vocabulary should be revised and fully mastered.

At various points there are exhortations to the reader to learn the vocabulary and to learn it in a certain way. These are based on experience with students over a nearly half a century and are a reminder of how readers might help themselves. The same applies to exhortations to learn declensions and conjugations. Effort put in at an early stage has real rewards.

Let me stress again that this book's basic aim is to help the reader to learn to read the Qur'ān. To go beyond the texts referred

to in this work, the reader will need a text, a translation, such as my own, and a dictionary. Dictionaries are a problem. Hava's Arabic Dictionary is quite helpful, but it has long been out of print and it is difficult to find. Penrice's Dictionary and Glossary of the Qur'ān was hardly at the cutting edge of scholarship when it was first printed in 1873. However, it was reprinted by the Curzon Press in 1971 and is sometimes available. It should be noted that Wehr's Arabic Dictionary, whether in the original German or in Milton Cowan's English translation, is a dictionary of modern Arabic. For the Qur'ān it is largely useless. However, it is an excellent work, and those readers of this book who go on to modern Arabic (and I hope that most of them will do) will find it indispensable. The great reference grammar for early and classical Arabic is Wright's Arabic Grammar, still being issued by the Cambridge University Press. However, the first edition was published in 1859/1862, and thus it does not cover modern Arabic.

This book is largely concerned with reading the Qur'ān. However, it is essential to remember that *al-Qur'ān* means 'the Recitation', that the Prophet delivered the Qur'ān orally, and that its oral dimension is crucial. With the knowledge that the reader has acquired, I hope that he or she will learn to understand the text both in written and recited form.

Letters	Independent	Initial	Medial	Final	Transliteration
<i>alif</i>	ا			ا	
<i>bā'</i>	ب	ب	ب	ب	<i>b</i>
<i>tā'</i>	ت	ت	ت	ت	<i>t</i>
<i>thā'</i>	ث	ث	ث	ث	<i>th</i>
<i>jīm</i>	ج	ج	ج	ج	<i>j</i>
<i>hā'</i>	ح	ح	ح	ح	<i>h</i>
<i>khā'</i>	خ	خ	خ	خ	<i>kh</i>
<i>dāl</i>	د			د	<i>d</i>
<i>dhāl</i>	ذ			ذ	<i>dh</i>
<i>rā'</i>	ر			ر	<i>r</i>
<i>zāy</i>	ز			ز	<i>z</i>
<i>sīn</i>	س	س	س	س	<i>s</i>
<i>shīn</i>	ش	ش	ش	ش	<i>sh</i>
<i>ṣād</i>	ص	ص	ص	ص	<i>ṣ</i>
<i>ḍād</i>	ض	ض	ض	ض	<i>ḍ</i>
<i>ṭā'</i>	ط	ط	ط	ط	<i>ṭ</i>
<i>ẓā'</i>	ظ	ظ	ظ	ظ	<i>ẓ</i>
<i>‘ayn</i>	ع	ع	ع	ع	<i>‘</i>
<i>ghayn</i>	غ	غ	غ	غ	<i>gh</i>
<i>fā'</i>	ف	ف	ف	ف	<i>f</i>
<i>qāf</i>	ق	ق	ق	ق	<i>q</i>
<i>kāf</i>	ك	ك	ك	ك	<i>k</i>
<i>lām</i>	ل	ل	ل	ل	<i>l</i>
<i>mīm</i>	م	م	م	م	<i>m</i>
<i>nūn</i>	ن	ن	ن	ن	<i>n</i>
<i>hā'</i>	ه	ه	ه	ه	<i>h</i>
<i>wāw</i>	و			و	<i>w</i>
<i>yā'</i>	ي	ي	ي	ي	<i>y</i>

The Arabic Alphabet

INTRODUCTION TO THE ARABIC ALPHABET

Arabic is written from right to left in a script that has an alphabet of 29 letters. (Perhaps 28 would be more accurate—see the notes on *hamza* below). Various forms of the script developed over the centuries, one of them, Kūfic, being particularly associated with the writing of the Qur'ān in the early centuries of Islam. The user of this book will need to be familiar with only one form. This is known as *naskh*, the primary printed form. The standard Egyptian text of the Qur'ān is written in a more elegant way than one finds in ordinary printing and has certain modifications that are explained below. (It should be noted that copies of the Qur'ān from North Africa are written in a different script, Maghribī, with different forms for the letters *fā'* and *qāf*.)

The alphabet set out on the opposite page has developed in a number of ways since the time of the Prophet Muḥammad. At that period dots were used relatively rarely to differentiate the letters, and for a time, as the early Kūfic script evolved, they appear not to have been used in the writing of the Qur'ān. However, by the end of the first Islamic century, determined efforts were being made to differentiate the letters fully by the use of dots, though it was some considerable time before all scribes used them. During the same period, the writing of *hamza* was introduced, and signs to indicate the short vowels were also added. A hybrid letter, *tā' marbūṭa*, was introduced to indicate the final letter of words that take the main feminine grammatical ending. This is a *hā'* to which the dots of the letter *tā'* have been added. From time to time the standard text uses an ordinary *tā'* where a *tā' marbūṭa* might have been expected. Printed *naskh*, and handwriting akin to it, have fewer combinations of letters, usually known as ligatures, than other styles of writing. The letters concerned are normally clear enough. One ligature has

almost attained the status of a letter. This is the combination of *lām* and *alif* (ﻻ).

Hamza (ء)

With the passage of time Arabic developed various spellings to indicate the presence of a glottal stop, *hamza* (full name *hamzat al-qat'*). The rules for these spellings are complicated, and are something of a nuisance for beginners. They owe their existence to historical circumstances. In seventh-century Arabic, the *hamza* had more or less dropped out of use in some dialects, including that of Quraysh, Muḥammad's tribe; but in other dialects it survived, as it did in the higher registers of language, including most poetry. Classical Arabic owed more to those dialects that preserved the *hamza* than to those that did not. The resulting orthography of *hamza*, where a 'seat', or *kursiyy*, indicated an absent *hamza*, was a compromise, allowing for texts to be comprehensible whether the *hamza* was actually written in or not. As time went on, forms with *hamza* prevailed over those without, and the need for complex spellings disappeared. However, by that time the writing system was largely fixed, and it preserved what is in effect various forms of double spelling, with the majority of forms having both a *hamza* and a 'seat' (*kursiyy*). The latter gives an indication of the pronunciation without *hamza*. There is a further complication. The writing system also developed a way of indicating a vowel placed before a word or a cluster that would otherwise begin with a vowelless consonant. This secondary form of *hamza* (full name *hamzat al-waṣl*) was born from theories about pronunciation held by the Arab grammarians, who took the view that such words and clusters could not begin without a vowel. To avoid the problem, an *alif* and a vowel without the *hamza* sign are placed at the beginning of the word or cluster. If that were all, the process would be relatively simple; but if the word preceding the word or cluster that begins without a vowel ends with (or can be given) a final vowel to which the vowelless letter can be linked (and thus pronounced without an extra vowel being added to the vowelless word or cluster), an *alif* and a joining sign, *waṣla*, are written instead. If

you cannot immediately understand the last sentence, do not be surprised. It takes time to absorb the complicated logic of these rules, but they are not such a problem for those whose initial aim is to read texts. Those wanting to write vocalised Arabic need a lot of practice to enable them to co-ordinate their use of these rules.

Vowels

The Qur'ān has long been written with full vocalisation. This is a feature found in few texts. Most Arabic, from the earliest times to the present day, carries no indication of short vowels. The signs for the short vowels were developed in Umayyad times. This is in contrast to the long vowels, which often occur in the earliest surviving documents from the Islamic period. The system of vocalisation that evolved is able to indicate three short vowels, three long vowels and two diphthongs. The short vowels are:

a (Arabic name *fatha*), written َ, e.g. اَ

i (Arabic name *kasra*), written ِ, e.g. اِ

u (Arabic name *ḍamma*), written ُ, e.g. اُ

The basic ways of writing the long vowels are:

ā, indicated by writing an *alif* after a *fatha*,

ī, indicated by writing a *yā'* after a *kasra*,

ū, indicated by writing a *wāw* after a *ḍamma*,

However, there are alternative ways of writing the long vowels, and some of these are to be found in the standard text of the Qur'ān. Those for *ī* and *ū* are simple. A small independent form of *yā'*, now obsolete, is used to indicate *ī*; and a small independent form of *wāw* is used to indicate *ū*. The writing of the alternative forms of *ā* is more complex. There are two principal forms:

1. **SHORT ALIF.** In this form a *fatha* is written perpendicularly, so that it resembles a short *alif* written independently. Thus one finds both كِتَاب and كِئِب for *kitāb*. With many words, and *kitāb* is one of these, the short *alif* predominates. It should be noted that this use of short *alif* has become less frequent as time has passed. It is

relatively uncommon in modern Arabic for the *alif* indicating long *ā* not to be written as a full letter, except in the demonstratives, where the written forms have become fossilised. (See Lesson 6.)

2. ALIF IN THE FORM of a *yā'* [*alif maqṣūra*]. Under rules that need not be set out in this book, the letter that indicates *ā* at the end of a word may be written as a *yā'* instead of an *alif*. This is known, perhaps not surprisingly, as *alif* in the form of a *yā'*. In the Qur'ān it frequently has a short *alif* written above it. The Arab grammarians had various theories about its origin, and the argument that it indicated some variation in pronunciation appears to have some validity. It must be noted that *alif* in the form of a *yā'* can occur only at the end of a word. If a word is extended by the addition of a suffix, *yā'* reverts to *alif*. Thus *ramā* 'he threw' is written with *alif* in the form of a *yā'*: رَمَى. When the suffix for 'it' is added, this becomes *ramā-hu*, written رَمَاهُ. It should also be noted that in a small number of words *ā* is indicated by a *wāw* and a short *alif*. The most common of these words are زَكَاةٌ *zakāt* 'alms-giving', صَلَاةٌ *ṣalāt* 'ritual prayer', حَيَاةٌ *ḥayāt* 'life', and الرِّبَا *al-ribā* 'usury'. This special spelling may originally have indicated an *o* sound.

The diphthongs are *aw* and *ay* represented by *fathā* + *wāw* (أَوْ) and *fathā* + *yā'* (أَيَّ) respectively.

Madda

It has become standard for a *hamza* followed by a long *ā* to be written as two *alifs*, one vertical and one horizontal (آ). This piece of orthography is not used in the standard text of the Qur'ān, a convention that is not always easy to follow. In this book *Ā* is used for purposes of clarity.

Sukūn

This is the sign to indicate the absence of a vowel. The usual form is a little circle placed above the consonant concerned (◌◌◌°), but the standard Egyptian text more frequently uses the sign ◌◌◌◌.

Tanwīn

The final vowel of a noun or adjective may have an *n* sound to indicate that it is indefinite. This is shown by writing the vowel twice, to give *un*, *an* or *in*.

Tashdīd

The sign *ˆ* (*shadda*) indicates the doubling (*tashdīd*) of a letter. *Kasra* with a *shadda* is printed immediately under the *shadda* in this book.

PRONUNCIATION

It is impossible to give a proper explanation of pronunciation by written description alone, and the notes that follow give only brief indications. Much can be learned from listening to recorded recitations of the Qur'ān, particularly if these are not too highly stylised.

<i>alif</i>	nil	bearer for <i>hamza</i> or sign of long <i>ā</i> .
<i>bā'</i>	<i>b</i>	
<i>tā'</i>	<i>t</i>	
<i>thā'</i>	<i>th</i>	as in 'think'.
<i>jīm</i>	<i>j</i>	as in 'jam'.
<i>ḥā'</i>		a hoarse, much stronger aspiration than <i>hā'</i> .
<i>khā'</i>		like the <i>ch</i> in the Scottish 'loch' or the German 'ach'.
<i>dāl</i>	<i>d</i>	
<i>dhāl</i>		transcribed as <i>dh</i> , but sounds like the <i>th</i> in 'the'.
<i>rā'</i>	<i>r</i>	a rolled <i>r</i> , always fully sounded.
<i>zāy</i>	<i>z</i>	
<i>sīn</i>	<i>s</i>	
<i>shīn</i>	<i>sh</i>	as in 'shingle'.
<i>ṣād</i>		an emphatic form of <i>s</i> .
<i>ḍād</i>		an emphatic form of <i>d</i> .
<i>ṭā'</i>		an emphatic form of <i>t</i> .

ḡā'		an emphatic form of <i>dh</i> (not of <i>z</i>).
'ayn		a guttural produced by compression of the throat, found in very few languages and best learned from a native speaker.
ghayn		a gargling sound, much like the <i>gr</i> in the French 'grand'.
fā'	f	
qāf		a <i>k</i> sound produced from the back of the throat.
kāf	k	
lām	l	
mīm	m	
nūn	n	
hā'	h	always pronounced.
wāw	w	also part of <i>ū</i> and <i>aw</i> .
yā'	γ	also part of <i>ī</i> and <i>ay</i> .

Lesson One

Nouns and Adjectives

Grammatically Arabic nouns and adjectives may be either definite or indefinite.

INDEFINITE

There is no indefinite article equivalent to the English 'a', 'an'. However, the large majority of nouns and adjectives have *tanwīn* (the addition of the sound *n* to the final vowel of a word) to indicate that the word is indefinite:

أَجْرٌ	<i>ajrun</i>	a reward
عَذَابٌ	<i>‘adhābun</i>	a punishment
كِتَابٌ	<i>kitābun</i>	a scripture, document
آيَةٌ	<i>āyatun</i>	a sign, verse
رَحْمَةٌ	<i>rahmatun</i>	a mercy
قُرْآنٌ	<i>qur’ānun</i>	a recitation

However, you will come across a considerable number of words that do **not** take *tanwīn* when they are indefinite. At this stage you can only learn what these words are by experience. Two examples are:

آخَرُ	<i>ākharu</i>	other
أَوَّلُ	<i>awwalu</i>	first

You must remember that it is impossible to add *tanwīn* to words that are shown as not taking it (either in the text or in the vocabularies), and **any attempt to do so is incorrect**.

DEFINITE

A noun may be made definite in one of two ways:

1. by being preceded by the definite article, equivalent to the English 'the'.
2. by being followed by the genitive of possession.

We shall deal here only with the definite article; on (2) see Lesson 7.

THE DEFINITE ARTICLE

Traditional wisdom tells us that the definite article is **أَلْ** (*al*) prefixed inseparably to a word, and that is the way that it has always been written:

أَلْبَلَدُ *al-baladu* the town
أَلْعَذَابُ *al-ʿadhābu* the punishment

In fact, the definite article is in essence simply a *lām* (*l*) but as Arabic phonetic theory holds that words cannot begin with an unvoiced consonant, the vowel *a* (*fathā*) is added to the *lām* to give *al*. Theory also holds that this *a* vowel is not an integral part of the definite article and is required only when no other vowel precedes the *l*. In effect this means that the added vowel is used only at the beginning of a sentence. In other places the vowel *a* (*fathā*) is replaced by a 'joining sign' **ـَ** (*waṣla*), which tells you to link the *l* of the definite article to the final vowel of the preceding word.

In short, you will find **أَلْ** at the beginning, and **ـَ** elsewhere in the sentence/verse. The use of the two can be seen in:

الْكِتَابُ الْمُبِينُ *al-kitābu l-mubīnu*

This is the first of two pieces of manipulation required by the definite article. The second initially appears more complicated, but you will soon get used to it. The sooner you do so the better, because until you have mastered it, you will not be able to read or pronounce correctly.

1. When it precedes half of the letters of the alphabet, the *l* of the definite article is pronounced as *l*.

These letters are: ب ج ح خ ع ف ق ك م و ه ي ء.

In Arabic terminology this group of letters is known as 'the moon letters' (because the word for 'moon' begins with one of them).

With such letters a *sukūn* is written over the *l* of the definite article:

الْيَوْمُ *al-yawmu* the day
الْكِتَابُ *al-kitābu* the document

2. For words beginning with all the other letters of the alphabet the pronunciation of the *l* is assimilated to the sound of the following consonant. These letters are:

ن ل ظ ط ض ص ش س ز ر ذ د ث ت.

They are known as 'the sun letters' (the word for 'sun' beginning with one of them). With such letters a *shadda* is written over the letter after the *l* (i.e. the letter to which the *lām* is assimilated). This is a clear indication of the doubling of the sound of the following letter.

الرَّحْمَةُ *al-rahmatu (ar-rahmatu)* the mercy
الرَّسُولُ *al-rasūlu (ar-rasūlu)* the messenger

The correct form of pronunciation is the one given in brackets. However, most systems of transliteration retain the spelling of the article with *l* and expect the reader to make the correct assimilation. Thus one normally sees *al-Raḥīmu* 'the Compassionate', which has to be read and pronounced as *ar-Raḥīmu*. This convention is followed in this book.

Note that in the Qur'ān when the definite article is prefixed to a word beginning with *lam*, only one *lam* is written. Thus *al-laylu*

'the night' is written **الَّيْلُ**. This is not normally the case in modern Arabic.

With reading practice you should soon become accustomed to these rules for reading and pronouncing the definite article.

Whatever you do, you must not forget that **if a word has the definite article, it cannot also have *tanwīn***. (Words cannot be definite and indefinite at the same time.)

THE WORD **ٱللَّهُ** ALLĀHU

Allāhu 'God' is a combination of the definite article and the word **إِلَٰهٌ** *ilāhun* 'a god', with the dropping of the initial *hamza* of the noun. Literally, it means 'the God', though that is not a natural English expression and will not be used in this book. Note that in some versions of the Qur'ān *Allāhu* is written without any indication of the long vowel.

GENDER

There are two genders in Arabic: masculine and feminine.

The simplest working rule is to treat words as masculine unless you have a reason for treating them as feminine. As you proceed, you will find that words may be feminine because of form, meaning, category or convention.

From the outset you will encounter a small number of words that are feminine through meaning, such as **أُمٌّ** *umm(un)* 'mother', or through convention, such as **أَرْضٌ** *ard(un)* 'earth'.

However, the first important group of feminine words that you have to deal with are those that take the ending **ةٌ** *-atun* when indefinite [also occasionally *atu*]. A couple of these have already been mentioned. Here are examples of the definite and indefinite feminine forms together:

ٱلْأَيَّاتُ	<i>al-āyatu</i>	أَيَّاتٌ	<i>āyatun</i>
ٱلرَّحْمَةُ	<i>al-rahmatu</i>	رَحْمَةٌ	<i>rahmatun</i>

Lesson One

There are a few masculine words with this ending, but the only common one is **خَلِيفَةٌ** *khalīfatun*. In the Qur'ān this word has the strict sense of 'successor' or 'viceroy'. In later times this was generalized to 'caliph'.

This ending in *-atun* is the one most commonly used to form a feminine adjective from a masculine one:

كَبِيرٌ	كَبِيرَةٌ	m.	<i>kabīrun / al-kabīru</i>
كَبِيرَةٌ	كَبِيرَةٌ	f.	<i>kabīratun / al-kabīratu</i>
شَدِيدٌ	شَدِيدَةٌ	m.	<i>shadīdun / al-shadīdu</i>
شَدِيدَةٌ	شَدِيدَةٌ	f.	<i>shadīdatun / al-shadīdatu</i>

USE OF ADJECTIVES

An adjective used attributively follows the noun and must agree with the noun in **four** things:

1. Definiteness
2. Gender
3. Number
4. Case

You should now be able to deal with the first two:

الْفَوْزُ الْعَظِيمُ	<i>al-fawzu l-‘azīmu</i>	the great victory
الْيَوْمُ الْآخِرُ	<i>al-yawmu l-ākhiru</i>	the last day
قُرْآنٌ مُبِينٌ	<i>qur'ānun mubīnun</i>	a clear recitation
رَحْمَةٌ وَسِعَتْ	<i>rahmatun wāsi‘atun</i>	a widespread mercy

Number and case will be dealt with shortly.

SIMPLE NON-VERBAL SENTENCES

The rule about agreement in definiteness is crucial, because a definite noun followed by an indefinite adjective is a complete sentence—a subject and a predicate—not requiring a verb. Arabic is thus able to manage without a verb for 'to be' in the present

tense. Hence many sentences are complete though they have no verb.

اللَّهُ عَزِيزٌ	<i>Allāhu ‘azīzun</i>	God is mighty
اللَّهُ قَوِيٌّ	<i>Allāhu qawiyyun</i>	God is strong
اللَّهُ قَوِيٌّ عَزِيزٌ	<i>Allāhu qawiyyun ‘azīzun</i>	God is powerful and mighty

Note that in this last example it is necessary to link the adjectives in English by using ‘and’. This is not necessary in Arabic, though the particle *وَ* (*wa-*) ‘and’ could be used. Single letter words in Arabic cannot be written separately, so *wa-* is linked to the following word, as will be seen in later lessons.

LEARNING VOCABULARY

The vocabulary that accompanies each lesson is intended to include all the words you need to understand the examples in the text of the lesson and to do the translation exercise that follows it. To make progress you will have to learn the vocabulary of each lesson as you come to it, and you should learn all the forms that are given: with nouns (and adjectives) you should learn the singular and the plural together; with verbs you should learn three forms—the perfect, imperfect and *maṣḍar*—together (see Lesson 8).

Because of the limits of Qur’ānic vocabulary, one often finds only a singular form or a plural form of a word in the Qur’ān, though the corresponding plural and singular may be common elsewhere. Two good examples of this are the plural *manāfi‘u*, ‘benefits’, commonly used in the Qur’ān, whilst the singular *manfa‘atun* is not found; and *arḍun*, ‘earth’, even more common, though its plurals *arāḍin* and *aradūna* do not occur. There are similar gaps in the incidence of verb forms. These missing forms are listed in the General Vocabulary and occasionally used as examples.

VOCABULARY ONE

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
ٱللَّهُ <i>Allāhu</i>		God
إِلَٰه <i>ilāhun</i>	آلِهَةٌ <i>ālihatun</i>	a god
أَجْرٌ <i>ajrun</i>	أُجُورٌ <i>ujūrun</i>	reward
آيَةٌ <i>āyatun</i>	آيَاتٌ <i>āyātun</i>	sign, verse
بَلَدٌ <i>baladun</i>	بِلَادٌ <i>bilādun</i>	town
رَسُولٌ <i>rasūlun</i>	رُسُلٌ <i>rusulun</i>	messenger
رَحْمَةٌ <i>rahmatun</i>		mercy
عَذَابٌ <i>‘adhābun</i>		punishment
فَوْزٌ <i>fawzun</i>		victory
قُرْآنٌ <i>qur’ānun</i>		Qur’ān, recitation
كِتَابٌ <i>kitābun</i>	كُتُبٌ <i>kutubun</i>	scripture, document, book
خَلِيفَةٌ <i>khalīfātun</i>	خُلَفَاءُ <i>khulafā’u</i>	successor, viceroy, caliph
أَرْضٌ <i>arḍun (f.)</i>		earth
أُمٌّ <i>ummun</i>	أُمَمَاتٌ <i>ummahātun</i>	mother
يَوْمٌ <i>yawmun</i>	أَيَّامٌ <i>ayyāmun</i>	day
أَمِينٌ <i>amīnun</i>		faithful, secure
آخِرٌ <i>āakhirun</i>		last, [next]
شَدِيدٌ <i>shadīdun</i>	شِدَادٌ <i>shidādun</i>	strong, severe
عَزِيزٌ <i>‘azīzun</i>		mighty

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
عَظِيمٌ <i>‘azīmun</i>		great, mighty
قَوِيٌّ <i>qawīyyun</i>		strong
كَبِيرٌ <i>kabīrun</i>		big, great
كَرِيمٌ <i>karīmun</i>	كِرَامٌ <i>kirāmun</i>	noble, generous
مَجِيدٌ <i>majīdun</i>		glorious
وَاسِعٌ <i>wāsi‘un</i>		wide, ample
مُبِينٌ <i>mubīnun</i>		clear
أَوَّلٌ <i>awwalu</i>	أَوَّلُونَ <i>awwalūna</i>	first
أُولَى <i>ūlā (f.)</i>		
آخِرٌ <i>ākharu</i>	آخِرُونَ <i>ākharūna</i>	other
أُخْرَى <i>ukhrā (f.)</i>	أُخَرٌ <i>ukharu</i>	

EXERCISE ONE

1. الْكِتَابُ الْمُبِينُ *al-kitābu l-mubīnu* [12:1]
2. كِتَابٌ مُبِينٌ *kitābun mubīnun* [5:15]
3. كِتَابٌ كَرِيمٌ *kitābun karīmun* [27:29]
4. قُرْآنٌ مُبِينٌ *qur’ānun mubīnun* [15:1]
5. الْقُرْآنُ الْمَجِيدُ *al-qur’ānu l-majīdu* [50:1]
6. قُرْآنٌ كَرِيمٌ *qur’ānun karīmun* [56:77]
7. قُرْآنٌ مَجِيدٌ *qur’ānun majīdun* [85:21]
8. الْقُرْآنُ الْعَظِيمُ *al-qur’ānu l-‘azīmu* [15:87]

Exercise One

9.	رَحْمَةً وَسِعَةً	<i>rahmatun wāsi'atun</i>	[6:147]
10.	آيَةً أُخْرَى	<i>āyatun ukhrā</i>	[20:22]
11.	الْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ	<i>al-yawmu l-ākhiru</i>	[2:126]
12.	يَوْمٍ كَبِيرٍ	<i>yawmun kabīrun</i>	[11:3]
13.	الْعَذَابِ الشَّدِيدِ	<i>al-‘adhābu l-shadīdu</i>	[10:70]
14.	يَوْمٍ عَظِيمٍ	<i>yawmun ‘azīmun</i>	[6:15]
15.	عَذَابٍ شَدِيدٍ	<i>‘adhābun shadīdun</i>	[3:4]
16.	أَجْرٍ عَظِيمٍ	<i>ajrun ‘azīmun</i>	[3:172]
17.	أَجْرٍ كَرِيمٍ	<i>ajrun karīmun</i>	[57:11]
18.	عَذَابٍ عَظِيمٍ	<i>‘adhābun ‘azīmun</i>	[2:7]
19.	أَجْرٍ كَبِيرٍ	<i>ajrun kabīrun</i>	[11:11]
20.	رَسُولٍ أَمِينٍ	<i>rasūlun amīnun</i>	[26:107]
21.	رَسُولٍ كَرِيمٍ	<i>rasūlun karīmun</i>	[44:17]
22.	الْبَلَدِ الْأَمِينِ	<i>al-baladu l-amīnu</i>	[95:3]
23.	إِلَهِ آخِرٍ	<i>ilāhun ākharu</i>	[15:96]
24.	رَسُولٍ مُبِينٍ	<i>rasūlun mubīnun</i>	[43:29]
25.	الْأَوَّلِ وَالْآخِرِ	<i>al-auwalu wa-l-ākhiru</i>	[57:3]
26.	الْأُولَى وَالْآخِرَةَ	<i>al-ūlā wa-l-ākhiratu</i>	[28:70]
27.	اللَّهُ عَزِيزٌ	<i>Allāhu ‘azīzun</i>	[2:209]
28.	اللَّهُ قَوِيٌّ	<i>Allāhu qawiyyun</i>	[8:52]
29.	اللَّهُ قَوِيٌّ عَزِيزٌ	<i>Allāhu qawiyyun ‘azīzun</i>	[58:21]
30.	الْقَوِيَّ الْأَمِينُ	<i>al-qawiyyu l-amīnu</i>	[28:26]

Lesson Two

Plurals

Arabic has two types of plural, known as sound plurals and broken plurals. In general, broken plurals are much more common than sound plurals. However, in the Qur'ān, the proportion of sound plurals is considerably higher than it is in later Arabic.

SOUND PLURALS

There are masculine and feminine sound plurals. These are indicated by word endings. Words with sound plurals are analogous to *house/houses* and *ox/oxen* in English.

Masculine sound plural

	SINGULAR		PLURAL
ظَالِمٌ	<i>ẓālimun</i>	ظَالِمُونَ	<i>ẓālimūna</i>
تَوَّابٌ	<i>taurwābun</i>	تَوَّابُونَ	<i>taurwābūna</i>
أَعْجَمِيٌّ	<i>a'jamiyyun</i>	أَعْجَمِيُّونَ	<i>a'jamiyyūna</i>

The masculine sound plural is very restricted in use. The only three common categories of words that take it are: participles, or nouns that were originally participles, like ظَالِمٌ *ẓālimun* 'wrongdoer'; words of the same form as تَوَّابٌ *taurwābun* 'relenting', most of which now refer to professions and occupations, though in the Qur'ān they normally have an intensive meaning; and relative adjectives like أَعْجَمِيٌّ *a'jamiyyun*.

There are a few words in the Qur'ān that are feminine singulars, ending in *-atun* but nevertheless have a sound masculine

plural. The only common word is **سَنَةٌ** *sanatun* 'a year', with the plural **سِنُونٌ** *sinūna*—though in modern Arabic **سِنُونٌ** has been superseded by the sound feminine plural **سَنَوَاتٌ** *sanawātun*.

Feminine sound plural

This is particularly, though not entirely, associated with the feminine singular ending in *-atun*.

SINGULAR	PLURAL
مُؤْمِنَةٌ <i>mu'minatun</i>	مُؤْمِنَاتٌ <i>mu'minātun</i>
آيَةٌ <i>āyatun</i>	آيَاتٌ <i>āyātun</i>

However, you cannot assume that all words ending in **ة** take a sound feminine plural. Many do not. Conversely, there are some words that have a sound feminine plural form though the singular gives no indication that this might be so, e.g. **سَمَاءٌ** *samā'un*, plural **سَمَآوَاتٌ** *samāwātun*.

BROKEN PLURALS

Broken plurals are formed by a change of vowel pattern from the singular to plural. Words with broken plurals are analogous to *mouse/mice* and *foot/feet* in English. The vast majority of Arabic nouns and a fair number of adjectives have broken plurals; and there are many forms of broken plural. Eventually you will find that, within certain limits, experience allows you to predict from the singular of the noun what the broken plural form is likely to be. At the outset it is impossible to make such predictions.

SINGULAR	PLURAL
عَبْدٌ <i>‘abdun</i>	عِبَادٌ <i>‘ibādun</i>
قَرْنٌ <i>qarnun</i>	قُرُونٌ <i>qurūnun</i>
فَكِيهَةٌ <i>fākihatun</i>	فَوَكِهٌ <i>fawākihu</i>
كِتَابٌ <i>kitābun</i>	كُتُبٌ <i>kutubun</i>

رَجُلٌ	<i>rajulun</i>	رِجَالٌ	<i>rijālun</i>
قَرْيَةٌ	<i>qaryatun</i>	قُرْآنٌ	<i>quran</i> ^A

There is a crucial grammatical rule that you must remember:

BROKEN PLURALS are treated grammatically as **feminine singulars**, unless they refer to male persons, when they are treated as masculine plurals (or to female persons, when they are treated as feminine plurals).

Thus قُرُونٌ *qurūnun*, فَوَاحِيهُ *fawākihū*, قُرْآنٌ *quran* and كُتُبٌ *kutubun* are all feminine singulars; and adjectives agreeing with them and similar nouns must, in all normal circumstances, be in the feminine singular.

كُتُبٌ قَيِّمَةٌ	<i>kutubun qayyimatun</i>	valuable documents
مَنْفَعٌ كَثِيرَةٌ	<i>manāfi‘u kathīratun</i>	many benefits
الْقُرُونُ الْأُولَى	<i>al-qurūnu l-ūlā</i>	the first generations

However, because رِجَالٌ *rijālun* and عِبَادٌ *‘ibādun* refer to male persons, they take either a broken plural adjective form or a sound masculine plural form:

رِجَالٌ مُؤْمِنُونَ	<i>rijālun mu‘minūna</i>	believing men
عِبَادٌ مُكْرَمُونَ	<i>‘ibādun mukramūna</i>	honoured servants

There are some nouns in the Qur’ān that are singular in form but plural in meaning. These normally take plural adjectives. Prominent amongst them is قَوْمٌ *qawm*, ‘people’:

الْقَوْمُ الْكَافِرُونَ	<i>al-qawmu l-kāfirūna</i>	the unbelieving people
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^A On this form see Lesson 3

Some broken plural nouns not referring to persons also take broken plural adjectives, e.g. أَيَّامٌ أُخْرُ *ayyāmun ukharu* 'other days'.

Occasionally such nouns are also found in the Qur'ān with feminine plural adjectives, but with the passing of time this has become increasingly rare, and it is surprising when one sees this usage in modern Arabic. A common mistake for beginners is to expect that a broken plural form of an adjective may have a feminine ending added to it. This is totally impossible.

VOCABULARY TWO

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
رَجُلٌ <i>rajulun</i>	رِجَالٌ <i>rijālun</i>	man
سَمَاءٌ <i>samā'un</i>	سَمَآوَاتٌ <i>samāwātun</i>	heaven, sky
عَبْدٌ <i>'abdun</i>	عِبَادٌ <i>'ibādun</i>	servant, slave
قَرْنٌ <i>qarnun</i>	قُرُونٌ <i>qurūnun</i>	generation [horn]
قَرْيَةٌ <i>qaryatun</i>	قُرَى <i>quran</i>	settlement, village
قَوْمٌ <i>qawmun</i>	أَقْوَامٌ <i>aqwāmun</i>	people
مَنْفَعَةٌ <i>manfa'atun</i>	مَنَافِعٌ <i>manāfi'u</i>	benefit
كَافِرٌ <i>kāfirun</i>	كَافِرُونَ <i>kāfirūna</i>	unbeliever, ungrateful
مُؤْمِنٌ <i>mu'minun</i>	مُؤْمِنُونَ <i>mu'minūna</i>	believer
ظَالِمٌ <i>ẓālimun</i>	ظَالِمُونَ <i>ẓālimūna</i>	wrongdoer
أَعْجَمِيٌّ <i>a'jamiyyun</i>	أَعْجَمِيُّونَ <i>a'jamiyyūna</i>	foreign
عَرَبِيٌّ <i>'arabiyyun</i>	عَرَبٌ <i>'arabun</i>	Arab, Arabic
مُسْلِمٌ <i>muslimun</i>	مُسْلِمُونَ <i>muslimūna</i>	Muslim
نَصْرَانِيٌّ <i>naṣrāniyyun</i>	نَصَارَى <i>naṣārā</i>	Christian
يَهُودِيٌّ <i>yahūdiyyun</i>	يَهُودٌ <i>yahūdun</i>	Jew, Jewish

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
سَنَةٌ <i>sanatun</i>	سِنُونُ <i>sinūna</i>	year
فَاكِهَةٌ <i>fākihatun</i>	فَوَاكِهُ <i>fawākihu</i>	fruit
كَثِيرٌ <i>kathīrun</i>	كَثِيرُونَ <i>kathīrūna</i>	many
	كَثَارٌ <i>kithārun</i>	
تَوَّابٌ <i>tawwābun</i>	تَوَّابُونَ <i>tawwābūna</i>	relenting (s.) repenting (pl.)
مُكْرَمٌ <i>mukramun</i>	مُكْرَمُونَ <i>mukramūna</i>	honoured

EXERCISE TWO

1. إِلَهَةٌ أُخْرَى *ālihatun ukhrā* [6:19]
2. مَنَافِعُ كَثِيرَةٌ *manāfi' u kathīratun* [23:21]
3. فَوَاكِهُ كَثِيرَةٌ *fawākihu kathīratun* [23:19]
4. الْقُرُونُ الْأُولَى *al-qurūnu l-ūlā* [20:51]
5. الْقُرَى ظَالِمَةٌ *al-qurā ḡālimatun* [11:102]
6. قَرْيَةٌ ظَالِمَةٌ *qaryatun ḡālimatun* [21:11]
7. الْيَهُودُ وَالنَّصَارَى *al-yahūdu wa-l-naṣārā* [5:18]
8. السَّمَوَاتُ وَالْأَرْضُ *al-samawātu wa-l-arḍu* [15:85]
9. أَغْجَمِيٌّ وَعَرَبِيٌّ *a'jamiyyun wa-'arabiyyun* [41:44]
10. الْقَوْمُ الظَّالِمُونَ *al-qawmu l-ḡālimūna* [6:47]
11. الْقَوْمُ الْكَافِرُونَ *al-qawmu l-kāfirūna* [12:87]
12. كَافِرٌ وَمُؤْمِنٌ *kāfirun wa-mu'minun* [64:2]
13. رِجَالٌ مُؤْمِنُونَ *rijālun mu'minūna* [48:25]

Exercise Two

- | | | | |
|-----|---------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------|
| 14. | الْمُؤْمِنُونَ وَالْمُؤْمِنَاتُ | <i>al-mu'minūna wa-l-mu'minātu</i> | [24:12] |
| 15. | مُؤْمِنُونَ وَمُؤْمِنَاتُ | <i>mu'minūna wa-mu'minātun</i> | [48:25] |
| 16. | الْأَوَّلُونَ وَالْآخِرُونَ | <i>al-awwalūna wa-l-ākhirūna</i> | [56:49] |
| 17. | اللَّهُ تَوَّابٌ | <i>Allāhu tawwābun</i> | [49:12] |
| 18. | عِبَادٌ مُكْرَمُونَ | <i>'ibādun mukramūna</i> | [21:26] |
| 19. | رَجُلٌ مُؤْمِنٌ | <i>rajulun mu'minun</i> | [40:28] |
| 20. | أَيَّامٌ أُخْرَى | <i>ayyāmun ukharu</i> | [2:184] |
| 21. | السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ | <i>al-samā'u wa-l-arḍu</i> | [44:29] |
| 22. | الْمُسْلِمُونَ وَالْمُسْلِمَاتُ | <i>al-muslimūna wa-l-muslimātu</i> | [33:35] |

Lesson Three

The Declension of Nouns

Arabic has three cases: nominative, accusative and genitive. A slightly simplistic explanation of their functions covers all main points:

1. The nominative is used for the subject (in most places) and for some predicates in non-verbal sentences.
2. The genitive is used after prepositions and to denote possession.
3. The accusative is used if you cannot use the nominative or genitive.

In Lessons 1 and 2 the nominative has been used. In Lesson 4 the use of the genitive will be introduced; and in Lesson 8 the use of the accusative will be introduced.

FORMS OF DECLENSION

There are five basic types of declension, the first three of which have sub-divisions. There are also special declension forms for the sound feminine plural and the sound masculine plural. The types are set out below in tables, and it is useful to learn them as they are set out. Learning the types in this way is not the theoretical exercise it might seem to be. It helps to give structure to one's knowledge, and, as with the verb tables that come later, it is akin to learning multiplication tables for arithmetic.

Type One

Type One consists of words that have the feminine ending ة . These are the simplest forms to decline. There are two sub-divisions: a) those words which are fully inflected and have three case endings; and b) those that are not and have only two case endings. In Type One this latter sub-division is confined to proper

names. Therefore although the words in the sub-division may appear indefinite in form, they are definite in meaning. This means that any adjective attached to them has to have the definite article.

Fully inflected (3 case endings)

	Indefinite		Definite
قَرْيَةٌ	<i>qaryatun</i> nom.	الْقَرْيَةُ	<i>al-qaryatu</i>
قَرْيَةً	<i>qaryatan</i> acc.	الْقَرْيَةَ	<i>al-qaryata</i>
قَرْيَةٍ	<i>qaryatin</i> gen.	الْقَرْيَةِ	<i>al-qaryati</i>

Partially inflected

nom.	مَكَّةُ	<i>makkatu</i>
acc.	مَكَّةَ	<i>makkata</i>
gen.	مَكَّةِ	<i>makkata</i>

The crucial difference between the fully and partially inflected form here (and in Type Two) is in the genitive. This can be clearly seen when an adjective is added, *al-mukarramatu*, commonly used to describe Mecca in later times. The adjective has to have the definite article because *makkatu*, as a proper noun, is definite.

nom.	مَكَّةُ الْمَكْرَمَةُ	<i>makkatu l-mukarramatu</i>
acc.	مَكَّةَ الْمَكْرَمَةِ	<i>makkata l-mukarramata</i>
gen.	مَكَّةِ الْمَكْرَمَةِ	<i>makkata l-mukarramati</i>

Type Two

Type Two embraces most nouns and adjectives. There are two points of special note with this type:

1. An *alif* is added to the indefinite accusative form of fully inflected words:

رَجُلًا *rajulan* a man

2. Partially inflected words have the same form for the accusative and genitive when they are indefinite; but when they are definite, they act like fully inflected words and have all three case endings. You can see this by looking at the declension of:

Fully inflected

	Indefinite		Definite	
nom.	يَوْمٌ	<i>yawmun</i>	الْيَوْمُ	<i>al-yawmu</i>
acc.	يَوْمًا	<i>yawman</i>	الْيَوْمَ	<i>al-yawma</i>
gen.	يَوْمٍ	<i>yawmin</i>	الْيَوْمِ	<i>al-yawmi</i>

Partially inflected

	Indefinite		Definite	
nom.	أَسْوَدٌ	<i>aswadu</i>	الْأَسْوَدُ	<i>al-aswadu</i>
acc.	أَسْوَدًا	<i>aswada</i>	الْأَسْوَدَ	<i>al-aswada</i>
gen.	أَسْوَدٍ	<i>aswada</i>	الْأَسْوَدِ	<i>al-aswadi</i>

Type Three

Type Three consists of words whose indefinite nominative ends with *-in*. Most, though not all, come from roots with *wāw* or *yā'* as the last radical. Beginners usually find this type the most difficult to learn. Pay special attention to the endings and in particular to the sole difference between the singular and plural forms, which is in the indefinite accusative:

Singulars

	Indefinite		Definite	
nom.	وَادٍ	<i>wādin</i>	الْوَادِي	<i>al-wādī</i>
acc.	وَادِيًا	<i>wādiyan</i>	الْوَادِي	<i>al-wādiya</i>
gen.	وَادٍ	<i>wādin</i>	الْوَادِي	<i>al-wādī</i>

Plurals

	Indefinite		Definite	
nom.	جَوَارٍ	<i>jawārin</i>	الْجَوَارِي	<i>al-jawārī</i>
acc.	جَوَارِي	<i>jawāriya</i>	الْجَوَارِي	<i>al-jawāriya</i>
gen.	جَوَارٍ	<i>jawārin</i>	الْجَوَارِي	<i>al-jawārī</i>

Type Four

This consists of words ending in **أ** or **ي**. Such words do not change for case, but they lose *tanwīn* when they are definite.

	Indefinite		Definite	
	عَصَا	<i>‘aṣan</i> nom., acc., gen.	الْعَصَا	<i>al-‘aṣa</i>
	قُرْأَى	<i>quran</i> nom., acc., gen.	الْقُرْأَى	<i>al-qurā</i>

Type Five

This consists of words ending in **أ** or **ي**. Words of this type are the same whether they are definite or indefinite, and they do not change for case.

	Indefinite		Definite	
	بُشْرَى	<i>bushrā</i> nom., acc., gen.	الْبُشْرَى	<i>al-bushrā</i>
	دُنْيَا	<i>dunyā</i> nom., acc., gen.	الدُّنْيَا	<i>al-dunyā</i>

SOUND FEMININE PLURALS

Indefinite			Definite		
سَمَوَاتٍ	<i>samāwātun</i>	nom.	السَّمَوَاتُ	<i>al-samāwātu</i>	
سَمَوَاتٍ	<i>samāwātin</i>	acc.	السَّمَوَاتِ	<i>al-samāwāti</i>	
سَمَوَاتٍ	<i>samāwātin</i>	gen.	السَّمَوَاتِ	<i>al-samāwāti</i>	

SOUND MASCULINE PLURALS

Indefinite			Definite		
ظَالِمُونَ	<i>ẓālimūna</i>	nom.	الظَّالِمُونَ	<i>al-ẓālimūna</i>	
ظَالِمِينَ	<i>ẓālimīna</i>	acc.	الظَّالِمِينَ	<i>al-ẓālimīna</i>	
ظَالِمِينَ	<i>ẓālimīna</i>	gen.	الظَّالِمِينَ	<i>al-ẓālimīna</i>	

PRONOUNS: NOMINATIVE FORMS

The nominative forms of the pronouns are:

أَنَا	<i>ana</i>	I	نَحْنُ	<i>nahnu</i>	We
أَنْتَ	<i>anta</i>	You (m.s.)	أَنْتُمْ	<i>antum</i>	You (m.p.)
أَنْتِ	<i>anti</i>	You (f.s.)	أَنْتُنَّ	<i>antunna</i>	You (f.p.)
هُوَ	<i>huwa</i>	He, it	هُمْ	<i>hum</i>	They (m.p.)
هِيَ	<i>hiya</i>	She, it, they	هُنَّ	<i>hunna</i>	They (f.p.)

Notes on pronouns:

- In all normal circumstances the plural forms can refer only to persons.
- In general terms *ana* is either masculine or feminine and *nahnu* is either masculine or feminine or both. *ana* and *nahnu* are much more commonly used of males than of females but *ana* refers to a woman in 11:72 and 12:51.

Lesson Three

- c) The third feminine singular form *hiya* will commonly mean 'they', as it is the pronoun that refers to broken plurals of nouns that do not denote male persons.
- d) Despite the spelling, the second vowel of *ana* is short. The *alif* is a spelling convention only.

VOCABULARY THREE

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
جَنَّةٌ <i>jannatun</i>	جَنَّاتٌ <i>jannātun</i>	garden
جَارِيَةٌ <i>jāriyatun</i>	جَوَارٍ <i>jawārin</i>	ship, young woman
حَقٌّ <i>ḥaqqun</i>	حُقُوقٌ <i>ḥuqūqun</i>	truth; true
فِتْنَةٌ <i>fitnatun</i>	فِتَنٌ <i>fitanun</i>	affliction, temptation
بُشْرَى <i>bushrā</i>		good tidings
الدُّنْيَا <i>dunyā</i>		world
وَادٍ <i>wādin</i>		valley
عَصَا <i>‘aṣan</i>		stick, staff
نَذِيرٌ <i>nadhīrun</i>	نُذُرٌ <i>nudhurun</i>	warner
هُدًى <i>hudan</i>		guidance
مَكَّةٌ <i>makkatu</i>		Mecca
فَقِيرٌ <i>faqīrun</i>	فُقَرَاءٌ <i>fuqarā'u</i>	poor
أَسْوَدٌ <i>aswadu</i>	سُودٌ <i>sūdun</i>	black
سَوْدَاءٌ <i>sawdā'u</i> (f.)		
أَبْيَضٌ <i>abyaḍu</i>	بَيْضٌ <i>bīḍ</i>	white
بَيْضَاءٌ <i>bayḍā'u</i> (f.)		
عَالٍ <i>‘ālin</i>		high, lofty

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
عَالِيَةٌ 'āliyātun (f.)		
لَطِيفٌ laṭīfun		gentle
جَاهِلٌ jāhilun	جَاهِلُونَ jāhilūna	ignorant

EXERCISE THREE

- A. 1. أَنْتُمْ مُسْلِمُونَ antum muslimūna [2:132]
 2. هُمْ مُسْلِمُونَ hum muslimūna [27:81]
 3. نَحْنُ فِتْنَةٌ nahnu fitnatun [2:102]
 4. أَنَا نَذِيرٌ ana nadhīrun [29:50]
 5. جَنَّةٌ عَالِيَةٌ jannatun 'āliyātun [69:22]
 6. أَنْتَ التَّوَّابُ anta l-tawwābu [2:128]
 7. أَنْتُمْ ظَالِمُونَ antum ḡālimūna [2:92]
 8. أَنْتُمْ الْفُقَرَاءُ antumu l-fuqarā'u [35:15]
 9. هِيَ ظَالِمَةٌ hiya ḡālimatun [11:102]
 10. هُوَ مُؤْمِنٌ huwa mu'minun [16:97]
 11. هُوَ اللَّطِيفُ huwa l-laṭīfu [67:14]
 12. أَنْتُمْ مُؤْمِنُونَ antum mu'minūna [60:11]
 13. أَنَا اللَّهُ الْعَزِيزُ ana llāhu l-'azīzu [27:9]
 14. هِيَ بَيْضَاءُ hiya bayḍā'u [7:108]
 15. هُوَ شَدِيدٌ huwa shadīdun [13:13]
 16. أَنْتَ الْعَزِيزُ anta l-'azīzu [5:118]

Exercise Three

- | | | | |
|-----|---------------------|-----------------------|---------|
| 17. | هِيَ فِتْنَةٌ | <i>hiya fitnatun</i> | [39:49] |
| 18. | أَنْتَ نَذِيرٌ | <i>anta nadhīrun</i> | [11:12] |
| 19. | أَنْتُمْ جَاهِلُونَ | <i>antum jāhilūna</i> | [12:89] |
| 20. | أَنَا التَّوَّابُ | <i>ana l-tawwābu</i> | [2:160] |

B. Write out in Arabic the nominative, accusative and genitive of the following:

fitnatun, rijālun, jannātun, ṣālimūna, wādin, al-arḍu, jāhilun, manāfi'u, al-mu'minūna, aswadu.

Lesson Four

Prepositions

All prepositions in Arabic take the genitive case:

فِي السَّمَاءِ	<i>fi l-samā'i</i>	in the sky/heaven
إِلَى النَّارِ	<i>ilā l-nāri</i>	to the fire
عَلَى سَفَرٍ	<i>‘alā safarin</i>	on a journey
مِنْ قُرْآنٍ	<i>min qur’ānin</i>	from a recitation

Note that when *min* is followed by the article or a word beginning with *hamzat al-waṣl* it becomes *mina*:

مِنَ الْجَنَّةِ	<i>mina l-jannati</i>	from the garden
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The majority of prepositions are written separately from the word they govern, as in the above example. However, those that consist of a single letter are prefixed to the word they govern, the most important being *li-* and *bi-*:

لِأَهْلِ	<i>li-ahlin</i>	to/for a people
بِرَحْمَةٍ	<i>bi-rahmatin</i>	by a mercy

If *li-* is prefixed to a word that also has the definite article, the preposition and the article are written together as **لِلْ**:

لِلْعِبَادِ	<i>li-l-‘ibādi</i>	to/for the servants
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Note also **لِلَّهِ** *li-llāhi*, ‘to/for God’. The article after *bi-* is written in full:

بِالْوَادِي	<i>bi-l-wādī</i>	in the valley
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Note the use of *wa-* with the genitive to start an oath (see also Lesson 38):

وَاللّٰهِ *wa llāhi* by God!
وَالشَّمْسِ *wa l-shamsi* by the sun!

On the spelling of the *basmala* see Lesson 7.

A PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE AS THE PREDICATE OF A NON-VERBAL SENTENCE

- a) If the subject is definite, the subject comes first, followed by the prepositional phrase as predicate:

اللّٰهُ مَعَ الصّٰبِرِيْنَ *Allāhu ma‘a al-ṣābirīna*
God is with the patient ones
الظّٰلِمُونَ فِي ضَلٰلٍ مُّبِيْنٍ *al-ẓālimūna fī ḍalālin mubīnin*
the wrongdoers are in manifest error
الصَّدَقٰتُ لِلْفُقَرَاءِ *al-ṣadaqātu li-l-fuqarā’i*
alms are for the poor

- b) If the subject is indefinite, the prepositional phrase must come first, followed by the subject:

فِي الْاَرْضِ فَسَادٌ كَبِيْرٌ *fī l-arḍi fasādun kabīrun*
there is much corruption on earth
عَلَى الْاَعْرَافِ رِجَالٌ *‘alā l-a‘rāfi rijālun*
there are men on the heights

‘TO HAVE’

One of the most common uses of *li-* is to express the verb ‘to have’ or its equivalent in non-verbal sentences:

لِلْكَافِرِينَ عَذَابٌ *li-l-kāfirīna 'adhābun*
 (to the unbelievers a punishment)
 the unbelievers have a punishment

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ *al-ḥamdu li-llāhi*
 (the praise to God)
 praise belongs to God

VOCABULARY FOUR

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
نَارٌ <i>nārun</i> (f.)	نِيرَانٌ <i>nīrānun</i>	fire, Hell
صَدَقَةٌ <i>ṣadaqatun</i>	صَدَقَاتٌ <i>ṣadaqātun</i>	alms
عُرْفٌ <i>'urfun</i>	أَعْرَافٌ <i>a'rāfun</i>	crest, ridge, height
سَبِيلٌ <i>sabīlun</i> (f.)	سُبُلٌ <i>subulun</i>	way, road, path
سَفَرٌ <i>safarun</i>	أَسْفَارٌ <i>asfārun</i>	journey
ضَلَالٌ <i>ḍalālun</i>		error
فَسَادٌ <i>fasādun</i>		corruption
حَمْدٌ <i>ḥamdun</i>		praise
أَهْلٌ <i>ahlun</i>	أَهْلُونَ <i>ahlūna</i>	people, family, folk
شَمْسٌ <i>shāmsun</i>		sun
رَحِيمٌ <i>raḥīmun</i>		compassionate
صَابِرٌ <i>ṣābirun</i>		patient, steadfast

Exercise Four

مِنْ	<i>min</i>	from, of
فِي	<i>fī</i>	in, concerning
لِ	<i>li-</i>	to, for
بِ	<i>bi-</i>	in, at, by
عَلَى	<i>‘alā</i>	on, against
إِلَى	<i>ilā</i>	to (motion)
مَعَ	<i>ma‘a</i>	with
بَيْنَ	<i>bayna</i>	between, among

EXERCISE FOUR

- | | | | |
|-----|-------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------|
| 1. | فِي الصَّدَقَاتِ | <i>fī l-ṣadaqāti</i> | [9:58] |
| 2. | فِي ضَلَالٍ مُبِينٍ | <i>fī ḍalālin mubīnin</i> | [6:74] |
| 3. | عَلَى النَّارِ | <i>‘alā l-nāri</i> | [51:13] |
| 4. | بَيْنَ السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ | <i>bayna l-samā’i wa-l-arḍi</i> | [2:164] |
| 5. | بَيْنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ | <i>bayna l-mu’minīna</i> | [9:107] |
| 6. | بَيْنَ الْقَوْمِ | <i>bayna l-qawmi</i> | [5:25] |
| 7. | مَعَ الْقَوْمِ الظَّالِمِينَ | <i>ma‘a l-qawmi l-ẓālimīna</i> | [6:68] |
| 8. | مَعَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ | <i>ma‘a l-mu’minīna</i> | [4:146] |
| 9. | مَعَ الرَّسُولِ | <i>ma‘a l-rasūli</i> | [25:27] |
| 10. | عَلَى هُدًى | <i>‘alā hudan</i> | [22:67] |
| 11. | عَلَى الرَّسُولِ | <i>‘alā l-rasūli</i> | [29:18] |
| 12. | عَلَى الْكَافِرِينَ | <i>‘alā l-kāfirīna</i> | [16:27] |
| 13. | مِنْ سَبِيلٍ | <i>min sabīlin</i> | [42:46] |
| 14. | إِلَى بَلَدٍ | <i>ilā baladin</i> | [35:9] |

15.	إِلَىٰ عَذَابٍ عَظِيمٍ	<i>ilā 'adhābin 'aẓīmin</i>	[9:101]
16.	مِنَ الرُّسُلِ	<i>mina l-rusuli</i>	[5:19]
17.	مِنَ أَيَّامٍ آخِرَ	<i>min ayyāmin ukhara</i>	[2:185]
18.	مِنَ إِلَهِ	<i>min ilāhin</i>	[28:72]
19.	بِاللَّهِ	<i>bi-llāhi</i>	[2:67]
20.	بِالْآخِرَةِ	<i>bi-l-ākhirati</i>	[2:4]
21.	بِوَادٍ	<i>bi-wādin</i>	[14:37]
22.	بُشْرَىٰ لِلْمُسْلِمِينَ	<i>bushrā li-l-muslimīna</i>	[16:89]
23.	لِلْقَوْمِ الظَّالِمِينَ	<i>li-l-qawmi l-ẓālimīna</i>	[11:44]
24.	لِلْمُؤْمِنَاتِ	<i>li-l-mu'mināti</i>	[24:31]
25.	لِلَّهِ الْآخِرَةُ وَالْأُولَىٰ	<i>li-llāhi l-ākhiratu wa-l-ūlā</i>	[53:25]

Lesson Five

The First Person Singular Genitive Suffix and the Pronoun of Separation

FIRST PERSON SINGULAR GENITIVE SUFFIX

To express 'of me', or, as it will normally be translated, 'my', the suffix *-ī* is added to the noun. Any short final vowel (and of course *tanwīn*, if applicable) that the noun may originally have had is suppressed:

رَبِّي *rabb-ī* my Lord
عِبَادِي *‘ibād-ī* my servants

Once the *-ī* suffix has been added, there can be no variation for case. With wording ending with *ta’ marbūṭa*, this is replaced by *ta’ maftūḥa*:

حَيَاتِي *ḥayāt-ī* my life
نِعْمَتِي *ni‘mat-ī* my blessing, bounty

If the dropping of *tanwīn* before the addition of a suffix produces a long vowel or a diphthong at the end of the word, the suffix becomes *-ya*:

هُدَايَ *hudā-ya* my guidance

The genitive suffix makes the noun definite, and so any adjective attached to this noun must have the definite article:

عِبَادِي الصَّالِحُونَ *‘ibād-ī l-ṣāliḥūna* my righteous servants

If the adjective is without the definite article, it is a predicate:

عِبَادِي صَالِحُونَ *‘ibād-ī ṣāliḥūna* my servants are righteous

رَبِّي قَرِيبٌ *rabb-ī qarībun* my Lord is near
 أَرْضِي وَسِعَةً *arḍ-ī wāsi'atun* my land is wide

One will of course find similar sentences where the predicate is a prepositional phrase:

إِبْنِي مِنْ أَهْلِي *ibn-ī min ahl-ī* my son is from my people

According to the use of *li-* set out in Lesson 4, *lī* 'to me', will mean 'I have ...' or '... is mine' or '... to my credit':

لِي عَمَلِي *lī 'amal-ī* my work is to my credit
 لِي آيَةٌ *lī āyatun* I [shall] have a sign

THE PRONOUN OF SEPARATION

You have now seen how an indefinite predicate and a prepositional phrase predicate are expressed. However, one can also have definite predicates in sentences such as 'my book is the new one' or 'God is the truth'.

To separate a definite predicate from a definite subject, a third person pronoun (known as *ḍamīr al-faṣl*, the pronoun of separation) is inserted between subject and predicate:

الْكَافِرُونَ هُمُ الظَّالِمُونَ *al-kāfirūna humu l-ẓālimūna*
 (the unbelievers they the wrongdoers)
 the unbelievers are the wrongdoers

اللَّهُ هُوَ التَّوَّابُ *Allāhu huwa l-tawwābu*
 (God He the relenting)
 God is the Relenting one

عَذَابِي هُوَ الْعَذَابُ الْأَلِيمُ *'adhāb-ī huwa l-'adhābu l-'alīmu*
 (my punishment it the painful punishment)
 my punishment is the painful one

VOCABULARY FIVE

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
ابْنٌ <i>ibnun</i>	أَبْنَاءُ/بَنُونَ <i>banūna/abnā'un</i>	son
وَلِيٌّ <i>waliyyun</i>	أَوْلِيَاءُ <i>awliyā'u</i>	friend, protector
خَالِدٌ <i>khālidun</i>	خَالِدُونَ <i>khālidūna</i>	remaining in, everlasting
صَالِحٌ <i>ṣāliḥun</i>		righteous
نِعْمَةٌ <i>ni' matun</i>		blessing, bounty
أَخٌ <i>akhun</i>	إِخْوَانٌ <i>ikhwānun</i>	brother
	إِخْوَةٌ <i>ikhwatun</i>	
رَبٌّ <i>rabbun</i>	أَرْبَابٌ <i>arbābun</i>	lord
عَمَلٌ <i>ʿamalun</i>	أَعْمَالٌ <i>a' mālun</i>	work
حَسْبٌ <i>ḥasbun</i>		sufficiency, reckoning
قَرِيبٌ <i>qarībun</i>		near
سَمِيعٌ <i>samī'un</i>		hearing (adjective)
حَيَاةٌ <i>ḥayātun</i>		life
(also حَيَوَةٌ)		

EXERCISE FIVE

1. عَذَابِي شَدِيدٌ *ʿadhāb-ī shadīdun* [14:7]
2. رَبِّي رَحِيمٌ *rabb-ī raḥīmun* [11:90]
3. رَبِّي قَرِيبٌ *rabb-ī qarībun* [11:61]
4. وَلِيِّيَ اللَّهُ *waliyy-ī Allāhu* [7:196]

5.	اللَّهُ رَبِّي	<i>Allāhu Rabb-ī</i>	[3:51]
6.	ابْنِي مِنْ أَهْلِي	<i>ibn-ī min ahl-ī</i>	[11:45]
7.	عَذَابِي هُوَ الْعَذَابُ الْأَلِيمُ	<i>‘adhāb-ī huwa l-‘adhābu l-alīmu</i>	[15:50]
8.	مَعِيَ رَبِّي	<i>ma‘-ī Rabb-ī</i>	[26:62]
9.	بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَ إِخْوَتِي	<i>bayn-ī wa-bayna ikhwat-ī</i>	[12:100]
10.	حَسْبِيَ اللَّهُ	<i>ḥasb-ī llāhu</i>	[39:38]
11.	اللَّهُ هُوَ الْهُدَى	<i>Allāhu huwa l-hudā</i>	[2:120]
12.	اللَّهُ هُوَ الْحَقُّ	<i>Allāhu huwa l-ḥaqqu</i>	[22:6]
13.	رَبِّي لَطِيفٌ	<i>Rabb-ī laṭīfun</i>	[12:100]
14.	هُوَ اللَّهُ رَبِّي	<i>huwa llāhu Rabb-ī</i>	[18:38]
15.	هِيَ عَصَايَ	<i>hiya ‘aṣā-ya</i>	[20:18]
16.	اللَّهُ هُوَ السَّمِيعُ	<i>Allāhu huwa l-samī‘u</i>	[40:20]
17.	اللَّهُ هُوَ رَبِّي	<i>Allāhu huwa Rabb-ī</i>	[43:64]
18.	أَنَا وَرُسُلِي	<i>ana wa-rusul-ī</i>	[58:21]
19.	هُوَ مِنَ الْكِتَابِ	<i>huwa mina l-kitābi</i>	[3:78]
20.	هُوَ فِي ضَلَالٍ مُبِينٍ	<i>huwa fī ḍalālin mubīnin</i>	[67:29]
21.	عَذَابِي شَدِيدٌ	<i>‘adhāb-ī shadīdun</i>	[14:7]
22.	هُوَ خَالِدٌ فِي النَّارِ	<i>huwa khālidun fī l-nāri</i>	[47:15]
23.	هُوَ الْأَوَّلُ وَالْآخِرُ	<i>huwa l-auwalu wa-l-ākhiru</i>	[57:3]
24.	أَنَا مِنَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ	<i>ana mina l-muslimīna</i>	[10:90]
25.	أَجْرِي عَلَى اللَّهِ	<i>ajr-ī ‘alā llāhi</i>	[11:29]

Lesson Six

Demonstratives

هَذَا ^A	This	m.s.	ذَلِكَ	That
هَذِهِ	This, these	f.s.	تِلْكَ	That, those
هَؤُلَاءِ	These	pl.	أُولَئِكَ	Those

Demonstratives are used **either** as pronouns **or** adjectivally.

In the Qur'ān the only forms that are used at all frequently as adjectives are *hādhā* and *hādhihi*. *dhālika*, *tilka*, *hā'ulā'i* and *ulā'ika* are usually used as pronouns, and only occasionally are they used adjectivally.

Some alternative forms of *dhālika* are found: ذَلِكُمْ *dhālikum* etc. The apparent change of the 'final pronoun' is due to the context.

Occasionally instead of *hā'ulā'i* the simple أُولَئِ is found. Despite the spelling, the first vowel is short, as it is in *ulā'ika*.

ADJECTIVAL USE

The demonstrative **precedes the noun and is linked to it by the definite article**:

هَذَا الْقُرْآنُ	this recitation
هَذِهِ النَّارُ	this fire
هَذِهِ الْأَنْهَارُ	these rivers
هَؤُلَاءِ الْقَوْمُ	these people
ذَلِكَ الْكِتَابُ	that book

^A From here onwards, Arabic text will normally be given without transliteration.

هَذِهِ الْقَرْيَةُ	this settlement
تِلْكَ الْقُرَى	those settlements
أُولَئِكَ الْأَحْزَابُ	those parties

The three elements of demonstrative, definite article and noun form an indivisible unit. The article is the essential link between the demonstrative and the noun. If the article cannot be used, for example when the noun carries a pronoun suffix (as in 'this shirt of mine'), the demonstrative cannot precede the noun. Instead, it must follow the phrase, in apposition to it.

كِتَابِي هَذَا	this book of mine
قَمِيصِي هَذَا	this shirt of mine
يَوْمُهُمْ هَذَا	this day of theirs

The other usages of the demonstrative are pronominal:

هَذِهِ نَاقَةٌ	this is a she-camel
هَذَا أَخِي	this is my brother
هَذَا هُوَ الْحَقُّ	this is the truth
قَبْلَ هَذَا	before this
هَؤُلَاءِ بَنَاتِي	these are my daughters
أُولَئِكَ عَلَى أَثَرِي	these men are on my track
تِلْكَ أُمَّةٌ	that is a community
ذَلِكَ هُوَ الضَّلَالُ	that is the error
أُولَئِكَ هُمُ الظَّالِمُونَ	those are the wrongdoers
بَعْدَ ذَلِكَ	after that

VOCABULARY SIX

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
أُمَّةٌ	أُمَمٌ	community
ابْنَةٌ	بَنَاتٌ	daughter
شَيْءٌ	أَشْيَاءٌ	thing
دَارٌ (f.)	دُورٌ / دِيَارٌ	abode
حِزْبٌ	أَحْزَابٌ	party
أَثَرٌ	آثَارٌ	track; effect
لِسَانٌ	أَلْسِنَةٌ	tongue
نَاقَةٌ	إِبِلٌ	she-camel
نَهْرٌ	أَنْهَارٌ	river
فَضْلٌ		bounty
سِحْرٌ		magic
صِرَاطٌ		way, path
قَمِيصٌ		shirt
مُجْرِمٌ		sinner
قَلِيلٌ		few
مُسْتَقِيمٌ		straight
عَجِيبٌ		amazing, strange, wonderful
حَلَالٌ		permissible
حَرَامٌ		forbidden, sacred
بَعِيدٌ		far reaching, distant

SINGULAR

يَسِيرٌ	easy
عَسِيرٌ	difficult
قَبْلَ	before
بَعْدَ	after

The prepositions *ba'da* and *qabla* are commonly used after *min*, becoming *min ba'di* and *min qabli*. There is no change in meaning.

EXERCISE SIX

1. ذَلِكَ هُوَ الْفَضْلُ الْكَبِيرُ [42:22]
2. هَذَا حَلَالٌ وَهَذَا حَرَامٌ [16:116]
3. هَذَا نَذِيرٌ مِنَ النَّذْرِ الْأُولَى [53:56]
4. هَذَا لِسَانٌ عَرَبِيٌّ [16:103]
5. هَذَا رَحْمَةٌ مِنْ رَبِّي [18:98]
6. ذَلِكَ الْفَضْلُ مِنَ اللَّهِ [4:70]
7. هَذَا صِرَاطٌ مُسْتَقِيمٌ [3:51]
8. هَذِهِ الْحَيَاةُ [29:64]
9. تِلْكَ الدَّارُ الْآخِرَةُ [28:83]
10. هَذَا شَيْءٌ عَجِيبٌ [50:2]
11. أُولَئِكَ عَلَى هُدًى [2:5]
12. ذَلِكَ هُوَ الضَّلَالُ الْبَعِيدُ [14:18]
13. هَذِهِ سَبِيلِي [12:108]
14. ذَلِكَ يَوْمٌ عَسِيرٌ [74:9]

Exercise Six

15. أُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ [8:74]
16. هَذَا رَبِّي [6:76]
17. هَذَا سِحْرٌ مُبِينٌ [61:6]
18. ذَلِكَ عَلَى اللَّهِ يَسِيرٌ [22:70]
19. أُولَئِكَ مِنَ الصَّالِحِينَ [3:114]
20. هَؤُلَاءِ قَوْمٌ مُجْرِمُونَ [44:22]
21. أُولَئِكَ فِي جَنَّاتٍ مُكْرَمُونَ [70:35]
22. هَؤُلَاءِ قَلِيلُونَ [26:54]
23. ذَلِكَ فِي كِتَابٍ [22:70]
24. هَذَا صِرَاطِي [6:153]
25. تِلْكَ آيَاتُ اللَّهِ [3:108]
26. رَبِّي عَلَى صِرَاطٍ مُسْتَقِيمٍ [11:56]
27. لِلْكَافِرِينَ عَذَابٌ مُهِينٌ [2:90]

Lesson Seven

Idāfa

Idāfa, ‘annexation’, commonly called in European grammars ‘the Construct’, is used primarily to represent the association of one noun with another. It very frequently shows the possession of one thing by another, hence the looser, though more easily comprehensible, description of it as the ‘genitive of possession’. However, the ‘genitive’ need not be a noun. You have already been introduced to the use of the suffix for ‘my’. This pronominal suffix is fully equivalent to a noun in the genitive case. It is also possible for the ‘genitive’ to be a clause. This is a common feature in the Qur’ān and will be dealt with in Lesson 34.

The crucial points to remember are:

1. A noun that is followed by this genitive **cannot** take **either** the definite article **or** *tanwīn*. In other words, a noun can **either** take *tanwīn* **or** have the definite article **or** have a following genitive, but only one of these three.
2. In normal circumstances, a noun followed by a genitive is definite in meaning. If an indefinite meaning is required another construction must be used. (There are some exceptions to this rule, but these are rare and need not be dealt with here).
3. The following genitive itself may be definite or indefinite in meaning.
4. Nothing must intervene between the noun and the following genitive. The only apparent exception is when the genitive also has a demonstrative, but this is not a real exception because the demonstrative + article + genitive noun is an indivisible unit.
5. The strict rule about the order of adjectives, that adjectives describing the genitive come before adjectives describing any preceding noun, is not really relevant to Qur’ānic

phraseology, in which complex phrases are broken up, normally by the use of *min* or *li-* or *fī*.

Here are some examples to show how the *idāfa* works:

شَفَا حُفْرَةٍ	the edge of a pit
أَهْلُ الْكِتَابِ	the people of the book
رَبُّ الْعَالَمِينَ	the Lord of [all] created beings
رَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ	God's mercy
أَهْلُ هَذِهِ الْقَرْيَةِ	the people of this settlement
عَذَابُ يَوْمٍ عَظِيمٍ	the punishment of a mighty day

These are all the examples you need in the first instance. There is no point in spending time at this stage on the tightly knit *idāfa* phrases that one finds in later Arabic.

To express possession of a noun with an indefinite meaning, prepositional constructions with *min* and *li-* are used:

حُفْرَةٌ مِنَ النَّارِ	a pit of the Fire
طَائِفَةٌ مِنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ	a group of the faithful
نِسْوَةٌ مِنَ الْمَدِينَةِ	some women of the city
عَدُوٌّ لِي	an enemy of mine
وَلِيٌّ لِلشَّيْطَانِ	a friend of the devil

IDIOMATIC USES OF *idāfa*

Idiomatic uses of *idāfa* are common in the Qur'ān, as indeed they are in all Arabic. Among the uses that you will come across frequently are:

1. The use of two nouns in *idāfa* to represent an idea that has to be translated as a noun and a qualifying adjective:

قَوْمٌ سَوَاءٌ	people of evil = an evil people
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2. The use of certain words, such as *umm*, *ab*, *ibn*, *ahl*, *ṣāhib* and *dhū* (accusative *dhā*, genitive *dhī* found only with a following genitive, see also Lesson 34) to represent a single idea:

ابْنُ السَّبِيلِ son of the road = traveller

أَهْلُ بَيْتٍ family of a house = a household

ذُو الْفَضْلِ possessed of bounty = bountiful

All these words, apart from *dhū*, can have their full meaning:

أَصْحَابُ النَّارِ the inhabitants of Hell

[This is not a full list of such words, but it is enough to introduce the idiomatic phrases in which they are used.]

Idāfa AND THE SOUND MASCULINE PLURAL

Sound masculine plurals with a following genitive lose the final *nūn* + *fatha* of the sound masculine plural. This is best shown with the word *ulū*, which is a plural equivalent of *dhū* and is found only with a following genitive:

أُولُو الْأَلْبَابِ nom. men of understanding
(lit. possessors of hearts)

أُولِيَ الْأَبْصَارِ acc., gen. men of insight
(lit. possessors of sight)

Note also *banū isrā'īla* (nom.), *banī isrā'īla* (acc., gen.), the 'Children of Israel'. Other examples, apart from some with pronominal suffixes, are rare and need not be mentioned here.

THE *basmala*

All the *sūras* in the Qur'ān, apart from *Sūra* 9, are prefaced by the formula 'In the name of the Merciful and Compassionate God'.

In this formula alone the *alif* of the word 'name' **إِسْمٌ** is dropped giving:

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

VOCABULARY SEVEN

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
الرَّحْمَنُ		the Merciful
	الْعَالَمِينَ	created beings
	(gen. pl. only)	
شَفَا		lip, rim, edge
حُفْرَةٌ		pit
أَبٌ	آبَاءٌ	father
صَاحِبٌ	أَصْحَابٌ	companion, inhabitant
طَائِفَةٌ		group, number, party
إِمْرَأَةٌ	نِسَاءٌ/نِسْوَةٌ	woman
أَمْرٌ	أُمُورٌ	affair, matter, command
إِنْسَانٌ	النَّاسُ	man; people (pl.)
ذُو	أُولُو	possessor of
إِسْمٌ	أَسْمَاءٌ	name
	الْأَبَابُ	hearts, intellects
بَصَرٌ	أَبْصَارٌ	sight; eye
يَدٌ (f.)	أَيْدٍ	hand

SINGULAR

PLURAL

عَدُوٌّ	أَعْدَاءُ	enemy
شَيْطَانٌ	شَيَاطِينُ	devil
سَوْءٌ		evil
عَاقِبَةٌ		end, consequence
مَدِينَةٌ	مُدُنٌ	city
بَيْتٌ	بُيُوتٌ	house

EXERCISE SEVEN

1. فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ [2:154]
2. بَنَاتُ الْأَخِ [4:23]
3. قَلِيلٌ مِنَ الْآخِرِينَ [56:14]
4. سَبِيلُ الْمُجْرِمِينَ [6:55]
5. الْفَضْلُ بِيَدِ اللَّهِ [3:73]
6. أَيْدِي النَّاسِ [30:41]
7. آيَاتُ الرَّحْمَنِ [19:58]
8. أَرْضُ اللَّهِ وَاسِعَةٌ [4:97]
9. هَذِهِ نَاقَةُ اللَّهِ [7:73]
10. قَبْلَ يَوْمِ الْحِسَابِ [38:16]
11. أُولَئِكَ حِزْبُ الشَّيْطَانِ [58:19]
12. اللَّهُ ذُو الْفَضْلِ الْعَظِيمِ [57:29]
13. كَثِيرٌ مِنَ النَّاسِ [22:18]

Exercise Seven

14. أُولَئِكَ أَصْحَابُ النَّارِ [2:81]
15. اللَّهُ عَدُوٌّ لِلْكَافِرِينَ [2:98]
16. أَثَارُ رَحْمَةِ اللَّهِ [30:50]
17. أَنَا أَوَّلُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ [7:143]
18. رَبُّ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ [44:7]
19. طَائِفَةٌ مِنْ أَهْلِ الْكِتَابِ [3:69]
20. طَائِفَةٌ مِنْ بَنِي إِسْرَائِيلَ [61:14]
21. اللَّهُ وَلِيُّ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ [3:68]
22. إِلَى اللَّهِ عَاقِبَةُ الْأُمُورِ [31:22]
23. فِتْنَةٌ فِي الْأَرْضِ وَفَسَادٌ كَبِيرٌ [8:73]
24. عَلَى شَفَا حُفْرَةٍ مِنَ النَّارِ [3:103]
25. الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ [1:2]

Lesson Eight

The Perfect Tense

Now that you are aware of the basic uses of the nominative and genitive, it is time to turn to the accusative. The best way to introduce the accusative is through the verb, since most verbs have their direct object in the accusative.

The vast majority of verbs in Arabic are **triliteral verbs**, which means that they have a root made of three radicals. Some verbs have four radicals, and are called **quadriliteral verbs**. These are not common in the Qur'ān and are dealt with very briefly in Lesson 15.

The verb has two main tenses, the *māḍī* and the *muḍāri'*. The *māḍī* is usually known in English as the 'perfect' tense. It normally indicates a completed action or state, and is translated into English as a past tense.

The first class of verbs to be dealt with is that of 'the sound verbs'. These are verbs that do not have a *wāw*, or a *yā'* or a *hamza* as one of their radicals, and do not have the same letter as both second and third radical. Although sound verbs need to be understood first, you should be aware that a fair number of verbs have different forms and conjugations because they have one or more weak radicals or doubled radicals. In fact, the two most common verbs in the Qur'ān, قَالَ *qāla*, 'to say' and كَانَ *kāna* 'to be', are verbs that have a *wāw* as their middle radical. These two verbs will be introduced gradually in Lessons 12, 15, 18 and 20.

SOUND VERBS

Let us take the example of the verb 'to write', whose three radical consonants are *k-t-b*. In a dictionary, the verb is listed under its radical in its simplest form, *kataba*, meaning 'he wrote'. The *māḍī* of *kataba* conjugates as follows:

Lesson Eight

	SINGULAR	PLURAL
3 m.	كَتَبَ	كَتَبُوا
3 f.	كَتَبَتْ	كَتَبْنَ
2 m.	كَتَبْتُمْ	كَتَبْتُمْ
2 f.	كَتَبْتِ	كَتَبْتِ
I	كَتَبْتُ	كَتَبْنَا

Learn these forms by heart, and learn them well. Only four forms of the *māḍī* of *kataba* occur in the Qur'ān, but the verb is a standard example in grammars. Knowing the singular and plural of *kataba* will enable you to handle countless verb forms.

NOTES

- a) Note that before the definite article or any other word beginning with *hamzat al-waṣl* the 3 f.s. form كَتَبَتْ *katabat* becomes كَتَبَتْ *katabati*.
- b) Note also the otiose *alif* added to the end of the 3 m.p. كَتَبُوا *katabū*. The *alif* acts as a word separator and is not pronounced. There are a number of places in the Qur'ān where this *alif* is not written.
- c) The vowel of the middle radical of the *māḍī* is a variable. Most verbs have a *fatha*, as *kataba* does. However, there are a fair number of verbs that have *kasra*, including some of the most common ones in the Qur'ān, such as 'alima, sami'a, 'amila, shahida and shariba. Verbs with *ḍamma* on the second radical, such as *kabura*, are rare.
- d) As explained in Lesson 1, the vocabularies will give the 3 m.s. of the perfect, the 3 m.s. of the imperfect and the verbal noun (*maṣḍar*) of every verb. The best practice is to learn the three forms together, even at this stage, when the imperfect and the *maṣḍar* have yet to be explained. Wherever possible, all three

forms are given in this book, whether the imperfect or the *maṣḍar* occurs in the Qur'ān or not.

USE OF THE VERB

At this stage the verb may be divided into three kinds: those that are linked to an object by the accusative (transitive verbs); those that are linked to an object by a preposition (e.g. the verb *naẓara* 'to look'—*naẓara ilā* 'to look at' and *naẓara fī* 'to look into'); and those that do not have an object (intransitive verbs). As in English some verbs that are basically transitive (e.g. 'to enter', as in 'he entered the house') may also be used intransitively ('he entered', with no object specified). A transitive verb may take more than one accusative in Arabic.

1. The direct object is placed in the accusative:

بَلَغَ مَغْرِبَ الشَّمْسِ	he reached the place where the sun set
سَمِعْتُمْ آيَاتِ اللَّهِ	you heard God's signs
عَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ	they did righteous deeds
كَتَبْنَاهَا	we wrote it (f.)

2. The most common word order in a sentence with a verb is:

1. Verb 2. Subject 3. Object 4. Adverbial phrase

However, the Qur'ān contains so many sentences in which this order is varied that you should note it only as a general point. The basic rule for the Qur'ān is that the verb will come first unless there is a reason for it not to do so. (What these reasons are will be set out later.)

3. a. If the verb precedes the subject, the verb normally agrees with the subject in gender, **but the verb must be in the singular no matter what the number of the subject is.**

كَرِهَ الْمُجْرِمُونَ	the sinners were reluctant
قَالَ الظَّالِمُونَ	the wrongdoers said

- b. There are some examples where a feminine subject is preceded by a masculine verb. This is a standard feature of early Arabic, which has never entirely disappeared:

كَانَ صَلَاتُهُمْ [8:35] their prayer was...
 قَالَ نِسْوَةٌ [12:30] some women said...
 ذَهَبَ آلِصَيَّاتُ [11:10] the ills have gone

4. If the verb follows the subject, it agrees both in number and gender.

أُولَئِكَ يَيْئِسُوا مِن رَّحْمَتِي [29:23]^A
 these have despaired of my mercy
 وَاللَّهُ أَمَرَنَا بِهَا [7:28]
 and God has ordered us [to do it]

5. The verb has an active participle and a passive participle. The active participle of *kataba* is كَاتِبٌ *kātibun* and the passive participle is مَكْتُوبٌ *maktūbun*. Up to and including Lesson 12 any participles used are treated as separate items of vocabulary.

Uses of the perfect which are not to be translated by a past tense will be dealt with later.

VOCABULARY EIGHT

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
بَعَثَ	يَبْعَثُ	بَعْثٌ	to send, raise
بَلَغَ	يَبْلُغُ	بُلُوغٌ	to reach
جَعَلَ	يَجْعَلُ	جَعْلٌ	to make, assign, appoint

^A For verbs with *hamza* as a radical see Lesson 22.

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
حَمَلَ	يَحْمِلُ	حَمْلٌ	to carry
خَلَقَ	يَخْلُقُ	خَلْقٌ	to create
دَخَلَ	يَدْخُلُ	دُخُولٌ	to enter
ذَكَرَ	يَذْكُرُ	ذِكْرٌ	to mention
ذَهَبَ	يَذْهَبُ	ذَهَابٌ	to go away
سَمِعَ	يَسْمَعُ	سَمْعٌ	to hear
شَرِبَ	يَشْرَبُ	شُرْبٌ	to drink
شَهِدَ	يَشْهَدُ	شَهَادَةٌ	to witness
ضَرَبَ	يَضْرِبُ	ضَرْبٌ	to strike, coin, journey
عَمِلَ	يَعْمَلُ	عَمَلٌ	to do, work
كَتَبَ	يَكْتُبُ	كِتَابَةٌ	to write
وَجَدَ	يَجِدُ	وُجُودٌ	to find
وَعَدَ	يَعِدُ	وَعْدٌ	to promise
رَجَعَ	يَرْجِعُ	رُجُوعٌ	to return
ظَهَرَ	يُظْهِرُ	ظُهُورٌ	to appear
كَرِهَ	يَكْرَهُ	كَرَاهَةٌ	to be reluctant, hate
لَبِثَ	يَلْبِثُ	لَبْثٌ	to tarry, linger

SINGULAR

PLURAL

سَيِّئَةٌ

سَيِّئَاتٌ

evil, ill

قَمَرٌ

moon

ضِيَاءٌ

light, illumination

Exercise Eight

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
نُورٌ	أَنْوَارٌ	light
مَثَلٌ	أَمْثَالٌ	likeness, parallel
مَظْلِعٌ		rising-place
مَغْرِبٌ	مَغَارِبٌ	setting-place
بَرٌّ		land
بَحْرٌ	بِحَارٌ	sea
حَمْلٌ		load
يَوْمُ الْبَعْثِ		Day of Resurrection
الزَّبُورُ		the Psalms
خَفِيفٌ		light (adj.)

EXERCISE EIGHT

1. دَخَلَ الْمَدِينَةَ [28:15]
2. دَخَلُوا قَرْيَةً [27:34]
3. جَعَلَ الشَّمْسُ ضِيَاءً وَالْقَمَرَ نُورًا [10:5]
4. بَعَثَ اللَّهُ رَسُولًا [25:41]
5. حَمَلَتْ حَمْلًا خَفِيفًا [7:189]
6. خَلَقَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ [7:54]
7. خَلَقَ اللَّهُ ذَلِكَ [10:5]
8. خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ [90:4]
9. ذَكِّرُوا اللَّهَ [3:135]
10. رَجَعْنَا إِلَى الْمَدِينَةِ [63:8]

11. رَجَعْتُمْ [9:94]
12. ضَرَبَ اللَّهُ مَثَلًا [39:29]
13. ضَرَبْتُمْ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ [4:94]
14. لَبِثُوا فِي الْعَذَابِ الْمُهِينِ [34:14]
15. لَبِثْتُمْ فِي كِتَابِ اللَّهِ إِلَى يَوْمِ الْبَعْثِ [30:56]
16. كَتَبْنَا فِي الزَّبُورِ مِنْ بَعْدِ الذِّكْرِ [21:105]
17. وَجَدَ قَوْمًا [18:93]
18. وَجَدْتُ امْرَأَةً [27:23]
19. وَجَدُوا اللَّهَ تَوَّابًا [4:64]
20. وَعَدَ اللَّهُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَالْمُؤْمِنَاتِ جَنَّاتٍ [9:72]
21. بَلَغَ مَطْلِعِ الشَّمْسِ [18:90]
22. ظَهَرَ أَمْرُ اللَّهِ [9:48]
23. ظَهَرَ الْفَسَادُ فِي الْبَرِّ وَالْبَحْرِ [30:41]
24. بَعَثْنَا فِي كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ رَسُولًا [16:36]

Lesson Nine

Pronominal suffixes

FIRST PERSON SINGULAR

In the first person singular, the accusative and genitive suffixes are distinct and are not interchangeable. We have already dealt with the first person singular genitive suffix $-ī$ in Lesson 5. The accusative suffix is $-nī$.

بَلَغَنِي it reached me
أَمَرْتَنِي you ordered me

With other persons, the suffix is the same for both accusative and genitive.

SECOND PERSON SINGULAR

m + noun كِتَابُكَ your book
m + verb وَجَدَكَ he found you
f + noun ذَنْبُكِ your sin
f + verb طَهَّرَكَ he has purified you

THIRD PERSON SINGULAR

m + noun يَدُهُ his hand
m + verb رَفَعْنَاهُ We raised it
f + noun وَلَدُهَا her child
f + verb وَعَدَهَا he promised it (f.)

Note that if the 3 m.s. suffix is preceded immediately by *i*, *ī*, or *ay*, the form changes to *-hi*:

فِيهِ in it
لِأَهْلِهِ to its folk
بِرَحْمَتِهِ through His mercy

If any letter comes between these vowels and the suffix, the rule does not apply, e.g. مِنْهُ *min-hu*.

PLURAL FORMS

First person + noun	نَصْرُنَا	our help
First person + verb	بَعَثْنَا	he sent us
Second person m + noun	قَرْيَتُكُمْ	your village
Second person m + verb	نَصَرَكُمْ	he helped you
Second person f + noun	بُيُوتُكُنَّ	your houses
Second person f + verb ^A	طَلَّقَكُنَّ	he divorced you
Third person m + noun	رَبُّهُمْ	their Lord
Third person m + verb	أَخَذَهُمْ	he seized them
Third person f + noun	أَوْلَادُهُنَّ	their children
Third person f + verb	خَلَقَهُنَّ	he created them

Note that the vowel change from *u* to *i* that occurs with the 3 m.s. suffix also applies to the two plural suffixes:

إِلَى قَوْمِهِمْ to their people
بَيْنَ أَيْدِيهِمْ وَأَرْجُلِهِمْ between their hands and feet

^A For these verbs see Lesson 15. There are few examples of this suffix with verbs.

Before *hamzat al-waṣl*, *hum* and *kum* become *humu* and *kumu*.

ALTERATIONS TO VERB FORMS WHEN SUFFIXES ARE ATTACHED

1. The otiose *alif* of the 3 m.p. is dropped:

نَصَرُوهُ they helped him

2. The end of the 2 m.p. becomes *-tumū*:

سَمِعْتُمُوهُ you heard it

عَلِمْتُمُوهُمْ you recognised them (f.)

ALTERATIONS TO PREPOSITIONS WHEN SUFFIXES ARE ATTACHED

1. *إِلَى ilā* and *عَلَى ‘alā* become *ilay-* and *‘alay-*:

إِلَيْهِ	<i>ilay-ya</i>	إِلَيْنَا	<i>ilay-nā</i>
إِلَيْكَ	<i>ilay-ka</i>	عَلَيْكُمْ	<i>‘alay-kum</i>
عَلَيْكَ	<i>‘alay-ki</i>	إِلَيْكُمْ	<i>ilay-kunna</i>
إِلَيْهِ	<i>ilay-hi</i>	عَلَيْهِمْ	<i>‘alay-him</i>
عَلَيْهَا	<i>‘alay-hā</i>	إِلَيْهِنَّ	<i>ilay-hinna</i>

2. *li-* with the suffix *-ī* becomes *lī*. Before all other suffixes *li-* becomes *la-*: لَهُ *lahu*, لَهُمْ *lahūm*, لَنَا *lanā*, etc.
3. With the first person singular suffix the prepositions مِنْ *min* and عَنْ *‘an* become مِنِّي *minnī* and عَنِّي *‘annī*, respectively.

VOCABULARY NINE

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
أَخَذَ	يَأْخُذُ	أَخْذٌ	to take, seize
أَمَرَ	يَأْمُرُ	أَمْرٌ	to order
تَبَعَ	يَتَّبِعُ	تَبَعٌ	to follow
خَرَجَ	يَخْرُجُ	خُرُوجٌ	to go out
رَفَعَ	يَرْفَعُ	رَفْعٌ	to raise
سَأَلَ	يَسْأَلُ	سُؤَالٌ	to ask
فَعَلَ	يَفْعَلُ	فَعْلَةٌ	to do
كَذَبَ	يَكْذِبُ	كِذْبٌ	to tell lies
نَصَرَ	يَنْصُرُ	نَصْرٌ	to help
عَلِمَ	يَعْلَمُ	عِلْمٌ	to know

SINGULAR

PLURAL

إِذْنٌ		permission
نَهْرٌ	أَنْهَارٌ	river
ذَنْبٌ	ذُنُوبٌ	sin
لَعْنَةٌ		curse
سَلَامٌ		peace
(f.) رِجْلٌ	أَرْجُلٌ	foot
(f.) نَفْسٌ	أَنْفُسٌ	soul, self
وَلَدٌ	أَوْلَادٌ	child

Exercise Nine

خِلَالِ	through
عَنْ	away from; concerning

EXERCISE NINE

1. مِنْ آلِهِ وَرَسُولِهِ [2:279]
2. هُنَّ أُمَّهَاتُهُمْ [58:2]
3. فَعَلْتَ فَعَلْتَكَ [26:19]
4. جَعَلَ خِلَالَهَا أَنْهَارًا [27:61]
5. خَرَجُوا مِنْ دِيَارِهِمْ [2:243]
6. خَرَجْنَا مَعَكُمْ [9:42]
7. الْأَمْرُ بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَكُمْ [6:58]
8. عَلَيْكَ لَعْنَتِي [38:78]
9. جَعَلْنَا آتَنَ مَرْيَمَ وَأُمَّهُ آيَةً [23:50]
10. نَصَرَكُمُ اللَّهُ يَبْدِرُ [3:123]
11. رَجِعُوا إِلَيْهِمْ [9:122]
12. الْأَمْرُ إِلَيْكَ [27:33]
13. كَذَبُوا عَلَى أَنْفُسِهِمْ [6:24]
14. تَبِعَ هُدَايَ [2:38]
15. سَأَلْتُمُوهُنَّ [33:53]
16. بِإِذْنِ رَبِّهِ [7:58]
17. نِعْمَتِي عَلَيْكُمْ [2:150]

18. دَخَلْتُمُوهُ [5:23]
19. بِإِذْنِ أَهْلِيهِ [4:25]
20. سَأَلَهَا قَوْمٌ مِّن قَبْلِكُمْ [5:102]
21. سَأَلَكَ عِبَادِي عَنِّي [2:186]
22. تَبِعَكَ [7:18]
23. تَبِعَنِي [14:36]
24. رَفَعَهُ اللَّهُ إِلَيْهِ [4:158]
25. سَلَامٌ عَلَيْكُمْ كَتَبَ رَبُّكُمْ عَلَى نَفْسِهِ الرَّحْمَةَ [6:54]
26. دَخَلَ جَنَّتُهُ [18:35]
27. أَخَذَهُمُ اللَّهُ بِذُنُوبِهِمْ [3:111]

Lesson Ten

The particle *mā*

There is very little of the Qur'ān that you can read without coming across *mā*, as it occurs over 2,000 times in the text. It is traditional to talk about the particle *mā* as a particle having various uses. In reality it is a series of words that have evolved into the same form. Most of these occur in the Qur'ān. Here are notes on the two most frequent, and most important, ones.

NEGATION WITH *mā*

1. *mā* is put in front of the perfect verb to negate the *māḍī*. This is the standard usage throughout the ages:

مَا لَبِثَ he did not tarry
مَا ظَلَمُونَا they did not wrong us
مَا مَنَعَنَا he did not prevent us

2. *mā* is also used to negate nominal sentences. This occurs much more frequently in the Qur'ān than it does in later Arabic. In the negation of nominal sentences *mā* is frequently followed by the subject in the nominative, as one would expect, but the predicate is then introduced by *bi-* with the genitive. This is an archaic usage, known to the Arab grammarians as the 'Hijāzī *mā*', as it was a feature of the Arabic of western Arabia. Here are two examples:

مَا هُوَ بِمَيِّتٍ he is not dead
مَا صَاحِبُكُمْ بِمَجْنُونٍ your companion is not possessed

Much less frequently the Hijāzī *mā* has its predicate in the accusative:

مَا هَذَا بَشَرًا this is not a human being

If *mā* is followed at a relatively short distance by *illā* 'except', it will be negative, the combined sense of the *mā* and the *illā* being 'only'.

مَا أَنْتُمْ إِلَّا بَشَرٌ you are only men

مَا مِنَّا إِلَّا لَهُ مَقَامٌ مَعْلُومٌ everyone of us [will] have a known station

مَا مِنْ إِلَهِ إِلَّا اللَّهُ there is no god but God

From time to time the negative *mā* is followed by a phrase that begins with *min*, the *min* being partitive and giving the sense 'any'.

مَا لِلظَّالِمِينَ مِنْ نَصِيرٍ wrongdoers have no helper

مَا لَكَ مِنْ اللَّهِ مِنْ وَلِيٍّ you have no protector against God

The phrase introduced by *min* is usually the real subject, but sometimes it is the object:

مَا عَلِمْنَا عَلَيْهِ مِنْ سُوءٍ we know no wrong against/of him

However, if you see *mā* followed shortly by *min*, do not assume that it is the negative *mā*. It may be, but, as you will shortly see, it could be the relative *mā*. Only the context will make this clear.

THE PRONOMINAL USE OF *mā*

Mā is also a relative pronoun meaning 'that which', 'what', 'whatsoever'. This is easily spotted when *mā* follows a verb or a noun.

عَلِمْتُمْ مَا فَعَلْتُمْ you knew what you did

نِصْفُ مَا تَرَكَ half of what he left

If *mā* is immediately followed by a prepositional phrase, it is likely to be the relative:

مَا فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ what is in the heavens and the earth

If *mā* follows a demonstrative, it is likely to be the relative at the start of the predicate:

هَذَا مَا وَعَدَ الرَّحْمَنُ this is what the Merciful promised

If *mā* introduces a clause after a preposition it will be the relative:

بِمَا عَمِلْتُمْ because of what you did

If a verb has its construction completed by a preposition as is the case of *amara* [أَمَرَ الرَّجُلَ بِشَيْءٍ] *amara l-rajula bi-shay'in* 'he ordered the man (accusative) to do (bi-) something', that preposition will take the 3 m.s. pronominal suffix to complete the construction and refer back to the *mā*:

مَا أَمَرْتَنِي بِهِ that which you have ordered me to do

Usually with the accusative there is no pronoun referring back to the *mā*, but occasionally the pronoun *-hu* will be found with this function.

It is quite common for the relative *mā* to be followed, with or without an intervening phrase, by *min* and a noun in the genitive. The meaning imparted by *min* is quite different from that given by *min* after the negative *mā*:

مَا ... مِنْ خَيْرٍ whatever good, such good as . . .

مَا ... مِنْ سُوءٍ whatever evil, such evil as . . .

مَا ... مِنْ عَمَلٍ whatever deed, such deeds as . . . (all) the deeds

Two sentences will show how the construction works in context:

فَرِحُوا بِمَا عِنْدَهُمْ مِنَ الْعِلْمِ [40:83]

they rejoiced in the knowledge they had

قَدِمْنَا إِلَى مَا عَمِلُوا مِنْ عَمَلٍ [25:23]

we have advanced on whatever work they have done

The notes given above should enable the reader to differentiate between the negative *mā* and the relative *mā* in most cases. In cases of doubt, context is crucial. Without it, for example, *mā* 'alima could mean either 'he did not know' or 'what he knew'. On the other hand, when the phrase *mā khalaqa llāhu* occurs in two consecutive verses [10:5 and 6], the context makes it clear that in verse 5 it is negative—it is followed by *illā*—and that in verse 6 it is relative—shown both by the preceding and following phrases.

VOCABULARY TEN

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
تَرَكَ	يَتْرُكُ	تَرْكٌ	to leave
ظَلَمَ	يَظْلِمُ	ظَلَمٌ	to do wrong
كَسَبَ	يَكْسِبُ	كَسَبٌ	to acquire, earn, gain
عَمِلَ	يَعْمَلُ	عَمَلٌ	to do, work
فَرِحَ	يَفْرَحُ	فَرَحٌ	to rejoice in
فَرَضَ	يَفْرِضُ	فَرَضٌ	to assign, prescribe
قَدِمَ	يَقْدُمُ	قُدُومٌ	to come, advance on
كَذَرَ	يَكْذِرُ	كَذْرٌ	to store
مَنَعَ	يَمْنَعُ	مَنْعٌ	to prevent
وَقَعَ	يَقَعُ	وُقُوعٌ	to fall, come to pass

Lesson Ten

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
بَشَرٌ		human being (s.); men, human beings (pl.)
سُوءٌ		evil, wrong
شَهِيدٌ	شُهَدَاءُ	witness
قَوْلٌ	أَقْوَالٌ	saying, words
	[أَقَاوِيلُ]	
مَقَامٌ		station
مُلْكٌ		sovereignty, kingdom
عِلْمٌ	عُلُومٌ	knowledge
نَاصِرٌ / نَصِيرٌ	أَنْصَارٌ	helper
نِصْفٌ		half
خَيْرٌ		good
مَجْنُونٌ		possessed (by <i>Jinn</i>)
مَعْرُوفٌ		kindness; proper
مَعْلُومٌ		known
مَيِّتٌ	مَيِّتُونَ	dead
خَلْفٌ		behind
عِنْدَ		with, in the possession of
إِلَّا		except

EXERCISE TEN

- | | | |
|-----|---|---------|
| 1. | مَا ظَلَمَهُمُ اللَّهُ | [3:117] |
| 2. | مَا جَعَلَ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ عَلَيْهِمْ سَبِيلًا | [4:90] |
| 3. | مَا ذُكِّرَ عَلَى اللَّهِ بَعْرِيزِ | [14:20] |
| 4. | مَا مِنَّا مِنْ شَهِيدٍ | [41:47] |
| 5. | وَمَا لَهُمْ مِنْ نَاصِرِينَ | [3:56] |
| 6. | مَا فَعَلُوهُ | [4:66] |
| 7. | مَا لَبِثُوا فِي الْعَذَابِ الْمُهِينِ | [34:14] |
| 8. | مَا سَأَلْتُكُمْ مِنْ أَجْرٍ | [34:47] |
| 9. | مَا عَلَيْهِمْ مِنْ سَبِيلٍ | [42:41] |
| 10. | مَا أَنَا إِلَّا نَذِيرٌ مُبِينٌ | [46:9] |
| 11. | مَا لَهُمْ بِهِ مِنْ عِلْمٍ | [53:28] |
| 12. | مَا كَتَبْنَاهَا عَلَيْهِمْ | [57:27] |
| 13. | مَا نَحْنُ بِمَسِّيَّينَ | [37:58] |
| 14. | وَجَدْنَا مَا وَعَدْنَا | [7:44] |
| 15. | مَا فَعَلْنَا فِي أَنْفُسِهِنَّ مِنْ مَّعْرُوفٍ | [2:240] |
| 16. | فِي مَا أَخَذْتُمْ | [8:68] |
| 17. | هَذَا مَا كَنَزْتُمْ لِأَنْفُسِكُمْ | [9:35] |
| 18. | مَا أَمَرَ اللَّهُ بِهِ | [13:21] |
| 19. | مَا بَيْنَ أَيْدِينَا وَمَا خَلْفَنَا | [19:64] |
| 20. | عَلِمْنَا مَا قَرَضْنَا عَلَيْهِمْ | [33:50] |

21. مَا عَمِلْتُهُ أَيْدِيهِمْ [36:35]
22. لِلّٰهِ مُلْكُ السَّمٰوٰتِ وَالْاَرْضِ وَمَا فِيْهِنَّ [5:120]
23. وَقَعَ الْقَوْلُ عَلَيْهِمْ بِمَا ظَلَمُوْا [27:85]
24. وَجَدُوْا مَا عَمِلُوْا [18:49]
25. مَا فِي الْبَرِّ وَالْبَحْرِ [6:59]
26. نِصْفَ مَا فَرَضْتُمْ [2:237]
27. ظَهَرَ الْفَسَادُ فِي الْبَرِّ وَالْبَحْرِ بِمَا كَسَبَتْ اَيْدِي النَّاسِ [30:41]

Lesson Eleven

Kull; baʿd; the accusative of time

كُلُّ *kull*

The masculine noun *kullun*, meaning ‘each’ or ‘every’, most commonly takes the indefinite genitive singular, but is also followed by an indefinite genitive plural when the plural is being used as a collective or is divisible into parts:

كُلُّ شَيْءٍ each, every thing

كُلُّ نَفْسٍ each, every soul

كُلُّ أَنْاسٍ each, every people

With the meaning ‘all’, it takes the definite genitive plural or is followed by the genitive of a singular noun that is being used as a collective or is divisible into parts.

كُلُّ الثَّمَرَاتِ all the fruits

كُلُّ الطَّعَامِ all the food

Note also كُلُّ ذَلِكَ *kullu dhālika* ‘all that’.

بَعْضُ *baʿd*

The basic construction of the masculine noun *baʿd*, meaning ‘some’, is that it takes the definite genitive plural or is followed by the genitive of a noun that is being used as a collective or is divisible into parts:

بَعْضُ الْكِتَابِ some of the book

بَعْضُ النَّبِيِّينَ some of the prophets

بَعْضُ الْأَقَاوِيلِ some of the stories

Sometimes بَعْضُ means 'one of':

بَعْضُ السَّيَّارَةِ one of the caravans

No other construction is normally allowed. However, the Qur'ān does have one phrase in which *ba'd* is followed by an indefinite genitive:

بَعْضُ يَوْمٍ part of a day

Very rarely *ba'd* is used without any following genitive (see 4:150), but this tends to be confined to phrases in which it occurs twice, first with a following genitive/pronominal suffix, then as an indefinite:

فَضَّلْنَا بَعْضَ النَّبِيِّينَ عَلَى بَعْضٍ^A

We have preferred some prophets over others

Often the construction is best translated as 'one another':

بَعْضُهُمْ أَوْلِيَاءُ بَعْضٍ they are friends of one another

The rule of agreement with phrases containing *كُلٌّ* and *بَعْضٌ* is that verbs or adjectives can agree either with *كُلٌّ* / *بَعْضٌ* themselves or with the logical subject (the following genitive). In the Qur'ān there is a strong tendency for the verb or adjective to agree with the logical subject.

كُلُّ نَفْسٍ رَهِيْنَةٌ every soul is pledged

^A On this form of the verb see Lesson 15.

In this example [74:38] the adjective رَهِيْنَةٌ agrees with the logical subject, the genitive نَفْسِ, rather than the formal grammatical subject كُلِّ.

ACCUSATIVE OF TIME

Arabic can express an adverbial phrase by putting a noun (or a phrase equivalent to a noun) into the accusative:

يَوْمًا أَوْ بَعْضَ يَوْمٍ for a day or part of a day

لَيْلًا وَنَهَارًا by night and day

أَوَّلَ مَرَّةٍ on / for the first time

This use of the accusative is common in the Qur'ān.

VOCABULARY ELEVEN

PERFECT IMPERFECT VERBAL NOUN

حَفِظَ	يَحْفَظُ	حِفْظٌ	to guard, preserve, keep
فَتَحَ	يَفْتَحُ	فَتْحٌ	to open
نَظَرَ	يَنْظُرُ	نَظَرٌ	to look at (إِلَى), into (فِي)

SINGULAR PLURAL

إِثْمٌ		sin
أَجَلٌ		term
ثَمَرَةٌ	ثَمَرَاتٌ	fruit
حَفِيظٌ	حَفَظَةٌ	guardian
رَهِيْنٌ		hostage, pledged
سَيَّارَةٌ	سَيَّارَاتٌ	caravan

Exercise Eleven

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
ظَنٌّ	ظُنُونٌ	thought, supposition, suspicion, conjecture
مَغْفِرَةٌ		forgiveness
مَكَانٌ	أَمْكِنَةٌ	place, side
لَيْلٌ	لَيَالٍ	night, night time
مَرَّةٌ	مَرَّاتٌ / مِرَارٌ	time, occasion
مَوْتٌ		death
نَهَارٌ		day, daytime
طَعَامٌ		food
نَبِيٌّ	أَنْبِيَاءٌ	prophet
بَابٌ	أَبْوَابٌ	gate, door
رَجِيمٌ		accursed
مُسْتَظَرٌّ		inscribed
صَغِيرٌ		small
قَدِيرٌ		having power over
فَوْقٌ		above, over (sometimes used as a synonym for <i>alā</i> , 'on'.)

EXERCISE ELEVEN

1. جَعَلْنَا بَغْضُكُمْ لِبَغْضٍ فِتْنَةً [25:20]
2. بَغْضُكُمْ لِبَغْضٍ عَدُوٌّ [20:123]
3. رَفَعْنَا بَعْضَهُمْ فَوْقَ بَعْضٍ [43:32]

4. بَغْضُ الظَّنِّ إِثْمٌ [49:12]
5. أُولَئِكَ بَغْضُهُمْ أَوْلِيَائُ بَغْضٍ [8:72]
6. تَرَكْنَا بَغْضَهُمْ [18:99]
7. نَظَرَ بَغْضُهُمْ إِلَى بَغْضٍ [9:127]
8. الْمُؤْمِنُونَ وَالْمُؤْمِنَاتُ بَغْضُهُمْ أَوْلِيَائُ بَغْضٍ [9:71]
9. اللَّهُ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ [5:40]
10. أَنْتَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ شَهِيدٌ [5:117]
11. فَتَحْنَا عَلَيْهِمُ أَبْوَابَ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ [6:44]
12. جَعَلْنَا لِكُلِّ نَبِيٍّ عَدُوًّا مِنَ الْمُجْرِمِينَ [25:31]
13. لِكُلِّ أُمَّةٍ أَجَلٌ [7:34]
14. الْمَوْتُ مِنْ كُلِّ مَكَانٍ [14:17]
15. ذَهَبَ كُلُّ إِلَهٍ بِمَا خَلَقَ [23:91]
16. بَعَثْنَا فِي كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ رَسُولًا [16:36]
17. رَبُّكَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ حَفِيزٌ [34:21]
18. كُلُّ نَفْسٍ بِمَا كَسَبَتْ رَهِينَةٌ [74:38]
19. وَكُلٌّ صَغِيرٌ وَكَبِيرٌ مُسْتَظَرٌّ [54:53]
20. لَهُمْ فِيهَا مِنْ كُلِّ الثَّمَرَاتِ وَمَغْفِرَةٌ [47:15]
21. كُلُّ مَا سَأَلْتُمُوهُ [14:34]
22. لَبِثْنَا يَوْمًا أَوْ بَعْضَ يَوْمٍ [18:19]
23. دَخَلُوهُ أَوَّلَ مَرَّةٍ [17:7]

Lesson Twelve

Kāna; qāla; lammā

The two most common verbs in the Qur'ān are *kāna* and *qāla*. They belong to a type of verb known as the 'hollow verb' because it has a weak letter, in the case of these two verbs a *wāw*, as the middle of three radicals (with *kāna* the radicals are *kāf*, *wāw*, *nūn*; with *qāla* they are *qāf*, *wāw*, *lām*). The weak letters *wāw* and *yā'* are in general liable to suppression or modification in such verbs and thus they have different patterns of conjugation from sound verbs like *kataba*. There are rules to govern such modifications, but it is easier and more effective to learn the verb forms thoroughly, without bothering about such rules.

كَانَ kāna

The verb *kāna* is used for those parts of the English verb 'to be' that can be expressed verbally in Arabic.

Learn the singular and plural of the *māḍī* of *kāna* from the table below and learn them well.

	SINGULAR	PLURAL
3 m.	كَانَ	كَانُوا
3 f.	كَانَتْ	كَانْنَ
2 m.	كُنْتَ	كُنْتُمْ
2 f.	كُنْتِ	كُنْتُنَّ
I	كُنْتُ	كُنَّا

Kāna has one other feature that must be mastered from the outset. Its predicate goes into the **accusative**, as though *kāna* were a **transitive verb**.

كَانَ مَرِيضًا	he was ill
كُنَّا مُؤْمِنِينَ	we were believers
مَا كَانَ إِبْرَاهِيمُ يَهُودِيًّا	Abraham was not a Jew
كَانُوا ظَالِمِينَ	they were wrongdoers

Note:

- Kāna* is not used impersonally in the way that the verb 'to be' is used in English.
- When *kāna/kānat* begins a sentence that is otherwise composed of a prepositional phrase followed by its indefinite subject, the verb simply signifies the past:

كَانَ لَهُ إِخْوَةٌ	he had brothers
كَانَ فِي قَصَصِهِمْ عِبْرَةٌ لِأُولِي الْأَلْبَابِ	in their story there was warning for men of understanding
كَانَ لَكُمْ أُسْوَةٌ حَسَنَةٌ فِي إِبْرَاهِيمَ	you have had a fine example in Abraham

The accusative will be found, but the meaning is then quite different:

كَانَ لِلنَّاسِ عَجَبًا	it has been a wonder for mankind
كَانَ فَاحِشَةً	it was an abomination

The Pluperfect

Kāna is also used with another perfect verb to represent the pluperfect. Over time, it has become ever more common for this second verb to be preceded by the particle *qad*. The construction of *kāna* with the Perfect of the second verb is to be found in the Qur'ān, but it is rare, in contrast to the common use of *kāna* with the Imperfect of the second verb (see Lesson 16). It should also be noted that, unlike the situation in later Arabic, none of the

examples of *kāna* with the Perfect has the particle *qad*, though the particle occurs over 220 times in the Qur'ān.

Although the basic meaning of *kāna* is 'he was', it is very frequently used in the Qur'ān with the sense of the present: 'he is'. This is shown most clearly by phrases referring to God: كَانَ اللَّهُ غَفُورًا رَحِيمًا means 'God is Forgiving and Compassionate'.

The use of the Perfect with a present meaning was a standard feature of early Arabic, but became less common as time went on. *Kāna* is only one of numerous verbs that exemplify this usage, but it stands out because the Imperfect of *kāna* cannot be used to express 'is'.

The Qur'ān also contains one or two idiomatic uses of *kāna*, which will be dealt with later.

قَالَ *qāla*

The verb *qāla* means 'to say' or 'to speak'. It is the main way of introducing direct speech. Its Perfect is formed in the same way as that of *kāna*:

	SINGULAR	PLURAL
3 m.	قَالَ	قَالُوا
3 f.	قَالَتْ	قَالْنَ
2 m.	قُلْتُمْ	قُلْتُمْ
2 f.	قُلْتِ	قُلْتُنَّ
I	قُلْتُ	قُلْنَا

لَمَّا *lammā*

The conjunction *lammā* means 'when', 'after'. It is used with the *māḍī* only, and indicates that the verb of the subordinate clause is prior in time to that of the main verb.

لَمَّا رَجَعَ مُوسَى إِلَى قَوْمِهِ قَالَ when Moses returned to his people, he said. . .

لَمَّا دَخَلُوا عَلَيْهِ قَالُوا when they went in to see him,
they said. . .

Note that when the verb *dakhala* is followed by the preposition 'alā, it means 'to go in to see'.

WORD ORDER

The word order at the end of a sentence is often inverted if it coincides with the end of the verse, with the inversion producing the end-of-verse assonance. It is particularly common for a prepositional phrase that depends on a verb or a participle to precede the verb or participle. For example, غَافِلٌ *ghāfil* 'heedless' takes the preposition عَنْ 'an to indicate 'of'. The simplest way of saying 'you are heedless of it' is أَنْتُمْ غَافِلُونَ عَنْهُ *antum ghāfilūna* 'an-hu. However, what one expects to find in the Qur'ān is أَنْتُمْ غَافِلُونَ عَنْهُ *antum* 'an-hu *ghāfilūna*. Similarly, مُؤْمِنٌ *mu'min* 'believer' takes بِ *bi-* to indicate 'in'. 'You are believers in it' in its simplest form is أَنْتُمْ مُؤْمِنُونَ بِهِ *antum mu'minūna bi-hi*. In the Qur'ān this is likely to be أَنْتُمْ بِهِ مُؤْمِنُونَ *antum bi-hi mu'minūna*.

VOCABULARY TWELVE

PERFECT IMPERFECT VERBAL NOUN

كَانَ	يَكُونُ	كَوْنٌ	to be
قَالَ	يَقُولُ	قَوْلٌ	to say
سَكَتَ	يَسْكُتُ	سُكُوتٌ	to abate; (+ 'an) to leave

SINGULAR

مَلَكٌ

PLURAL

مَلَائِكَةٌ

angel

Lesson Twelve

SINGULAR

PLURAL

حَرْجٌ

trouble, difficulty

أُسْوَةٌ

example

بِضَاعَةٌ

بِضَائِعٌ

merchandise

رَقِيبٌ

watcher

سَارِقٌ

سَارِقُونَ

thief

عِبْرَةٌ

lesson, warning

عَجَبٌ

wonder

غَضَبٌ

anger

غَفْلَةٌ

heedlessness

قَصَصٌ

story

لَوْحٌ

الَّلَّوَّاحُ

tablet

مَتَاعٌ

أَمْتِعَةٌ

goods, baggage

فَاحِشَةٌ

فَوَاحِشٌ

abomination

هَشِيمٌ

dry twigs,

stubble

بَصِيرٌ

observant, seeing

حَسَنٌ

fine, good

غَافِلٌ

heedless

خَبِيرٌ

aware

غَفُورٌ

forgiving

مَفْعُولٌ

done

مَرِيضٌ

مَرَضَى

ill, sick

مُوسَى

Moses

SINGULAR

PLURAL

إِبْرَاهِيمُ

Abraham

EXERCISE TWELVE

- | | | |
|-----|---|----------|
| 1. | كَانَ لَهُنَّ وَلَدٌ | [4:12] |
| 2. | كَانُوا قَوْمًا مُّجْرِمِينَ | [7:133] |
| 3. | كَانُوا كَهَشِيمٍ | [54:31] |
| 4. | كُنَّا مُسْلِمِينَ | [27:42] |
| 5. | كُنْتُ فِي غَفْلَةٍ مِنْ هَذَا | [50:22] |
| 6. | كَانَ أَمْرُ اللَّهِ مَفْعُولًا | [4:47] |
| 7. | كَانَ عَدُوًّا لِلَّهِ وَمَلَائِكَتِهِ وَرُسُلِهِ | [2:98] |
| 8. | كَانَ مَعَهُ | [23:91] |
| 9. | كَانَ بِعِبَادِهِ خَبِيرًا بَصِيرًا | [17:96] |
| 10. | كَانَ رَبُّكَ بَصِيرًا | [25:20] |
| 11. | كَانُوا عَلَيْهِ شُهَدَاءَ | [5:44] |
| 12. | كَانَ النَّاسُ أُمَّةً | [2:213] |
| 13. | كُنْتَ أَنْتَ الرَّقِيبَ عَلَيْهِمْ | [5:117] |
| 14. | مَا كُنَّا سَارِقِينَ | [12:73] |
| 15. | كُنْتُمْ مُّجْرِمِينَ | [34:32] |
| 16. | كُنْتُمْ عَلَى شَفَا حُفْرَةٍ مِنَ النَّارِ | [3:103] |
| 17. | كَانَ مِنَ الْقُرُونِ مِنْ قَبْلِكُمْ | [11:116] |
| 18. | كَانُوا قَوْمَ سَوْءٍ | [21:74] |
| 19. | كَانَ ذَلِكَ عَلَى اللَّهِ يَسِيرًا | [4:169] |

Exercise Twelve

20. كَانَتْ مِنْ قَوْمٍ كَافِرِينَ [27:43]
21. مَا كَانَ عَلَى النَّبِيِّ مِنْ حَرْجٍ [33:38]
22. كَانَ لَكُمْ فِي رَسُولِ اللَّهِ أُسْوَةٌ حَسَنَةٌ [33:21]
23. كَانَ فِي ضَلَالٍ مُبِينٍ [43:40]
24. لَمَّا سَكَتَ عَنْ مُوسَى الْغَضَبُ أَخَذَ الْأَلْوَاخَ [7:154]
25. لَمَّا فَتَحُوا مَتَاعَهُمْ وَجَدُوا بِضَاعَتَهُمْ [12:65]
26. كُنَّا عَنْ هَذَا غَافِلِينَ [7:172]

Lesson Thirteen

The Dual

In addition to the singular and plural, Arabic has a dual.

NOUNS

	MASCULINE		FEMININE	
	indef.	def.	indef.	def.
nom.	رَجُلَانِ	الْوَالِدَانِ	مَرَّتَانِ	الْفِتَّتَانِ
acc., gen.	رَجُلَيْنِ	الْوَالِدَيْنِ	مَرَّتَيْنِ	الْفِتَّتَيْنِ

Notice that in the feminine dual the *tā' marbūṭa* of the singular changes to *tā' maftūḥa*.

The above examples show that the dual is the same whether it is indefinite or has the definite article. However, if the dual has a following genitive, the final *nūn* of the dual ending is dropped:

nom.	يَدَاهُ	his hands
acc., gen.	يَدَيْهِ	

If the accusative/genitive ending is followed by *hamzat al-waṣl*, the *sukūn* of the dual ending becomes a *kasra*:

بَيْنَ يَدَيِ اللَّهِ [49:1]

All the occurrences of the dual of يَد *yad* 'hand' in the Qur'ān are as the first element of an *iḍāfa*. So too are all the examples of the singular and the plural, apart from *ulī l-aydī* [38:45].

Note that *bayna yaday-*, originally 'between the hands of' means 'before', not only of space but also of time.

With the dual, the first person suffix becomes *-ya*, according to the rule given in Lesson 5.

PRONOUNS

There is a third person pronoun هُمَا *humā* and a second person pronoun كُمَا *kumā*. In the nominative these are independent forms, in the accusative and genitive they are suffixes. The suffix *-humā* may become *-himā* according to the rule already given about third person pronouns in Lesson 10.

DEMONSTRATIVES

Unlike the singular and plural these decline:

	These two		Those two	
	m.	f.	m.	f.
nom.	هَذَانِ	هَتَانِ	ذَانِكَ	تَانِكَ
acc., gen.	هَذَيْنِ	هَتَيْنِ	ذَيْنِكَ	تَيْنِكَ

VERBS

There are three perfect forms. Again, the example is *kataba*:

3 m.d.	كَتَبَا
3 f.d.	كَتَبَتَا
2 d.	كَتَبْتُمَا

None of these perfect dual forms is common in the Qur'ān, but they do occur from time to time:

أَكَلَا مِنْهَا the two of them ate some of it

Remember that if a dual subject is preceded by a verb, **that verb will be in the singular.**

قَالَ رَجُلَانِ two men said
قَدَّمَ^A يَدَاهُ his hands have sent forward

On this form of the verb see Lesson 15.

Dūna AND ITS DERIVATIVES

The preposition دُونَ *dūna*, originally 'on this side of', frequently means 'without', and this is almost always the case with the compound *bi-dūni*. However, the compound *min dūni* is not so easily translated. It most frequently means 'to the exclusion of' or 'apart from', but it can simply mean 'without'.

VOCABULARY THIRTEEN

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN
أَكَلَ	يَأْكُلُ	أَكْلٌ to eat
SINGULAR	PLURAL	
سَجَنٌ		prison
وَالِدٌ		father; (dual) parents
فَتًى	فَتِيَّةٌ	youth
سَاحِرٌ		magician, sorcerer
بُرْهَانٌ		proof
مَجْمَعٌ		meeting, meeting-place, confluence
^A عَيْنٌ (f.)	عُيُونٌ	spring
حِجَابٌ		obstacle, partition, veil
شَرِيكٌ	شُرَكَاءُ	partner, associate
زَرْعٌ		cultivation; green crops
نَخْلٌ		date-palms
رُمَّانٌ		pomegranates
مَبْسُوطٌ		spread, extended
فِئَةٌ		party, group

^A When عَيْنٌ has the sense of 'eye', its Qur'ānic plural is أَغْنَى

EXERCISE THIRTEEN

1. مِمَّا تَرَكَ الْوَالِدَانِ [4:33]
2. قَالَ رَجُلَانِ [5:23]
3. يَدَاهُ مَبْسُوطَتَانِ [5:64]
4. آخِرَانِ [5:106]
5. دَخَلَ مَعَهُ السَّجَنَ فَتَيَانِ [12:36]
6. هَذَانِ سَاحِرَانِ [20:63]
7. وَجَدَ فِيهَا رَجُلَيْنِ [28:15]
8. ذَانِكَ بُرْهَانَانِ مِنْ رَبِّكَ [28:32]
9. طَائِفَتَانِ مِنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ [49:9]
10. فِيهِمَا عَيْنَانِ [55:50]
11. ابْنَتَيْنِ هَتَيْنِ (genitive) [28:27]
12. وَجَدَ مِنْ دُونِهِمُ امْرَأَتَيْنِ [28:23]
13. بَلَّغَا مَجْمَعَ بَيْنَهُمَا [18:61]
14. فِيهِمَا إِثْمٌ كَبِيرٌ [2:219]
15. بَيْنَهُمَا حِجَابٌ [7:46]
16. جَعَلَا لَهُ شُرَكَاءَ [7:190]
17. وَمَا نَحْنُ لَكُمْ بِمُؤْمِنِينَ [10:78]
18. خَلَقْنَا السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا [15:85]
19. جَعَلْنَا بَيْنَهُمَا زُرْعًا [18:32]
20. مَا خَلَقْنَاهُمَا إِلَّا بِالْحَقِّ [44:39]
21. فِيهِمَا فَاكِهَةٌ وَنَخْلٌ وَرُمَانٌ [55:68]
22. جَعَلْنَا اللَّيْلَ وَالنَّهَارَ آيَتَيْنِ [17:12]

Lesson Fourteen

Cardinal Numbers

It takes a good deal of practice and no little mental agility to learn to handle the Arabic cardinal numbers correctly. However, if you learn each rule and how to apply it correctly and then learn how to apply the rules in combination, you will find the numbers much less difficult than they might appear at the outset.

Here are the basic forms:

	<i>with masculine noun</i>	<i>with feminine noun</i>
one	أَحَدٌ	إِحْدَى
two	إِثْنَانِ	إِثْنَتَانِ
three	ثَلَاثَةٌ	ثَلَاثٌ
four	أَرْبَعَةٌ	أَرْبَعٌ
five	خَمْسَةٌ	خَمْسٌ
six	سِتَّةٌ	سِتٌّ
seven	سَبْعَةٌ	سَبْعٌ
eight	ثَمَانِيَةٌ	ثَمَانٍ
nine	تِسْعَةٌ	تِسْعٌ
ten	عَشْرَةٌ	عَشْرٌ
eleven	أَحَدَ عَشَرَ	إِحْدَى عَشْرَةَ
twelve	إِثْنَا عَشَرَ	إِثْنَتَا عَشْرَةَ
thirteen	ثَلَاثَةَ عَشَرَ	ثَلَاثَ عَشْرَةَ

Lesson Fourteen

	<i>with masculine noun</i>	<i>with feminine noun</i>
fourteen	أَرْبَعَةَ عَشَرَ	أَرْبَعَ عَشْرَةَ
fifteen	خَمْسَةَ عَشَرَ	خَمْسَ عَشْرَةَ
sixteen	سِتَّةَ عَشَرَ	سِتَّ عَشْرَةَ
seventeen	سَبْعَةَ عَشَرَ	سَبْعَ عَشْرَةَ
eighteen	ثَمَانِيَةَ عَشَرَ	ثَمَانِيَّ عَشْرَةَ
nineteen	تِسْعَةَ عَشَرَ	تِسْعَ عَشْرَةَ

	<i>with both genders</i>
twenty	عِشْرُونَ
thirty	ثَلَاثُونَ
forty	أَرْبَعُونَ
fifty	خَمْسُونَ
sixty	سِتُّونَ
seventy	سَبْعُونَ
eighty	ثَمَانُونَ
ninety	تِسْعُونَ
one hundred	مِائَةٌ
one thousand	أَلْفٌ

The Qur'ān has a reasonably full range of numerals, but it would be surprising if in a work of its size all the numerals were to be covered. Basically we can find all the cardinal numbers up to twelve, though not necessarily with both masculine and feminine nouns. Above that, the only figures involving units are nineteen

and ninety-nine (though 309 is dealt with by periphrasis). The tens (twenty, thirty, etc.) are all there, as are some larger numbers (100, 200, 300, 1,000, 5,000, 50,000 and 100,000 etc.). The outline given below uses Qur'ānic examples where possible, but it would be wrong not to try to explain the whole system fully. The Qur'ān contains two or three apparently anomalous examples, of some interest to specialists in grammar. At this stage they can be ignored.

BASIC RULE

The gender of a numeral is decided by the singular of the noun associated with it, even if the construction of the numeral requires the plural of that noun.

DETAILED RULES

The cardinal numbers as fall into three basic groupings: a) 3–10; b) 11–99; c) 100 etc.

A. Apart from compound numerals, 1 and 2 can be left out of major consideration.

However remember:

1. a) *aḥadun* is a noun, used (i) in compound numbers, and (ii) in some idiomatic phrases. Of the latter only one deserves attention at this stage: *aḥadun* frequently means 'any one' or 'some one' or, after a negative, 'no one'. There are examples of the partitive phrase *min aḥadin* 'any one' in the Qur'ān, sometimes as subject, sometimes as object.
- b) In addition to *aḥadun/iḥdā*, basically a noun, there is a form *wāḥidun/wāḥidatun*, which is basically an adjective. Note, however, *kullu wāḥidin* 'each one'.
2. **Requires the use of the dual.** No other construction is possible.

B. 3–10 take the *genitive plural*, but it is essential here to remember that the number goes into the opposite gender to that of the singular of the noun:

ثَلَاثَةُ أَيَّامٍ three days

أَرْبَعَةُ شُهَدَاءَ	four witnesses
سَبْعُ سَمَوَاتٍ	seven heavens
تِسْعُ آيَاتٍ	nine verses

Note

- a) The form of eight used with feminine nouns declines like the definite forms of *wādin*:

ثَمَانِي حُجَجٍ	eight years
-----------------	-------------

- b) The form of ten used with feminine nouns is vocalised with a *sukūn* on the *shīn*: عَشْرُ سُورٍ 'ashru suwarin. However, the form used with masculine nouns has a *fatha* on the *shīn*: عَشْرَةُ مَسَاكِينٍ 'asharatu masākīna 'ten poor people'. This is the opposite to the forms of ten used in the numerals eleven to nineteen.

C. 11–99 take the accusative singular.

11. Both numerals agree in gender with the noun and are undeclinable:

إِحْدَى عَشْرَةَ مَدِينَةً	eleven cities
أَحَدَ عَشَرَ كَوْكَبًا	eleven stars

12. Both numerals agree in gender with the noun. The ten does not decline, but the unit declines:

m. nom.	إِثْنَا عَشَرَ شَهْرًا	twelve months
f. nom.	إِثْنَتَا عَشْرَةَ عَيْنًا	twelve springs
m. acc., gen.	إِثْنِي عَشَرَ نَقِيبًا	twelve chiefs
f. acc., gen.	إِثْنَتِي عَشْرَةَ مَدِينَةً	twelve cities

- 13–19. The unit goes into the gender opposite to that of the noun, the ten is in the same gender as the noun. Both ten and the unit are undeclinable.

The only form found in the Qur'ān [*tis'ata 'ashara*] is not followed by a noun. If it were, it would be a masculine one, as the context implies.

20–90. These are sound masculine plurals and are declined as such. Questions of gender do not arise:

ثَلَاثُونَ شَهْرًا	thirty months
(acc.) أَرْبَعِينَ سَنَةً	forty years
(gen.) سِتِّينَ مِسْكِينًا	sixty poor people
(acc.) ثَمَانِينَ جَلْدَةً	eighty lashes

With 21, 22, 23 etc. the patterns of agreement and disagreement recur. Note that if the unit can normally have *tanwīn*, **it cannot be dropped**.

إِحْدَى وَعِشْرُونَ مَدِينَةً	twenty-one cities
إِثْنَانِ وَثَلَاثُونَ رَسُولًا	thirty-two messenger
ثَلَاثَةٌ وَأَرْبَعُونَ كِتَابًا	forty-three books
أَرْبَعٌ وَخَمْسُونَ قَرْيَةً	fifty-four villages

D. 100, 200/1,000, 2,000 etc. take the genitive singular. Again questions of gender do not arise.

100	مِائَةُ عَامٍ	one hundred years
200	مِائَتَا رَجُلٍ	two hundred men
	(note the dual <i>mi'atā</i> without <i>nūn</i>)	
300	ثَلَاثُ مِائَةِ يَوْمٍ	three hundred days
	[In 300–900 <i>mi'a</i> irregularly stays in the singular]	
1,000	أَلْفُ سَنَةٍ	one thousand years
2,000	أَلْفَا رَجُلٍ	two thousand men (again no <i>nūn</i>)

3,000 ثَلَاثَةُ آلَافٍ مَلَكٍ three thousand angels

(the Qur'ān deals with this example by periphrasis: ثَلَاثَةُ آلَافٍ مِنَ الْمَلَائِكَةِ.)

The genitive singular construction applies only on the hundred or thousand. For an additional one or two the noun is repeated—in the singular or dual, as is appropriate—in the same case as the hundred or thousand, e.g. أَلْفٌ لَيْلَةً وَلَيْلَةً, 'a thousand and one nights'. Once there is an additional three etc. (right up to ninety-nine), the rules for the additional numeral apply:

208 مِائَتَانِ وَثَمَانِي مَنَافِعَ 208 benefits

456 أَرْبَعُ مِائَةٍ وَسِتُّ وَخَمْسُونَ آيَةً 456 verses

Ordinal numbers and fractions are dealt with in Lesson 31.

Note that the numerals *sab'un* 'ijāfun 'seven lean ones' [12:46], *sab'un shidādun* 'seven hard ones' [12:48] and 'ishrūna ṣābirūna 'twenty men of patience' [8:65] are examples of the relatively rare construction where the numeral is qualified by an adjective.

At this point you should try and learn the numerals as set out in the tables above and as many of the examples as possible.

VOCABULARY FOURTEEN

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
حِجَّةٌ	حَجَجٌ	year
عَامٌ	أَغْوَامٌ	year
شَهْرٌ	شُهُورٌ/أَشْهُرٌ	month
كَوْكَبٌ	كَوَاكِبٌ	star
نَقِيبٌ	نُقَبَاءُ	chief

SINGULAR

PLURAL

مِسْكِينٌ

مَسَاكِينُ

poor, destitute

جَلْدَةٌ

lash, stripe

عَجِيفٌ

عَجَافٌ

thin

EXERCISE FOURTEEN

Revise the numerals given in the lesson.

Lesson Fifteen

Derived Forms of the Verb

Virtually all languages have some way of modifying verbs to produce other verbs. In some cases there will be a close link in meaning, in others virtually none. One common way with Indo-European languages is to put prepositions and other prefixes before verbs, e.g. 'stand' → 'withstand' 'understand'; 'see' → 'oversee'. The Latin verb '*mitto*' has not come into English; but from its forms modified by a prepositional prefix we get 'admit', 'demit', 'emit', 'omit', 'permit', 'remit', 'submit', 'transmit'. The role played by the root structure in Arabic precludes such developments. Instead, modifications to vowel patterns, including the use of prefixes and infixes, take place. These modified forms of the verb are known as the derived forms of the verb, the form we have dealt with so far being the first, or base, form. There are fourteen derived forms, of which eight (2–8 and 10) are important. Grammars tend to discuss at length the various shades of sense imparted by each form. This is unhelpful initially, as the so-called norms are often misleading or inapplicable. The crucial step at this stage is to learn and recognise the base within each derived form and how the bases are manipulated. As all the patterns are predetermined, this is not difficult.

Remember to learn the derived form of the verb in its correct derived form. You should learn *arsala* not *rasala* ⁴ or anything like that.

The basic forms of the trilateral verb are to be found in the following tables. At this stage you should try to commit the 3 m.s. perfect forms to memory. For the verb *qabila* these are:

Form	Perfect	Imperfect	Verbal noun	Active participle	Passive participle
2	قَبَّلَ	يُقَبِّلُ	تَقْبِيلٌ	مُقَبِّلٌ	مُقَبَّلٌ
3	قَابَلَ	يُقَابِلُ	مُقَابَلَةٌ or قِبَالٌ	مُقَابِلٌ	مُقَابَلٌ
4	أَقْبَلَ	يُاقِبِلُ	إِقْبَالٌ	مُاقِبِلٌ	مُاقِبَلٌ
5	تَقَبَّلَ	يَتَقَبَّلُ	تَقَبُّلٌ	مُرَقَّبِلٌ	مُتَقَبَّلٌ
6	تَقَابَلَ	يَتَقَابِلُ	تَقَابُلٌ	مُتَقَابِلٌ	مُتَقَابَلٌ
7	إِنْقَبَلَ	يَنْقَبِلُ	إِنْقِبَالٌ	مُنْقَبِلٌ	مُنْقَبَلٌ
8	اِقْتَبَلَ	يَقْتَبِلُ	اِقْتِبَالٌ	مُقْتَبِلٌ	مُقْتَبَلٌ
10	اِسْتَقْبَلَ	يَسْتَقْبِلُ	اِسْتِقْبَالٌ	مُسْتَقْبِلٌ	مُسْتَقْبَلٌ

NOTES ON THE FIFTH AND SIXTH FORMS

1. In the Qur'ān and some other early texts the initial prefix *ta-* is dropped from the imperfect tenses:

Indicative: *تَكَلَّمُ takallamu* (for *tatakallamu*); *تَنْزَلُ tanazzalu* (for *tatanazzalu*); *تَذَكَّرُونَ tadhakkarūna* (for *tatadhakkarūna*); *تَسَاءَلُونَ tasā'alūna* (for *tatasā'alūna*); *تَنَاصَرُونَ tanāṣarūna* (for *tatanāṣarūna*).

Other tenses: *تَصَدَّقُوا taṣaddaqū* (for *tataṣaddaqū*); *تَعَاوَنُوا ta'āwanū* (for *tata'āwanū*); *تَفَرَّقُوا tafarraquū* (for *tatafarraquū*)

2. For the 5th and 6th forms the Qur'ān contains a range of examples of Hījāzī dialect forms which, instead of the *ta-* prefix use the prefix *it-*. The *tā'* of this prefix then assimilates to a following *thā'*, *dāl*, *dhāl*, *zāy*, *sīn*, *ṣād*, or *ṭā'*. Most instances are 5th forms, and most are in the imperfect tenses, but there are some perfect forms and a few participles. Here are some of the verbs involved (the finite verbs are given in

the perfect, regardless of their Qur'ānic tense—and the list is not complete):

إِدْبَرِ إِذْكَرَ إِزَيْنَ إِتَمَعَ إِصْدَقَ إِصْعَدَ إِطَوَّفَ
إِطَيَّرَ إِثَاقَلَ إِدَارَكَ مُدَثِّرَ مُزَمَّلَ

NOTE ON THE EIGHTH FORM

The infixed *t* of this form may change to *d* or to *ṭ* under the influence of the preceding first radical:

إِدْعَى *idda'a* (see Lesson 30); إِذْخَرَ (from *dhakhara*);
إِزْدَجَرَ *izdajara*; إِزْدَادَ *izdāda* (Lesson 28); إِضْطَبَرَ *iṣṭabara*;
إِضْطَادَ *iṣṭāda* (Lesson 28); إِضْطَرَّ *iḍṭarra* (Lesson 26);
إِطَّلَعَ *iṭṭala'a*, etc.

[For the full extent of the rule see Wright 1, 66–67.]

NOTES ON OTHER FORMS

The 9th form of the verb, which works in the same way as the doubled verb (see Lesson 26), is in general very rare and does not merit special attention. In the Qur'ān it is found only a dozen times, always connected with colours. There are two 3 f.s. perfect: *إِبْيَضَّتْ* *ibyaddat* 'to be white' and *إِسْوَدَّتْ* *iswaddat* 'to be black'; the same verbs in the 3 f.s. imperfect: *تَبَيَّضَ* *tabyaddu*, *تَسْوَدَّ* *taswaddu*; and three participles: *مُسْوَدٌّ* *muswaddun*, and also *مُخْضَرٌّ* *mukhdarrun* 'green' and *مُضْفَرٌّ* *musfarrun* 'yellow'. There is also one 11th form participle: *مُذْهَمٌّ* *mudhāmmun* 'dark green'.

QUADRILITERAL VERBS

Quadriliteral verbs have four radicals instead of three. They are quite rare in the Qur'ān, and most of those that do occur are onomatopoeic, like *دَمَدَمَ* *damdama* and *وَسَّوَسَ* *waswasa*. Genuine

quadrilaterals are *بَغَثَر* *ba' thara* and the two derived forms *إِشْمَاز* *ish-ma'azza* and *إِقْشَعَرَّ* *iqsha'arra*. In all cases the radicals are obvious, and no special attention needs to be paid to these verbs in the Qur'ān. Their role in other Arabic is more important.

VOCABULARY FIFTEEN

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
2 أَخَّرَ	يُؤَخِّرُ	تَأْخِيرٌ	to defer
2 عَلَّمَ	يُعَلِّمُ	تَعْلِيمٌ	to teach
2 قَدَّمَ	يُقَدِّمُ	تَقْدِيمٌ	to send forward, to bring forward
2 كَذَّبَ	يُكَذِّبُ	تَكْذِيبٌ	to deny, give the lie to
3 جَادَلَ	يُجَادِلُ	جِدَالٌ	to dispute, contend with
3 جَاهَدَ	يُجَاهِدُ	جِهَادٌ	to strive
3 قَاتَلَ	يُقَاتِلُ	قِتَالٌ	to fight, confound
4 أَرْسَلَ	يُرْسِلُ	إِرْسَالٌ	to send
4 أَنْزَلَ	يُنْزِلُ	إِنْزَالٌ	to send down
4 أَهْلَكَ	يُهْلِكُ	إِهْلَاكٌ	to destroy
5 تَذَكَّرَ	يَتَذَكَّرُ	تَذَكُّرٌ	to remember, bear in mind
5 تَوَكَّلَ	يَتَوَكَّلُ	تَوَكُّلٌ	to put one's trust in ('alā)
6 تَعَاوَنَ	يَتَعَاوَنُ	تَعَاوُنٌ	to co-operate, help one another
7 انْقَلَبَ	يَنْقَلِبُ	إِنْقِلَابٌ	return, be overturned

Exercise Fifteen

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
8 اتَّبَعَ	يَتَّبِعُ	اتِّبَاعٌ	to follow
8 اِخْتَلَفَ	يَخْتَلِفُ	اِخْتِلَافٌ	to vary, differ
10 اِسْتَغْفَرَ	يَسْتَغْفِرُ	اِسْتِغْفَارٌ	to seek forgiveness
10 اِسْتَكْبَرَ	يَسْتَكْبِرُ	اِسْتِكْبَارٌ	to be haughty, insolent, proud

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
دِينٌ	أَدْيَانٌ	religion
سَاعَةٌ	سَاعَاتٌ	hour
مَاءٌ	مِيَاهٌ	water

EXERCISE FIFTEEN

- | | | |
|-----|------------------------------------|---------|
| 1. | عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ | [55:2] |
| 2. | عَلَّمْتُكَ الْكِتَابَ | [5:110] |
| 3. | ذَلِكَ بِمَا قَدَّمْتَ أَيْدِيكُمْ | [3:182] |
| 4. | مَا قَدَّمَ وَأَخَّرَ | [75:13] |
| 5. | كَذَّبُوا بِآيَاتِنَا | [3:11] |
| 6. | كَذَّبَ بِالسَّاعَةِ | [25:11] |
| 7. | جَاهِدُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ | [2:218] |
| 8. | جَاهِدَاكَ | [29:8] |
| 9. | قَدْ جَادَلْتَنَا | [11:32] |
| 10. | قَاتِلْهُمْ اللَّهُ | [9:30] |

11. قَاتِلُوهُمْ فِي الدِّينِ [60:9]
12. أَنْزَلْنَاهُ قُرْآنًا عَرَبِيًّا [12:2]
13. أَنْزَلَ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ مَاءً [2:22]
14. مَا أَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ عَلَى بَشَرٍ مِنْ شَيْءٍ [6:91]
15. أَهْلَكْنَاهُمْ بِذُنُوبِهِمْ [6:6]
16. مَا أَهْلَكْنَا مِنْ قَرْيَةٍ إِلَّا وَلَهَا كِتَابٌ مَعْلُومٌ [15:4]
17. أَرْسَلَ رَسُولَهُ بِالْهُدَى [9:33]
18. أَرْسَلْنَا نُوحًا إِلَى قَوْمِهِ [11:25]
19. أَرْسَلْنَا إِلَيْنَا رَسُولًا [20:134]
20. تَوَكَّلْتُ عَلَى اللَّهِ رَبِّي وَرَبَّكُمْ [11:56]
21. انْقَلَبَ عَلَى وَجْهِهِ [22:11]
22. انْقَلَبُوا إِلَى أَهْلِهِمْ [83:31]
23. نَصَرُوهُ وَاتَّبَعُوا النُّورَ [7:157]
24. اتَّبَعُوا الْحَقَّ مِنْ رَبِّهِمْ [47:3]
25. اخْتَلَفُوا فِي الْكِتَابِ [2:176]
26. اخْتَلَفَ الْأَحْزَابُ مِنْ بَيْنِهِمْ [43:65]
27. وَاسْتَغْفَرَ لَهُمُ الرَّسُولُ [4:64]
28. فَاسْتَغْفَرُوا لِذُنُوبِهِمْ [3:135]
29. وَاسْتَكْبَرْتَ وَكُنْتَ مِنَ الْكَافِرِينَ [39:59]
30. فَاسْتَكْبَرُوا وَكَانُوا قَوْمًا مُجْرِمِينَ [7:133]

Lesson Sixteen

The Imperfect

The *mudāri'* is usually known in English as the Imperfect, or, if one wishes to contrast it with the allied Subjunctive and Jussive moods, the Imperfect Indicative. The Imperfect stresses the incompleteness of an action or state. Standing on its own, it most frequently translates into an English present or future, though sometimes a verb in the imperfect may have a potential meaning. The Imperfect of *kataba* is as follows:

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَكْتُبُ	يَكْتُبَانِ	يَكْتُبُونَ
3 f.	تَكْتُبُ	تَكْتُبَانِ	يَكْتُبْنَ
2 m.	تَكْتُبُ	تَكْتُبَانِ	تَكْتُبُونَ
2 f.	تَكْتُبِينَ	تَكْتُبَانِ	تَكْتُبْنَ
1	أَكْتُبُ	—	نَكْتُبُ

Examples of the use of the Imperfect:

أَعْلَمُ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ	I know what you do not know
يَظْلِمُونَ النَّاسَ	they wrong the people
تَحْدُ كُلُّ نَفْسٍ مَا عَمِلَتْ	every soul will find what it has done

The *mudāri'* is used following the *māḍī* of another verb to show an action or state closely related to, or virtually simultaneous with, the first verb:

- ^A اِسْتَوَى عَلَى الْعَرْشِ يُدَبِّرُ الْأَمْرَ he sat on the throne directing the matter
- ^A جَاءَتْهُ ^B إِحْدَاهُمَا تَمْشِي one of the two of them came to him

IMPERFECT FORM NOTES

1. The Imperfect of *kataba* should be learned by heart from the table above. Once you have mastered the Imperfect of *kataba*, do the same with the Imperfect of the derived forms listed in Lesson 15. The prefixes, endings and suffixes of the derived forms work exactly like those of the first form, subject only to a variation of the vowel of the prefix, depending on which derived form is being used.

The forms of the Imperfect are not as straightforward as the Perfect, for they involve a combination of prefixes, endings and suffixes, and two pairs of the forms (3 f.s. / 2 m.s. and 3 f.d. / 2 d.) are identical. One has to get used to this.

2. In verbs with the pattern *kataba*, i.e. with a *fatha* on the second radical in the *māḍī*, the vowel of the second radical of the *mudāriʿ* is a variable.

In the majority of verbs of this pattern, the vowel is a *damma* as in *yaktubu*. However, most verbs with one of the letters *hamza*, *ḥā'*, *khā'*, *ʿayn*, *ghayn* or *hā'* as second or third radical take *fatha* as the vowel of the second radical in the Imperfect; but such common examples as *dakhala* / *yadkhulu* and *rajaʿa* / *yarjiʿu* are indications of the fallibility of this rule of thumb.

As mentioned in Lesson 9, the best procedure is to learn the 3 m.s. Imperfect when you learn the 3 m.s. Perfect.

3. Verbs of the pattern of *shariba* take *fatha* in the Imperfect: *yashrabu*. This rule does not apply to verbs with an initial *wāw*.
4. Verbs of the pattern of *kabura* take *damma* in the Imperfect.

^A For these verbs see Lesson 30.

^B For the verb *jā'a* 'to come' see Lesson 28.

5. This variability of the second radical vowel applies to the first form only. It does not apply to any of the derived forms. Note that when a suffix is added to the 3 m.p. and 2 m.p. the *nūn* remains:

يَسْمَعُونَكُمْ they hear you
تَأْمُرُونَنَا you order us

Beginners are tempted to assume that with a suffix this *nūn* will drop out. This is through a false analogy with what happens to sound masculine plural nouns. Dropping the *nūn* changes the mood (as you will see when the Subjunctive is dealt with in Lesson 17), and is thus impossible when the verb is an Imperfect Indicative.

THE IMPERFECT OF KĀNA

Also learn the *mudāriʿ* of *kāna*, but remember that this is not used to express the present tense of the verb 'to be'. That must be done by means of a nominal sentence or using the Perfect of *kāna* as explained in Lesson 12. However, the imperfect of *kāna* is used for the future. See the section on *sa-* and *sawfa* below.

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَكُونُ	يَكُونَانِ	يَكُونُونَ
3 f.	تَكُونُ	تَكُونَانِ	يَكُنَّ
2 m.	تَكُونُ	تَكُونَانِ	تَكُونُونَ
2 f.	تَكُونِينَ	تَكُونَانِ	تَكُنَّ
1	أَكُونُ	—	نَكُونُ

NEGATIVE OF THE *mudāriʿ*

The basic negative of the Imperfect is *lā*. However, *mā* is also found. The primary difference between them is that *lā* is a general negative, while *mā* negates a fact.

سَ sa- AND سَوْفَ sawfa

The particles *sa-* (prefixed to the *muḍāri'*) and *sawfa* (an independent word preceding the *muḍāri'*) are used to indicate the future. They are not common, as the context usually gives enough indication of time. Note that *sa-* cannot be used with a negative and *sawfa lā* (the only correct combination) is very rare and not found in the Qur'ān.

سَيَكُونُ مِنْكُمْ مَرْضَى there will be sick people among you
سَوْفَ تَعْلَمُونَ you will know

Kāna WITH THE *muḍāri'*

The *māḍī* of *kāna* is used with the *muḍāri'* of a second verb to indicate a continuous past tense:

كَانَ فَرِيقٌ مِنْهُمْ يَسْمَعُونَ كَلَامَ اللَّهِ [2:75]
a party of them was listening to the word of God
كُنْتُمْ بِهَا تُكَذِّبُونَ [23:105]
you were denying it

VOCABULARY SIXTEEN

PERFECT IMPERFECT VERBAL NOUN

أَبْصَرَ ⁴	يُنْصِرُ	إِبْصَارٌ (+bi-) to see, observe
دَبَّرَ ²	يُدَبِّرُ	تَذْيِيرٌ to manage, arrange
كَلَّمَ ²	يُكَلِّمُ	تَكْلِيمٌ to speak to, address

SINGULAR PLURAL

حِكْمَةٌ	wisdom
زَكَاةٌ / زَكَوَةٌ	alms

Exercise Sixteen

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
صَلَاةٌ / صَلَوَةٌ	صَلَوَاتٌ	prayer
عَرْشٌ		throne
فَرِيقٌ		party, company
قَدَمٌ (f.)	أَقْدَامٌ	foot
كَلَامٌ		speech, words, word
تَحْتَ		beneath

EXERCISE SIXTEEN

1. [16:89] تَبْعْتُ مِنْ كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ شَهِيدًا
2. [18:60] أَبْلُغُ مَجْمَعَ الْبَحْرَيْنِ
3. [41:29] نَجْعَلُهُمَا تَحْتَ أَقْدَامِنَا
4. [23:33] يَأْكُلُ مِمَّا تَأْكُلُونَ مِنْهُ... وَيَشْرَبُ مِمَّا تَشْرَبُونَ
5. [19:27] (f.s.) تَحْمِلُهُ
6. [2:18] هُمْ لَا يَزِجُوعُونَ
7. [13:23] يَدْخُلُونَ عَلَيْهِمْ مِنْ كُلِّ بَابٍ
8. [2:235] سَتَذْكُرُونَهُنَّ
9. [14:25] يَضْرِبُ اللَّهُ الْآمَثَالَ لِلنَّاسِ
10. [2:79] يَكْتُبُونَ الْكِتَابَ بِأَيْدِيهِمْ
11. [11:64] يَأْخُذْكُمْ عَذَابٌ قَرِيبٌ
12. [19:55] كَانَ يَأْمُرُ أَهْلَهُ بِالصَّلَاةِ وَالزَّكَاةِ
13. [59:12] لَا يَخْرُجُونَ مَعَهُمْ

14. يَسْأَلُونَكَ عَنِ الشَّهْرِ الْحَرَامِ [2:217]
15. يَسْمَعُ كَلَامَ اللَّهِ [9:6]
16. يَعْلَمُ مَا تَكْسِبُ كُلُّ نَفْسٍ [13:42]
17. لَا يُكَلِّمُهُمُ اللَّهُ وَلَا يَنْظُرُ إِلَيْهِمْ [3:77]
18. يَنْصُرُونَكُمْ [26:93]
19. اللَّهُ شَهِيدٌ عَلَىٰ مَا تَعْمَلُونَ [3:98]
20. عَلَىٰ رَبِّهِمْ يَتَوَكَّلُونَ [8:2]
21. يَسْتَغْفِرُونَهُ وَاللَّهُ غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ [5:74]
22. يَعْلَمُكُمُ الْكِتَابُ وَالْحِكْمَةُ [2:151]
23. لَا يَسْتَكْبِرُونَ [5:82]
24. لَا تُكَذِّبُ بَيَّاتٍ رَبَّنَا [6:27]
25. يُجَاهِدُونَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ بِأَمْوَالِكُمْ وَأَنْفُسِكُمْ [61:11]
26. يَتَذَكَّرُ أُولُوا الْأَلْبَابِ [39:9]
27. سَأُنْزِلُ مِثْلَ مَا أَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ [6:93]
28. يُهْلِكُونَ أَنْفُسَهُمْ [6:26]
29. لَا يُقَاتِلُونَكُمْ [59:14]
30. سَوْفَ يُنْصَرُونَ [37:175]

Lesson Seventeen

Interrogatives

There are two interrogative particles that simply introduce a question. They are هَلْ *hal* and أَ *a-*. One peculiarity of *a-* is that if it is used with *wa-* or *fa-* it precedes that particle, giving *a-fa-* or *a-wa-* (not *fa-a-* or *wa-a-*).

أَلَهُمْ أَرْجُلٌ	do they have feet?
أَفِي قُلُوبِهِمْ مَرَضٌ	is there sickness in their hearts?
هَلْ أَنْتُمْ شَاكِرُونَ	are you grateful?
هَلْ أَتَّبِعُكَ	shall I follow you?
أَفَلَا تَسْمَعُونَ	will you not hear?
أَوْ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ	do they not know?

Note that *a-lā* may be a negative and interrogative combined:

أَلَا تَأْكُلُونَ will you not eat?

or it may have the extended meaning 'indeed':

أَلَا لِلَّهِ الدِّينُ الْخَالِصُ God indeed has the pure religion

The meaning will depend on the context, though when *a-lā* is followed by إِنَّ *inna* (see Lesson 19) it will always mean 'indeed'.

أَمْ *am* 'or' introduces an alternative in an interrogative question. It can be used only in interrogative sentences, and in the Qur'ān it is used only after *a-*. The general word for 'or' *aw* is used after *hal*.

Specific interrogative words that do not require a special construction are:

أَيْنَ *ayna*, 'where?'

أَيْنَ الْمَفْرُ where is the place of escape?

In the Qur'ān *ayna* is not preceded by *min* or *ilā* to produce 'whence' and 'whither', as we find elsewhere.

أَيْنَ تَذْهَبُونَ where are you going?

أَنَّى *annā*, 'whence?' and then 'how?'

أَنَّى لَكَ هَذَا whence does this [come] to you?

أَنَّى يُبْصِرُونَ how [can] they see?

أَيَّانَ *ayyāna*, 'when?'

أَيَّانَ يَوْمُ الدِّينِ when is the Day of Judgement?

مَتَى *matā*, 'when?'

مَتَى نَصْرُ اللَّهِ when is God's help?

كَيْفَ *kayfa*, 'how?'

كَيْفَ تَعْلَمُونَ how do you know?

كَيْفَ تَصْبِرُ how [can] you endure?

مَا *mā*, 'what?'

مَا أَصْحَابُ الشَّامِ what are the companions of the left?

مَا الْقَارِعَةُ what is the calamity?

The most striking examples of the interrogative *mā* are in the phrase مَا أَذْرَاكَ *mā adrā-ka* 'what has given you knowledge of. . .?' which occurs thirteen times in early Meccan *sūras* (on the verb أَذْرَى *adrā* see Lesson 30).

If *dhā* is added to *mā* to give *mā-dhā* the meaning can only be interrogative:

مَاذَا يُنْفِقُونَ what do they spend?

مَاذَا تَأْمُرُونَ what do you order?

لِمَ *li-ma*, 'why?'

لِمَ تَلْبِسُونَ الْحَقَّ بِالْبَاطِلِ why do you confound the truth with falsehood?

لِمَ تَكْفُرُونَ بِآيَاتِ اللَّهِ why do you not believe in God's signs?

The shortened interrogative *-ma* with other prepositions, common elsewhere in Arabic, occurs only occasionally in the Qur'an: بِمَ *bi-ma* and فِيمَ *fī-ma*. Note that the fuller form لِمَاذَا *li-mā-dhā* does not occur in the Qur'an.

مَنْ *man*, 'who?'

مَنْ رَبُّكُمَا [20:49] who is the lord of the two of you?

مَنْ يَنْصُرُنِي [11:63] who will help me?

If *dhā* is added to *man* to give *man-dhā* the meaning can only be interrogative (as we have seen with *mā-dhā*). *Man-dhā* is, however, found in the Qur'an only in a set phrase مَنْ ذَا الَّذِي *man-dhā lladhī* 'who is there who. . .?', which occurs a handful of times.

كَمْ *kam*, 'how many?'

The usual construction when *kam* is an interrogative is for it to take the accusative, like the number group 11 to 99. However, on the few occasions that it occurs as an interrogative in the Qur'ān the accusative is suppressed:

كَمْ لَبِثْتَ how long did you linger?

The context indicates that a reply with an accusative word such as *yawman* or *sanatan* is implied. In other places, *kam* is used in an exclamatory way and is followed by *min* and the genitive. كَأَيِّنْ *ka'ayyin*, a rare synonym of *kam*, is only used in this exclamatory fashion.

أَيُّ *ayyun* 'which?'

In the Qur'ān *ayy* is always followed by a genitive or a suffix. It remains in the masculine regardless of the gender of the following noun:

أَيُّ شَيْءٍ what thing?
 أَيُّ الْفَرِيقَيْنِ which of the two parties?
 فِي أَيِّ صُورَةٍ in what form?
 أَيُّ آيَاتِ اللَّهِ which of God's signs?

INDIRECT QUESTIONS

All the above interrogatives are also used to introduce indirect questions. So too is the conditional particle **إِنْ** *in* 'if' (on which see Lesson 36).

VOCABULARY SEVENTEEN

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
شَكَرَ	يَشْكُرُ	شُكْرٌ	to thank, be thankful
صَبَرَ	يَصْبِرُ	صَبْرٌ	to be patient, endure
صَدَقَ	يَصْدُقُ	صِدْقٌ	to tell the truth
قَسَمَ	يَقْسِمُ	قِسْمٌ	to divide
عَقَلَ	يَعْقِلُ	عَقْلٌ	to understand
عَجَلَ	يَعْجَلُ	عَجَلٌ	to hasten to
10 اسْتَعْجَلَ	يَسْتَعْجِلُ	اسْتِعْجَالٌ	to hasten, seek to hasten
كَفَرَ	يَكْفُرُ	كُفْرٌ	to deny, not to believe in, to be an unbeliever
لَبَسَ	يَلْبِسُ	لَبْسٌ	to confound
4 أَصَمَعَ	يُصَمِّعُ	إِصْمَاعٌ	to make hear
2 بَشَّرَ	يُبَشِّرُ	تَبَشِيرٌ	to bring good news/tidings
5 تَبَيَّنَ	يَتَبَيَّنُ	تَبَيُّنٌ	to become clear, be made clear
4 أَنْفَقَ	يُنْفِقُ	إِنْفَاقٌ	to spend

SINGULAR PLURAL

خُسْرَانٌ	loss, ruin
[from <i>khasira</i> 'to lose']	
حُكْمٌ	judgement
ذِكْرَى	remembrance, reminder

SINGULAR PLURAL

مَفْرٌ		refuge
قَارِعَةٌ		calamity
مَرَضٌ		illness
شِمَالٌ		left, left hand
يَمِينٌ	أَيْمَانٌ	right, right hand; oath
قَلْبٌ	قُلُوبٌ	heart
صُورَةٌ	صُورٌ	form
صَمٌّ (f.) أَصَمُّ	صُمٌّ	deaf
خَالِصٌ		pure
بَاطِلٌ		false

EXERCISE SEVENTEEN

1. أَفَلَا تَتَذَكَّرُونَ [6:80]
2. سَنَنْظُرُ أَصَدَقْتَ أَمْ كُنْتَ مِنَ الْكَاذِبِينَ [27:27]
3. أَفَنَجْعَلُ الْمُسْلِمِينَ كَالْمُجْرِمِينَ [68:35]
4. مَتَى هَذَا الْوَعْدُ [10:48]
5. أَنَّى لَهُمُ الذِّكْرَى [44:13]
6. مَا أَضْحَابُ الْيَمِينِ [56:27]
7. مَا أَذْرَاكَ مَا يَوْمُ الدِّينِ [82:17]
8. فَهَلْ وَجَدْتُمْ مَا وَعَدَ رَبُّكُمْ [7:44]
9. هَلْ عِنْدَكُمْ مِنْ عِلْمٍ [6:148]

10. أَوَلَا يَعْلَمُونَ [2:77]
11. أَبَعَثَ اللَّهُ بَشْرًا رَسُولًا [17:94]
12. أَلَا لَهُ الْحُكْمُ [6:62]
13. نَنْظُرُ كَيْفَ تَعْمَلُونَ [10:14]
14. أَفَلَا تَعْقِلُونَ [3:65]
15. أَبَشِّرْهُمُونِي [15:54]
16. أَكْذَبْتُمْ بِآيَاتِي [27:84]
17. أَهْمُ يَقْسِمُونَ رَحْمَةَ رَبِّكَ [43:32]
18. هَلْ عَلِمْتُمْ مَا فَعَلْتُمْ [12:89]
19. أَعَجِلْتُمْ أَمْرَ رَبِّكُمْ [7:150]
20. أَفَبِعَذَابِنَا يَسْتَعْجِلُونَ [26:204]
21. هَلْ يَسْمَعُونَكُمْ [26:72]
22. وَتَبَيَّنَ لَكُمْ كَيْفَ فَعَلْنَا بِهِمْ [14:45]
23. أَفَمَا نَحْنُ بِمَبِيتِينَ [37:58]
24. فَهَلْ أَنْتُمْ مُسْلِمُونَ [11:14]
25. أَلَا ذَلِكَ هُوَ الْخُسْرَانُ الْمُبِينُ [39:15]
26. وَمَا أَدْرَاكَ مَا الْقَارِعَةُ [101:3]
27. أَفَأَنْتَ تُسْمِعُ الصُّمَّ [10:42]
28. كَيْفَ تَأْخُذُونَهُ [4:21]
29. أَكَانَ لِلنَّاسِ عَجَبًا [10:2]
30. أَفَلَا يَنْظُرُونَ إِلَى الْآيِلِ [88:17]

Lesson Eighteen

The Subjunctive

The Subjunctive is closely related in form to the Imperfect Indicative, with the change of the final short vowel from *u* to *a*, and the dropping of the final *na* if it is preceded by a long vowel. These changes affect all numbers and persons except the 3 f.p. and the 2 f.p.

Learn the basic form of the Subjunctive from the table below.

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَكْتُبَ	يَكْتُبَا	يَكْتُبُوا
3 f.	تَكْتُبَ	تَكْتُبَا	يَكْتُبْنَ
2 m.	تَكْتُبَ	تَكْتُبَا	تَكْتُبُوا
2 f.	تَكْتُبِي	تَكْتُبَا	تَكْتُبْنَ
I	أَكْتُبَ	—	نَكْتُبَ

The Subjunctive in Arabic is used only after specific particles that require a subjunctive. With the exception of *لَنْ* *lan*, all these particles introduce subordinate clauses. In subordinate clauses the Subjunctive indicates an act or a state that is dependent on, and subsequent to, what precedes the subjunctive particle.

The most important of particles that take the Subjunctive are:

أَنَّ *an* 'that' (very frequently translated in other words, such as 'to')

لِ *li-* and حَتَّى *hattā* 'so that', 'until';

لِأَنَّ *li-an*, كَيْ *kay* and لِكَيْ *likay*, which all mean 'so that', feature rarely in the Qur'ān.

لَنْ *lan* 'not'—a strong denial of the future (formed originally from لَّا أَنْ *lā-an*).

The negative used with the Subjunctive after these subordinating particles is normally لَا *lā*, but see note 3 on أَنْ *an* on p. 115.

لَا أَنْ *an lā* normally becomes أَلَّا *allā*. لِ *li-* cannot be used with a negative.

EXAMPLES OF THE USE OF THE SUBJUNCTIVE:

تَأْمُرُونَنَا أَنْ نَكْفُرَ بِاللَّهِ [34:33]
you command us not to believe in God

أَمْ حَسِبْتُمْ أَنْ تَدْخُلُوا الْجَنَّةَ [2:214]
do you think that you will enter Paradise?

حَسِبُوا أَلَّا تَكُونَ فِتنَةً [5:71]
they thought that there would be no mischief

جَعَلَ لَكُمُ اللَّيْلَ لِتَسْكُنُوا فِيهِ [10:67]
he made the night for you to rest in

لَنْ نَدْخُلَهَا حَتَّى يَخْرُجُوا مِنْهَا [5:22]
we won't enter it till they leave it

It is important to note that the subjunctive particle requires the Subjunctive only in the verb that it governs or a verb that is made parallel to the first subjunctive by *wa-*, *fa-*, *aw* or *thumma*.

Take the first example above. Taking the text further, it runs:

تَأْمُرُونَنَا أَنْ نَكْفُرَ بِاللَّهِ وَنَجْعَلَ لَهُ أَندَادًا [34:33]
you command us not to believe in God
and establish rivals to him

Any verb that occurs in another clause within the subjunctive clause **will be in the indicative** unless it too is governed by a subjunctive particle, *e.g.*:

أَصْلَاتُكَ تَأْمُرُكَ أَنْ نَشْرَكَ مَا يَعْبُدُ آبَاؤُنَا [11:87]

does your prayer tell you that we should
abandon what our forefathers have served?

7:129 has *an* and three subjunctives but then reverts to the indicative after *kayfa*:

عَسَى رَبُّكُمْ أَنْ يُهْلِكَ عَدُوَّكُمْ وَيَسْتَخْلِفَكُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ
فَيَنْظُرَ كَيْفَ تَعْمَلُونَ^A

it may be that your Lord will destroy your enemy and make
you successors in the land to see how you act

The Subjunctive is used in these examples because the act or state mentioned in the subordinate clause is dependent on the main verb and subsequent to it in time. However, *an* may be followed by another tense, normally the perfect, if the verb governing it does not indicate any expectation or effect. This is normally the Perfect.

مَا لَيْتَ أَنْ جَاءَ بِعِجْلٍ حَنِيذٍ [11:69]

soon he came with a roast calf

نَعْلَمُ أَنْ قَدْ صَدَقْتَنَا [5:113]

we know that you have told us the truth

The same applies to *hattā* when it has the meaning 'until':

مَا اخْتَلَفُوا حَتَّى جَاءَهُمُ الْعِلْمُ [10:93]

they did not disagree until knowledge came to them

The Subjunctive of *kāna* conjugates as follows:

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَكُونَ	يَكُونَا	يَكُونُوا
3 f.	تَكُونَ	تَكُونَا	يَكُنَّ

^A For the verb عَسَى 'asā see Lesson 37.

2 m.	تَكُونُوا	تَكُونَا	تَكُونُ
2 f.	تَكُنَّ	تَكُونَا	تَكُونِي
1	نَكُونُ	-	أَكُونُ

NOTES ON أَنْ *an*

1. It is common in Arabic for *an* clauses to be preceded by prepositions. Thus we find *أَمَرَنِي أَنْ أَذْهَبَ* *amara-nī an adhhaba* and *أَمَرَنِي بِأَنْ أَذْهَبَ* *amara-nī bi-an adhhaba*. The Arab grammarians point out that *an* clauses are the equivalent of *maṣḍars*, and so *أَمَرَنِي بِأَنْ أَذْهَبَ* *amara-nī bi-an adhhaba* is the equivalent of *أَمَرَنِي بِالذَّهَابِ* *amara-nī bi-l-dhahābi*. All three mean 'he told me to go'. In the Qur'ān this use of prepositions with *an* clauses is rare: it is confined to 'alā (acting both in its own right and as the preposition taken by the participle *قَادِرٌ* *qādir* 'able to').

2. *An* is found in combination with both *قَبْلَ* *qabla* / *مِنْ قَبْلَ* *min qabli* and *بَعْدَ* *ba'da* / *مِنْ بَعْدَ* *min ba'di* to form conjunctions meaning 'before' and 'after' respectively. Some examples have the Subjunctive and some the Perfect, e.g.:

نَفِدَ الْبَحْرُ قَبْلَ أَنْ تَنْفَدَ كَلِمَاتُ رَبِّي [18:109]

the sea would be exhausted before the words of my Lord would be exhausted

بَعْدَ أَنْ نَزَعَ الشَّيْطَانُ بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَ إِخْوَتِي [12:100]

after Satan caused dissension between me and my brothers

3. In some verses the negative used after *an* is *lan* and not *lā*.

ظَنُّوا أَن لَّن يَنْبَغْتَ اللَّهُ أَحَدًا [72:7]

they thought that God would not raise anyone

There are further uses of *an*, dealt with in Lesson 37.

أَنَّ *anna*

The use of *an* with the perfect is relatively rare because there is a related particle which is normally used in factual statements.

This is أَنَّ *anna*. It is essential to remember that while the two particles have some linkage in meaning **they differ totally in the construction they require.**

Anna takes an accusative, which must follow it **immediately** except in the one special case set out below. The accusative after *anna* may be a noun (or a pronoun like *hādha*) or a pronominal suffix.

Examples:

يَشْهَدُونَ أَنَّ اللَّهَ حَرَّمَ هَذَا [6:150]

they bear witness that God forbade this

عَلِمُوا أَنَّ الْحَقَّ لِلَّهِ [28:75]

they will know that the truth belongs to God

يَعْلَمُونَ أَنَّهُ الْحَقُّ مِنْ رَبِّهِمْ [2:26]

they know that it is the truth from their Lord

كَانَ عَاقِبَتُهُمَا أَنَّهُمَا فِي النَّارِ [59:17]

the consequence for both of them is that they will be in the fire

NOTES ON أَنَّ *anna*

1. Note that the rest of the sentence follows normal rules, as though the accusative after *anna* were a nominative. Under no circumstances can *anna* take a double accusative.
2. The only case in which a phrase can be placed between *anna* and its accusative is when the subordinate clause consists of an indefinite subject with a prepositional phrase as predicate.

In such a case the rules for prepositional predicate sentences have priority:

نَعْلَمُ أَنَّ مِنْكُمْ مُكَذِّبِينَ [69:49]

we know that some of you will deny the truth

It should be clear from the above sentences that the only requirement after *anna* is the following accusative. This accusative is essential, but, as set out in Note 1, the rest of the sentence follows the normal grammatical rules, as though the word in the accusative were a nominative.

3. *Anna* and the first person singular pronominal suffix produce two forms: *annī* and *anna-nī*. Likewise *anna* and the first person plural pronominal suffix produce *annā* and *anna-nā*.
4. The Qur'ān has *bi-anna* with the meaning 'because', *dhālika bi-anna*... 'that is because' being a common phrase:

ذَلِكَ بِأَنَّهُمْ كَفَرُوا بِاللَّهِ [9:80]

that is because they disbelieve in God

ذَلِكَ بِأَنَّهُمْ قَوْمٌ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ [9:6]

that is because they are a people who do not know

FURTHER NOTES ON أَنَّ *an* AND أَنَّ *anna*

It is impossible to have the Subjunctive after *anna*, just as it is impossible to have an *anna* type accusative after *an*.

Though *an* and *anna* normally introduce indirect statements, it is sometimes the case that the clause introduced by *an* or *anna* turns out to be the subject of the sentence:

وَأَنَّ تَصَدَّقُوا خَيْرٌ لَّكُمْ^A [2:280]

for you to remit [the debt] as alms is better for you

As a simple working rule remember:

an + subjunctive; *anna* + accusative.

^A This is a shortened form of *tataṣaddaqū*—see Lesson 15.

This is of course a simplification, but if you stick to it you will get an important area of grammar correct.

VOCABULARY EIGHTEEN

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
حَسِبَ	يَحْسِبُ	مَحْسِبَةٌ	to think, reckon
حَكَمَ	يَحْكُمُ	حُكْمٌ	to judge, decide
سَكَنَ	يَسْكُنُ	سُكُونٌ	to dwell, be at rest
طَمَعَ	يَطْمَعُ	طَمَعٌ	to desire
عَجَزَ	يَعْجِزُ	عَجْزٌ	to be unable
نَزَعَ	يَنْزِعُ	نَزْعٌ	to cause strife, dissension
نَفَدَ	يَنْفَدُ	نَفَادٌ	to be exhausted
2 حَرَّمَ	يُحَرِّمُ	تَحْرِيمٌ	to forbid, prohibit
2 نَزَّلَ	يُنْزِلُ	تَنْزِيلٌ	to send down
4 أَنْذَرَ	يُنْذِرُ	إِنْذَارٌ	to warn
3 بَايَعَ	يُبَايِعُ	مُبَايَعَةٌ	to do allegiance to
4 أَذْخَلَ	يُدْخِلُ	إِذْخَالٌ	to cause to enter
ذَبَحَ	يَذْبَحُ	ذَبْحٌ	to sacrifice
4 أَشْخَطَ	يُسْخِطُ	إِنْخِاطٌ	to vex
4 أَشْرَكَ	يُشْرِكُ	إِشْرَاكٌ	to ascribe partners to
5 تَصَدَّقَ	يَتَصَدَّقُ	تَصَدُّقٌ	to give alms

SINGULAR

PLURAL

بَقَرَةٌ

COW

Exercise Eighteen

SINGULAR

PLURAL

جَزَاءٌ		recompense
خَطِيئَةٌ	خَطِيئَاتٌ / خَطَايَا	sin
عِجْلٌ		calf
عَاقِبَةٌ		end, consequence
لَحْمٌ		flesh
مَالٌ	أَمْوَالٌ	property
حَنِידٌ		roast
وَسْطٌ		middle
غُرَابٌ		crow

EXERCISE EIGHTEEN

1. يَسْأَلُكَ أَهْلُ الْكِتَابِ أَنْ تُنَزِّلَ عَلَيْهِمْ كِتَابًا مِنَ السَّمَاءِ [4:153]
2. جَعَلْنَاكُمْ أُمَّةً وَسَطًا لِتَكُونُوا شُهَدَاءَ عَلَى النَّاسِ [2:143]
3. كَرِهُوا أَنْ يُجَاهِدُوا بِأَمْوَالِهِمْ وَأَنْفُسِهِمْ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ [9:81]
4. جَزَاءُوهُمْ أَنْ عَلَيْهِمْ لَعْنَةُ اللَّهِ [3:87]
5. يُبَايِعُكَ عَلَى أَنْ لَا يُشْرِكَ بِاللَّهِ شَيْئًا [60:12]
6. أَعَجَزْتَ أَنْ أَكُونَ مِثْلَ هَذَا الْغُرَابِ [5:31]
7. ذَلِكَ بِأَنَّهُمْ اتَّبَعُوا مَا أَصْحَبَ اللَّهُ [47:28]
8. آيَتِكَ إِلَّا تُكَلِّمَ النَّاسَ ثَلَاثَ لَيَالٍ [19:10]
9. نَزَّلَ بِهِ عَلَى قَلْبِكَ لِتَكُونَ مِنَ الْمُنذِرِينَ [26:193-4]
10. نَظْمَعُ أَنْ يَدْخِلَنَا رَبُّنَا مَعَ الْقَوْمِ الصَّالِحِينَ [5:84]

11. لَنْ يُؤَخَّرَ اللَّهُ نَفْسًا [63:11]
12. إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْمُرُكُمْ أَنْ تَذْبَحُوا بَقَرَةً [2:67]
13. هُوَ الْحَقُّ مِنْ رَبِّكَ لِتُنذِرَ قَوْمًا [32:3]
14. يُبَشِّرُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ أَنَّ لَهُمْ أَجْرًا كَبِيرًا [17:9]
15. جَعَلْنَا اللَّيْلَ لِيَسْكُنُوا فِيهِ [27:86]
16. هُوَ الْقَادِرُ عَلَى أَنْ يَبْعَثَ عَلَيْكُمْ عَذَابًا [6:65]
17. تَبَيَّنَ لَهُمْ أَنَّهُمْ أَصْحَابُ الْجَحِيمِ^A [9:113]
18. تَبَيَّنَ لَهُ أَنَّهُ عَدُوٌّ لِلَّهِ [9:114]
19. وَكَتَبْنَا عَلَيْهِمْ فِيهَا أَنَّ النَّفْسَ بِالنَّفْسِ وَالْعَيْنَ بِالْعَيْنِ [5:45]
20. سَخَّرَ الْبَحْرَ لِيَأْكُلُوا مِنْهُ لَحْمًا [16:14]
21. ذَلِكَ جَزَاءُهُمْ بِأَنَّهُمْ كَفَرُوا بِآيَاتِنَا [17:98]
22. إِنَّا نَظْمَعُ أَنْ يَغْفِرَ لَنَا رَبُّنَا خَطَايَانَا [26:51]
23. أَوَلَا يَذْكُرُ الْإِنْسَانُ أَنَّا خَلَقْنَاهُ [19:67]
24. وَأَنْزَلَ مَعَهُمُ الْكِتَابَ بِالْحَقِّ لِيَحْكُمَ بَيْنَ النَّاسِ [2:213]
25. هَلْ أَتَّبِعَكَ عَلَى أَنْ تُعَلِّمَنِي [18:66]

^A *Al-Jahīmu* and *Jahannam* (p. 125) are two of the names for Hell.

Lesson Nineteen

Inna

Anna is only one of a number of particles that take an accusative, with the rest of the sentence or clause acting as though that accusative were a nominative. Of these the most important is *إِنَّ inna*—in fact, this is the word with which the construction originated. *Inna* is really a fossilized verb, which makes it easier to understand why the accusative is required.

Inna is commonly translated as ‘indeed’ or even ‘verily’, but neither rendering is adequate to give the effect of the word. In most cases it is best left untranslated.

Like *anna*, *inna* and the first person singular pronominal suffix produce two forms: *innī* and *inna-nī*; *inna* and the first person plural pronominal suffix produce *innā* and *inna-nā*.

Inna has three main functions:

- a) to give emphasis (hence its translation as ‘indeed’)
- b) to allow a change in word order, with the subject preceding the verb
- c) to act as a slightly disjunctive ‘marker’

The catch is that it may have one, two or all of these functions at once. Experience alone will tell you which.

Simple examples of the use of *inna*:

إِنَّ اللَّهَ مَعَ الصَّابِرِينَ	God is with the patient
إِنَّهُمْ عِبَادُكَ	they are Your servants
إِنَّ خَلْقَنَا هُمْ مِنْ تُرَابٍ	We created them from dust
إِنَّ أَرْضِي وَاسِعَةٌ	My land is wide
إِنَّ مَعَ الْعُسْرِ يُسْرًا	there is some ease with [all] the difficulty

Notes on the use of *inna*

1. It is common for the second half of a sentence introduced by *inna* to be prefixed by *la-*. In such cases it is immaterial whether the second half of the sentence is a predicate or a deferred subject.

إِنَّ رَبَّكَ لَذُو مَغْفِرَةٍ your Lord is forgiving
 إِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ لَآيَةً لَّكُمْ in that there is a sign for you

2. When *inna* has been followed by a pronominal suffix, one may still find that cluster followed by a nominative pronoun.

إِنَّكُمْ أَنْتُمْ الظَّالِمُونَ you are the wrong-doers
 إِنَّكَ أَنْتَ الْوَهَّابُ you are the Forgiving

3. It is not uncommon for *inna* to have the pronominal suffix *-hu* attached to it and then for the rest of the sentence to move off in a completely different direction. In effect, the only role of the suffix in such circumstances is to meet the grammatical requirements of *inna*. This is also true of *anna*.

إِنَّهُ أَنَا اللَّهُ الْعَزِيزُ الْحَكِيمُ I am God, the Mighty and Decisive
 إِنَّهُ لَا يَفْلِحُ الظَّالِمُونَ the wrong-doers will not prosper

THE USE OF *qāla*

The most striking use of the 'marker' function is after the verb *qāla* 'to say', the perfect of which was given in Lesson 12. The imperfect and subjunctive conjugate in the same way as those of *kāna*.

Imperfect

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَقُولُ	يَقُولَانِ	يَقُولُونَ
3 f.	تَقُولُ	تَقُولَانِ	يَقُلْنَ
2 m.	تَقُولُ	تَقُولَانِ	تَقُولُونَ
2 f.	تَقُولِينَ	تَقُولَانِ	تَقُلْنَ
I	أَقُولُ	—	نَقُولُ

Subjunctive

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَقُولَ	يَقُولَا	يَقُولُوا
3 f.	تَقُولَ	تَقُولَا	يَقُلْنَ
2 m.	تَقُولَ	تَقُولَا	تَقُولُوا
2 f.	تَقُولِي	تَقُولَا	تَقُلْنَ
I	أَقُولَ	—	نَقُولَ

Whereas other verbs in Arabic readily have indirect statements introduced by *an* or *anna*, this is not the case with *qāla*. In all normal circumstances it is followed by:

- direct speech, not introduced by *inna*;
- direct speech, introduced by *inna*;
- indirect speech, also introduced by *inna*.

The third instance is rare in the Qur'ān.

Examples of *qāla* followed by *inna* and direct speech:

قَالَ إِنِّي سَقِيمٌ he said, 'I am ill.'
 قَالَ إِنَّ هَؤُلَاءِ ضَيْفِي he said, 'These are my guests.'

قَالُوا إِنَّا نَصَارَى they said, 'We are Christians.'

Examples of *qāla* followed immediately by direct speech without *inna*:

قَالَ الْكَافِرُونَ هَذَا سَاحِرٌ the unbelievers said, 'This is a sorcerer.'

قَالَتْ أَنَّى يَكُونُ لِي غُلَامٌ she said, 'How can I have a son?'

Very occasionally other verbs are followed by *inna* and direct speech, e.g.:

رَبُّنَا يَعْلَمُ إِنَّا إِلَيْنَكُم مَّرْسَلُونَ [36:16]

our Lord knows we are sent to you

نَشْهَدُ إِنَّكَ لَرَسُولُ اللَّهِ [63:1]

we bear witness that you are God's messenger

VOCABULARY NINETEEN

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
جَمَعَ	يَجْمَعُ	جَمْعٌ	to gather, collect
غَفَلَ	يَغْفُلُ	غَفْلَةٌ	to be heedless, forget
3 خَادَعَ	يُخَادِعُ	خِدَاعٌ	to try to deceive
4 أَحْسَنَ	يُحْسِنُ	إِحْسَانٌ	to do good
4 أَفْلَحَ	يُفْلِحُ	إِفْلَاحٌ	to prosper
4 أَخْلَصَ	يُخْلِصُ	إِخْلَاصٌ	to be sincere

SINGULAR

PLURAL

تُرَابٌ

earth, dust

زَلْزَلَةٌ

earthquake

شَيْخٌ

old man

Exercise Nineteen

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
ضَيْفٌ		guest; guests
عَدْلٌ		justice
عُسْرٌ		difficulty
غُلَامٌ		boy, son
نَعَمٌ	أَنْعَامٌ	animal, beast
يُسْرٌ		ease
سَقِيمٌ		sick, ill
أَصْفَرٌ	(f.) صُفْرٌ / صَفَرَاءُ	yellow
مُنَافِقٌ		hypocrite
وَهَّابٌ		forgiving
بَشِيرٌ		bearer of good news/tidings

EXERCISE NINETEEN

- | | | |
|----|---|---------|
| 1. | إِنَّا إِلَيْهِ رَاجِعُونَ | [2:156] |
| 2. | إِنَّكَ جَامِعُ النَّاسِ | [3:9] |
| 3. | إِنَّ كَذَلِكَ نَفْعَلُ بِالْمُجْرِمِينَ | [37:34] |
| 4. | قَالُوا إِنَّا إِلَى رَبِّنَا مُنْقَلِبُونَ | [7:125] |
| 5. | إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْمُرُ بِالْعَدْلِ وَالْإِحْسَانِ | [16:90] |
| 6. | إِنَّ جَعَلْنَاكَ خَلِيفَةً فِي الْأَرْضِ | [38:26] |
| 7. | إِنَّ جَهَنَّمَ جَزَاءُكُمْ | [17:63] |
| 8. | إِنَّكَ لَمُجْنُونٌ | [15:6] |
| 9. | إِنَّ اللَّهَ غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ | [2:173] |

10. قَالَ الْكَافِرُونَ إِنَّ هَذَا لَسَاحِرٌ مُبِينٌ [10:2]
11. إِنَّ لَنَا نَذْرًا [5:22]
12. إِنَّ اللَّهَ عَدُوٌّ لِلْكَافِرِينَ [2:98]
13. إِنَّا أَنْزَلْنَا إِلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ بِالْحَقِّ [4:105]
14. إِنَّ لَهُ أَبًا شَيْخًا كَبِيرًا [12:78]
15. إِنَّهُ مِنْ عِبَادِنَا الْمُخْلَصِينَ [12:24]
16. إِنَّ هَذَا لَشَيْءٌ عَجِيبٌ [11:72]
17. إِنَّ الشَّيْطَانَ لِلْإِنْسَانِ عَدُوٌّ مُبِينٌ [12:5]
18. إِنَّهُ مِنَ الصَّالِحِينَ [21:75]
19. إِنَّهُ بِمَا تَعْمَلُونَ بَصِيرٌ [11:112]
20. إِنَّ زَلْزَلَةَ السَّاعَةِ شَيْءٌ عَظِيمٌ [22:1]
21. إِنَّهَا بَقَرَةٌ صَفْرَاءُ [2:69]
22. إِنَّ اللَّهَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ قَدِيرٌ [2:148]
23. إِنِّي تَوَكَّلْتُ عَلَى اللَّهِ [11:56]
24. إِنَّ كَثِيرًا مِنَ النَّاسِ عَنْ آيَاتِنَا لَغَافِلُونَ [10:92]
25. إِنَّ لَكُمْ فِي الْأَنْعَامِ لَعِبْرَةً [23:21]
26. أَلَا إِنَّ لِلَّهِ مَا فِي السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضِ [24:64]
27. إِنَّ الْمُنَافِقِينَ يُخَادِعُونَ اللَّهَ [4:142]
28. إِنَّا أَرْسَلْنَاكَ بِالْحَقِّ بَشِيرًا وَنَذِيرًا [35:24]
29. قَالُوا شَهِدْنَا عَلَى أَنْفُسِنَا [6:130]
30. قَالُوا وَجَدْنَا آبَاءَنَا لَهَا عَابِدِينَ [21:53]

Lesson Twenty

The Jussive

Like the Subjunctive, the Jussive is closely related in form to the Imperfect Indicative. With the Jussive the final short vowel changes from the *u* of the Indicative and the *a* of the Subjunctive to a *sukūn*. However, when the following word begins with a prosthetic vowel the *sukūn* changes to a *kasra*. In other persons there is no difference between the forms of the Subjunctive and the Jussive. Learn the basic form of the Jussive from the table below.

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَكْتُبْ	يَكْتُبَا	يَكْتُبُوا
3 f.	تَكْتُبْ	تَكْتُبَا	يَكْتُبْنَ
2 m.	تَكْتُبْ	تَكْتُبَا	تَكْتُبُوا
2 f.	تَكْتُبِي	تَكْتُبَا	تَكْتُبْنَ
I	أَكْتُبْ	—	نَكْتُبْ

The Jussive of *kāna* is:

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَكُنْ	يَكُونَا	يَكُونُوا
3 f.	تَكُنْ	تَكُونَا	يَكُنَّ
2 m.	تَكُنْ	تَكُونَا	تَكُونُوا
2 f.	تَكُونِي	تَكُونَا	تَكُنَّ
I	أَكُنْ	—	نَكُنْ

In the Qur'ān there are occasions on which the forms of *yakun*, *takun*, *akun* and *nakun* become *yaku*, *taku*, *aku* and *naku*. These forms are common in poetry but rare elsewhere. The important thing is to be able to recognise them for the forms they are. There are no such problems with the jussive of *qāla*, which is:

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَقُلْ	يَقُولَا	يَقُولُوا
3 f.	تَقُلْ	تَقُولَا	يَقُلْنَ
2 m.	تَقُلْ	تَقُولَا	تَقُولُوا
2 f.	تَقُولِي	تَقُولَا	تَقُلْنَ
1	أَقُلْ	—	نَقُلْ

The Jussive has four uses:

1. It is used after the negative particle *لَمْ* *lam* 'not' (and the rare *لَمَّا* *lammā* 'not yet').

In dealing with *lam* + the Jussive, grammarians normally say something akin to Wright's view that it 'invariably has the meaning of *mā* + the perfect' (*Grammar*, 2, 24). However, this is not true either of the Qur'ān or of early Arabic in general, where *lam* + the Jussive usually has a past meaning but sometimes a present meaning:

أَوَلَمْ تُؤْمِنُ [2:260]

do you not believe?

أَلَمْ تَعْلَمْ أَنَّ اللَّهَ لَهُ مُلْكُ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ [5:40]

do you not know that God has sovereignty over the heavens and the earth?

أَلَمْ يَعْلَمُوا أَنَّ اللَّهَ يَعْلَمُ سِرَّهُمْ [9:78]

do they not know that God knows their secret?

لَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُ وَلِيٌّ [17:111]

he has no protector

2. After the negative *lā*, the Jussive is used to express prohibitions:

لَا تَحْزَنْ do not be sad

لَا تُفْسِدُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ do not cause mischief in the earth

لَا تَكُونُوا أَوَّلَ كَافِرٍ do not be the first infidel

3. After *li-*, *fal-* or *wal-*, the Jussive is used to express indirect commands:

لِيُنْفِقْ ذُو سَعَةٍ مِنْ سَعَتِهِ let the man of substance spend some of his substance

وَلْنَحْمِلْ خَطَايَاكُمْ let us bear your sins

عَلَى اللَّهِ فَلْيَتَوَكَّلِ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ let the believers trust in God

4. In conditional sentences (see Lesson 36).

VOCABULARY TWENTY

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
حَزَنَ	يَحْزَنُ	حُزْنٌ	to be sad
عَرَفَ	يَعْرِفُ	مَعْرِفَةٌ	to know, recognize
قَرَبَ	يَقْرُبُ	قُرْبٌ	to come near, approach
نَقَضَ	يَنْقُضُ	نَقْضٌ	to break one's oath
أَفْسَدَ	يُفْسِدُ	فَسَادٌ	to cause mischief

SINGULAR PLURAL

حُلُمٌ

puberty

سِرٌّ

أَسْرَارٌ

secret

SINGULAR

PLURAL

شَجَرَةٌ

شَجَرٌ

tree

كُفُوٌ

equal

سَعَةٌ

wealth

EXERCISE TWENTY

1. لَمْ تُنذِرْهُمْ [2:6]
2. يُعَلِّمُكُمْ مَا لَمْ تَكُونُوا تَعْلَمُونَ [2:151]
3. لَمْ أَشْرِكْ بِرَبِّي أَحَدًا [18:42]
4. لَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُ وَلِيٌّ [17:111]
5. أَلَمْ تَعْلَمْ أَنَّ اللَّهَ يَعْلَمُ مَا فِي السَّمَاءِ وَالْأَرْضِ [22:70]
6. لَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُ شَرِيكٌ فِي الْمُلْكِ [25:2]
7. لَمْ يَبْلُغُوا الْحُلُمَ [24:58]
8. لَمْ يَجْعَلِ اللَّهُ لَهُ نُورًا [24:40]
9. أَلَمْ أَقُلْ لَكُمْ [68:28]
10. لَا تَسْتَغِثِ [46:35]
11. فَعَلِمَ مَا لَمْ تَعْلَمُوا [48:27]
12. أَقَلِمَ يَنْظُرُوا إِلَى السَّمَاءِ فَوْقَهُمْ [50:6]
13. عَلَّمَ الْإِنْسَانَ مَا لَمْ يَعْلَمْ [96:5]
14. فَلَمْ يَجِدُوا لَهُمْ مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ أَنْصَارًا [71:25]
15. أَلَمْ نَجْعَلْ لَهُ عَيْنَيْنِ [90:8]

Exercise Twenty

16. أَلَمْ نُهِكِ الْأَوَّلِينَ [77:16]
17. لَمْ تَكُونُوا مُؤْمِنِينَ [37:29]
18. لَمْ يَسْمَعْهَا [31:7]
19. أَلَمْ يَعِدْكُمْ رَبُّكُمْ وَعْدًا حَسَنًا [20:86]
20. لَا تَقْرَبَا هَذِهِ الشَّجَرَةَ [2:35]
21. لَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُ كُفُوًا أَحَدٌ [112:4]
22. لَا تَحْزَنِي [28:7]
23. لَا تَعْبُدِ الشَّيْطَانَ [19:44]
24. لَا تَسْأَلْنِي عَنْ شَيْءٍ [18:70]
25. لَا تَكُنْ مَعَ الْكَافِرِينَ [11:42]
26. لَا تَقْتُلُوا أَوْلَادَكُمْ [17:31]
27. لَا تَنْقُضُوا الْأَيْمَانَ [16:91]
28. لَا تَدْخُلُوا مِنْ بَابٍ وَاحِدٍ [12:67]

Lesson Twenty-One

Laysa; idh; idhā; man

لَيْسَ *laysa*

You already know that *kāna* is not used in the Imperfect to give the sense of 'is'. However, there is a verb that is used to mean 'is not'. This is *laysa*. It has a present meaning (and only a present meaning), but its forms in the only tense that exists resemble those of a Perfect (of sorts):

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	لَيْسَ	لَيْسَا	لَيْسُوا
3 f.	لَيْسَتْ	لَيْسَتَا	لَيْسْنَ
2 m.	لَسْتَ	لَسْتُمَا	لَسْتُمْ
2 f.	لَسْتِ	لَسْتُمَا	لَسْتُنَّ
1	لَسْتُ	—	لَسْنَا

The predicate of *laysa* is introduced either by *bi-* and the genitive or, less frequently, by the accusative. You have already seen this with the Hījāzī *mā* in Lesson 10. What appears to have happened is that in the Hījāz the usage of *mā* was assimilated to the usage of *laysa*.

أَلَيْسَ اللَّهُ بِعَزِيزٍ	is not God mighty?
لَسْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ بِوَكِيلٍ	I am not a guardian over you
لَسْتَ مُرْسَلًا	you are not someone sent as a messenger

إِذْ *idh* AND إِذَا *idhā*

Idh and *idhā* are two closely related particles that developed from an obsolete noun *idh(un)* ‘time’.

In general *idh* as a conjunction means ‘when’ or ‘since’. The only exception to this is when it is used with *qabla* or *ba‘da* to form compound conjunctions; *qabla idh* ‘before’ and *ba‘da idh* ‘after’.

Idh is most commonly followed by the perfect but imperfect and nominal sentences also occur. In the Qur’ān the ratio is 15:3:1, and *idh* almost always means ‘when’. There are a couple of possible exceptions as well as a handful of examples in which *idh* is followed by *lam*, but these are unlikely to cause difficulties. Typical Qur’ānic examples are:

إِذْ دَخَلُوا عَلَيْهِ [15:52]

when they went in to see him

إِذْ تَصْعَدُونَ [3:153]

when you were climbing (the hill)

إِذِ الظَّالِمُونَ فِي غَمَرَاتِ الْمَوْتِ [6:93]

when the sinners are in death’s pangs

In the Qur’ān the combination *wa-idh* at the beginning of a verse has a specific and highly idiomatic use to introduce a piece of narrative. The only convincing way that this can be rendered into English is to translate it as ‘and [remember] when ...’, unless it occurs in a series (e.g. in verses 2:49, 50, 51, 53, 54, 55) when the ‘remember’ is required only on the first occasion. This translation of *wa-idh* is confirmed by a handful of examples in which the Imperative ‘remember’ actually occurs. Here are a couple of examples:

وَإِذْ قَالَ رَبُّكَ لِلْمَلَائِكَةِ [15:28]

remember when your Lord said to the angels. . .

وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ [33:7]

remember when we took from the prophets their covenant. . .

Idhā has two functions:

1. As a conjunction meaning 'when', 'as often as', *idhā* is normally followed by the Perfect, though the Imperfect is sometimes found. Usually it implies a condition, and then its construction is normally that of a conditional sentence [see Lesson 36].

A fuller form *idhā-mā* is also found from time to time, also with the construction of conditional sentences.

One striking and somewhat unusual use of the conjunction *idhā* occurs in early Meccan *sūras*, where *idhā* is used in an exclamatory, almost oath-like way. *Sūra* 81, for example, starts with twelve examples of this, and *Sūra* 82 with four. In such cases the subject may precede the verb:

إِذَا السَّمَاءُ أَنْفَطَرَتْ [82:1]

when the heavens are split asunder

2. If *idhā* is followed by a noun or pronoun, it acts as an interjection with the meaning 'lo', 'behold'. This is much less common than the conjunction *idhā*. In most examples of this usage, *idhā* is followed by a third person pronoun:

نَزَعَ يَدَهُ فَإِذَا هِيَ بَيْضَاءُ he withdrew his hand and,
behold, it was white

فَإِذَا هُمْ يَنْظُرُونَ behold, they look on

إِذَا هُمْ يَسْخَطُونَ behold, they are vexed

However, sometimes nouns follow *idhā* in this construction:

إِذَا فَرِيقٌ مِنْهُمْ مُعْرِضُونَ [24:48]

behold, a group of them turning away

مَنْ *man*

You have already read of the use of *mā* as a relative pronoun meaning 'that which' in Lesson 10 and of the use of *mā* and *man* as interrogative pronouns meaning 'what?' and 'who?' in Lesson 17. It will therefore come as no surprise to learn that *man* also operates

as a relative pronoun 'he who', 'she who' or 'those who'. Under all normal circumstances, *man* is treated grammatically as a masculine singular, even when it refers to the feminine or the plural.

Examples of *man* as singular:

- مَنْ وَجَدَنَا مَتَاعَنَا عِنْدَهُ the one in whose possession we found our goods
- أَتَجْعَلُ فِيهَا مَنْ يُفْسِدُ فِيهَا will you place in it someone who will cause mischief in it?
- الْبِرُّ مَنْ اتَّقَى the pious man is the one who fears God

Examples of *man* as singular/plural:^A

- مَنْ كَفَرَ فَعَلَيْهِ كُفْرُهُ whoever disbelieves bears the consequence of his unbelief
- مَنْ عَمِلَ صَالِحًا فَلِنَفْسِهِ whoever acts righteously it is to his own advantage

Examples of *man* as plural:

- ذُرِّيَّةٌ مِّنْ حَمَلْنَا مَعَ نُوحٍ the descendants of those whom we carried with Noah
- لَا يَعْلَمُ مَنْ فِي السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ الْغَيْبَ those who are in the heavens and earth do not know the unseen
- تُنذِرُ مَنِ اتَّبَعَ الذِّكْرَ you warn those who follow the reminder
- أَفَأَنْتَ تُنْقِذُ مَنْ فِي النَّارِ can you rescue those who are in the fire?

^A On the use of *fa-* in the following examples see Lesson 36.

VOCABULARY TWENTY-ONE

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
رَكَضَ	يَرْكُضُ	رَكْضٌ	to run
صَعِدَ	يَصْعَدُ	صُعُودٌ	to ascend
زَيَّنَ ²	يُزَيِّنُ	تَزْيِينٌ	to cause to seem good
وَاعَدَ ³	يُوَاعِدُ	مُوعَاذَةٌ	to make an agreement with
عَاهَدَ ³	يُعَاهِدُ	مُعَاهَدَةٌ	to make a covenant with
أَسْلَمَ ⁴	يُسْلِمُ	إِسْلَامٌ	to submit
أَخْطَأَ ⁴	يُخْطِئُ	إِخْطَاءٌ	to make a mistake
أَغْرَقَ ⁴	يُغْرِقُ	إِغْرَاقٌ	to drown
أَعْرَضَ ⁴	يُعْرِضُ	إِعْرَاضٌ	to turn away
انْفَطَرَ ⁷	يَنْفَطِرُ	انْفِطَارٌ	to be split
أَنْقَذَ ⁴	يُنْقِذُ	إِنْقَاذٌ	to save

SINGULAR PLURAL

مَثْوًى

lodging

جِنٌّ

Jinn

حِزْبٌ أَحْزَابٌ

party

ذُرِّيَّةٌ

seed, offspring, descendants

غَمْرَةٌ

غَمَرَاتٌ

pang

قَبْرٌ

قُبُورٌ

grave

14. وَمِنَ الْحَيِّ مَنْ يَعْمَلُ بَيْنَ يَدَيْهِ بِإِذْنِ رَبِّهِ [34:12]
15. مَا أَنْتَ بِمُسْمِعٍ مَنْ فِي الْقُبُورِ [35:22]
16. مِنْهُمْ مَنْ عَاهَدَ اللَّهَ [9:75]
17. مِنَ الْأَخْزَابِ مَنْ يُنْكِرُ بَعْضَهُ [13:36]
18. مِنَ النَّاسِ مَنْ يُجَادِلُ فِي اللَّهِ بِغَيْرِ عِلْمٍ [22:8]
19. إِذَا هُمْ مِنْهَا يَرْكُضُونَ [21:12]
20. فَإِذَا هُمْ فَرِيقَانِ [27:45]
21. إِذَا أَنْتُمْ بَشَرٌ [30:20]
22. إِذَا فَرِيقٌ مِنْهُمْ بِرَبِّهِمْ يُشْرِكُونَ [30:33]
23. وَإِذْ زَيْنَ لَهُمُ الشَّيْطَانُ أَعْمَالَهُمْ [8:48]
24. وَإِذْ وَاعَدْنَا مُوسَى أَرْبَعِينَ لَيْلَةً [2:51]

Lesson Twenty-Two

Verbs with a *hamza* as one of their Radicals

The basic rules for the spelling of *hamza* were set out in the Introduction to the Arabic alphabet (p. 1). To recapitulate:

1. At the beginning of a word the bearer of *hamza* is *alif*.
2. When *hamza* follows a short vowel or *sukūn* the bearer is determined by the vowel immediately before and the vowel immediately after the *hamza* in the following order of precedence: *kasra*, *ḍamma*, *fatha* (*sukūn* can have no precedence^A), i.e.:
 - a) if there is a *kasra* in either place, the bearer is *yā'* without dots;
 - b) if there is no *kasra* in either place, but there is a *ḍamma* in either place, the bearer is *wāw*;
 - c) if neither *kasra* nor *ḍamma* occur, the bearer will be an *alif*.
3. After a long vowel *hamza* does not have a bearer:
 - a) if it is the final letter;
 - b) if the vowel following the *hamza* is *fatha*.
4. In other cases the bearer of the *hamza* that follows a long vowel is determined by the vowel coming after the *hamza*. Rules 3 and 4 are illustrated clearly by the following examples:

friends	أَصْدِقَاءُ
His friends	
nom.	أَصْدِقَاؤُهُ
acc.	أَصْدِقَاءَهُ
gen.	أَصْدِقَائِهِ

^A Unless the *sukūn* is followed by *hamza* as final radical, in which case there is no bearer.

5. *hamza* followed by *ā* is written *alif madda* **آ**.

Rules with which you will not yet be familiar are:

6. At the beginning of a word *fathā*, when followed by *hamza* plus *sukūn*, becomes a *madda*.
7. In theory prosthetic *kasra* when followed by *hamza* plus *sukūn* becomes **إِ** and prosthetic *ḍamma* + *hamza* + *sukūn* becomes **أُ**. However, after another vowel reversion takes place. This happens most often with verb forms, including verbal nouns, particularly in the 8th form. However, it is not a feature that appears in the Qur'ān. The only regular 8th forms that occur are those of **أَمَرَ** *amara* [Imperfect 28:20, Imperative 65:6] and of **أَمِنَ** *amina* [Perfect passive 2:283]. That of **أَخَذَ** *akhadha*, which occurs over 120 times, acts as though it were an assimilated verb (see Lesson 24), producing **اِتَّخَذَ** *ittakhadha*, as would have been normal in the Ḥijāz.
8. In the Imperfect of third radical *hamza* verbs, final *hamza* preceded by *fathā* and followed by *ḍamma* retains *alif* as its bearer, e.g.: **يَقْرَأُ**.
9. The *maṣḍar* of the 2nd form of third-radical *hamza* verbs is based on the pattern *taf'īlatun*, e.g. **تَبَرُّة** *tabri'atun* from **بَرَّأَ** *barra'a*.

You have already been introduced to some of the most important verbs with *hamza* as one of their radicals: *akhadha*, *akala*, *amara* and *sa'ala*. The vocabulary that follows includes all the remaining verbs that have *hamza* as one of their radicals and sound letters as the other two and that occur in the Qur'ān with reasonable frequency. By far the most important of them is the 4th form **آمَنَ** *āmana*, 'to believe', the active participle of which is *mu'minun*, 'a believer'.

It will not be possible to introduce you to verbs that have *hamza* as one radical and a *wāw* or a *yā'* as one of the other two until hollow and defective verbs are dealt with (see Lessons 28 and 30). They include some of the most common verbs in the Qur'ān:

جَاءَ *jā'a*, أَتَى *atā*, رَأَى *ra'a*, شَاءَ *shā'a*, سَاءَ *sā'a*; and the fourth form آتَى *ātā*.

ADVERBS IN -u

Arabic has one genuine adverbial ending: final *ḍamma*. Most of the words in which it occurs are nouns that have developed a prepositional form. Thus from *qabla*, *ba'da*, *tahta* and *fawqa* there is an adverbial form قَبْلُ *qablu*, بَعْدُ *ba'du*, تَحْتُ *tahtu* and فَوْقُ *fawqu*. These adverbial forms are invariable. 'Beforehand' may be *qablu* or *min qablu* and so on. The adverbial form قَطُّ *qattu*, 'ever', common elsewhere in Arabic, does not occur in the Qur'ān.

VOCABULARY TWENTY-TWO

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
آثَرَ ⁴	يُؤَثِّرُ	إِثَارٌ	to prefer
أَذِنَ	يَأْذِنُ	إِذْنٌ	to permit, allow
10 اسْتَأْذَنَ	يَسْتَأْذِنُ	اسْتِئْذَانٌ	to seek permission
أَمِنَ	يَأْمَنُ	أَمْنٌ	to be secure; to trust in
4 أَمَنَ	يُؤْمِنُ	إِيمَانٌ	to believe
4 أَنْسَ	يُؤْنِسُ	إِينَاسٌ	to see, perceive
6 تَسَاءَلَ	يَتَسَاءَلُ	تَسَاوُلٌ	to ask one another
قَرَأَ	يَقْرَأُ	قُرْآنٌ	to recite
2 نَبَأَ	يُنَبِّئُ	نَبِيَّةٌ	to inform, tell
4 أَنْبَأَ	يُنْبِئُ	إِنْبَاءٌ	to inform, tell
4 أَنْشَأَ	يُنْشِئُ	إِنْشَاءٌ	to raise, create, produce, grow

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN
بَرِحَ	يَبْرَحُ	بَرَحٌ to leave
4 أَقْبَلَ	يُقْبِلُ	إِقْبَالٌ to advance
كَمَا		like (conjunction)
مِثْلَ		like (preposition)

EXERCISE TWENTY-TWO

1. أَقْبَلَ بَعْضُهُمْ عَلَى بَعْضٍ يَتَسَاءَلُونَ [37:27]
2. أُولَئِكَ يَفْرُوُونَ كِتَابَهُمْ [17:71]
3. قَرَأَهُ عَلَيْهِمْ [26:199]
4. أَذِنَ لَهُ الرَّحْمَنُ [20:109]
5. لَنْ أُبْرَحَ الْأَرْضَ حَتَّى يَأْذَنَ لِي أَبِي [12:80]
6. سَأَلَكَ عِبَادِي عَنِّي [2:186]
7. يَسْأَلُونَ أَيَّانَ يَوْمُ الدِّينِ [51:12]
8. يَسْأَلُكَ النَّاسُ عَنِ السَّاعَةِ [33:63]
9. أَنْشَأَكُمْ مِنْ نَفْسٍ وَاحِدَةٍ [6:98]
10. أَنْتُمْ أَنْشَأْتُمْ شَجَرَتَهَا أَمْ نَحْنُ الْمُنْشِئُونَ [56:72]
11. أَنْشَأْنَا مِنْ بَعْدِهِمْ قُرُونًا آخَرِينَ [23:42]
12. كَانَ يَأْمُرُ أَهْلَهُ بِالصَّلَاةِ وَالزَّكَاةِ [19:55]
13. آمَنَ بِاللَّهِ وَمَلَائِكَتِهِ وَكُتُبِهِ وَرُسُلِهِ [2:285]
14. أَنْوْمِنُ لِبَشَرَيْنِ مِثْلِنَا [23:47]

Exercise Twenty-Two

15. أَفَبِالْبَاطِلِ يُؤْمِنُونَ وَبِنِعْمَةِ اللَّهِ هُمْ يَكْفُرُونَ [16:72]
16. تُؤْثِرُونَ الْحَيَاةَ الدُّنْيَا [87:16]
17. قَدْ أَثَرَكِ اللَّهُ عَلَيْنَا [12:91]
18. أَنْبَأَهُمْ بِأَسْمَائِهِمْ [2:33]
19. فَيَنْبِئُهُمْ بِمَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ [6:108]
20. أَتَنْبِئُونَ اللَّهَ بِمَا لَا يَعْلَمُ [10:18]
21. مَنْ أَنْبَأَكَ هَذَا [66:3]
22. فَاسْتَأْذِنُوكَ لِلْخُرُوجِ [9:83]
23. إِنِّي أَنَسْتُ نَارًا [20:10]
24. أَنْبِئُكُمْ بِمَا تَأْكُلُونَ [3:49]

Lesson Twenty-Three

Relative Sentences

You have already seen how the two main relative pronouns, *mā* and *man*, are used. It is now time to look at the way the relative **الَّذِي** *alladhī* is used. *Alladhī* can be used as a pronoun, in which case it acts like *mā* or *man*. However, it is basically an adjective, and its adjectival use needs careful attention.

Alladhī declines in a way that is similar to that of the demonstratives. The singular and plural do not decline, but the dual does:

	m.s.	f.s.
	الَّذِي	الَّتِي
	m.d.	f.d.
nom.	الَّذَانِ	الَّتَانِ
acc., gen.	الَّذَيْنِ	الَّتَيْنِ
	m.p.	f.p.
	الَّذِينَ	اللَّوَاتِي اللَّائِي

The masculine dual forms occur only once each in the Qur'ān, whilst the feminine dual forms do not occur at all. Note that in the dual and in the feminine plural forms the *lām* is written twice, as opposed to once elsewhere.

The first element of **الَّذِي** *alladhī* is the definite article. This means that *alladhī* can **be used only with a definite antecedent**. The form of *alladhī* that is used is determined by the antecedent in **number, gender and case**. In the Qur'ān you cannot actually see that this is so for case, as the two dual examples, the only ones

in which case is clearly shown, are both examples of pronominal usage and thus are their own antecedent. Two non-Qur'ānic examples that have the same meaning but different word order will show how *alladhī* works:

a) لَا يَرْجِعُ الرَّجُلَانِ اللَّذَانِ نَصَرَانِي

the two men who helped me will not return

In this example a negative verb (*lā yarji'u*) is followed by a definite subject/antecedent in the nominative together with its relative adjective, which agrees with it in number, gender and case (*l-rajulāni lladhāni*), then the relative sentence (*naṣarā-nī*). It is important to note that *lladhāni* is not part of the relative sentence.

b) إِنَّ الرَّجُلَيْنِ اللَّذَيْنِ نَصَرَانِي لَا يَرْجِعَانِ

The second sentence has the same meaning, but it starts with the particle *inna* followed by the definite subject/antecedent in the accusative together with its relative adjective, which agrees with it in number, gender and case (*l-rajulayni lladhayni*), then the same relative sentence (*naṣarā-nī*), and finally the verb of the main sentence with its negative (*lā yarji'āni*). Once again it should be noted that the relative adjective is not part of the relative sentence.

If the relative sentence is changed from 'who helped me' to 'whom I helped', the sentences become:

c) لَا يَرْجِعُ الرَّجُلَانِ اللَّذَانِ نَصَرْتُهُمَا

d) إِنَّ الرَّجُلَيْنِ اللَّذَيْنِ نَصَرْتُهُمَا لَا يَرْجِعَانِ

The analysis given above again applies, but this time the relative sentence *naṣartu-humā* has an explicit pronoun referring back to the antecedent. With *naṣarā-nī* in (a) and (b) the pronoun is implicit in the verb. This referring pronoun is an essential part of the relative sentence. In fact, there are two things to be remembered about the relative sentence: (i) it must normally be a complete sentence in itself; (ii) it must normally contain a referring pronoun, whether this is explicit or implicit.

Now look at the sentences with an indefinite subject substituted for the definite one:

(a) لَا يَرْجِعُ رَجُلَانِ نَصْرَانِي

(b) إِنَّ رَجُلَيْنِ نَصْرَانِي لَا يَرْجِعَانِ

two men who helped me will not return

(c) لَا يَرْجِعُ رَجُلَانِ نَصَرْتُهُمَا

(d) إِنَّ رَجُلَيْنِ نَصَرْتُهُمَا لَا يَرْجِعَانِ

two men whom I helped will not return

The following rules govern the above sentences:

1. The relative adjective is used only with a definite antecedent, with which it agrees in number, gender and case; it has no role in the relative sentence.
2. The relative sentence is normally a complete sentence in itself.
3. The relative sentence must contain a pronoun that refers to the antecedent.

Exceptions of which you must be aware are:

- a) Sentences in which the antecedent is definite but the relative adjective is not used.

The commonly accepted rule that this should occur only when a noun is used in a generalized way (see Wright, 2, 318) is not true of early Arabic, where the relative adjective is quite often omitted:

كَمِثْلِ الْحِمَارِ يَحْمِلُ أَشْفَارًا

[62:5 'like the donkey that carries books'] fits the rule.

ذَلِكَ الْكِتَابُ لَا رَيْبَ فِيهِ

[2:2 'this is the book in which there is no doubt'] and

التَّابُوتُ فِيهِ سَكِينَةٌ

[2:248 'the ark in which there is an assurance'] do not.

Lesson Twenty-Three

- b) Sentences in which the relative sentence is not a complete sentence:

Where a subject can be implied from a relative pronoun or adjective and where the predicate is a prepositional phrase, or, more rarely, an adverb:

الَّذِينَ مَعَكَ [73:20]

those who are with you

الْقُلُوبِ الَّتِي فِي الصُّدُورِ [22:46]

their hearts which are in their breasts

- c) Sentences in which the referring pronoun is omitted from the relative sentence. This is common with *mā*, much less so with *alladhī*, but cf.:

[for أَنْزَلَهُ] الْكِتَابِ الَّذِي أَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ [4:136]

the scripture which God has sent down

[for وَعَدَهَا] جَنَّاتٍ عَدْنٍ الَّتِي وَعَدَ الرَّحْمَنُ عِبَادَهُ [19:61]

gardens of Eden which the Merciful has promised
His servants

[for يَعِدُكُمُوهُ] بَعْضُ الَّذِي يَعِدُكُمْ [40:28]

some of what he promises you

[for تَعْبُدُونَهُمْ] الَّذِينَ تَعْبُدُونَ [10:104]

those whom you worship

[for تَقُولُهُ] الَّذِي تَقُولُ [4:81]

what you say

VOCABULARY TWENTY-THREE

PERFECT IMPERFECT VERBAL NOUN

حَبِطَ يَحْبِطُ حُبُوطٌ to be useless

سَخَّرَ² يُسَخِّرُ تَسْخِيرٌ to subject

مَتَّعَ² يُمَتِّعُ تَمَتُّيعٌ to let enjoy; make provision for

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
4 أَقْرَضَ	يُقْرِضُ	قَرْضٌ	to lend, make a loan
4 أَنْعَمَ	يُنْعِمُ	إِنْعَامٌ	to bless, be gracious
5 تَفَرَّقَ	يَتَفَرَّقُ	تَفَرُّقٌ	to be divided
6 تَبَارَكَ	يَتَبَارَكُ	تَبَارُكٌ	to be blessed

SINGULAR PLURAL

أَصْلٌ	أُصُولٌ	root
بَأْسٌ		might
تَابُوتٌ		ark
حَبٌّ	حُبُوبٌ	grain
حَجَرٌ	حِجَارَةٌ	stone
حَدِيدٌ		iron
حِمَارٌ	حَمِيرٌ	donkey
خَضِرٌ		green crop
رِجْسٌ		abomination
رَيْبٌ		doubt
	أَسْفَارٌ	books
سَكِينَةٌ		tranquillity, reassurance
سِيمًا		sign
فَتًى	فَتِيَّةٌ	youth
وَقُودٌ		fuel
سَمْنٌ	سِمَانٌ	fat

EXERCISE TWENTY-THREE

1. نِعْمَتِي الَّتِي أَنْعَمْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ [2:40]
2. هَذِهِ النَّارُ الَّتِي كُنْتُمْ فِيهَا تُكَذِّبُونَ [52:14]
3. النَّارُ الَّتِي وَقُودُهَا النَّاسُ وَالْحِجَارَةُ [2:24]
4. لَا تَقْتُلُوا أَنْفُسَ الَّتِي حَرَّمَ اللَّهُ [6:151]
5. إِنَّ وَلِيِّ اللَّهِ الَّذِي نَزَّلَ الْكِتَابَ [7:196]
6. هُوَ الَّذِي سَخَّرَ الْبَحْرَ لِتَأْكُلُوا مِنْهُ [16:14]
7. أَهَذَا الَّذِي بَعَثَ اللَّهُ رَسُولًا [25:41]
8. الَّذِي أَظْمَعُ أَنْ يَغْفِرَ لِي خَطِيئَتِي يَوْمَ الدِّينِ [26:82]
9. مَنَذَا الَّذِي يُفْرِضُ اللَّهُ قَرْضًا حَسَنًا [2:245]
10. تَبَارَكَ الَّذِي بِيَدِهِ الْمُلْكُ [67:1]
11. هُوَ الَّذِي أَخْرَجَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا [59:2]
12. أَحْسَنَ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ خَلَقَهُ [32:7]
13. أُولَئِكَ الَّذِينَ حَبِطَتْ أَعْمَالُهُمْ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ [3:22]
14. لَا تَكُونُوا كَالَّذِينَ تَفَرَّقُوا وَاخْتَلَفُوا [3:105]
15. يُبَشِّرُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ الَّذِينَ يَعْمَلُونَ الصَّالِحَاتِ أَنَّ لَهُمْ أَجْرًا كَبِيرًا [17:9]
16. يَجْعَلُ الرَّجْسَ عَلَى الَّذِينَ لَا يَعْقِلُونَ [10:100]
17. وَيَقُولُ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا لَسْتَ مُرْسَلًا [13:43]
18. إِنَّهَا شَجَرَةٌ تَخْرُجُ فِي أَصْلِ الْجَحِيمِ [37:64]

19. [19:7] إِنَّا نُبَشِّرُكَ بِغُلَامٍ اسْمُهُ يَحْيَى
20. [12:43] سَبْعَ بَقَرَاتٍ سِمَانٍ يَأْكُلُهُنَّ سَبْعَ عَجَافٍ
21. [13:4] إِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّقَوْمٍ يَعْقِلُونَ
22. [18:13] إِنَّهُمْ فَتِيَّةٌ آمَنُوا بِرَبِّهِمْ
23. [24:1] سُورَةٌ أَنْزَلْنَاهَا
24. [6:99] فَأَخْرَجْنَا مِنْهُ خَضِرًا نُخْرِجُ مِنْهُ حَبًّا
25. [7:46] عَلَى الْأَعْرَافِ رِجَالٌ يَعْرِفُونَ كُلًّا بِسِيمَاهُمْ
26. [4:92] كَانَ مِنْ قَوْمٍ بَيْنَكُمْ وَبَيْنَهُمْ مِيثَاقٌ
27. [57:25] أَنْزَلْنَا الْحَدِيدَ فِيهِ بَأْسٌ شَدِيدٌ وَمَنَافِعُ لِلنَّاسِ
28. [11:48] أُمَّمٌ سَنُنَفِّسُهُمْ

Lesson Twenty-Four

Assimilated Verbs

A. VERBS WITH *wāw* AS FIRST RADICAL

Verbs with *wāw* as their first radical are common, and many of them are important. Three of these, **وَجَدَ** *wajada*, **وَقَعَ** *waqa'a* and **وَعَدَ** *wa'ada*, have already been included in earlier lessons. As *wāw* is a weak radical, it is subject to some change. There are three points to be remembered:

1. The most characteristic feature of verbs beginning with *wāw* is that almost all of them lose the *wāw* in the Imperfect active (but not the passive, see Lesson 33):

(وَقَعَ) يَقَعُ (وَعَدَ) يَعِدُ (وَجَدَ) يَجِدُ

2. The *wāw* changes to a *yā'* in the *maṣḍars* of the 4th and 10th forms and in some *maṣḍar mīmī* forms. It is only these latter that occur in the Qur'an:

(وَعَدَ) مِيْعَادٌ (وَجَدَ) مِيْثَاقٌ
(وَزَنَ) مِيْزَانٌ (وَرَثَ) مِيْرَاثٌ

3. The *wāw* is changed into a *tā'* in the 8th form. There are only a couple of verbs in the Qur'an that show this change: **إِتَّكَأَ** *ittaka'a* 'to recline on', which is rare, and **إِتَّقَى** *ittaqa* 'to protect oneself, guard against, be god-fearing', which is common. As *ittaqa* is also a defective verb, it will not be dealt with until Lesson 30.

There are two verbs with *wāw* as their first radical that in general do not occur in the Perfect but only in the imperfect tenses and the Imperative. These are **يَدْعُ** *yada'u*

and يَذُرُ *yadhuru*. *Yada'u* occurs only once in the Imperative, once in the 2nd form, and twice in the 10th form passive participle/noun of place. *Yadharu*, on the other hand, occurs twenty-odd times in the imperfect tenses and twenty-odd in the Imperative. In the rest of Arabic *yada'u* is much the more common. Both mean 'to let', 'to allow', 'leave alone'.

B. VERBS WITH *yā'* AS FIRST RADICAL

Verbs with *yā'* as their first radical have fewer changes (and are less common) than those with *wāw*. There are two basic changes:

1. In the Imperfect passive of the first form and in the Imperfect and the participles of the 4th form the *yā'* changes to *wāw*.
2. The *yā'* is changed into a *tā'* in the 8th form (as with assimilated verbs beginning with *wāw*).

There are only a handful of verbs in the Qur'ān from roots beginning with *yā'*. The only one to show any mutation is أَيقَنَ *ayqana* 'to be certain', in all the Qur'ānic forms of which (3/2 m.pl. Imperfect and active participle) the *yā'* is transformed to *wāw*.

VOCABULARY TWENTY-FOUR

PERFECT IMPERFECT VERBAL NOUN

	يَذُرُ		to let, allow
وَرِثَ	يَرِثُ	إِثْرٌ	to inherit
وَزَرَ	يَزِرُ	وِزْرٌ	to carry a burden
وَسِعَ	يَسِعُ	وُسْعٌ	to be wide; encompass
وَصَفَ	يَصِفُ	وُصْفٌ	to describe
وَصَلَ	يَصِلُ	وُصُولٌ	to arrive
وَضَعَ	يَضَعُ	وَضْعٌ	to put down

Exercise Twenty-Four

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
وَعَظَ	يَعِظُ	عِظَةٌ / وَعَظٌ	to exhort, admonish
وَهَبَ	يَهِبُ	هَبَةٌ	to give
8 اِتَّخَذَ	يَتَّخِذُ	اِتِّخَاذٌ	to take, adopt
يَيْئَسُ	يَنْئِسُ	يَأْسٌ	to despair
4 اَيَقَنَ	يُوقِنُ	اِيْقَانٌ	to be certain
بَطَلَ	يَبْطُلُ	بَطْلٌ	to be worthless

SINGULAR

PLURAL

صَنَمٌ	أَصْنَامٌ	idol
فَرْدٌ	أَفْرَادٌ	individual, alone
وَاِزْرَةٌ		soul bearing a burden
مِيزَانٌ	مَوَازِينُ	balance

EXERCISE TWENTY-FOUR

1. إِنَّا نَحْنُ نَرِثُ الْأَرْضَ وَمَنْ عَلَيْهَا [19:40]
2. يَرِثُهَا عِبَادِيَ الصَّالِحُونَ [21:105]
3. أَتَذَرُ مُوسَى وَقَوْمَهُ لِيُفْسِدُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ [7:127]
4. لَا تَذَرْنِي فَرْدًا [21:89]
5. لَا تَزِرُ وَازِرَةٌ وِزْرَ أُخْرَى [6:164]
6. وَسِعَ رَبِّي كُلَّ شَيْءٍ عِلْمًا [6:80]
7. وَتَصِفُ أَلْسِنَتُهُمُ الْكَذِبَ [16:62]

8. مِمَّا تَصِفُونَ [21:18]
9. فَلَا يَصِلُونَ إِلَيْكُمَا [28:35]
10. لَنْ يَصِلُوا إِلَيْكَ [11:81]
11. وَضَعَ آلِيزَانَ [55:7]
12. نَضَعُ الْمَوَازِينَ لِيَوْمِ الْقِيَامَةِ [21:47]
13. إِنَّ اللَّهَ وَعَدَكُمْ وَعْدَ الْحَقِّ [14:22]
14. أَلَمْ يَعِدْكُمْ رَبُّكُمْ وَعْدًا حَسَنًا [20:86]
15. أَعْظَمُكُمْ بِوَاحِدَةٍ [34:46]
16. يَعِظُكُمْ اللَّهُ [24:17]
17. وَقَعَ الْحَقُّ وَبَطَلَ مَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ [7:118]
18. وَهَبْنَا لَهُمْ مِنْ رَحْمَتِنَا [19:50]
19. وَهَبْ لِي رَبِّي حُكْمًا [26:21]
20. أُولَئِكَ يَتْلُوا مِنْ رَحْمَتِي [29:23]
21. يَتْلُوا مِنَ الْآخِرَةِ [60:13]
22. هُمْ بِالْآخِرَةِ هُمْ يُوقِنُونَ [27:3]
23. كَانُوا بِآيَاتِنَا يُوقِنُونَ [27:82]
24. اتَّخَذُ أَضْنَامًا إِلَهَةً [6:74]
25. يَتَّخِذُ مِنْكُمْ شُهَدَاءَ [3:140]
26. يَتَّخِذُونَ الْكَافِرِينَ أَوْلِيَاءَ [4:139]

Lesson Twenty-Five

The Elative

The Elative is the form used in Arabic to express the comparative and superlative.

THE FORM

The basic form is أَفْعَلُ *af'alu*, e.g.:

أَكْرَمُ	from	كَرِيمٌ
أَحْسَنُ	from	حَسَنٌ
أَسْفَلُ	from	سَافِلٌ

If the two last radicals are the same, contraction takes place:

أَشَدُّ	from	شَدِيدٌ
أَعَزُّ	from	عَزِيزٌ
أَقْلُّ	from	قَلِيلٌ

If the last radical is *wāw* or *yā'*, that radical becomes *alif maqṣūra* in the elative form:

أَزْكَى	from	زَكِيٌّ
أَبْقَى	from	بَاقٍ

In general, an elative cannot be formed from:

- a) a passive participle;
- b) a derived form participle;
- c) a word that has the same form of the elative;
- d) a noun.

To express the elative of such a word, a compound phrase must be used. This consists of an elative meaning 'more', such as *aktharu*, *ashaddu*, *a'ḡamu*, together with an appropriate noun in the indefinite accusative singular. If a derived form participle is concerned, it is the appropriate *maṣḍar* that is used. In the Qur'ān we find examples of only (b) and (d).

أَشَدُّ حُبًّا more loving [2:165]
 أَغْظَمُ أَجْرًا more rewarding [73:20]

This compound construction must also be used if one needs to express the idea of 'less' or 'least'. There is only one clear example in the Qur'ān:

أَقَلُّ عَدَدًا less numerous [72:24]

'Better/best' is expressed by the noun *khayr* 'good', and 'worse/worst' by the noun *sharr*, 'bad, evil'. Both words can have their ordinary meaning or an elative meaning, depending on the construction and, sometimes, on the context.

It should be noted that elative forms sometimes convey only an intensive meaning 'very...', etc. Thus *al-ḥajju al-akbaru* [9:3] means 'the great pilgrimage'. This is particularly common with *a'lamu*, which normally means 'well-aware'.

THE CONSTRUCTIONS

a) Comparative

The form does not change for number or gender, but it does for case.

'Than' is expressed by *min*.

إِثْمُهُمَا أَكْثَرُ مِنْ نَفْعِهِمَا their sin is greater than their benefit
 (acc.) أَصْغَرَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ smaller than that
 هِيَ أَحْسَنُ it is better

نَحْنُ أَحَقُّ بِالسُّلْكِ مِنْهُ we are more deserving of sovereignty
than him

اللَّهُ خَيْرٌ وَأَبْقَى God is better and more enduring
هُوَ شَرٌّ لَهُمْ it is worse for them

If comparison is made to a word that has already occurred in the sentence, there are two possible ways of referring to it, either by the appropriate pronominal suffix after *min* or by a clause after *mimmā* ('than that which'). There is very little trace of this in the Qur'ān. The nearest to the first way has *anfusi-him* in the place of a simple suffix:

النَّبِيُّ أَوْلَىٰ بِالْمُؤْمِنِينَ مِنْ أَنْفُسِهِمْ [33:6]

the Prophet is closer to the believers than they are themselves

An example of the second way is:

عَمَرُوهَا أَكْثَرَ مِمَّا عَمَرُوهَا [30:9]

they built it up more than they had already built it up

b) Superlative

The two main constructions are:

1. the elative plus an indefinite genitive singular (this is much less common in the Qur'ān than elsewhere):

فِي أَحْسَنِ تَقْوِيمٍ in the finest form

(acc.) أَكْثَرُ شَيْءٍ جَدَلًا the most contentious thing

2. the elative plus a definite genitive plural, collective, suffix, etc.:

أَكْثَرُ النَّاسِ most of the people

أَوْهَنُ الْبُيُوتِ the frailest house

أَدْنَى الْأَرْضِ the nearest part of the earth
هُوَ خَيْرُ النَّاصِرِينَ he is the best helper

In these two constructions, the elative form again does not change for number or gender. (It acts like a noun rather than an adjective.)

أَوَّلَ مَرَّةٍ (acc.) the first time
أَوَّلَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ the first of the believers
OR the first believers

The elative can also be used adjectivally to express the superlative:

الْعَذَابُ الْأَكْبَرُ the greatest punishment
الْأَفُقُ الْأَعْلَى the highest horizon

This construction, which gives no problems when translating from Arabic, gives rise to problems when one is translating into Arabic, as it can properly be used only with masculine words [though present-day usage will eventually destroy this rule]. There is a special form for the feminine superlative adjective: *فُعْلَى* *fu' lā*; and this feminine form is found with only a very limited number of adjectives. The Qur'ān has a greater proportion of these feminine elative forms than one would expect from their incidence elsewhere in Arabic. Even so there are only nine of them, and one, *الدُّنْيَا* *al-dunyā*, has a specialised usage (*الدَّارُ الدُّنْيَا* *al-dār al-du-nyā* 'the lowest world', i.e. 'this world') in the majority of its occurrences.

الْعُرْوَةُ الْوُثْقَى the firmest handle
الصَّلَاةُ الْوُسْطَى the middle prayer
آيَاتُ رَبِّهِ الْكُبْرَى the greatest signs of his Lord

VOCABULARY TWENTY-FIVE

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN
عَمَرَ	يَعْمُرُ	عَمْرٌ to build, build up
اسْتَمَعَ 8	يَسْتَمِعُ	اسْتِمَاعٌ to listen to

SINGULAR PLURAL

أَفُقٌ	آفَاقٌ	horizon
بَرٌّ	أَبْرَارٌ	pious, god-fearing
بَطْشٌ		might
جَدَلٌ		contention
خُلْدٌ		eternity
رَازِقٌ	s.p.	provider of sustenance
شِقَاقٌ		dissension
عَدَدٌ		number
عَدَاوَةٌ		enmity
عُدْوَةٌ		side of a valley
عُرْوَةٌ		handle
مُسْتَقَرٌّ		abode
قَسْوَةٌ		hardness
تَقْوِيمٌ		form
مَقِيلٌ		noon resting-place
أَبْقَى		more lasting

SINGULAR

[from حَقِيقٌ]	أَحَقُّ	more deserving
[from دَانٍ]	أَدْنَى (f.) / دُنْيَا	lowest, nearest
[from رَذِيلٌ]	أَرْذَلُ	worst
[from زَكِيٌّ]	أَزْكَى	purser
[from سَافِلٌ]	أَسْفَلُ	lower
	أَقْصَى (f.) / قُضْوَى	further, furthest
[from كَرِيمٌ]	أَكْرَمُ	nobler
	أَلْوَثَقَى	firmer
[from تَقِيٌّ]	أَتْقَى	more pious
	أَوْلَى	nearer
	أَوْهَنُ	frailest
	خَيْرٌ	good, better, best
	شَرٌّ	bad, worse, worst

EXERCISE TWENTY-FIVE

1. سَأَلُوا مُوسَى أَكْبَرَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ [4:153]
2. نَحْنُ أَكْثَرُ أَمْوَالًا وَأَوْلَادًا [34:35]
3. أَأَنْتُمْ أَعْلَمُ أَمْ اللَّهُ [2:140]
4. أَجْرُ الْآخِرَةِ أَكْبَرُ [16:41]
5. هِيَ كَالْحِجَارَةِ أَوْ أَشَدَّ قَسْوَةً [2:74]

6. [9:40] كَلِمَةُ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا السُّفْلَى وَكَلِمَةُ اللَّهِ هِيَ الْعُلْيَا
7. [49:13] إِنَّ أَكْرَمَكُمْ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ أَتْقَاكُمْ
8. [26:111] اتَّبِعَكَ الْأَرْضُولُونَ
9. [11:7] أَيُّكُمْ أَحْسَنُ عَمَلًا
10. [25:15] أَذَلِكَ خَيْرٌ أَمْ جَنَّةُ الْخُلْدِ
11. [20:73] اللَّهُ خَيْرٌ وَأَبْقَى
12. [41:52] مَنْ أَضَلُّ مِمَّنْ هُوَ فِي شِقَاقٍ بَعِيدٍ
13. [4:135] قَالَ اللَّهُ أُولَىٰ بِهِمَا
14. [5:103] أَكْثَرُهُمْ لَا يَعْقِلُونَ
15. [5:82] أَشَدُّ النَّاسِ عَدَاوَةً
16. [8:42] أَنْتُمْ بِالْعُدْوَةِ الدُّنْيَا وَهُمْ بِالْعُدْوَةِ الْقُصْوَى
17. [6:157] فَمَنْ أَظْلَمُ مِمَّنْ كَذَّبَ بِآيَاتِ اللَّهِ
18. [5:60] هَلْ أَنْبَيْتُكُمْ بِشَرِّ مِنْ ذَلِكَ
19. [17:110] لَهُ الْأَسْمَاءُ الْحُسْنَى
20. [11:31] اللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ بِمَا فِي أَنْفُسِهِمْ
21. [25:24] أَصْحَابُ الْجَنَّةِ يَوْمَئِذٍ خَيْرٌ مُسْتَقَرًّا وَأَحْسَنُ مَقِيلًا
22. [3:198] وَمَا عِنْدَ اللَّهِ خَيْرٌ لِلْأَبْرَارِ
23. [23:72] هُوَ خَيْرٌ الرَّازِقِينَ
24. [18:19] رَبُّكُمْ أَعْلَمُ بِمَا لَبِثْتُمْ
25. [24:30] ذَلِكَ أَزْكَىٰ لَهُمْ

26. خَلَقَ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ أَكْبَرُ مِنْ خَلْقِ النَّاسِ [40:57]
وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ
27. يَسْتَمِعُونَ الْقَوْلَ وَيَتَّبِعُونَ أَحْسَنَهُ [39:18]
28. نَحْنُ أَقْرَبُ إِلَيْهِ مِنْكُمْ [56:85]

Lesson Twenty-Six

Doubled Verbs

Doubled verbs are those in which the second and third radicals are the same. The presence of the same two letters leads to some variations from the sound verbs. Two rules cover these changes:

1. When both the first and the third radicals have vowels, the short vowel on the second radical drops out and the second and third radicals combine, e.g. رَدَّ *radda*, مَسَّ *massa*, ضَلَّ *ḍalla*, etc.
2. When the third radical has a vowel and the first does not, the vowel of the second radical moves back to the first, e.g. يَمُرُّ *yamurru*, نُمِدُّ *numiddu*, يَصُدُّ *yaṣuddu*, etc.

The crucial point is that for contraction to take place the third radical must have a vowel. If the third radical has *sukūn* no contraction can take place. Thus the vowel of the second radical will reappear if the vowel of the third radical disappears through conjugation: رَدَدْتُ *radadtu*, مَسِسْتُ *masistu*, ضَلَلْتُ *ḍalaltu*, etc. Nor can there be contraction if the second radical has a long vowel, e.g. *mardūdun*.

JUSSIVE FORMS OF DOUBLE VERBS

In the seventh century there were two forms of Jussive for those persons of the doubled verb that take *sukūn* on the final consonant, i.e. forms analogous to *yaktub*, etc. The first is the same form that one finds with a sound verb, يَمَسَسُ *yamsas* (from *massa*), يُشَاقِقُ *yushāqiq* (from the 3rd form *shāqqa*), يُحَبِّبُ *yuhbib* (from *aḥabba*), يُضِلُّ *yudlil* (from *aḍalla*), يَزْتَدِدُ *yartadid* (from *irtadda*), etc. Alternatively, contraction of the kind mentioned above can take place, with the doubled letter taking a final *kasra* (e.g. يَزْتَدِّ *yartaddi*).

yartaddi, also from *irtadda*). The forms without contraction are more common in the Qur'ān, as seems to have been the case in the Hijāz in general.

VOCABULARY TWENTY-SIX

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
4 أَحَبَّ	يُحِبُّ	حُبٌّ	to love
3 حَاجَّ	يُحَاجُّ	حِجَاجٌ	to argue about (<i>fī</i>)
4 أَحَلَّ	يُحِلُّ	إِحْلَالٌ	to make lawful, permit
رَدَّ	يَرُدُّ	رَدٌّ	to return, restore
صَدَّ	يَصُدُّ	صَدٌّ	to block
ضَرَّ	يَضُرُّ	ضَرٌّ	to harm
8 اضْطَرَّ	يَضْطَرُّ	اضْطِرَارٌ	to force, compel
ضَلَّ	يَضِلُّ	ضَلَالٌ	to stray, err
4 أَضَلَّ	يُضِلُّ	إِضْلَالٌ	to cause to stray
ظَنَّ	يَظُنُّ	ظَنْنٌ	to think
عَدَّ	يَعُدُّ	عَدٌّ	to count
4 أَعَدَّ	يُعِدُّ	إِعْدَادٌ	to prepare, make ready
قَصَّ	يَقْصُصُ	قَصَصٌ	to tell
مَرَّ	يَمُرُّ	مَرٌّ	to pass
مَسَّ	يَمَسُّ	مَسٌّ	to touch
نَفَعَ	يَنْفَعُ	نَفْعٌ	to benefit

Exercise Twenty-Six

SINGULAR PLURAL

بَيْعٌ	trading
رَبًّا (with article الرَّبُّوا)	usury
أَشْرَارٌ	evil men (pl.)
أَنْبَاءٌ نَبَأٌ	news
أَلِيمٌ	painful

EXERCISE TWENTY-SIX

1. أَحَلَ اللَّهُ الْبَيْعَ وَحَرَّمَ الرِّبَا [2:275]
2. يُحِلُّونَهُ عَامًا وَيُحَرِّمُونَهُ عَامًا [9:37]
3. يُقَاتِلُونَكُمْ حَتَّى يَرُدُّوكُمْ عَنْ دِينِكُمْ [2:217]
4. فَرَدَدْنَاهُ إِلَى أُمِّهِ [28:13]
5. مَسَّهُ الشَّرُّ [17:83]
6. مَسَّ الْإِنْسَانَ الضُّرُّ [10:12]
7. نَحْنُ نَقُصُّ عَلَيْكَ نَبَأَهُم بِالْحَقِّ [18:13]
8. قَدْ قَصَصْنَاهُمْ عَلَيْكَ مِنْ قَبْلُ [4:164]
9. كُنَّا قَوْمًا ضَالِّينَ [23:106]
10. يَضِلُّونَ عَنْ سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ [38:26]
11. وَيُضِلُّ اللَّهُ الظَّالِمِينَ [14:27]
12. يُضِلُّونَكُمْ بِغَيْرِ عِلْمٍ [16:25]
13. فَقَالَ لَهُ فِرْعَوْنُ إِنِّي لَأَظُنُّكَ يَا مُوسَى مَسْحُورًا [17:101]

14. ظَنَنْتُمْ أَنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَعْلَمُ كَثِيرًا مِّمَّا تَعْمَلُونَ [41:22]
15. مَا لَا يَنْفَعُنَا وَلَا يَضُرُّنَا [6:71]
16. لَا تَضُرُّوهُ شَيْئًا [11:57]
17. ثُمَّ أَضْطَرُّهُ إِلَى عَذَابِ النَّارِ [2:126]
18. أَعَدَّ لِلْكَافِرِينَ عَذَابًا أَلِيمًا [33:8]
19. أَعَدَّ اللَّهُ لَهُمْ جَنَّاتٍ [9:89]
20. كُنَّا نَعُدُّهُمْ مِنَ الْأَشْرَارِ [38:62]
21. إِنَّ يَوْمًا عِنْدَ رَبِّكَ كَأَلْفِ سَنَةٍ مِّمَّا تَعُدُّونَ [22:47]
22. إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُحِبُّ الْمُفْسِدِينَ [28:77]
23. فَلَمْ يُحَاجُّوْنَ فِي مَا لَيْسَ لَكُمْ بِهِ عِلْمٌ [3:66]
24. أَتُحَاجُّونَنَا فِي اللَّهِ [2:139]
25. إِنَّهُمْ لَيَصَدُّونَهُمْ عَنِ السَّبِيلِ [43:37]
26. كَأَيِّنْ مِنْ آيَةٍ فِي السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ يَمُرُّونَ عَلَيْهَا [12:105]

Lesson Twenty-Seven

Exceptive Sentences with *illā*

The main exceptive particle *illā* was mentioned briefly in Lesson 10, and occasional examples have been given since then. However, *illā* is a pervasive word (it occurs over 600 times in the Qur'ān), and the rules for its use need to be understood.

When *illā* follows a positive sentence, the exception is put in the accusative case:

شَرَبُوا مِنْهُ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا مِنْهُمْ they drank from it—except a few of them

سَجَدُوا إِلَّا إِبْلِيسَ they prostrated themselves, except Iblis

كُلُّ شَيْءٍ هَالِكٌ إِلَّا وَجْهَهُ everything will perish except His face

However, exceptions to positive sentences are a small proportion of the total. More often, *illā* is used to introduce exceptions to negative sentences, particularly where the negative and the exceptive combine to give the meaning 'only'.

In all normal circumstances the exception to a negative goes into the logical case. The same applies to interrogative sentences that imply negation. Before turning to Qur'ānic examples, let us look at six non-Qur'ānic examples, three of which show what or who it is to which the exception is made, and three of which do not:

مَا ذَهَبَ أَحَدٌ إِلَّا زَيْدٌ no one left, except Zayd

مَا سَمِعْتُ أَحَدًا إِلَّا زَيْدًا I didn't hear anyone, except Zayd

مَا مَرَرْتُ بِأَحَدٍ إِلَّا بِزَيْدٍ I didn't pass by anyone, except Zayd

With *aḥad* omitted the sentences run:

مَا ذَهَبَ إِلَّا زَيْدٌ only Zayd left
 مَا سَمِعْتُ إِلَّا زَيْدًا I heard only Zayd
 مَا مَرَرْتُ إِلَّا بِزَيْدٍ I passed only Zayd

When the exception is of a totally different kind from the term to which the exception is made, only the accusative can be used for the exception:

مَا شَرَبَ الْقَوْمُ إِلَّا حِمَارًا none of the people drank, but a donkey did

It is also possible for the exception to take the form of a clause (with or without *wa-* or *qad* or *an* to introduce it) or a prepositional phrase.

Before giving some Qur'ānic examples, it is necessary to introduce the archaic negative particle *إِنْ in*, 'not'. The negative *in* is relatively common in the Qur'ān: there are well over 100 examples. All but a handful of these are in exceptive sentences with *illā* introducing the exception:

إِنْ هَذَا إِلَّا سِحْرٌ مُبِينٌ this is simply manifest magic
 إِنْ يُهْلِكُونَ إِلَّا أَنْفُسَهُمْ they destroy only themselves
 إِنْ الْحُكْمُ إِلَّا لِلَّهِ judgement belongs to God alone

OTHER EXAMPLES

مَا الْمَسِيحُ ابْنُ مَرْيَمَ إِلَّا رَسُولٌ [5:75]
 the Anointed One, the son of Mary, was only a prophet
 مَا تَسْقُطُ مِنْ وَرَقَةٍ إِلَّا يَعْلَمُهَا اللَّهُ [6:59]
 no leaf falls without God knowing it

لَا تَكَلِّمْ نَفْسًا إِلَّا بِإِذْنِهِ^A [11:105]

no soul shall speak except with His permission

وَمَا أَهْلَكْنَا مِنْ قَرْيَةٍ إِلَّا لَهَا مُنْذِرُونَ [26:208]

We have not destroyed any settlement without it having had warners

مَا كَانَ حُجَّتُهُمْ إِلَّا أَنْ قَالُوا [45:25]

their only argument is to say, . . .

لَنْ تَمَسَّنَا النَّارُ إِلَّا أَيَّامًا مَعْدُودَةً [2:80]

The fire will touch us only for a few days

VOCABULARY TWENTY-SEVEN

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
سَجَدَ	يَسْجُدُ	سُجُودٌ	to prostrate oneself
سَحَرَ	يَسْحِرُ	سِحْرٌ	to bewitch
سَقَطَ	يَسْقُطُ	سُقُوطٌ	to fall
عَبَدَ	يَعْبُدُ	عِبَادَةٌ	to serve, worship
غَفَرَ	يَغْفِرُ	مَغْفِرَةٌ	to forgive
5 تَنَزَّلَ	يَتَنَزَّلُ	تَنْزِيلٌ	to descend
هَلَكَ	يَهْلِكُ	هَلَاكٌ	to perish
وَضَعَ	يَضَعُ	وَضْعٌ	to give birth to (sentence 21)

SINGULAR PLURAL

أَفْكَ	lie
(f.) أَنْثَى	إِنَاثٌ female

^A For the dropping of the prefix see Lesson 16.

SINGULAR PLURAL

بَشِيرٌ		bringer of good tidings
حُجَّةٌ	s.p.	proof
دَابَّةٌ	دَوَابٌّ	beast
رِزْقٌ		sustenance
قَدَرٌ		measure
لِسَانٌ	أَلْسِنَةٌ	tongue
الْمَسِيحُ		the Anointed One
وَرَقَةٌ	وَرَقٌ	leaf
خَاطِئٌ	s.p.	sinner

EXERCISE TWENTY-SEVEN

1. مَن يَغْفِرُ الذُّنُوبَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ [3:135]
2. لَا يَذْكُرُونَ اللَّهَ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا [4:142]
3. إِنَّ هُوَ إِلَّا نَذِيرٌ مُبِينٌ [7:184]
4. مَا يَتَّبِعُ أَكْثَرُهُمْ إِلَّا ظَنًّا [10:36]
5. لَن يُؤْمِنَ مِن قَوْمِكَ إِلَّا مَن قَدْ آمَنَ [11:36]
6. مَا نُؤَخِّرُهُ إِلَّا لِأَجَلٍ مَّعْدُودٍ [11:104]
7. مَا شَهِدْنَا إِلَّا بِمَا عَلَّمْنَا [12:81]
8. مَا أَرْسَلْنَا مِن رَّسُولٍ إِلَّا بِلِسَانٍ قَوْمِهِ [14:4]
9. مَا خَلَقْنَا السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا إِلَّا بِالْحَقِّ [15:85]
10. إِنَّ نَحْنُ إِلَّا بَشَرٌ مِّثْلُكُمْ [14:11]

11. فَاتَّبِعُوهُ إِلَّا فَرِيقًا مِنَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ [34:20]
12. مَا يُؤْمِنُ أَكْثَرُهُمْ بِاللَّهِ إِلَّا وَهُمْ مُشْرِكُونَ [12:106]
13. مَا يَعْبُدُونَ إِلَّا كَمَا يَعْبُدُ آبَاؤُهُمْ [11:109]
14. مَا نُزِّلَهُ إِلَّا بِقَدَرٍ مَعْلُومٍ [15:21]
15. مَا أَرْسَلْنَا مِنْ قَبْلِكَ إِلَّا رِجَالًا [16:43]
16. يَقُولُ الظَّالِمُونَ إِنْ تَتَّبِعُونَ إِلَّا رَجُلًا مَسْحُورًا [17:47]
17. مَا تَنْزَلُ إِلَّا بِأَمْرِ رَبِّكَ [19:64]
18. إِنْ هُمْ إِلَّا كَالْأَنْعَامِ [25:44]
19. لَبِثَ فِيهِمْ أَلْفَ سَنَةٍ إِلَّا خَمْسِينَ عَامًا [29:14]
20. مَا يَغْفِلُهَا إِلَّا الْعَالَمُونَ [29:43]
21. مَا تَحْمِلُ مِنْ أُنْثَى وَلَا تَضَعُ إِلَّا بِعِلْمِهِ [41:47]
22. إِنْ مِنْ قَرْيَةٍ إِلَّا نَحْنُ مُهْلِكُوهَا قَبْلَ يَوْمِ الْقِيَامَةِ [17:58]
23. لَا يَأْكُلُهُ إِلَّا الْخَاطِئُونَ [69:37]
24. مَا هَذَا إِلَّا إِفْكٌ [34:43]
25. مَا مُحَمَّدٌ إِلَّا رَسُولٌ [3:144]
26. مَا مِنْ دَابَّةٍ فِي الْأَرْضِ إِلَّا عَلَى اللَّهِ رِزْقُهَا [11:6]

Lesson Twenty-Eight

Hollow Verbs

Hollow verbs are those with *wāw* or *yā'* as their middle radical. There are three distinct types:

1. those whose middle radical is *wāw* and whose original vowel pattern was that of *kataba*;
2. those whose middle radical is *yā'* and whose original vowel pattern was that of *kataba*;
3. those whose original vowel pattern was that of *shariba*. (It is immaterial what the middle radical is. The only place where it may show up is the *maṣḍar*.)

FIRST FORM

Because of the importance of *qāla* and *kāna*, the two most common verbs in Arabic, you have already been introduced to the first form of type 1.

For type 2 a *kasra* takes the place of the *ḍamma* that comes between the first and third radicals in contracted forms; and an *ī* replaces the *ū* in the long vowel that comes between the first and third radicals in the imperfect tenses.

Learning a table is, however, more effective than applying substitution rules:

Perfect

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	سَارَ	سَارَا	سَارُوا
3 f.	سَارَتْ	سَارَتَا	سَارْنَ
2 m.	سِرْتُ	سِرْتُمَا	سِرْتُمْ
2 f.	سِرْتِ	سِرْتُمَا	سِرْتُنَّ
1	سِرْتُ	—	سِرْنَا

Imperfect

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَسِيرُ	يَسِيرَانِ	يَسِيرُونَ
3 f.	تَسِيرُ	تَسِيرَانِ	يَسِرْنَ
2 m.	تَسِيرُ	تَسِيرَانِ	تَسِيرُونَ
2 f.	تَسِيرِينَ	تَسِيرَانِ	تَسِرْنَ
I	أَسِيرُ	—	نَسِيرُ

Subjunctive

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَسِيرَ	يَسِيرَا	يَسِيرُوا
3 f.	تَسِيرَ	تَسِيرَا	يَسِرْنَ
2 m.	تَسِيرَ	تَسِيرَا	تَسِيرُوا
2 f.	تَسِيرِي	تَسِيرَا	تَسِرْنَ
I	أَسِيرَ	—	نَسِيرَ

Jussive

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَسِرْ	يَسِيرَا	يَسِيرُوا
3 f.	تَسِرْ	تَسِيرَا	يَسِرْنَ
2 m.	تَسِرْ	تَسِيرَا	تَسِيرُوا
2 f.	تَسِيرِي	تَسِيرَا	تَسِرْنَ
I	أَسِرْ	—	نَسِرْ

Type 3 is identical with type 2 in the Perfect: **خَفْتُ** *khiftu*, **خَفْنَا** *khifnā*, etc. from **خَافَ** *khāfa* (for an original *khawifa*). However, in the Imperfect type 3 has *ā* instead of the *ū* of type 1 and the *ī* of type 2: **يَخَافُ** *yakhāfu*, etc.; and when this long vowel is shortened, one gets a *fatha*: **يَخْفَنُ** *yakhafna*, **تَخْفَنُ** *takhafna*. Once again tables are a clearer guide:

Perfect

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	خَافَ	خَافَا	خَافُوا
3 f.	خَافَتْ	خَافَتَا	خَفْنَ
2 m.	خَفْتُ	خَفْتُمَا	خَفْتُمْ
2 f.	خَفْتِ	خَفْتُمَا	خَفْتُنَّ
1	خَفْتُ	—	خَفْنَا

Imperfect

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَخَافُ	يَخَافَانِ	يَخَافُونَ
3 f.	تَخَافُ	تَخَافَانِ	يَخْفَنَ
2 m.	تَخَافُ	تَخَافَانِ	تَخَافُونَ
2 f.	تَخَافِينَ	تَخَافَانِ	تَخْفَنَ
1	أَخَافُ	—	نَخَافُ

Subjunctive

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَخَافَ	يَخَافَا	يَخَافُوا
3 f.	تَخَافَ	تَخَافَا	يَخَافْنَ
2 m.	تَخَافَ	تَخَافَا	تَخَافُوا
2 f.	تَخَافِي	تَخَافَا	تَخَافْنَ
I	أَخَافُ	—	نَخَافُ

Jussive

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَخَفْ	يَخَافَا	يَخَافُوا
3 f.	تَخَفْ	تَخَافَا	يَخَفْنَ
2 m.	تَخَفْ	تَخَافَا	تَخَافُوا
2 f.	تَخَافِي	تَخَافَا	تَخَفْنَ
I	أَخَفْ	—	نَخَفْ

DERIVED FORMS

Four of the derived forms (2nd, 3rd, 5th and 6th forms) act like sound verbs with the *wāw* or *yā'* appearing as an ordinary radical (*zawwaja*, *bāya'a*, *rāwada*, *tabayyana*, *tafāwata*, etc.). The other four derived forms that we deal with (4th, 7th, 8th and 10th forms) have hollow forms which are the same for all three types of hollow verbs.

Perfect

In the Perfect the same shortening is found for all four forms, 4th, 7th, 8th and 10th: the vowel before the third radical is a *fatha*: أَرَدْتُمْ *aradtum* from أَرَادَ *arāda*, اِسْتَطَعْنَا from اِسْتَطَاعَ, etc.

Imperfect etc.

In the imperfect tenses, in the *maṣḍars* and in the participles, the forms fall into pairs. The 4th and 10th forms undergo one set of changes, and the 7th and 8th forms another:

4th and 10th forms The Imperfects are similar to that of سَارَ *sā-ra*, يَسِيرُ *yasīru*: يُرِيدُ *yurīdu* from أَرَادَ *arāda*; يَسْتَطِيعُ *yastatī'u* from اِسْتَطَاعَ *istatā'a*.

The *maṣḍars* show no real sign of the weak radical and have a compensatory *tā' marbūṭa* instead: إِرَادَةٌ *irādatun* and اِسْتِطَاعَةٌ *istitā'atun*. The Qur'ān also has the form اِقَامَ *iqāmun* instead of the normal اِقَامَةٌ *iqāmatun* as the *maṣḍar* of أَقَامَ *aqāma*.

The participles are clearly differentiated:

active: مُجِيبٌ *mujībun*, مُسْتَقِيمٌ *mustaqīmun*;

passive: مُطَاعٌ *muṭā'un*, مُسْتَنَارٌ *mustanārun*.

7th and 8th forms These forms are very rare in the Qur'ān. (The 7th form is rare in general).

The Imperfects are similar to that of خَافَ *khāfa*, يَخَافُ *yakhāfu*: يَنْهَارُ *yanhāru* from اِنْهَارَ *inhāra*; يَكْتَالُ *yaktālu* from اِكْتَالَ *iktāla* (Ip. Jussive نَكْتُلُ *naktal*).

The *maṣḍars* show the weak radical as *yā'*, regardless of what the middle radical is: اِنْهِيَارٌ *inhiyārūn*; اِكْتِيَالٌ *iktiyālun*.

There is only one form for both the active and passive participles: مُنْهَارٌ *munhārūn*, مُكْتَالٌ *muktālun*.

There are a number of important hollow verbs in addition to *kāna* and *qāla*. They include some doubly defective verbs, which have *hamza* as the final radical. The three you will come across most frequently are جَاءَ *jā'a*, شَاءَ *shā'a* and سَاءَ *sā'a*. These are given in the vocabulary. You should note that اِسْتَجَابَ *istajāba* is used more frequently than أَجَابَ *ajāba* for 'to answer'. In later Arabic *ajāba* is the more common.

VOCABULARY TWENTY-EIGHT

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
سَارَ	يَسِيرُ	سَيْرٌ	to journey
خَافَ	يَخَافُ	خَوْفٌ	to fear
جَاءَ	يَحْيِيْ		to come
زَادَ	يَزِيدُ	زِيَادَةٌ	to increase
شَاءَ	يَشَاءُ		to wish
سَاءَ	يُسُوْءُ	سُوْءٌ	to be bad
أَرَادَ ⁴	يُرِيدُ	إِرَادَةٌ	to want
أَطَاعَ ⁴	يُطِيعُ	إِطَاعَةٌ	to obey
^{A 10} اِسْتَطَاعَ	يَسْتَطِيعُ	إِسْطَاعَةٌ	to be able
قَامَ	يَقُومُ	قِيَامٌ	to stand, rise
أَقَامَ ⁴	يُقِيمُ	(إِقَامَةٌ) إِقَامٌ	to perform, uphold
^B مَاتَ	يَمُوتُ	مَوْتُ	to die
ذَاقَ	يَذُوقُ	ذَوْقٌ	to taste

^A This verb—exceptionally—sometimes drops the *tā'* of the 10th form prefix, producing *istā'ū*, *yastī'*, and *tastī'*

^B Though *māta* has a *wāw* as its middle radical, the contracted forms of the Perfect normally have a *kasra*: *mittu* etc.

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
4 أَحَاطَ	يُحِيطُ	إِحَاطَةٌ	to surround, comprehend
4 أَصَابَ	يُصِيبُ	إِصَابَةٌ	to smite, befall
10 اسْتَجَابَ	يَسْتَجِيبُ	جَوَابٌ	to answer
4 أَجَابَ	يُجِيبُ	جَوَابٌ	to answer
صَرَفَ	يَصْرِفُ	صَرْفٌ	to turn, turn away (trans.)
4 أَبْدَلَ	يُبْدِلُ	إِبْدَالٌ	to give in exchange

بَرْدٌ	cold (noun)
بَيِّنَةٌ	clear proof
كَيْدٌ	plotting, wiles
وَبَالٌ	mischievous
وِزْنٌ	weight
بِالْأَمْسِ	yesterday

EXERCISE TWENTY-EIGHT

1. لَا تَخَافِي وَلَا تَحْزَنِي [28:7]
2. أَفَلَمْ يَسِيرُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ [40:82]
3. سَاءَتْ مُسْتَقَرًّا [25:66]
4. سَاءَ مَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ [58:15]
5. مَا تَشَاؤُونَ إِلَّا أَنْ يَشَاءَ اللَّهُ [76:30]

6. نُصِيبُ بِرَحْمَتِنَا مَنْ نَشَاءُ [12:56]
7. سَيُصِيبُ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا مِنْهُمْ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ [9:90]
8. جَاؤُوهُمْ بِالْبَيِّنَاتِ [10:74]
9. أَجِئْنَا لِنُعْبِدَ اللَّهَ وَحْدَهُ [7:70]
10. أَتُرِيدُ أَنْ تَقْتُلَنِي كَمَا قَتَلْتَ نَفْسًا بِالْأَمْسِ [28:19]
11. لَمْ يُرْزَ إِلَّا الْحَيَاةَ الدُّنْيَا [53:29]
12. أَرَدْنَا أَنْ يُبَدِّلَهُمَا رَبُّهُمَا خَيْرًا مِنْهُ [18:81]
13. مَا كَانُوا يَسْتَطِيعُونَ السَّمْعَ [11:20]
14. قَالُوا سَمِعْنَا وَأَطَعْنَا [2:285]
15. سَنُطِيعُكُمْ فِي بَعْضِ الْأَمْرِ [47:26]
16. وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ أَنْ تَقُومَ السَّمَاءُ [30:25]
17. فَلَتَقُمْ طَائِفَةٌ مِنْهُمْ مَعَكَ [4:102]
18. لَا نُقِيمُ لَهُمْ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ وَزَنًا [18:105]
19. لَا يَذُوقُونَ فِيهَا بَرْدًا وَلَا شَرَابًا [78:24]
20. ذَاقَتْ وَبَالَ أَمْرِهَا [65:9]
21. يَسْتَجِيبُ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ [42:26]
22. فَاسْتَجَابَ لَهُ رَبُّهُ فَصَرَفَ عَنْهُ كَيْدَهُنَّ [12:34]
23. يَقُولُ مَاذَا أَجَبْتُمُ الْمُرْسَلِينَ [28:65]
24. أَحَظْتُ بِمَا لَمْ تُحِظْ بِهِ [27:22]

Lesson Twenty-Nine

The Vocative

In the Qur'ān the vocative is normally introduced by the simple particle *yā* or the compound one *yā ayyuhā*. The constructions taken by the two particles are somewhat different.

يَا *yā*

yā must be followed by a noun that does not have the article. The noun may have a pronominal suffix or a following genitive.

If *yā* is followed by a simple noun, the noun is in the nominative, **without** *tanwīn*:

يَا أَرْضُ O earth
يَا سَمَاءُ O heaven
يَا صَالِحُ O Ṣaliḥ

Forms such as *yā 'īsā*, *yā mūsā*, *yā bushrā* are regarded as falling within this rule, though there is of course no visible change.

If *yā* is followed by a noun with a pronominal suffix or with a following genitive, the noun is in the accusative. The use of *tanwīn* is of course impossible.

يَا أَهْلَ الْكِتَابِ O people of the book
يَا أُولِي الْأَلْبَابِ O men of understanding
يَا بَنِيَّ O my sons

When the *yā* is followed by a noun with the first person singular pronominal suffix, it is usual for the long vowel of the suffix to be shortened, although this does not always occur.

يَا رَبِّ My Lord!

يَا قَوْمِ My people!
يَا عِبَادِ My servants!

يَا أَيُّهَا *yā ayyuhā*

yā ayyuhā is followed either by a noun or an adjective with the article:

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ O people
يَا أَيُّهَا النَّملُ O ants
يَا أَيُّهَا الْعَزِيزُ O Mighty One
يَا أَيُّهَا النَّبِيُّ O prophet

or by a definite clause:

الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا those who believe

which becomes:

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا O you who believe

There are a handful of other phrases such as *alladhīna hādū* 'those who are Jews' and *alladhīna kafarū* 'those who disbelieve', but they are rarely found. The only singular phrase is in 15:6:

قَالُوا يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِي نُزِّلَ عَلَيْهِ الذِّكْرُ إِنَّكَ لَمَجْنُونٌ
they said, 'You to whom the reminder has been sent
down, you are possessed by the *Jinn*'

OMISSION OF THE VOCATIVE PARTICLE

It is quite common for there to be no particle before *rabbi* and *rabba-nā*:

رَبَّنَا Our Lord!

Otherwise omission is relatively rare. There are, however, some good examples in *Sūra* 12. The first two are with the name *Yūsuf*. Verse 29 simply has the name in the nominative and then the rest of the sentence:

يُوسُفُ أَغْرِضْ عَنْ هَذَا [12:29]

○ Joseph, turn away from this

In verse 46 the name is followed by an adjective preceded by *ay-yuhā*:

يُوسُفُ أَيُّهَا الصَّادِقُ [12:46]

○ Joseph, you man of truth!

Verse 101 has a compound phrase, with an accusative vocative:

فَاطِرَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ ○ Creator of the heavens and the earth

اللَّهُمَّ *allāhumma*

Allāhumma as the vocative of *allāh* occurs five times: 3:26; 5:114; 8:32; 10:10; and 39:46.

An anomalous vocative *yā abati*, from *ab*, is found eight times: 12:4; 12:100; 19:42; 19:43; 19:44; 19:45; 28:26 and 37:102. [The corresponding form from *umm* does not occur.]

VOCABULARY TWENTY-NINE

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
3 سَارَعَ	يُسَارِعُ	سِرَاعٌ	to vie in; race
4 أَبْلَغَ	يُبْلِغُ	إِبْلَاغٌ	to convey
4 أَكْثَرَ	يَكْثُرُ	إِكْتِنَارٌ	to multiply, make much of
8 اِعْتَذَرَ	يَعْتَذِرُ	إِعْتِذَارٌ	to make excuses
فَطَرَ	يَفْطُرُ	فِطْرٌ	to create

SINGULAR

رَهْطٌ	kin; person
صَدِّيقٌ	truthful
كَلِمَةٌ	word
لِبَاسٌ	clothing; garment
نَمْلٌ	ants (collective)
رِسَالَةٌ	message, letter
مَائِدَةٌ	table
أَبَدًا	ever

EXERCISE TWENTY-NINE

1. قَالَ مُوسَى لِقَوْمِهِ يَا قَوْمِ إِنَّكُمْ ظَلَمْتُمْ [2:54]
2. يَا مَرْيَمُ إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُبَشِّرُكِ بِكَلِمَةٍ مِنْهُ [3:45]
3. يَا مُوسَى إِنَّا لَن نَدْخُلُهَا أَبَدًا [5:24]
4. يَا بَنِي آدَمَ قَدْ أَنْزَلْنَا عَلَيْكُمْ لِبَاسًا [7:26]
5. قَالَ يَا نُوحُ إِنَّهُ لَيْسَ مِنْ أَهْلِكَ [11:46]
6. يَا أَهْلَ الْكِتَابِ لِمَ تَكْفُرُونَ بِآيَاتِ اللَّهِ [3:70]
7. يَا دَاوُودُ إِنَّا جَعَلْنَاكَ خَلِيفَةً فِي الْأَرْضِ [38:26]
8. يَا عِبَادِيَ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِنَّ أَرْضِي وَاسِعَةٌ [29:56]
9. يَا أَهْلَ الْكِتَابِ لَسْتُمْ عَلَى شَيْءٍ [5:68]
10. يَا عِيسَى ابْنَ مَرْيَمَ هَلْ يَسْتَطِيعُ رَبُّكَ أَنْ يُنْزِلَ عَلَيْنَا مَائِدَةً [5:112]

11. يَا قَوْمِ لَيْسَ بِي ضَلَالَةٌ [7:61]
12. قَالَ يَا قَوْمِ لَقَدْ أَتَيْتُكُمْ بِرِسَالَةٍ مِنِّي [7:79]
13. يَا أَهْلَ الْكِتَابِ لِمَ تَصُدُّونَ عَن سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ مَن آمَنَ [3:99]
14. يَا قَوْمِ لَا أَسْأَلُكُمْ عَلَيْهِ أَجْرًا [11:51]
15. يَا أَبَتِ لِمَ تَتَّبِعُ مَا لَا يَشْمَعُ [19:42]
16. يَا قَوْمِ أَرَهْطِي أَعَزُّ عَلَيْكُم مِّنَ اللَّهِ [11:92]
17. يَا قَوْمِ هَؤُلَاءِ بَنَاتِي [11:78]
18. قَالَ مُوسَىٰ يَا فِرْعَوْنُ إِنِّي رَسُولٌ مِّن رَّبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ [7:104]
19. قَالُوا يَا نُوحُ قَدْ جَادَلْتَنَا فَأَكْثَرْتَ جِدَالَنَا [11:32]
20. يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ قَدْ جَاءَكُم بُرْهَانٌ مِّن رَّبِّكُمْ [4:174]
21. يَا أَيُّهَا الرَّسُولُ لَا يَحْزُنكَ الَّذِينَ يُسَارِعُونَ فِي الْكُفْرِ [5:41]
22. يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ أَنْتُمُ الْفُقَرَاءُ إِلَى اللَّهِ [35:15]
23. يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لِمَ تَقُولُونَ مَا لَا تَفْعَلُونَ [61:2]
24. يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا لَا تَعْتَذِرُوا الْيَوْمَ [66:7]

Lesson Thirty

Defective Verbs

There are three types of defective verbs:

1. verbs of the *kataba* pattern with *wāw* as their final radical, e.g. *rajā*;
2. verbs of the *kataba* pattern with *yā'* as their final radical, e.g. *ramā*;
3. verbs of the *shariba* pattern with either *wāw* or *yā'* as their final radical, e.g. *raḍiya*, *baqiya* and *nasiya*.

As there are no defective verbs that are as common as *kāna* or *qāla*, it is not possible to introduce them gradually. However, they are easier to deal with than hollow verbs. Many of the forms of the Perfect, Imperfect and Subjunctive do not differ from those of the sound verb, but care is needed with the Jussive, where the final radical often appears only as a short vowel.

VERBS OF THE *kataba* PATTERN WITH *wāw* AS FINAL RADICAL

Perfect

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	رَجَا	رَجَوَا	رَجَوْا
3 f.	رَجَتْ	رَجَتَا	رَجَوْنَ
2 m.	رَجَوْتَ	رَجَوْتُمَا	رَجَوْتُمْ
2 f.	رَجَوْتِ	رَجَوْتُمَا	رَجَوْتُنَّ
I	رَجَوْتُ	—	رَجَوْنَا

Imperfect

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَرْجُو	يَرْجُوَانِ	يَرْجُونَ
3 f.	تَرْجُو	تَرْجُوَانِ	يَرْجُونَ
2 m.	تَرْجُو	تَرْجُوَانِ	تَرْجُونَ
2 f.	تَرْجِيْنَ	تَرْجُوَانِ	تَرْجُونَ
I	أَرْجُو	—	نَرْجُو

Subjunctive

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَرْجُوَ	يَرْجُوَا	يَرْجُوا
3 f.	تَرْجُوَ	تَرْجُوَا	يَرْجُونَ
2 m.	تَرْجُوَ	تَرْجُوَا	تَرْجُوا
2 f.	تَرْجِيْ	تَرْجُوَا	تَرْجُونَ
I	أَرْجُوَ	—	نَرْجُوَ

Jussive

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَرْجُ	يَرْجُوَا	يَرْجُوا
3 f.	تَرْجُ	تَرْجُوَا	يَرْجُونَ
2 m.	تَرْجُ	تَرْجُوَا	تَرْجُوا
2 f.	تَرْجِيْ	تَرْجُوَا	تَرْجُونَ
I	أَرْجُ	—	نَرْجُ

VERBS OF THE *kataba* PATTERN WITH *yā'* AS FINAL
RADICAL

Perfect

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	رَمَى	رَمَيَا	رَمَوْا
3 f.	رَمَتْ	رَمَتَا	رَمَيْنَ
2 m.	رَمَيْتَ	رَمَيْتُمَا	رَمَيْتُمْ
2 f.	رَمَيْتِ	رَمَيْتُمَا	رَمَيْتُنَّ
1	رَمَيْتُ	—	رَمَيْنَا

Imperfect

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَرْمِي	يَرْمِيَانِ	يَرْمُونُ
3 f.	تَرْمِي	تَرْمِيَانِ	يَرْمِينَ
2 m.	تَرْمِي	تَرْمِيَانِ	تَرْمُونُ
2 f.	تَرْمِينَ	تَرْمِيَانِ	تَرْمِينَ
1	أَرْمِي	—	نَرْمِي

Subjunctive

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَرْمِي	يَرْمِيَا	يَرْمُوا
3 f.	تَرْمِي	تَرْمِيَا	يَرْمِينَ
2 m.	تَرْمِي	تَرْمِيَا	تَرْمُوا
2 f.	تَرْمِي	تَرْمِيَا	تَرْمِينَ
1	أَرْمِي	—	نَرْمِي

Jussive

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَزِم	يَزِمَا	يَزُمُوا
3 f.	تَزِم	تَزِمَا	يَزِمِينَ
2 m.	تَزِم	تَزِمَا	تَزُمُوا
2 f.	تَزِمِي	تَزِمَا	تَزِمِينَ
I	أَزِم	—	نَزِم

VERBS OF THE *shariba* PATTERN

Perfect

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	بَقِيَ	بَقِيَا	بَقُوا
3 f.	بَقِيَتْ	بَقِيَتَا	بَقِينَ
2 m.	بَقِيَتْ	بَقِيْتُمَا	بَقِيْتُمْ
2 f.	بَقِيَتْ	بَقِيْتُمَا	بَقِيْتُنَّ
I	بَقِيْتُ	—	بَقِينَا

Imperfect

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَبْقَى	يَبْقَيَانِ	يَبْقَوْنَ
3 f.	تَبْقَى	تَبْقَيَانِ	يَبْقِينَ
2 m.	تَبْقَى	تَبْقَيَانِ	تَبْقَوْنَ
2 f.	تَبْقَيْنَ	تَبْقَيَانِ	تَبْقَيْنَ
I	أَبْقَى	—	نَبْقَى

Subjunctive

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَبْقَى	يَبْقَيَا	يَبْقَوْا
3 f.	تَبْقَى	تَبْقَيَا	يَبْقَيْنَ
2 m.	تَبْقَى	تَبْقَيَا	تَبْقَوْا
2 f.	تَبْقَي	تَبْقَيَا	تَبْقَيْنَ
I	أَبْقَى	—	نَبْقَى

Jussive

	SINGULAR	DUAL	PLURAL
3 m.	يَبْقَ	يَبْقَيَا	يَبْقَوْا
3 f.	تَبْقَ	تَبْقَيَا	يَبْقَيْنَ
2 m.	تَبْقَ	تَبْقَيَا	تَبْقَوْا
2 f.	تَبْقَي	تَبْقَيَا	تَبْقَيْنَ
I	أَبْقَ	—	نَبْقَ

DERIVED FORMS

In the Perfect **all** the derived forms conjugate like *ramā*, regardless of which type the verb is in the first form. In the imperfect tenses they also conjugate like *ramā*, apart from the 5th and 6th forms, which conjugate like the imperfect tenses of *baqiya*.

The basic forms are:

Form	Perfect	Imperfect	Subjunctive	Jussive
2	لَقِيَ	يُلْقِي	يُلْقِي	يُلَقِّ
3	لَاقَى	يَلَاقِي	يَلَاقِي	يَلَاقِ
4	أَلْقَى	يُلْقِي	يُلْقِي	يُلَقِّ
5	تَلَقَّى	يَتَلَقَّى	يَتَلَقَّى	يَتَلَقِّ
6	تَرَاضَى	يَتَرَاضَى	يَتَرَاضَى	يَتَرَاضِ
7	انْقَضَى	يَنْقَضِي	يَنْقَضِي	يَنْقَضِ
8	التَّقَى	يَلْتَقِي	يَلْتَقِي	يَلْتَقِ
10	اسْتَغْلَى	يَسْتَغْلِي	يَسْتَغْلِي	يَسْتَغْلِ

Note that the *maṣḍar* of the 2nd form of defective verbs, like that of the 2nd form of third radical *hamza* verbs, is based on the form *taf'ilatun*. Thus the *maṣḍar* of سَمِيَ *sammā* is تَسْمِيَةٌ *tasmiyatun*.

As with hollow verbs, some of the most important defective verbs have two weak radicals. They include أَتَى *atā* and its 4th form آتَى *ātā*, وَفَى *wafā* and its 4th form أَوْفَى *awfā*, وَلَّى *waliya* and its 2nd and 5th forms وَلَّى *wallā* and تَوَلَّى *tawallā*, and اِتَّقَى *ittaqa*, the 8th form of وَقَى *waqā*.

Verbs with two final weak radicals are treated as though the middle radical is sound. They conjugate like *ramā* or *baqiya*. On this basis the triply weak أَوَى *awā* is no different from *atā*.

Special attention should be paid to the very common verb رَأَى *ra'ā*, 'to see'. The Perfect is regular and conjugates like *rama*. However, in the Imperfect the *hamza* disappears: يَرَى *yarā*, يَرَاوْنَ *yarauna*, نَرَى *narā*, etc. The same loss of *hamza* occurs in both the Perfect and the Imperfect of the 4th form.

VOCABULARY THIRTY

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
أَتَى	يَأْتِي	إِثْيَانٌ	to come
آتَى ⁴	يُؤْتِي	إِيتَاءٌ	to give
رَأَى	يَرَى	رَأْيٌ	to see
جَزَى	يَجْزِي	جَزَاءٌ	to requite
دَعَا	يَدْعُو	دُعَاءٌ	to call, pray
رَجَا	يَرْجُو	رَجَاءٌ	to hope
قَضَى	يَقْضِي	قَضَاءٌ	to determine
مَشَى	يَمْشِي	مَشْيٌ	to walk
هَدَى	يَهْدِي	هُدًى	to guide
بَقِيَ	يَبْقَى	بَقَاءٌ	to remain
خَشِيَ	يَخْشَى	خَشْيَةٌ	to fear
لَقِيَ	يَلْقَى	لِقَاءٌ	to meet
نَسِيَ	يَنْسَى	نَسْيٌ	to forget
سَمَّى ²	يُسَمِّي	تَسْمِيَةٌ	to name
صَلَّى ²	يُصَلِّي	صَلَاةٌ	to pray
نَادَى ³	يُنَادِي	نِدَاءٌ	to call out to
أَلْقَى ⁴	يُلْقِي	إِلْقَاءٌ	to throw
أَعْطَى ⁴	يُعْطِي	إِعْطَاءٌ	to give
أَوْفَى ⁴	يُوفِي	إِيفَاءٌ	to fulfil, give in full
تَوَلَّى ⁵	يَتَوَلَّى	تَوَلَّى	to turn away; to take on oneself

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN
إِتَّقَى ⁸	يَتَّقِي	إِتْقَاءٌ to protect oneself, to be god-fearing
شَعَرَ	يَشْعُرُ	شُعُورٌ to feel, perceive
أَنْجَى ⁴	يُنْجِي	إِنْجَاءٌ to rescue

SINGULAR	PLURAL
طِينٌ	clay
رُغَبٌ	terror
(f.) سُوقٌ	أَسْوَاقٌ market
ثُمَّ	then
بَغْتَةً	suddenly

EXERCISE THIRTY

1. أَتَتْ بِهِ قَوْمَهَا [19:27]
2. تَأْتِيَهُمُ السَّاعَةُ بَغْتَةً وَهُمْ لَا يَشْعُرُونَ [12:107]
3. كَمْ أَتَيْتُهُمْ مِنْ آيَةٍ بَيِّنَةٍ [2:211]
4. يُقِيمُونَ الصَّلَاةَ وَيُؤْتُونَ الزَّكَاةَ [5:55]
5. إِنِّي أَرَاكَ وَقَوْمَكَ فِي ضَلَالٍ مُبِينٍ [6:74]
6. أَفَرَأَيْتُمُ الْمَاءَ الَّذِي تَشْرَبُونَ [56:68]
7. أُولَئِكَ يَرْجُونَ رَحْمَةَ اللَّهِ [2:218]
8. إِنِّي دَعَوْتُ قَوْمِي لَيْلًا وَنَهَارًا [71:5]
9. وَسَيَجْزِي اللَّهُ الشَّاكِرِينَ [3:144]

10. خَلَقَكُمْ مِنْ طِينٍ ثُمَّ قَضَى أَجَلًا [6:2]
11. يَمْشُونَ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ [25:63]
12. يَأْكُلُ الطَّعَامَ وَيَمْشِي فِي الْأَسْوَاقِ [25:7]
13. الْيَوْمَ نَنْسَاهُمْ كَمَا نَسُوا لِقَاءَ يَوْمِهِمْ هَذَا [7:51]
14. لَا يَخْشَوْنَ أَحَدًا إِلَّا اللَّهَ [33:39]
15. هُوَ سَمَّاكُمُ الْمُسْلِمِينَ [22:78]
16. فَدَاثَهُ الْمَلَائِكَةُ وَهُوَ قَائِمٌ يُصَلِّي [3:39]
17. هَدَيْنَاهُمْ إِلَى صِرَاطٍ مُسْتَقِيمٍ [6:87]
18. إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَهْدِي مَنْ هُوَ كَاذِبٌ كَفَّارٌ [39:3]
19. أَلْقَى عَصَاهُ [7:107]
20. سَنُلْقِي فِي قُلُوبِ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا الرُّعْبَ [3:151]
21. أَنُحْيِيَنَّ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَكَانُوا يَتَّقُونَ [27:53]
22. أَوْفَى بِعَهْدِهِ وَاتَّقَى [3:76]
23. أَفَرَأَيْتِ الَّذِي تَوَلَّى وَأَعْطَى قَلِيلًا [53:34]
24. تَوَلَّى عَنْهُمْ وَقَالَ يَا قَوْمِ لَقَدْ أَبْلَغْتُكُمْ رِسَالَاتِ رَبِّي [7:93]
25. ثُمَّ يَتَوَلَّى فَرِيقٌ مِنْهُمْ وَهُمْ مُعْرِضُونَ [3:23]

Lesson Thirty-One

Ordinal and Other Numbers

In addition to the cardinal numbers set out in Lesson 14, the Qur'ān has examples of three other kinds of numerals: ordinals, fractions and distributives. The use of distributives is very limited, but there is a fair scattering of the ordinals [first to sixth, and eighth] and fractions [a half, a third, a quarter, a fifth, a sixth, an eighth, a tenth]. General tables for the ordinals up to 'tenth', the fractions up to 'one tenth' and the distributives up to 'four each' are set out below.^A

ORDINALS

You have already been fully introduced to the only ordinal that needs care: *awwalu*, *ūlā* f., 'first', normally with the definite article. This operates effectively as an elative. The other ordinals from 'second' to 'tenth' are adjectives of the pattern *fā'ilun*. In the case of 'second' the final weak radical produces *thānin*, which declines like *wālin*; with 'sixth' the basic radicals *s-d-s*, not apparent in the cardinal forms, appear in full; and with 'eighth' there is no sign of the *-in* ending of the cardinal. Ordinal numbers between 'two' and 'ten' agree in number, gender and case with the noun to which they are attached:

	masc.	fem.
first	الْأَوَّلُ	الْأُولَى
second	ثَانٍ	ثَانِيَّةٌ
third	ثَالِثٌ	ثَالِثَةٌ

^A For ordinals above 'tenth' and for other rare numerical forms see Wright, *Arabic Grammar*, I, pp. 262–264.

fourth	رَابِعٌ	رَابِعَةٌ
fifth	خَامِسٌ	خَامِسَةٌ
sixth	سَادِسٌ	سَادِسَةٌ
seventh	سَابِعٌ	سَابِعَةٌ
eighth	ثَامِنٌ	ثَامِنَةٌ
ninth	تَاسِعٌ	تَاسِعَةٌ
tenth	عَاشِرٌ	عَاشِرَةٌ

FRACTIONS

Apart from *نِصْفٌ* *nisfun*, 'half', which is not linked to any other part of the numerical system, the basic form for fractions is *فُعْلٌ* *fu'ulun* / *فُعْلٌ* *fu'lun*.

In addition, there is a form *مِيفْآلُون*, which is found with a quarter and a tenth only, the form *مِيشَارُون* '1/10' occurring in 34:45. All the other fractions that occur in the Qur'ān are of the *fu'ulun* form. (In later Arabic *fu'lun* is much the more common form.)

1/2	نِصْفٌ	
1/3	ثُلُثٌ	
1/4	رُبْعٌ	مِزْبَاعٌ
1/5	خُمْسٌ	
1/6	سُدُسٌ	
1/7	سَبْعٌ	
1/8	ثَمَنٌ	
1/9	تُسْعٌ	
1/10	عُشْرٌ	مِغْشَارٌ

DISTRIBUTIVES

The two distributive forms are *fu'ālu* and *maf'alu*. Both are to be found in the phrase مَثْنَى وَثُلَاثَ وَرُبَاعَ *mathnā wa-thulātha wa-rubā'* 'two, three or four each' that occurs in 4:3 and 35:1. *mathnā* also occurs with *furādā*, 'singly', in 34:46.

VOCABULARY THIRTY-ONE

In addition to the numerals in the lesson you will need the following words:

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
أَرَى ⁴	يُرِي		to show
رَضِيَ	يَرْضَى	رِضْوَانٌ / مَرْضَاةٌ	to be pleased with (+ 'an)
إِتَّغَى ⁸	يَتَّبِعِي	إِتِّغَاءٌ	to seek
كَفَى	يَكْفِي	كِفَايَةٌ	to be sufficient

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
زَوْجٌ	أَزْوَاجٌ	spouse
	صُحُفٌ	sheets
كَلْبٌ	كِلَابٌ	dog
نَجْوَى		secret conference

Idioms Note the construction كَفَى بِاللَّهِ حَسِيبًا *kafā bi-llāhi ḥasīban* 'there is sufficiency in God as a reckoner' i.e. 'God is sufficient as a reckoner'. There are further examples in sentences 22 and 23 below.

EXERCISE THIRTY-ONE

1. لِكُلِّ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهُمَا السُّدُسُ [4:11]
2. مَا يَكُونُ مِنْ نَجْوَى ثَلَاثَةٍ إِلَّا هُوَ رَابِعُهُمْ [58:7]
3. رَابِعُهُمْ كَثْبُهُمْ [18:22]
4. لَكُمْ الرُّبْعُ مِمَّا تَرَكْنَ [4:12]
5. لِأُمِّهِ الثُّلُثُ [4:11]
6. لَهُنَّ ثُلُثَا مَا تَرَكَ [4:11]
7. لَقَدْ كَفَرَ الَّذِينَ قَالُوا إِنَّ اللَّهَ ثَالِثُ ثَلَاثَةٍ [5:73]
8. أَنَا أَوَّلَ الْعَابِدِينَ [43:81]
9. لَا تَكُونُوا أَوَّلَ كَافِرٍ بِهِ [2:41]
10. إِنَّ هَذَا لَفِي الصُّحُفِ الْأُولَى [87:18]
11. أَلَمْ نُهْلِكِ الْأَوَّلِينَ [77:16]
12. جَاءَ وَعَدُ أُولَاهُمَا [17:5]
13. وَيَقُولُونَ سَبْعَةٌ وَثَامِنُهُمْ كَثْبُهُمْ [18:22]
14. لَهُنَّ الثَّمَنُ مِمَّا تَرَكْتُمْ [4:12]
15. مَا بَلَغُوا مِغْشَارَ مَا آتَيْنَاهُمْ [34:45]
16. إِنَّ رَبَّكَ يَعْلَمُ أَنَّكَ تَقُومُ أَدْنَى مِنْ ثُلُثِي اللَّيْلِ [73:20]
وَنِصْفَهُ وَثُلُثَهُ
17. لَكُمْ نِصْفُ مَا تَرَكَ أَزْوَاجُكُمْ [4:12]
18. رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمْ وَرَضُوا عَنْهُ [58:22]
19. فَأَرَاهُ آيَةَ الْكُبْرَى [79:20]

20. كَذَلِكَ يُرِيهِمُ اللَّهُ أَعْمَالَهُمْ [2:167]
21. أَوَلَمْ يَكْفِهِمْ أَنَّا أَنزَلْنَا عَلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ [29:51]
22. كَفَى بِاللَّهِ وَلِيًّا [4:45]
23. كَفَى بِاللَّهِ شَهِيدًا بَيْنَنَا وَبَيْنَكُمْ [10:29]
24. لَيْسَ عَلَيْكُمْ جُنَاحٌ أَنْ تَبْتَغُوا فَضْلًا مِنْ رَبِّكُمْ [2:198]

Lesson Thirty-Two

The Imperative

The Imperative occurs in the second person only. It is used for commands, and only for commands—it cannot be used with a negative. As you have already been shown in Lesson 20, prohibitions (negative commands) are expressed by *lā* and the Jussive.

The Imperative is formed directly from the second person of the Jussive, by dropping the prefix *ta-* or *tu-*.

a) If the letter that follows that prefix has its own vowel, that is all there is to process:

Imperative	2 Jussive
قُلْ	تَقُلْ
كُونِي	تَكُونِي
قُولُوا	تَقُولُوا
ذَرُوا	تَذَرُوا
قِي	تَقِي
قَذِرْ	تُقَذِرْ
قَدِّمُوا	تُقَدِّمُوا
جَاهِدُوا	تُجَاهِدُوا
تَوَكَّلْ	تَتَوَكَّلْ
تَوَفَّ	تَتَوَفَّ

The only exception to this rule is with the 4th form doubled and hollow verbs. This is dealt with in the section on the 4th form below.

b) If the letter that follows the prefix does not have its own vowel, a vowel must be added. In most cases this will be a temporary *hamzat al-waṣl* (in the 1st, 7th, 8th and 10th forms), but the 4th form takes the permanent *hamzat al-qaṭʿ*.

1st Form

If the vowel of the second radical is *ḍamma*, the added vowel is *ḍamma*; if it is *fatha* or *kasra*, the added vowel is *kasra*:

Imperative	2 Jussive
اُكْتُبْ	تَكْتُبْ
اِرْجِعُوا	تَرْجِعُوا
اِذْهَبَا	تَذْهَبَا
اِشْرَبِي	تَشْرَبِي

4th Form

The prefix *tu-* is replaced by *a-* (*hamzat al-qaṭʿ* and *fatha*), regardless of the presence or absence of a vowel on the first radical:

Imperative	2 Jussive
أَدْخُلْ	تَدْخُلْ
أَنْذِرُوا	تُنْذِرُوا
أَلْقِ	تُلْقِ
أَقِمْ	تُقِمْ
أَقِمْوَا	تُقِمْوَا
أَعِدُّوَا	تُعِدُّوَا

8th and 10th Forms

With these forms *ta-* is replaced by a temporary *kasra*:

Imperative	2 Jussive
اِتَّصِرْ	تَتَّصِرْ
اِتَّخِذُوا	تَتَّخِذُوا
اِتَّقُوا	تَتَّقُوا
اِسْتَغْفِرْ	تَسْتَغْفِرْ
اِسْتَفْتِ	تَسْتَفْتِ
اِسْتَقِيمُوا	تَسْتَقِيمُوا

SPECIAL FORMS

Three verbs that have *hamza* as their initial radical—*akhadha*, *akala*, *amara*—lose the *hamza* in the imperative:

Imperative	2 Jussive
خُذْ	تَأْخُذْ
خُذُوا	تَأْخُذُوا
كُلْ	تَأْكُلْ
كَلَّا	تَأْكَلَا
مُرْ	تَأْمُرْ

By a quirk of Qur'ānic orthography, *mur*, which occurs with *wa-* in *wa-mur* is written with a redundant *alif*, *hamza*, *sukūn* before the *mīm*: وَأَمُرْ. Tradition is the only justification for this. The verb *sa'ala* has both forms that retain the *hamza* (إِسْأَلُوا *is'alū* and

فَأَسْأَلُ *fa-s'al* etc.) and one that drops the *hamza* (سَل *sal*). The latter is what one would expect in the Hijāz.

The 4th form verb *ātā* has some imperative forms that have an initial *hā'* instead of *hamza*. In the Qur'ān only the masculine plural form هَاتُوا *hātū* is to be found.

VOCABULARY THIRTY-TWO

PERFECT IMPERFECT VERBAL NOUN

بَدَأَ	يَبْدَأُ	بَدْءٌ	to begin
رَزَقَ	يَرْزُقُ	رِزْقٌ	to give sustenance to
سَرَقَ	يَسْرِقُ	سَرَقٌ	to steal
هَجَرَ	يَهْجُرُ	هَجْرٌ	to forsake, leave
تَمَتَّعَ ⁵	يَتَمَتَّعُ	تَمَتُّعٌ	to enjoy, enjoy oneself

SINGULAR PLURAL

سُورَةٌ	سُورٌ	<i>sura</i>
قِبْلَةٌ		direction, <i>qibla</i>
قُوَّةٌ	قُوَى	power, force
كَئِيلٌ		measure
آلٌ		family

EXERCISE THIRTY-TWO

1. أَغْرَضَ عَنْهُمْ وَتَوَكَّلْ عَلَى اللَّهِ [4:81]
2. خُذُوا مَا آتَيْنَاكُمْ بِقُوَّةٍ وَاذْكُرُوا مَا فِيهِ [2:63]
3. أَسْكُنْ أَنْتَ وَزَوْجُكَ الْجَنَّةَ وَكُلَا مِنْهَا [2:35]

4. وَمُرَّ أَهْلَكَ بِالصَّلَاةِ وَاصْطَبِرْ عَلَيْهَا [20:132]
5. آمِنُوا بِاللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ [57:7]
6. بَشِّرِ الْمُنَافِقِينَ بِأَنَّ لَهُمْ عَذَابًا أَلِيمًا [4:138]
7. اسْتَغْفِرِي لِدُنْيِكَ [12:29]
8. اجْعَلُوا بُيُوتَكُمْ قِبْلَةً وَأَقِيمُوا الصَّلَاةَ [10:87]
9. إِنَّ الشَّيْطَانَ لَكُمْ عَدُوٌّ فَاتَّخِذُوهُ عَدُوًّا [35:6]
10. أَنْذِرْ قَوْمَكَ مِنْ قَبْلِ أَنْ يَأْتِيَهُمْ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ [71:1]
11. اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ وَكُونُوا مَعَ الصَّادِقِينَ [9:119]
12. رَبِّ اجْعَلْ هَذَا بَلَدًا آمِنًا وَارْزُقْ أَهْلَهُ مِنَ الثَّمَرَاتِ [2:126]
13. رُدُّوهُ إِلَى اللَّهِ وَالرَّسُولِ [4:59]
14. أَرُونِي مَاذَا خَلَقُوا مِنَ الْأَرْضِ [46:4]
15. قُمْ فَأَنْذِرْ [74:2]
16. قُلْ تَمَتَّعْ بِكُفْرِكَ قَلِيلًا إِنَّكَ مِنْ أَصْحَابِ النَّارِ [39:8]
17. قَالَ رَبِّ انصُرْنِي عَلَى الْقَوْمِ الْمُفْسِدِينَ [29:30]
18. أَوْفِ لَنَا الْكَيْلَ وَتَصَدَّقْ عَلَيْنَا [12:88]
19. اِعْمَلُوا مَا شِئْتُمْ إِنَّهُ بِمَا تَعْمَلُونَ بَصِيرٌ [41:40]
20. أَخْرِجُوا آلَ لُوطٍ مِنْ قَرْيَتِكُمْ [27:56]
21. فَاتُّوا بِسُورَةٍ مِنْ مِثْلِهِ وَادْعُوا شُهَدَاءَكُمْ [2:23]
22. يَقُولُونَ سَلَامٌ عَلَيْكُمْ آذِخُوا الْجَنَّةَ بِمَا كُنْتُمْ تَعْمَلُونَ [16:32]
23. قُلْ أَطِيعُوا اللَّهَ وَالرَّسُولَ [3:32]
24. اِصْبِرْ عَلَى مَا يَقُولُونَ وَاهْجُرْهُمْ هَجْرًا جَمِيلًا [73:10]
25. قُلْ سِيرُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ فَانظُرُوا كَيْفَ بَدَأَ الْخَلْقَ [29:20]

Lesson Thirty-Three

The Passive

The Passive is much less common than the Active. Early Arabic, in particular, does not allow the Passive to be used with the agent. Thus one will always find the equivalent of 'the thunderbolt took them' rather than 'they were taken by the thunderbolt'. On the other hand, the use of impersonal passive verbs produces a series of third person masculine singular passive forms from intransitive verbs or those, like *aḥāṭa bi-* or *ghaḍiba 'alā*, whose object is governed by a preposition. The Passive is formed by using a different set of vowels from those used in the Active. Conjugation is precisely the same as that of the Active. The basic forms for the Passive of *qabila* are:

Form	Perfect	Imperfect	Subjunctive	Jussive
1	قُبِلَ	يُقْبَلُ	يُقْبَلَ	يُقْبَلْ
2	قُبِّلَ	يُقَبَّلُ	يُقَبَّلَ	يُقَبَّلْ
3	قُوِيَ	يُقَابَلُ	يُقَابَلَ	يُقَابَلْ
4	أُقِيلَ	يُقْبَلُ	يُقْبَلَ	يُقْبَلْ
5	تُقَبَّلَ	يَتَقَبَّلُ	يَتَقَبَّلَ	يَتَقَبَّلْ
6	تُقَوَّيَ	يَتَقَابَلُ	يَتَقَابَلَ	يَتَقَابَلْ
7	أُنْقِيلَ	يُنْقَبَلُ	يُنْقَبَلَ	يُنْقَبَلْ
8	أُقْتَبَلَ	يُقْتَبَلُ	يُقْتَبَلَ	يُقْتَبَلْ
10	أُسْتَقْبَلَ	يُسْتَقْبَلُ	يُسْتَقْبَلَ	يُسْتَقْبَلْ

Note that there is no variation in the vowel of the second radical of the first form in the Passive.

DOUBLED VERBS

There are no special problems. Contraction takes place as in the Active. Thus from the verb رَدَّ *radda* there are such passive forms as رُدِّتْ *ruddat*, رُدِّدْتُ *rudidtu*, رُدِّدُوا *ruddū*, تُرَدِّدُ *turaddu*, يُرَدِّدُونَ *yuraddūna*, نُرَدِّدُ *nuraddu*, etc.

There are a handful of examples of the 8th form Passive اُضْطَرَّ *uḍṭurra*, which, as elsewhere in Arabic, is more common in the Passive than the Active.

ASSIMILATED VERBS

Note that first radical *wāw* is retained in the imperfect passive of the first form, unlike the active where the *wāw* normally disappears in the imperfect tenses.

وَجَدَ *wajada*

imperfect active: يَجِدُ *yajidu* imperfect passive: يُوجَدُ *yūjadu*

HOLLOW VERBS

Hollow verb passives are generally rare in Arabic, and the only examples in the Qur'ān are the 1st and 4th form passives. (7th, 8th and 10th form examples are to be found in other texts.)

Form	Perfect	Imperfect	Subjunctive	Jussive
1	قِيلَ	يُقَالُ	يُقَالَ	يُقَلْ
4	أُحِيطَ	يُحَاطُ	يُحَاطَ	يُحَظْ

As mentioned above, the forms *uḥīṭa* and *yuhāṭa* are impersonal, as are جِيَءَ *jī'a* (from جَاءَ *jā'a*) and, probably, سِيَءَ *sī'a* (from سَاءَ *sā'a*).

In the Perfect of these forms, the long vowel *ī* remains in those persons in which *ā* is found in the active. When contraction takes place, *ī* becomes *i*. Thus the 2 m.s. of *qīla* is قِلْتَ *qilta*. The imperfect tenses conjugate like the imperfect tenses of *khāfa*.

DEFECTIVE VERBS

Form	Perfect	Imperfect	Subjunctive	Jussive
1	جَزِيَ	يُجْزَى	يُجْزَى	يُجْزَ
3	نُودِيَ	يُنَادَى	يُنَادَى	يُنَادَ
4	أُوتِيَ	يُؤْتَى	يُؤْتَى	يُؤْتَ
5	تُؤْتَى	يَتَوَفَّى	يَتَوَفَّى	يَتَوَفَّ

All these forms conjugate like *nasiya*.

The Qur'ān has a greater incidence of passives of defective verbs than of hollow verbs, but only three are relatively common: the 4th form *ātā*; the 4th form *awḥā*; and the 1st form *jazā*. Otherwise there is a scattering of 1st, 3rd, 4th and 5th form passives, and the occasional 8th form passive participle (e.g. the plural of مُضْطَفًى). Other derived form passives, though found elsewhere in Arabic, need not detain us here. It is worth noting that there are a couple of examples of *yurā*, the imperfect passive of *ra'ā*, and one of *yuraw*, which is the 3 m.p. subjunctive of *arā*.

THE IMPERSONAL PASSIVE

The impersonal passive is expressed by the 3 m.s. It is usually easy to spot:

قُضِيَ بَيْنَهُمْ	there was judgement between them
أُسْتَهْزِئَ بِهِ	there was mockery of him
يُكْشَفُ عَنْ سَاقٍ	there is uncovering of a leg
(metaphorical for fighting taking place)	

It should be noted that the impersonal use extends to the passive participle. First, two non-Quranic examples:

الْمَغْضُوبُ عَلَيْهِ	the man against whom there is anger
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Exercise Thirty-Three

الْمَغْضُوبُ عَلَيْهَا the woman against whom there is anger

Hence we get in the *Fātiḥa* the genitive phrase:

الْمَغْضُوبِ عَلَيْهِمْ those against whom there is anger

VOCABULARY THIRTY-THREE

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
غَضِبَ	يَغْضِبُ	غَضَبٌ	to be angry with (+ 'alā)
وَفَّى ²	يُوفِّي	تَوْفِيَّةٌ	to pay, repay
تَوَفَّى ⁵	يَتَوَفَّى	تَوَفٍّ	to take
أَوْحَى ⁴	يُوحِي	إِيْحَاءٌ	to inspire
نَفَخَ	يَنْفُخُ	نَفْخٌ	to blow
بَلَّغَ ²	يُبَلِّغُ	تَبْلِيغٌ	to convey
إِسْتَهْزَأَ ¹⁰	يَسْتَهْزِئُ	إِسْتِهْزَاءٌ	to mock (+ bi-)

SINGULAR

بَلَاغٌ	message, conveyance
صُورٌ	trumpet

EXERCISE THIRTY-THREE

1. أُخْرِجُوا مِنْ دِيَارِهِمْ [3:195]
2. أَخِذُوا مِنْ مَّكَانٍ قَرِيبٍ [34:51]
3. مَا أَوْتَيْتُمْ مِنَ الْعِلْمِ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا [17:85]

4. لَنْ تُؤْمِنَ حَتَّى نُؤْتِيَ مَثَلًا مَّا أُوتِيَ رُسُلُ اللَّهِ [6:124]
5. حِيءَ بِالنَّبِيِّينَ وَالشُّهَدَاءِ وَقُضِيَ بَيْنَهُمْ [39:69]
6. سَتُدْعُونَ إِلَى قَوْمٍ أُولِي بَأْسٍ شَدِيدٍ [48:16]
7. أَغْشَيْتَ وَجُوهَهُمْ قِطْعًا مِنَ اللَّيْلِ [10:27]
8. ثُمَّ تَوَفَّى كُلَّ نَفْسٍ مَّا كَسَبَتْ وَهُمْ لَا يُظْلَمُونَ [2:281]
9. لَقَدْ وَعَدْنَا نَحْنُ وَآبَاؤُنَا هَذَا مِنْ قَبْلُ [23:83]
10. يَرَوْنَ مَّا يُوعَدُونَ [46:35]
11. أَوْحِيَ إِلَيْنَا أَنَّ الْعَذَابَ عَلَى مَنْ كَذَّبَ وَتَوَلَّى [20:48]
12. لَقَدْ أَشْهَرْنَا بِرُسُلٍ مِنْ قَبْلِكَ [21:41]
13. هَلْ يَهْلِكُ إِلَّا الْقَوْمُ الظَّالِمُونَ [6:47]
14. قُولُوا آمَنَّا بِالَّذِي أُنْزِلَ إِلَيْنَا [29:46]
15. هُمْ لَا يُنْصَرُونَ [41:16]
16. لَا تَظْلِمُونَ وَلَا تُظْلَمُونَ [2:279]
17. يُرْزَقُونَ فِيهَا بِغَيْرِ حِسَابٍ [40:40]
18. هَذِهِ بِضَاعَتُنَا رُدَّتْ إِلَيْنَا [12:65]
19. لَا تَأْكُلُوا مِمَّا لَمْ يُذْكَرِ اسْمُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْهِ [6:121]
20. هَلْ تُحْزَنُونَ إِلَّا بِمَا كُنْتُمْ تَكْسِبُونَ [10:52]
21. هَذَا بَلَاغٌ لِلنَّاسِ وَلِيُنْذَرُوا بِهِ [14:52]
22. أُولَئِكَ يُنَادُونَ مِنْ مَكَانٍ بَعِيدٍ [41:44]
23. قَدْ كَذَّبَ رُسُلٌ مِنْ قَبْلِكَ جَاءُوا بِالْبَيِّنَاتِ [3:184]
24. أَبْلَغُكُمْ مَّا أُرْسِلْتُ بِهِ [46:23]

Exercise Thirty-Three

25. يُنْفَخُ فِي الصُّورِ [6:73]
26. اتَّقُوا النَّارَ الَّتِي أُعِدَّتْ لِلْكَافِرِينَ [3:131]
27. ظَنُّوا أَنَّهُمْ أُحِيطَ بِهِمْ [10:22]
28. إِنَّ هَذَا لَشَيْءٌ يُرَادُ [38:6]

Lesson Thirty-Four

More about Nouns

Idāfa CLAUSES

In Lesson 7 attention was drawn in passing to the fact that the second element of an *idāfa* may sometimes be a clause rather than the normal noun or pronoun. Now that the full range of verbs has been introduced, it is appropriate to look at these *idāfa* clauses, the most common usages of which are temporal. The majority of Qur'ānic examples in which a verb provides the second element of an *idāfa* involve *yawm* or *hīn*:

هَذَا يَوْمٌ يَنْفَعُ الصَّادِقِينَ صِدْقُهُمْ [5:119]

this is the day when the truthful will benefit
from their truthfulness

إِلَى يَوْمٍ يُنْعَثُونَ [15:36]

till the day when they are raised

يَوْمَ وُلِدَ [19:15]

the day he was born

يَوْمَ يُكْشَفُ عَنْ سَاقٍ [68:42]

on the day when [the] leg shall be bared

حِينَ يَرَوْنَ الْعَذَابَ [25:42]

when they see the torment

حِينَ يُنَزَّلُ الْقُرْآنُ [5:101]

when the Recitation is being sent down

ذُو *dhū*, أَبٌ *ab*, أَخٌ *akh*, فَمٌّ *fam*

The noun *dhū* (accusative *dhā*, genitive *dhī*- found only with a following genitive) was mentioned briefly in Lesson 7.

A few other nouns have long final vowels when they are the first element in an *idāfa* construction. The most important of these words are common in the Qur'ān, and have already been partially introduced: *ab* and *akh*. Both originally had a *wāw* as the third radical. When these words are the first element in an *idāfa* they have the following forms:

nom.	acc.	gen.
أَبُو الْوَلَدِ	أَبَا الْوَلَدِ	أَبِي الْوَلَدِ
أَبُوهُ	أَبَاهُ	أَبِيهِ
أَخُو الْبِنْتِ	أَخَا الْبِنْتِ	أَخِي الْبِنْتِ
أَخُوهَا	أَخَاهَا	أَخِيهَا

In the Qur'ān *ab* and *akh* normally occur only with suffixes:

abū-humā, *abā-nā*, *abī-kum*; *akhū-ka*, *akhā-hum*, *akhī-hi*

There are three exceptions: *abā aḥadin* [33:40], *abī laḥabin* [111:1] and *akhā 'ādin* [46:21]. The rarity of such examples does not reflect usage outside the Qur'ān, where the use of *abū* in proper names, for example, is widespread.

The dual of *ab* is أَبَوَانِ *abawāni* / أَبَوَيْنِ *abawayni* (with the sense of 'parents'); and that of *akh* is أَخَوَانِ *akhawāni* / أَخَوَيْنِ *akhawayni*.

The most awkward noun in this little group is فَمٌّ *fam*, 'mouth', which has the following forms as the first element of an *idāfa* (here with the suffix *-hu* as the second element):

	nom.	acc.	gen.
(regular)	فَهُ	فَهُ	فِيهِ
OR			
(irregular)	فُوهُ	فَاهُ	فِيهِ

The only one of these forms found in the Qur'ān is *fā-hu* [13:14], though the plural, which is أَفْوَاهُ *afwāhun*, occurs a dozen times.

THE IMPROPER GENITIVE

The improper genitive occurs in two types of phrases:

1. Where an adjective is followed by a genitive that restricts its meaning:

وَاسِعُ الْمَغْفِرَةِ	[53:32]	wide in forgiveness
سَرِيعُ الْحِسَابِ	[3:19]	swift to the reckoning
شَدِيدُ الْعَذَابِ	[2:165]	severe in punishment
شَدِيدُ الْإِحَالِ	[13:13]	mighty in wrath
غَلِيظُ الْقَلْبِ	[3:159]	hard-hearted

2. Where the genitive comes after the participle of a transitive verb and takes the place of an object in the accusative:

كُلُّ نَفْسٍ ذَائِقَةُ الْمَوْتِ	[3:185]	every soul will taste death
(acc.) هَذِيَّا بَالِغَ الْكَعْبَةِ	[5:95]	an offering getting to the Ka'ba
(acc.) مُقِيمِ الصَّلَاةِ	[14:40]	performing prayer
(gen.) مُتَّخِذِي أَخْدَانٍ	[5:5]	taking 'companions'

Such genitives are termed 'improper' because they have no grammatical influence on the governing word, other than causing it to drop *tanwīn*, even though they modify its meaning. The governing word many therefore take the

definite article. This is rare in early Arabic but has gradually become more common. In the Qur'ān we find:

(acc.) الْمُقِيمِي الصَّلَاةِ [22:35] those performing prayer
(in contrast to وَالْمُقِيمِينَ الصَّلَاةَ [4:162], with the same meaning)

Ghayr AND ITS DERIVATIVES

Ghayrun is in the first instance a noun, used with a following genitive, to mean 'something different from' or 'other than...' or 'another...':

غَيْرَ الْإِسْلَامِ [3:85] other than Islam
غَيْرَ الْحَقِّ [5:77] anything but the truth
غَيْرَ سَبِيلِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ [4:115] [a way] other than that of the believers

If the second element of the *idāfa* is indefinite, the *idāfa* phrase will have the sense of an indefinite adjectival phrase, and be treated as such grammatically:

أَجْرٌ غَيْرُ مَمْنُونٍ [41:8] an unbroken reward
عَمَلٌ غَيْرُ صَالِحٍ [11:46] an unrighteous deed

In such cases it is the second term in the *idāfa* that will link back in gender and number either to the noun to which the phrase as appended or to the subject:

غَيْرُ مُشْرِكِينَ بِهِ [22:31] not associating anything with him
[links back to the imperative *ijtanibū* in the previous verse]

غَيْرُ مُفْجِرِي اللَّهِ [9:2] not frustrating God
[refers back to *anna-kum* that immediately precedes it]

جَنَّاتٍ مَّعْرُوشَاتٍ وَغَيْرَ [6:141] gardens [both] trellised
مَّعْرُوشَاتٍ and untrellised

إِنَّهُمْ غَيْرُ مَلُومِينَ [23:6] they are not blameworthy

In the Qur'ān it is extremely rare for the second term to be definite, though there is a well-known example from the *Fātiḥa*:

غَيْرِ الْمَغْضُوبِ عَلَيْهِمْ [1:7]

[the suffix *-him* refers back to *alladhīna*; see also Lesson 33]

If repetition of the negative idea occurs, *ghayr* is not repeated but *wa-lā* is used instead:

غَيْرَ بَاغٍ وَلَا عَادٍ [2:173] not outraging nor transgressing

The accusative *ghayra* is also used as a preposition, meaning 'without'. The compound forms *bi-ghayri* (see Lesson 21) and *min ghayri* are also common. With these prepositions, too, repetition is by use of *wa-lā*:

بِغَيْرِ عِلْمٍ وَلَا هُدًى وَلَا كِتَابٍ مُنِيرٍ [22:8]

without knowledge or guidance or an
illuminating scripture

VOCABULARY THIRTY-FOUR

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
بَسَطَ	يَبْسُطُ	بَسْطٌ	to spread, extend
خَتَمَ	يَخْتِمُ	خَتْمٌ	to seal
سَبَقَ	يَسْبِقُ	سَبْقٌ	to precede
فَتَنَ	يَفْتِنُ	فِتْنَةٌ	to tempt, afflict, stir up
فَرَّ	يَفِرُّ	فِرَارٌ	to flee
كَشَفَ	يَكْشِفُ	كَشْفٌ	to uncover, remove, re- lieve

Lesson Thirty-Four

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN
وُلِدَ	يُولَدُ	[passive] to be born
تَبَّ		to wither, perish
بَغَى	يَبْغِي	to outrage; to seek
عَدَا	يَعْدُو	to transgress, turn away, run
4 أَصْلَحَ	يُضْلِحُ	إِضْلَاحٌ to put right
4 أَعْجَزَ	يُعْجِزُ	إِعْجَازٌ to frustrate

SINGULAR PLURAL

إِمْرُؤٌ	man
حَكَمٌ	arbiter
(f.) سَاقٌ	سُوقٌ leg
عِقَابٌ	punishment, requital
عَمَدٌ	columns, supports
فَمٌ	أَفْوَاهٌ mouth
مَحَالٌ	wrath, anger
هَدْيٌ	offering
	أَخْدَانٌ companions
سَرِيعٌ	quick, swift
غَلِيظٌ	thick, rough, hard
مَغْرُوشٌ	in trellises
[from يَلُومُ, لَامٌ] مَلُومٌ	blamed, blameworthy
مَمْنُونٌ	broken, cut

غَيْرَ other than
غَيْرَ without

EXERCISE THIRTY-FOUR

1. يَوْمَ تَشْهَدُ عَلَيْهِمْ أَلْسِنُهُمْ [24:24]
2. يَوْمَ نَخْشُرُهُمْ جَمِيعًا [10:28]
3. يَوْمَ خَلَقَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ [9:36]
4. يَوْمَ يَسْمَعُونَ الصَّيْحَةَ [50:42]
5. يَوْمَ هُمْ عَلَى النَّارِ يُفْتَنُونَ [51:13]
6. يَوْمَ يُنْفَخُ فِي الصُّورِ [6:73]
7. يَوْمَ يَفِرُّ الْمَرْءُ مِنْ أَخِيهِ [80:34]
8. أَبُونَا شَيْخٌ كَبِيرٌ [28:23]
9. تَبَّتْ يَدَا أَبِي لَهَبٍ [111:1]
10. اِرْجِعُوا إِلَىٰ أَبِيكُمْ فَقُولُوا يَا أَبَانَا إِنَّ ابْنَكَ سَرَقَ [12:81]
11. قَالَ لِأَبِيهِ وَقَوْمِهِ مَاذَا تَعْبُدُونَ [37:85]
12. مَا كَانَ أَبُوكَ أَمْرًا سُوًى [19:28]
13. كَانَ أَبَوَاهُ مُؤْمِنَيْنِ [18:80]
14. أَخْرَجَ أَبَوَيْكُم مِّنَ الْجَنَّةِ [7:27]
15. قَالَ لَهُم أَخُوهُمْ نُوحٌ أَلَا تَتَّقُونَ [26:106]
16. أَرْسَلْنَا مُوسَىٰ وَأَخَاهُ هَارُونَ بِآيَاتِنَا [23:45]
17. هَلْ آمَنُكُمْ عَلَيْهِ إِلَّا كَمَا أَمْسَكُكُمْ عَلَىٰ أَخِيهِ [12:64]

Exercise Thirty-Four

18. فَأُضْلِحُوا بَيْنَ أَخَوَيْكُمْ [49:10]
19. إِنَّ رَبَّكَ وَاسِعُ الْمَغْفِرَةِ [53:32]
20. إِنَّ اللَّهَ قَوِيٌّ شَدِيدُ الْعِقَابِ [8:52]
21. وَلَا اللَّيْلُ سَابِقُ النَّهَارِ [36:40]
22. الْمَلَائِكَةُ بَاسِطُو أَيْدِيهِمْ [6:93]
23. الْيَوْمَ نَخْتِمُ عَلَى أَفْوَاهِهِمْ [36:65]
24. يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تَدْخُلُوا بُيُوتًا غَيْرَ بُيُوتِكُمْ [24:27]
25. أَفَغَيْرَ اللَّهِ أَبْتَغِي حَكَمًا [6:114]
26. إِنَّ لَكَ لَأَجْرًا غَيْرَ مَمْنُونٍ [68:3]
27. السَّلَامُ عَلَيَّ يَوْمَ وُلِدْتُ وَيَوْمَ أَمُوتُ [19:33]

Lesson Thirty-Five

More on the Accusative

THE PARTICLE *iyyā-*

iyyā- is a particle which is normally found only with a pronominal suffix attached to it. The particle and suffix indicate the accusative (though the particle and the 1 s. suffix produce *iyyā-ya*).

It tends to be used in the Qur'ān to enable the object to be placed in front of the verb for emphasis. The best known example of this is in the *Fātiḥa*:

إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِينُ [1:5]

You we worship, You we turn to for help

In that verse the accusative is not repeated. It is more common for the suffix to be repeated with the verb for further emphasis:

فَإِيَّاي فَارْهَبُونِي [16:51]

Me, be in awe of Me

Otherwise it is used for a second pronominal object:

نَحْنُ نَرْزُقُهُمْ وَإِيَّاكُمْ [17:31]

We provide sustenance for them and for you

يُخْرِجُونَ الرُّسُولَ وَإِيَّاكُمْ [60:1]

they drive out the messenger and you

وَعَدَهَا إِيَّاهُ [9:114]

he promised it to him

When it follows *inna* it indicates the subject, as in:

وَإِنَّا أَوْ إِيَّاكُمْ لَعَلَىٰ هُدًى [34:24]

we or you are rightly guided

It is also used after *illā*:

لَا تَعْبُدُوا إِلَّا إِيَّاهُ [12:40] serve Him only

There is no Qur'ānic example of the usage found elsewhere in Arabic, in which *iyḡā*-...*wa-iyḡā* has the sense of 'beware'.

THE ACCUSATIVE OF ABSOLUTE NEGATION

In this usage, known in Arabic as *لَا لِنَفْيِ الْجِنْسِ* *lā li-nafyi l-jinsi*, the negative *lā* is followed immediately by a noun in the accusative without *tanwīn*. The most famous example occurs at the beginning of the *shahāda*:

لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ there is no god but God

There are examples throughout the Qur'ān, e.g.:

لَا رَيْبَ فِيهِ [2:2] there is no doubt about it

لَا مَرَدَّ لَهُ [13:11] there is no turning it back

لَا كَاشِفَ لَهُ [6:17] there is no one to remove it

THE COGNATE ACCUSATIVE

In this usage, known in Arabic as the *maf'ūl mutlaq*, a verb may take its own *maṣḍar* (or sometimes the *maṣḍar* of a verb with the same or a similar meaning) to add greater force to the verb or to extend its meaning. In its simplest form we find:

عَدَّهُمْ عَدًّا [19:94] he has numbered them [exactly]

إِذَا رُجَّتِ الْأَرْضُ رَجًّا [56:4] when the earth shall be shaken

Sometimes the *maṣḍar* is repeated for greater emphasis:

إِذَا دُكَّتِ الْأَرْضُ دَكًّا دَكًّا [89:21]

when the earth shall be pounded to bits

More commonly the verb is followed by an adjective, with the *maṣḍar* and adjective usually translating most easily into English as an adverb:

يُرِيدُ الَّذِينَ يَتَّبِعُونَ الشَّهَوَاتِ أَنْ تَمِيلُوا مَيْلًا عَظِيمًا [4:27]

those who follow their own desires wish you to deviate greatly

But such translations are not always possible:

ضَلَّ ضَلَالًا بَعِيدًا [4:116] he wandered far astray

إِنَّكُمْ لَتَقُولُونَ قَوْلًا عَظِيمًا [17:40] you are saying something truly shocking

THE ACCUSATIVE OF SPECIFICATION

The main uses of the accusative of specification (Arabic التَّمْيِيزُ *tamyīz*) have already been dealt with: the accusative used with the cardinal numbers from eleven to ninety-nine (and with *kam*); and in the compound elative. It always takes the form of an indefinite noun placed immediately after the phrase it limits or defines. Typical of other, wide uses are:

إِشْتَغَلَ الرَّأْسُ شَيْبًا [19:4] my head is aflame with hoariness

قَرَّرِي عَيْنًا [19:26] be consoled

إِنْ طِبَّنَ نَفْسًا [4:4] if they are pleased

THE ACCUSATIVE OF CAUSE

The accusative is also used to indicate cause or motive, in Arabic

لَهُ الْمَفْعُولُ *al-maf'ūl lahu:*

حَسَدًا مِنْ عِنْدِ أَنْفُسِهِمْ [2:109] through envy on their part

حَذَرَ الْمَوْتِ [2:19] for fear of death

إِيتِغَاءَ مَرْضَاةِ اللَّهِ [2:207] in seeking God's approval

THE ACCUSATIVE OF CIRCUMSTANCE

This usage, known in Arabic as the *الْحَالُ ḥāl*, is common and used in a highly idiomatic way. The general rules devised by the Arab grammarians are complex and frequently broken. The framework that follows is slightly loose, but it should enable you to understand what is taking place.

1. The *ḥāl* must be additional to a complete sentence and must answer the question *كَيْفَ kayfa*, 'how?'
2. The *ḥāl* must refer back to something definite, a noun or a pronoun. It cannot normally refer to an indefinite word such as *rajulun*.
3. The *ḥāl* accusative must itself be indefinite, and normally either a participle or a noun/adjective equivalent to a participle.

Examples

أَصْبَحَ فِي الْمَدِينَةِ خَائِفًا [28:18] in the morning he was in the city, fearing

دَعَانَا ... قَاعِدًا أَوْ قَائِمًا [10:12] he called to us... sitting or standing

This *ḥāl* also occurs in the plural, with broken plural forms:

يَذْكُرُونَ اللَّهَ قِيَامًا وَقُعُودًا [3:191]

they remember God, standing or sitting

Other participial equivalents are:

تَتْلَى ... آيَاتُنَا بَيِّنَاتٍ [45:25] our signs are recited as clear proof

أَرْسَلْنَاكَ لِلنَّاسِ رَسُولًا [4:79] we sent you as a messenger for the people

It appears in exceptions, sometimes as a variation on a simple sentence:

مَا نُزِيلُ الْمُرْسَلِينَ إِلَّا مُبَشِّرِينَ وَمُنْذِرِينَ [6:48]
we only send the messengers as bearers of good tidings and warners

as a variation of

بَعَثَ اللَّهُ النَّبِيِّنَ مُبَشِّرِينَ وَمُنْذِرِينَ [2:213]
God sent the prophets as bringers of good tidings and as warners

It will normally be linked to its object through *li-* and the genitive:

نَزَّلَ عَلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ بِالْحَقِّ مُصَدِّقًا لِمَا بَيْنَ يَدَيْهِ [3:3]
he has sent down to you the Scripture in truth, confirming what came before it

With a phrase attached it may be a compressed relative:

يُدْخِلُهُ نَارًا خَالِدًا فِيهَا [4:14]
he will cause him to enter a fire in which he will remain for ever

Note also such uses of the *ḥāl* as:

اتَّبِعْ مِلَّةَ إِبْرَاهِيمَ حَنِيفًا [3:95]
follow the religion of Abraham, a man of pure faith

إِلَى اللَّهِ مَرْجِعُكُمْ جَمِيعًا [5:48]
you will all return to God

Occasionally a *ḥāl* accusative is found with no previous phrase to which it can obviously be attached:

مُتَكِّئِينَ عَلَيْهَا مُتَقَابِلِينَ [56:16]

reclining on them, facing one another

In addition to *ḥāl* accusatives, there are *ḥāl* clauses. The simplest example is the continuation of 28:18, the first example above. In full the sentence runs:

أَصْبَحَ فِي الْمَدِينَةِ خَائِفًا يَتَرَقَّبُ

in the morning he was in the city, fearing, watching

VOCABULARY THIRTY-FIVE

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
تَلَا	يَتْلُو	تِلَاوَةٌ	to recite
خَرَّ	يَخْرُ	خَرٌّ	to fall
رَهَبَ	يَرْهَبُ	رَهْبَةٌ	to fear, be in awe of
كَادَ	يَكِيدُ	كَيْدٌ	to strive, plot, outwit
مَالَ	يَمِيلُ	مَيْلٌ	to incline, lean, deviate
4 أَصْبَحَ	يُصْبِحُ	إِصْبَاحٌ	to become; be in the morning
4 أَنَابَ	يُنِيبُ	إِنَابَةٌ	to come back to; repent
6 تَرَاضَى	يَتَرَاضَى	تَرَاضٍ	to agree with one another
8 إِزْدَادَ	يَزْدَادُ	إِزْدِيَادٌ	to increase, grow
10 اسْتَعَانَ	يَسْتَعِينُ	اسْتِعَانَةٌ	to ask for help (+ acc.)

SINGULAR PLURAL

حَنِيفٌ	حُنَفَاءُ	of pure faith
صَنِيعَةٌ		cry
عِزَّةٌ		might, power
مَلَجَأٌ		refuge
مَكْرٌ		plot, trickery
مِلَّةٌ	مِلَلٌ	community
إِمْلَاقٌ		poverty
جَمِيعٌ		all
جَمٌّ		much
دَاخِرٌ		humble, lowly
سَاجِدٌ	سُجَّدٌ	prostrating oneself
مُغَاضِبٌ		angry
لَا جَرَمَ		undoubtedly, certainly

Idioms

طَابَ نَفْسًا	to be consoled
قَرَّ عَيْنًا	to be pleased

EXERCISE THIRTY-FIVE

1. أَفَمَنْ يُلْقَى فِي النَّارِ خَيْرٌ أَمْ مَنْ يَأْتِي آمِنًا يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ [41:40]
2. أَخَذْتَهُمُ الصَّيْحَةَ مُصْبِحِينَ [15:83]
3. أَتَوْهُ دَاخِرِينَ [27:87]
4. فَاعْبُدِ اللَّهَ مُخْلِصًا لَهُ الدِّينَ [39:2]
5. خَرُّوا لَهُ سُجَّدًا [12:100]
6. لَا غَالِبَ لَكُمْ الْيَوْمَ [8:48]
7. لَا مَلْجَأَ مِنَ اللَّهِ إِلَّا إِلَيْهِ [9:118]
8. لَا عِلْمَ لَنَا إِلَّا مَا عَلَّمْتَنَا [2:32]
9. لَا جُنَاحَ عَلَيْكُمْ فِيمَا تَرَاضَيْتُمْ بِهِ [4:24]
10. لَا جِدَالَ فِي الْحَجِّ [2:197]
11. ثُمَّ آزَدَاوَا كُفْرًا [3:90]
12. قُلِ اللَّهُ أَسْرَعُ مَكْرًا [10:21]
13. وَاللَّهُ أَشَدُّ بَأْسًا [4:84]
14. أَهْيَأَهُمْ أَحْسَنُ عَمَلًا [18:7]
15. إِنَّهُمْ يَكِيدُونَ كَيْدًا [86:15]
16. يَعْمَلُونَ عَمَلًا دُونَ ذَلِكَ [21:82]
17. يُحِبُّونَ الْمَالَ حُبًّا جَمًّا [89:20]
18. مَا كُنْتُمْ إِتَانًا تَعْبُدُونَ [10:28]
19. نَرْزُقُهُمْ وَإِيَّاكُمْ [17:31]
20. لَا تَقْتُلُوا أَوْلَادَكُمْ خَشْيَةً إِمْلَاقٍ [17:31]

21. مَا تُنْفِقُونَ إِلَّا ابْتِغَاءَ وَجْهِ اللَّهِ [2:272]
22. إِنَّ الْعِزَّةَ لِلَّهِ جَمِيعًا [4:139]
23. دَعَا رَبَّهُ مُنِيبًا إِلَيْهِ [39:8]
24. ذَهَبَ مُغَاضِبًا [21:87]
25. اِرْجِعِي إِلَىٰ رَبِّكِ رَاضِيَةً مَرْضِيَّةً [89:28]
26. فَجَمَعْنَاهُمْ جَمْعًا [18:99]
27. لَا جَزْمَ أَنَّ لَهُمُ النَّارَ [16:62]
28. يُخْرِجُكُمْ إِخْرَاجًا [71:18]

Lesson Thirty-Six

Conditional Sentences

Conditional sentences consist of two halves: a clause containing a condition (Arabic الشَّرْطُ *al-shart*), and a main clause, which is a response (Arabic الْجَوَابُ *al-jawāb*) to the condition. In many grammars terminology going back to ancient Greek is used: the *shart* is called the *protasis* and the *jawāb* the *apodosis*.

The general rules for conditionals worked out by the Arab grammarians apply by and large to the Qur'ān; but they do focus on a somewhat later period when the pattern of tense usage was slightly different. Also the words meaning 'if' are used in a slightly more distinctive way in the Qur'ān.

The explanations that follow are aimed at helping the reader to understand the numerous conditionals that occur in the Qur'ān. As should be expected from what has been said above, they do not cover some conditional expressions that occur in later Arabic, and thus these explanations do not provide the reader with the complete framework needed to cover medieval and modern Arabic.

As Arabic has a simple tense system, it cannot operate as many languages do and express shades of conditional meaning by using a wide range of tenses. However, this is not a problem, as many of the shades of meaning are expressed by the use of three words for 'if': *law*, *in* and *idhā*:

1. *law* indicates that the conditional proposition (whether positive or negative) has not happened or will not happen: an unreal or hypothetical condition. It can be translated into English as 'if [he] had [done]', 'if [he] were to [do]', or, 'had [he done]', 'were [he] to [do]'.
2. *in* indicates that the conditional proposition is expected to happen or has happened: a future or past real condition.

3. *idhā*, which has been partly dealt with in Lesson 21, indicates that the proposition has happened or is felt certain to happen. In the Qur'ān the original sense of 'when' applies, but conditional force is indicated both by the tense usage and by the use of *fa-* to introduce the *jawāb* [see B below].

The differentiation between *in* and *idhā* is a feature of early Arabic that has been steadily eroded with the passing of time. In modern Arabic it scarcely exists. However, the clear differentiation of all three particles is crucial to conditional expressions in the Qur'ān, as the Qur'ān does not make full use of the full range of tenses allowable under the general rules for conditional sentences.

These rules are that the Arabic perfect or jussive are the equivalent of the English present or future and the Arabic pluperfect represents the English past. This is not so in the Qur'ān, as the pluperfect occurs only a handful of times. It is also the case that tense usage varies somewhat with each of the three particles, and a separate explanation for each is required.

There are two other rules that should be known before the Qur'ānic conditionals are examined in detail:

1. If the *shart* is a negative proposition, the negative is normally expressed by *lam* with the jussive [but see C 1b]. This is in contrast to the *jawāb*, in which a range of negatives appropriate to the accompanying tense is used.
2. With *in* and *idhā* the particle *fa-* is used to introduce the *jawāb* if a perfect or a jussive verb is not the first element in the *jawāb* [see B below]. This rule does not apply fully in the Qur'ān.

A. THE USE OF لَوْ *law*

1. a) The *shart* is most frequently expressed by *law* with the perfect, though *law anna* (with an accusative) and *law* with the imperfect are also found. There is no example of *law* followed by the jussive.

b) Unlike its use in other Arabic, *law* is not used with a negative proposition, i.e. there is no example of *law lam*.

Negative propositions are expressed by *law-lā an/anna*.^A

2. If the *jawāb* to *law* begins with a verb, it will be a perfect, most frequently introduced by *la-*. However, *la-* is not used if the perfect is preceded by the negative *mā*.

3. It is uncommon for the *sharṭ* to follow the *jawāb*, unless the *sharṭ* is used to round off a verse with assonance in *-ūn*, as in:

إِنَّ أَوْهَنَ الْبُيُوتِ لَبَيْتُ الْعَنْكَبُوتِ لَوْ كَانُوا يَعْلَمُونَ [29:41]

the most fragile house is that of the spider, did they know [it]

4. The use of *wa-law* as the final clause of a sentence (normally coinciding with the end of a verse) needs special notice. It means 'if only' or 'even if' or 'although'. Note that *wa-law* is the only way in which 'although' is expressed in the Qur'ān—*wa-in* is not used in this way—and in this sense the clause may well not be hypothetical:

وَمَا أَنْتَ بِمُؤْمِنٍ لَّنَا وَلَوْ كُنَّا صَادِقِينَ [12:17]

you will not believe us although we are telling the truth

Examples of the use of *law*

لَوْ شَاءَ رَبُّكَ لَجَعَلَ النَّاسَ أُمَّةً وَاحِدَةً [11:118]

had your Lord wished, He would have made men one community

لَوْ أَطَاعُونَا مَا قُتِلُوا [3:168]

had they obeyed us, they would not have been killed

لَوْ نَشَاءُ لَأَرَيْنَاكَهُمْ [47:30]

if we wished, we would show them to you

^A For *law-lā* meaning either 'why not' or 'but for' see Lesson 37.

لَوْ أَنَّ اللَّهَ هَدَانِي لَكُنْتُ مِنَ الْمُتَّقِينَ [39:57]

if only God had guided me, I should have been one of those who protected themselves

لَوْلَا أَنَّهُ كَانَ مِنَ الْمُسَبِّحِينَ لَلَبِثَ فِي بَطْنِهِ [37:143-4]

had he not been one of those who glorify God, he would have lingered in its belly

مَاذَا عَلَيْهِمْ لَوْ آمَنُوا بِاللَّهِ [4:39]

what harm would it do them if they were to believe in God?

لَا يَسْتَوِي الْخَبِيثُ وَالطَّيِّبُ وَلَوْ أَعْجَبَكَ كَثْرَةُ الْخَبِيثِ [5:100]

evil and good are not equal, though the abundance of the evil may amaze you

إِنْ حِسَابُهُمْ إِلَّا عَلَىٰ رَبِّي لَوْ تَشْعُرُونَ [26:113]

their account rests only with my Lord, if you did but know it

B. THE USE OF *fa-* IN REAL CONDITIONS

Before dealing with *in* and *idhā* in detail, it is necessary to look more fully at the way *fa-* is used in conditionals introduced by either of these words. As already mentioned, *fa-* is normally used to introduce the *jawāb* if a conditional verb (i.e. a perfect or a jussive) is not used to start the *jawāb*. Most grammars do not state this rule explicitly. They simply list the non-standard *jawābs* [NSJs]: those beginning with an imperfect, an imperative, an indirect command, an interrogative, a negative or any other particle (*qad*, *inna*, etc.).

There are sentences in the Qur'ān that do not obey this rule and lack the *fa-*:

إِنْ يَرَوْا كَلَّ آيَةٍ لَا يُؤْمِنُوا بِهَا [6:25]

if they see a sign, they do not believe in it

إِذَا تُلِيَتْ عَلَيْهِمْ آيَاتُنَا بَيِّنَاتٍ مَا كَانَ مُحْجَتُهُمْ إِلَّا أَنْ قَالُوا [45:25]

when Our signs are recited to them as clear proof their only argument is to say . . .

However, such sentences are rare and they do not follow any pattern. More rarely *fa-* appears at the beginning of the *jawāb* when one would not expect it:

إِذَا نَزَلَ بِسَاحَتِهِمْ فَسَاءَ صَبَاحُ الْمُنْذَرِينَ [37:177]

when it descends into their courtyard, how terrible
will be the morning of those who have been
warned

There are a few examples where *fa-* is found, though the *jawāb* begins with a with a normal conditional perfect verb, to indicate that the perfect tense has a past meaning, despite the conditional structure. The clearest examples of this are in *sūra* 12:26 and 27.

C. THE USE OF *إِنْ in*

1. a) In the *shart* the verb may be either a perfect or a jussive.
There is also a handful of occurrences of the pluperfect.
b) A negative condition is expressed by *in lam* or, very rarely, by *illā*. Both are followed by the jussive.
2. In the *jawāb* the jussive is much more commonly used than the perfect. In fact, the four most common types of NSJ (imperatives, nominal sentences, negatives and *inna*) are all more common than the perfect.
3. The only common negative in the *jawāb* is *lā*. Otherwise there are three occurrences of *mā* and two of *lan*. Note that with conditionals introduced by *in* there is no example of *lam* being used in the *jawāb*.
4. Reversed sentences, i.e. where the *shart* forms the second half of the sentence, are relatively frequent with *in*.
5. Even more frequent are the reversed conditionals in which the *shart* introduced by *in* rounds off a verse in assonance with *-īn, ūn*:

مَتَى هَذَا الْوَعْدُ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ صَادِقِينَ [36:48]

when is this promise, if you are telling the truth?

Examples of the use of *in*

إِنْ كَانَ مِثْقَالَ حَبَّةٍ مِنْ خَرْدَلٍ أَتَيْنَا بِهَا [21:47]

If it is the weight of a grain of mustard-seed, We will bring it.

إِنْ قِيلَ لَكُمْ آزِجُوا فَآزِجُوا [24:28]

if you are told, 'return', return

إِنْ أَغْرَضُوا فَمَا أَرْسَلْنَاكَ عَلَيْهِمْ حَفِيظًا [42:48]

if they turn away, We have not sent you to be a guardian over them

إِنْ تَوَلَّوْا فَإِنِّي أَخَافُ عَلَيْكُمْ عَذَابَ يَوْمٍ كَبِيرٍ [11:3]

if you turn your backs, I fear for you the punishment of a great day

إِنْ نَشَأْ نُنْزِلْ عَلَيْهِمْ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ آيَةً [26:4]

if We wish, We can send down a sign from the sky to them

إِنْ لَمْ تَجِدُوا فِيهَا أَحَدًا فَلَا تَدْخُلُوهَا [24:28]

if you find no one inside, still do not enter it

إِنْ يُكَذِّبُوكَ فَقَدْ كَذَّبَتْ قَبْلَهُمْ قَوْمُ نُوحٍ [22:42]

If they deny the truth of your message, so too did the people of Nūh before them

إِنْ يَنْصُرْكُمُ اللَّهُ فَلَا غَالِبَ لَكُمْ [3:160]

if God helps you, none can overcome you

إِنْ يَسْلُبْهُمُ الذَّبَابُ شَيْئًا لَا يَسْتَنْقِذُوهُ مِنْهُ [22:73]

if a fly robs them of anything, they will not rescue it from it

إِلَّا تَصْرِفَ عَنِّي كَيْدَهُنَّ أَصْبُ إِلَيْهِنَّ [12:33]

if you do not turn their wiles from me, I shall incline to them in youthful folly

D. THE USE OF إِذَا *idhā*

1. (a) In the *sharṭ* the perfect predominates, though there are a dozen or so occurrences of the imperfect.
 (b) There is a single occurrence of *idhā lam* and the jussive.
2. If the *jawāb* begins with a verb, the perfect predominates, though there are some examples of the imperfect.
3. Most of the examples of a negative *jawāb* involve *lā*, but two examples begin with the negative *in* (with no *fa-*) and one with *fa-laysa*. Unlike conditionals introduced by *in*, there is a handful of examples of *lam* (without *fa-*) in the *jawāb* of a sentence introduced by *idhā*.
4. Reversed sentences, i.e. where the *sharṭ* forms the second half of the sentence, are relatively frequent with *idhā*. However, *idhā* is not used in reversed conditionals to provide assonance at the end of a verse, in marked contrast to *in*. It should be noted that in the majority of occurrences *idhā* is almost always best translated as 'when'. However, the information given above and the fact that it conforms to conditional tense usage indicate that *idhā* is a genuine conditional particle.

Examples of the use of *idhā*

إِذَا ذُكِرَ اللَّهُ وَجِلَتْ قُلُوبُهُمْ [22:35]

their hearts are filled with awe when God is mentioned

إِذَا جَاءَ الْخَوْفُ رَأَيْتَهُمْ يَنْظُرُونَ إِلَيْكَ [33:19]

when fear comes, you see them looking at you

إِذَا قَرَأْنَاهُ فَاتَّبِعْ قُرْآنَهُ [75:18]

when we recite it, follow its recitation

إِذَا أَرَادَ اللَّهُ بِقَوْمٍ سُوءًا فَلَا مَرَدَّ لَهُ [13:11]

when God wills ill on a people, there is no turning it back

إِذَا جَاءَهُ لَمْ يَجِدْهُ شَيْئًا [24:39]

when he gets to it he finds it to be nothing

إِذَا مَا غَضِبُوا هُمْ يَغْفِرُونَ [42:37]

they forgive when they are angry

E. لَئِنْ *la-in*

There are close on sixty examples in the Qur'ān where *in* is preceded by the particle *la-*, indicating that the *jawāb* will be an oath or a strong statement. Most of these have a *jawāb* beginning with *la-*, usually with the Energetic, but occasionally without it. In a few cases the *jawāb* begins with *inna... la-*, or with *idhan*, or with a negative. For examples see Lesson 39, which deals with the Energetic.

F. إِمَّا *immā*

Immā (but not *immā... wa-immā*, which means 'whether...or') appears always to mean 'if', though some of the commentators dispute this. It is always followed by the Energetic, and the *jawāb* then being introduced by *fa-* (without a conditional verb). For examples see Lesson 39.

G. IMPERATIVE *shart*, JUSSIVE *jawāb*

A further form of conditional, in which the *shart* is introduced by an imperative and the *jawāb* by a jussive, is reasonably prominent in the Qur'ān:

أَوْفُوا بِعَهْدِي أُوفِ بِعَهْدِكُمْ [2:40]

fulfil [your] covenant with me and I will fulfil [my]
covenant with you

الْقُوَّةَ عَلَى وَجْهِ أَبِي يَأْتِ بَصِيرًا [12:93]

throw it over my father's face, and he will see again

ذُرُونَا نَتَّبِعْكُمْ [48:15]

let us follow you

This is normally the construction used with the imperative of *yadharu*.

H. QUASI-CONDITIONALS

There are a number of words that have the force of a conditional particle when they have a general sense, in which case they are followed by conditional sentence structures. You have already become familiar with the two most important words: *مَنْ* *man* (Lesson 17) and *مَا* *mā* (Lesson 10). When *man* and *mā* mean 'whoever' and 'whatever' respectively, and they appear at the beginning of a sentence, conditional tenses come into play.

Other words used in the Qur'ān in this way are *أَيْنَ* *annā*, 'wherever', *أَيْنَمَا* *aynamā*, 'wherever', *حَيْثُ* *haythu* and *حَيْثُمَا* *haythumā*, 'wherever', *مَهْمَا* *mahmā*, 'whatever', *كُلَّمَا* *kullamā*, 'whenever', and *أَيُّمَا* *ayyumā* (which declines), 'whichever'. All are rare.

Examples of quasi-conditionals

مَنْ يَشَاءِ اللَّهُ يُضِلَّهُ [6:39]

God sends astray those whom He wishes

كُلَّمَا أَوْقَدُوا نَارًا لِلْحَرْبِ أَطْفَأَهَا اللَّهُ [5:64]

whenever they light a fire for war, God will extinguish it

أَيُّمَا آلَاجَلَيْنِ قَضَيْتُ فَلَا عُدْوَانَ عَلَيَّ [28:28]

whichever of the two terms I fulfil, it will be no injustice to me

مَهْمَا تَأْتِنَا بِهِ مِنْ آيَةٍ ... فَمَا نَخْشُ لَكَ بِمُؤْمِنِينَ [7:132]

whatever sign you bring us... we will not put our faith in you

كُلُوا مِنْهَا حَيْثُ شِئْتُمْ [7:161]

eat of it wherever you will

حَيْثُمَا كُنْتُمْ فَوَلُّوا وُجُوهَكُمْ شَطْرَهُ [2:144]

wherever you may be, turn your faces towards it

فَاتُوا حَزَنَكُمْ أَنَّى شِئْتُمْ [2:223]

go to your tillage however you wish

أَيْنَمَا تَكُونُوا يُدْرِكُكُمُ الْمَوْتُ [4:78]

wherever you are, death will overtake you

I. THE USE OF رَأَى *ra'ā* IN CONDITIONAL SENTENCES

The verb *ra'ā* is used in two completely different, highly idiomatic ways in conditional sentences. The first is its use in the imperfect after *law* to mean 'if only':

لَوْ تَرَىٰ إِذْ وَقَفُوا عَلَىٰ رَبِّهِمْ [6:30]

if you could see [them] when they are set before their Lord

The second is when the second person of the perfect follows the interrogative *a-* and precedes *in*:

أَرَأَيْتُمْ إِنْ أَخَذَ اللَّهُ سَمْعَكُمْ وَأَبْصَارَكُمْ [6:46]

have you considered [what will happen] if God takes away your hearing and your sight?

In such sentences *a-ra'aytum in/a-ra'ayta in* translates most convincingly as 'have you considered the position if', or 'what will happen if'.

VOCABULARY THIRTY-SIX

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
رَتَعَ	يَرْتَعُ	رَتْعٌ	to enjoy oneself
سَعَى	يَسْعَى	سَعْيٌ	to strive, move, run
سَلَبَ	يَسْلُبُ	سَلْبٌ	to rob
لَعِبَ	يَلْعَبُ	لَعِبٌ	to play
نَهَى	يَنْهَى	نَهْيٌ	to forbid
هَزَّ	يَهْزُ	هَزٌّ	to shake

Lesson Thirty-Six

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
وَجَلَ	يُوجَلُ		to be in awe of
كَفَّرَ ²	يُكْفَرُ	تَكْفِيرٌ	to forgive, redeem
سَاقَطَ ³	يُسَاقِطُ	مُسَاقَاةٌ	to cause to fall, bring down
ضَاعَفَ ³	يُضَاعِفُ	مُضَاعَفَةٌ	to multiply
أَنكَرَ ⁴	يُنْكِرُ	إِنْكَارٌ	to deny, disapprove; not to know
أَذْرَكَ ⁴	يُذْرِكُ	إِذْرَاكٌ	to overtake
أَعَادَ ⁴	يُعِيدُ	إِعَادَةٌ	to repeat, return (trans.)
أَسَاءَ ⁴	يُسِيءُ	إِسَاءَةٌ	to do wrong
تَزَكَّى ⁵	يَتَزَكَّى	تَزَكٍّ	to be purified
الْتَقَطَ ⁸	يَلْتَقِطُ	الْتِقَاطٌ	to pick up
اسْتَأْخَرَ ¹⁰	يَسْتَأْخِرُ	اسْتِئْخَارٌ	to postpone
اسْتَقْدَمَ ¹⁰	يَسْتَقْدِمُ	اسْتِقْدَامٌ	to bring forward
اسْتَنْقَذَ ¹⁰	يَسْتَنْقِذُ	اسْتِنْقَاذٌ	to rescue

SINGULAR PLURAL

جُبٌّ	pit, well
جِذْعٌ	trunk of a palm-tree
مَدْخَلٌ	place to enter
ذُبَابٌ	fly
أَذْقَانٌ	chins

SINGULAR PLURAL

مَرَدٌّ		turning back
رُطَبٌ		fresh, ripe dates
صَرِيحٌ		help
مَغَارَةٌ		cave
غِيَابَةٌ	s.p.	bottom; recess
كَبِيرَةٌ	كِبَائِرُ	enormity
شَطْرٌ		towards

EXERCISE THIRTY-SIX

1. [2:23] **إِنْ كُنْتُمْ فِي رَيْبٍ مِّمَّا نَزَّلْنَا عَلَىٰ عَبْدِنَا فَأْتُوا بِسُورَةٍ مِّنْ مِّثْلِهِ**
2. [3:75] **إِنْ تَأْمَنُوا بَدِينَارٍ لَا يُوَدِّهِ إِلَيْكَ**
3. [3:184] **إِنْ كَذَّبُوكَ فَقَدْ كُذِّبَ رُسُلٌ مِّن قَبْلِكَ**
4. [4:31] **إِنْ تَحْتَبِئُوا كِبَائِرَ مَا تُهَوِّنُ عَنْهُ نُكْفِّرْ عَنْكُمْ سَيِّئَاتِكُمْ**
5. [5:42] **وَإِنْ تُغْرِضْ عَنْهُمْ فَلَنْ يَصْرِوْكَ شَيْئًا**
6. [22:68] **إِنْ جَادَلُوكَ فَقُلِ اللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ بِمَا تَعْمَلُونَ**
7. [23:107] **إِنْ عُدْنَا فَنَا ظَالِمُونَ**
8. [36:43] **إِنْ نَشَأْ نُغْرِقْهُمْ**
9. [12:10] **الْقُوَّةُ فِي غِيَابَاتِ الْحُبِّ يَلْتَقِظُهُ بَعْضُ السَّيَّارَةِ**
10. [19:25] **هَزِّي إِلَيْكَ بِجِذْعِ النَّخْلَةِ تُسَاقِطُ عَلَيْكَ رُطْبًا**
11. [12:12] **أَرْسَلَهُ مَعَنَا غَدًا يَزْتَعُ وَيَلْعَبُ**

12. ذُرُوهَا تَأْكُلُ فِي أَرْضِ اللَّهِ [7:73]
13. ذَلِكُمْ خَيْرٌ لَّكُمْ إِن كُنتُمْ تَعْلَمُونَ [61:111]
14. هَاتُوا بُرْهَانَكُمْ إِن كُنتُمْ صَادِقِينَ [2:111]
15. إِذَا تَوَلَّى سَعَى فِي الْأَرْضِ لِيُفْسِدَ فِيهَا [2:205]
16. إِذَا قَضَيْتُمُ الصَّلَاةَ فَادْكُرُوا اللَّهَ قِيَامًا وَقُعُودًا [4:103]
17. إِذَا جَاءَ أَجْلُهُمْ لَا يَسْتَأْخِرُونَ سَاعَةً وَلَا يَسْتَقْدِمُونَ [16:61]
18. إِذَا يُتْلَى عَلَيْهِمْ يَخِرُّونَ لِلْأَذْقَانِ سُجَّدًا [17:107]
19. وَلَوْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ لَذَهَبَ بِسَمْعِهِمْ [2:20]
20. لَوْ يَحْجِدُونَ مَلَجًا أَوْ مَغَارَاتٍ أَوْ مُدْخَلًا لَوَلَّوْا إِلَيْهِ [9:57]
21. إِن لَّبِثْتُمْ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا لَوْ أَنَّكُمْ كُنتُمْ تَعْلَمُونَ [23:114]
22. لَوْ كَانُوا عِنْدَنَا مَا مَاتُوا وَمَا قُتِلُوا [3:156]
23. أَيَّ آيَاتِ اللَّهِ تُنْكِرُونَ [40:81]
24. هُوَ مَعَهُمْ أَيْنَمَا كَانُوا [58:7]
25. كُلَّمَا أَرَادُوا أَنْ يَخْرُجُوا مِنْهَا أُعِيدُوا فِيهَا [32:20]
26. مَنْ عَمِلَ صَالِحًا فَلِنَفْسِهِ وَمَنْ أَسَاءَ فَعَلَيْهَا [41:46]
27. لَوْ تَرَى إِذِ الظَّالِمُونَ فِي غَمَرَاتِ الْمَوْتِ [6:93]
28. أَرَأَيْتُمْ إِن كَانَ مِنْ عِنْدِ اللَّهِ وَكَفَرْتُمْ بِهِ [46:10]
29. قَدْ أَفْلَحَ مَنْ تَزَكَّى [87:14]
30. إِن تَكُ حَسَنَةً يُضَاعِفْهَا [4:40]

Lesson Thirty-Seven

More about *an*; ‘*asa* and *la‘alla*

أَنَّ *an*

The most important use of *an*, as a conjunction meaning ‘that’, was dealt with in Lesson 18. However, there are half a dozen other uses of *an* in the Qur’ān that did not survive as important features in later Arabic, although occasional examples are to be found. It is usually possible to see how they developed from the central use of *an*. Three of these further uses are important enough to need explanation here.

1. The most common of these uses is known by the Arab grammarians as *an il-mufasssira*, the *an* that introduces direct speech. There are over fifty examples of it in the Qur’ān. The function of *an il-mufasssira* is to introduce direct speech after a verb other than *qāla* (though in 5:117 it is used after *qāla* itself). A dozen verbs, all with the general sense of ‘conveying a message’ are involved, the most common being *أَوْحَى* *awḥā* ‘to inspire’ and *نَادَى* *nādā* ‘to call out.’ The *an* is normally followed by an imperative or the equivalent of an imperative (a prohibition, wish, salutation or a vocative). Other constructions are unusual.

نَادَيْنَاهُ أَنْ يَا إِبْرَاهِيمُ [37:104]

We called out to him, ‘O Ibrāhīm’

أَوْحَيْنَا إِلَىٰ مُوسَىٰ أَنْ أَلْقِ عَصَاكَ [7:117]

We inspired Mūsā, saying, ‘Throw your staff.’

أَرْسَلْنَا نُوحًا إِلَىٰ قَوْمِهِ أَنْ أَنْذِرْ قَوْمَكَ [71:1]

We sent Nūḥ to his people, saying ‘Warn your people.’

2. Secondly, *an* may mean ‘because’. This is the least common of the three usages explained here. It would appear that it is used where *bi-an* (or *bi-anna* and the accusative) might normally have been expected; though in at least one verse [49:17] the difference between ‘that’ and ‘because’ is small and might indicate another way in which the usage developed. Clear examples are the second *an* in 26:51:

نَظْمَعُ أَنْ يَغْفِرَ لَنَا رَبُّنَا خَطَايَانَا أَنْ كُنَّا أَوَّلَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ

we earnestly hope that our Lord will forgive us our sins because we were the first of the believers

and the second *an* in 29:2:

أَحْسِبَ النَّاسُ أَنْ يُتْرَكُوا أَنْ يَقُولُوا آمَنَّا

do the people think that they will be left alone because they say, ‘We believe’?

See also 40:28:

أَتَقْتُلُونَ رَجُلًا أَنْ يَقُولَ رَبِّيَ اللَّهُ

would you kill a man because he says, ‘My Lord is God’?

3. Thirdly, there are over thirty examples when *an* is best understood as *allā* or *li-allā* ‘that not’. There is some uncertainty about the basis of this usage, and some grammarians look to the ellipse of *makhāfata*, with *an* standing for *makhāfata an* ‘for fear that’ i.e. ‘lest’. This is quite clearly so in 4:6, where there cannot be any other meaning:

لَا تَأْكُلُوهَا إِسْرَافًا وَبِدَارًا أَنْ يَكْبَرُوا

do not devour it in squandering and in haste lest they grow up (for fear that they will grow up)

With a number of other examples, e.g. after the verb *amina*, one can understand the verse by assuming that a preposition

(in this case *min*) has been omitted. However there is a basic core of examples that can only be understood by taking *an* in the sense of *allā* or *li-allā*:

جَعَلْنَا عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ أَكِنَّةً أَنْ يَفْقَهُوهُ [6:25]

we have placed veils on their hearts so that they do not understand it

لَا يَأْتِلْ أُولُو الْفَضْلِ مِنْكُمْ وَالسَّعَةِ أَنْ يُؤْتُوا أُولِيَ الْقُرْبَى [24:22]

let not those of you who possess bounty and abundance swear that they will not give to relations

My own explanation is that from time to time negatives that one would expect to appear in the text simply do not do so, possibly due to some Hijāzī influence. There are also examples of this construction in seventh century poetry, but it soon dropped out of use.

عَسَى 'asā

The most common way of expressing 'perhaps', 'it may be that' in the Qur'ān is by use of 'asā, a verb that occurs only in the perfect, with a following *an* clause. 'Asā can be used either personally or impersonally. Eventually Arabic came to prefer the impersonal verb, but in the Qur'ān, as elsewhere in early Arabic, the personal form is more common. In only two examples does it conjugate ('asaytum, 2:246 and 47:22), but in most cases the verb is followed by a subject:

عَسَى اللَّهُ أَنْ يَغْفُو عَنْهُمْ [4:99]

it may be that God will pardon them

عَسَى رَبُّكُمْ أَنْ يُهْلِكَ عَدُوَّكُمْ [7:129]

perhaps your Lord will destroy your enemy

عَسَى رَبَّنَا أَنْ يُبَدِّلَنَا خَيْرًا مِنْهَا [68:32]

perhaps our Lord will give us better than this in its place

عَسَى أَنْ تَكْرَهُوا شَيْئًا [4:19]

perhaps you dislike a thing

لَعَلَّ *la'alla*

In later Arabic *la'alla*, which is a fossilized verb with the construction of *inna*, means 'perhaps'. However, in early Arabic *la'alla* had two meanings: 'perhaps' and 'so that'. If it occurs near the end of the verse you can expect it to mean 'so that'. This covers over ninety percent of the instances where it appears. If it occurs elsewhere in the sentence, particularly at the beginning, it is likely to mean 'perhaps'.

The translation 'that haply', often used in translations of the Qur'ān, goes back to ingenious efforts by some Arab grammarians and commentators to combine the meaning 'perhaps', with which they were perfectly familiar, with 'so that', which was obsolete by the time they wrote. From time to time they would grasp the nettle and acknowledge that *la'alla* means 'so that', but more often they were reluctant to abandon the meaning they knew best.

The frequent usage of *la'alla* in the sense of 'so that' is because *la'alla* + a 3 m.p. or 2 m.p. suffix allows a verb ending in *-ūn(a)* to complete the verse and thus maintain the appropriate assonance. This is most clearly shown in verses where *li-* plus the subjunctive is followed by *wa-la'alla* + a suffix + an imperfect verb.

Examples of 'so that'

فَاجْتَنِبُوهُ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُفْلِحُونَ [5:90]

avoid it, so that you may prosper

جَعَلَ لَكُمْ فِيهَا سُبُلًا لَعَلَّكُمْ تَهْتَدُونَ [43:10]

He has put roads in it for you, that you may find the right way

لِيُنذِرَكُمْ وَلِتَتَّقُوا وَلَعَلَّكُمْ تُرْحَمُونَ [7:63]

that he may warn you and that you may protect yourselves and that you may be given mercy

Examples of 'perhaps'

لَعَلَّه فِتْنَةٌ لَكُمْ وَمَتَاعٌ إِلَىٰ حِينٍ [21:111]

perhaps it is a trial for you, with enjoyment for a time

لَعَلَّ السَّاعَةَ تَكُونُ قَرِيبًا [33:63]

perhaps the hour is something near

When the 1 s. pronominal suffix is attached to *la'alla*, the resulting form is *la'all-i*:

لَعَلِّي أَزْجِعُ إِلَىٰ النَّاسِ [12:46] so that I may return to the people

VOCABULARY THIRTY-SEVEN

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
عَبَسَ	يَغْبُسُ		to frown
عَفَا	يَغْفُو	عَفْوٌ	to pardon (+ <i>'an</i>)
عَادَ	يَعُودُ	مَعَادٌ	to return; do again
عَاذَ	يَعُوذُ		to seek refuge with
غَدَا	يَغْدُو	غَدُوٌّ	to be/do in the morning
كَبَرَ	يَكْبُرُ	كِبَرٌ	to grow up
كَرِهَ	يَكْرَهُ	كَرَاهَةٌ	to be reluctant, hate
مَادَ	يَمِيدُ		to shake
بَيَّنَّ 2	يُبَيِّنُ	تَبْيَانٌ	to make clear
أَسْرَفَ 4	يُسْرِفُ	إِسْرَافٌ	to be prodigal
أَمْسَكَ 4	يُمْسِكُ	إِمْسَاكٌ	to hold fast, withhold
تَفَكَّرَ 5	يَتَفَكَّرُ	تَفَكُّرٌ	to think, reflect

Lesson Thirty-Seven

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
تَنَادَى ⁶	يَتَنَادَى	تَنَادٍ	to call to one another
إِيتَلَى ⁸	يَأْتَلِي	إِيتِلَاءٌ	to swear
اجْتَنَبَ ⁸	يَجْتَنِبُ	اجْتِنَابٌ	to avoid

SINGULAR PLURAL

حَلَّافٌ		accustomed to swear
بِدَارٌ		haste, anticipation
حَزْثٌ		tillage
رُؤْيَا (f.)		dream
	رَوَاسٍ	firm mountains
كِنَانٌ	أَكِنَّةٌ	coverings
نَحْلٌ		bees
هَدْدٌ		crash, destruction
أَعْمَى	عُمَى	blind
شَقِيٌّ	أَشْقِيَاءُ	unfortunate, wretched
مَهِينٌ		contemptible

Idioms	أُولُو الْقُرْبَى	relations
	ضَرَبَ الذُّكْرَ صَفْحًا عَن	to neglect

EXERCISE THIRTY-SEVEN

1. وَأَحْذَرُهُمْ أَنْ يَفْتِنُوكَ عَنْ بَغْضِ مَا أَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ إِلَيْكَ [5:49]
2. يَعِظُكُمُ اللَّهُ أَنْ تَعُودُوا لِمِثْلِهِ أَبَدًا [24:17]
3. أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ أَنْ أَكُونَ مِنَ الْجَاهِلِينَ [2:67]
4. أَلْقَى فِي الْأَرْضِ رَوَاسِيَ أَنْ تَمِيدَ بِكُمْ [16:15]
5. بِمَنْسِكَ السَّمَاءِ أَنْ تَقَعَ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ [22:65]
6. أَفَأَمِنْ أَهْلُ الْقُرَى أَنْ يَأْتِيَهُمْ بَأْسُنَا [7:97]
7. إِنَّا أَرْسَلْنَا نُوحًا إِلَى قَوْمِهِ أَنْ أَنْذِرْ قَوْمَكَ مِنْ قَبْلِ أَنْ يَأْتِيَهُمْ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ [71:1]
8. أَوْحَيْنَا إِلَى مُوسَى أَنْ أَضْرِبْ بِعَصَاكَ الْبَحْرَ [26:63]
9. أَوْحَى رَبُّكَ إِلَى النَّحْلِ أَنْ اتَّخِذِي مِنَ الْجِبَالِ بُيُوتًا [16:68]
10. نَادَيْنَاهُ أَنْ يَا إِبْرَاهِيمُ قَدْ صَدَّقْتَ الرُّؤْيَا [37:104-5]
11. تَنَادَوْا مُصْبِحِينَ أَنْ أَعْدُوا عَلَى حَزْبِكُمْ [68:21-2]
12. أَنْزَلَتْ سُورَةً أَنْ آمِنُوا بِاللَّهِ وَجَاهِدُوا مَعَ رَسُولِهِ [9:86]
13. آخِرُ دَعْوَاهُمْ أَنْ الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ [10:10]
14. عَبَسَ وَتَوَلَّى أَنْ جَاءَهُ الْأَعْمَى [80:1-2]
15. أَفَنَضْرِبُ عَنْكُمُ الذِّكْرَ صَفْحًا أَنْ كُنْتُمْ قَوْمًا مُسْرِفِينَ [43:5]
16. لَا تُطِيعُ كُلَّ حَلَافٍ مِثْنٍ ... أَنْ كَانَ ذَا مَالٍ وَبَنِينَ [68:10, 14]
17. تَخِزُ الْجِبَالَ هَدًّا أَنْ دَعَا لِلرَّحْمَانِ وَلَدًا [19:90-1]
18. ذَلِكَ أَنْ لَمْ يَكْ رَبُّكَ مُهْلِكَ الْقُرَى بِظُلْمٍ [6:131]

Exercise Thirty-Seven

19. فَلَعَلَّكَ تَارِكٌ بَعْضُ مَا يُوحَىٰ إِلَيْكَ ... أَنْ يَقُولُوا [11:12]
20. يُرِيكُمْ آيَاتِهِ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَعْقِلُونَ [2:73]
21. جَاهِدُوا فِي سَبِيلِهِ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُفْلِحُونَ [5:35]
22. أَنْزَلْنَا إِلَيْكَ الْذِّكْرَ لِتُبَيِّنَ لِلنَّاسِ مَا نُزِّلَ إِلَيْهِمْ [16:44]
وَلَعَلَّهُمْ يَتَفَكَّرُونَ
23. إِنَّا جَعَلْنَاهُ قُرْآنًا عَرَبِيًّا لَعَلَّكُمْ تَعْقِلُونَ [43:3]
24. عَسَىٰ أَنْ تُحِبُّوا شَيْئًا وَهُوَ شَرٌّ لَكُمْ [2:216]
25. عَسَىٰ رَبُّكُمْ أَنْ يُهْلِكَ عَدُوَّكُمْ [7:129]
26. عَسَىٰ اللَّهُ أَنْ يَأْتِيَنِي بِهِمْ جَمِيعًا [12:83]
27. عَسَىٰ أَلَّا أَكُونَ بِدُعَاءِ رَبِّي شَقِيًّا [19:48]

Lesson Thirty-Eight

Special verbs; *law-lā*

SPECIAL VERBS

THE 'SISTERS OF *kāna*'

Arabic has over twenty verbs that behave similarly to *kāna*. They are known as 'the sisters of *kāna*'. Over half of them occur in the Qur'ān, but only five: لَيْسَ *laysa*, مَا زَالَ *mā zāla*, ظَلَّ *ẓalla*, مَا دَامَ *mā dāma*, and أَصْبَحَ *aṣbaḥa* are important.

The verb that is closest to *kāna* in meaning is *laysa*; but, as was set out in Lesson 21, the two verbs are not particularly close in construction, because of the common use of *bi-* to introduce the predicate after *laysa*.

The characteristic of the other four verbs is that they take the same construction as *kāna*, i.e. an accusative predicate or an imperfect verb, though they differ markedly in meaning.

مَا زَالَ *mā zāla*

مَا زَالَ *mā zāla*, imperfect لَا يَزَالُ *lā yazālu* or مَا يَزَالُ *mā yazālu*, means 'not to cease', i.e. 'to continue':

مَا زِلْتُمْ فِي شَكٍّ [40:34]

you continued to be in doubt

لَا يَزَالُونَ يُقَاتِلُونَكُمْ [2:217]

they will continue to fight you

لَا يَزَالُونَ مُخْتَلِفِينَ [11:118]

they continue to differ

ظَلَّ *ẓalla*

Uniquely, ظَلَّ *ẓalla*, ‘to continue’, contracted from *ẓalila*, is found from time to time with only one *lām*. Two of these shorter forms occur in the Qur’ān: ظَلَّتْ *ẓalta* [20:97] and ظَلْتُمْ *ẓaltum* [56:65].

نَظَلُّ لَهَا عَاكِفِينَ [26:71] we remain devoted to them

أ ظَلْتُمْ تَفْكُهُونَ [56:65] you would continue to jest

مَا دَامَ *mā dāma*

With مَا دَامَ *mā dāma* the *mā* is not the negative that we find in *mā zāla* but a special use of *mā* that has not yet been introduced. It requires a perfect verb and means ‘as long as’. *mā dāma* basically means ‘as long as x remains’ or ‘as long as x is’, and these are the meanings you will find in the Qur’ān. Elsewhere, *mā dāma* may mean nothing more than ‘as long as’.

مَا دُمْتُ حَيًّا [19:31] as long as I remain alive

مَا دُمْتُ عَلَيْهِ قَائِمًا [3:75] as long as you stand over him

أَصْبَحَ *aṣbaḥa*

Aṣbaḥa means ‘to do in the morning’ or ‘to be in the morning’, as mentioned in Lesson 34. To translate the verb and the following phrase into English, one normally has to say ‘In the morning he. . .’ etc. The verb may also mean, simply, ‘to become’.

أَصْبَحُوا فِي دَارِهِمْ جَاثِمِينَ [7:91]

in the morning they were crouching in their dwellings

أَصْبَحُوا خَاسِرِينَ [5:53]

they became losers

^A On this form of the verb with *ta-* for *tata-* see Lesson 15.

Remember too the example quoted in the section on the *ḥāl* accusative:

أَصْبَحَ فِي الْمَدِينَةِ خَائِفًا يَتَرَقَّبُ [28:18]

In the morning he was in the city, afraid and vigilant

كَادَ *kāda*

The verb *kāda*, imperfect *yakādu*, is closely allied to 'the sisters of *kāna*'. In the positive it means 'almost', with the tense of *kāda* determining the tense of the following verb in English:

كَادُوا يَقْتُلُونَنِي [7:150] they almost killed me

تَكَادُ السَّمَاوَاتُ يَتَفَطَّرْنَ [42:5] the heavens are almost torn asunder

With a negative preceding it *kāda* means 'scarcely':

لَا يَكَادُونَ يَفْقَهُونَ قَوْلًا [18:93] they scarcely understand any speech

لَمْ يَكْذُ يَرَاهَا [24:40] he scarcely saw it

'VERBS OF BEGINNING'

A further set of verbs connected with those mentioned above is that known as 'the verbs of beginning'. These verbs are used in the perfect, followed by another verb in the imperfect. With this construction the verbs mean 'he began to...'. They fall into two groups:

a) those, such as *بَدَأَ bada'a*, *شَرَعَ shara'a* and *طَفِقَ ṭafiqā*, whose basic meaning is 'to begin'. Only one of these verbs occurs in the Qur'ān. It is *ṭafiqā*, which in general is not very common:

طَفِقَا يَخْصِفَانِ عَلَيْهِمَا مِنْ وَرَقِ الْجَنَّةِ [7:22]

the two of them began to cover themselves with the leaves of paradise

b) verbs, such as *أَخَذَ akhadha* and *جَعَلَ ja'ala*, whose basic meaning is not 'to begin' but something quite different. Again,

there is only one of these verbs that occurs in the Qur'ān. It is *aṣḥaḥa*, which has just been treated above:

أَصْبَحَ يُقَلِّبُ كَفَّيْهِ [18:42]

in the morning he began wringing his hands

لَوْلَا *law-lā*

law-lā, mentioned briefly in Lesson 36, functions in two ways:

1. it means 'why not?'. This is the more common usage in the Qur'ān, with *law-lā* being followed by a verb, sometimes with an intervening subordinate clause:

لَوْلَا أَنْزَلَ عَلَيْهِ آيَةً مِنْ رَبِّهِ [13:7]

why has not a sign from his Lord been sent down to him?

لَوْلَا جَاءُوا عَلَيْهِ بِأَرْبَعَةِ شُهَدَاءَ [24:13]

why did they not produce four witnesses against it?

لَوْلَا تَذَكَّرُونَ^A [56:62]

why are you not reminded?

2. *law-lā* also means 'but for'. In the Qur'ān this usage requires a nominative [whereas in later Arabic nouns are put in the nominative, but the suffixed forms of pronouns are used]:

لَوْلَا نِعْمَةُ رَبِّي [37:57]

but for the blessing of my Lord

لَوْلَا رِجَالٌ مُؤْمِنُونَ [48:25]

but for believing men

^A On this form of the verb with *ta-* for *tata-* see Lesson 15.

لَوْلَا أَنتُمْ [34:31]

but for you

لَوْلَا كَلِمَةٌ سَبَقَتْ مِنْ رَبِّكَ لَقُضِيَ بَيْنَهُمْ [41:45]

but for a word that had gone before from your Lord,
there would have been judgement between them

VOCABULARY THIRTY-EIGHT

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
فَقِهَ	يَفْقَهُ	فِقْهٌ	to understand
5 تَفَكَّهُ	يَتَفَكَّهُ	تَفَكُّهٌ	to jest
خَصَفَ	يَخْصِفُ		to cover oneself
خَطَفَ	يَخْطِفُ	خَطْفٌ	to snatch
عَرَجَ	يَعْرِجُ		to mount
2 قَلَّبَ	يُقَلِّبُ	تَقْلِيْبٌ	to turn over, wring
4 أَبَانَ	يُبَيِّنُ	إِبَانَةٌ	to make clear
4 أَضَاءَ	يُضِيءُ	إِضَاءَةٌ	to give light
5 تَرَقَّبَ	يَتَرَقَّبُ	تَرْقُبٌ	to be vigilant
8 إِظْلَعَ	يَظْلِعُ	إِظْلَاعٌ	to study

SINGULAR PLURAL

بَرْقٌ		lightning
زَيْتٌ		oil
شَكٌّ	شُكُوكٌ	doubt
(f.) كَفٌّ	أَكْفٌ	palm of the hand, hand

Exercise Thirty-Eight

SINGULAR

PLURAL

مِرْيَةٌ	doubt
حَيٌّ	أَحْيَاءُ
جَائِمٌ	alive
عَاكِفٌ	crouching
نَادِمٌ	devoted
مُحَضَّرٌ	repentant
مُسْوَدٌّ	brought forward
	black

EXERCISE THIRTY-EIGHT

1. لَا يَزَالُ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا فِي مِرْيَةٍ [22:55]
2. مَا زَالَتْ تِلْكَ دَعْوَاهُمْ [21:15]
3. لَا تَزَالُ تَطَّلِعُ [5:13]
4. ظَلَّ وَجْهُهُ مُسْوَدًّا [16:58]
5. فَظَلَّمْ تَفَكَّهُونَ [56:65]
6. ظَلُّوا فِيهِ يَغْرُجُونَ [15:14]
7. مَا دَامُوا فِيهَا [5:24]
8. مَا دُمْتُمْ حُرْمًا [5:96]
9. وَكُنْتُ عَلَيْهِمْ شَهِيدًا مَا دُمْتُ فِيهِمْ [5:117]
10. أَصْبَحُوا نَادِمِينَ [26:157]
11. أَصْبَحْتُمْ بِنِعْمَتِهِ إِخْوَانًا [3:103]
12. أَصْبَحْتُمْ مِنَ الْخَاسِرِينَ [41:23]

13. يَكَادُ الْبَرْقُ يَخْطِفُ أَبْصَارَهُمْ [2:20]
14. يَكَادُ زَيْتُهَا يُضِيءُ وَلَوْ لَمْ تَمْسَسْهُ نَارٌ [24:35]
15. لَا يَكَادُ يُبَيِّنُ [43:52]
16. لَا يَكَادُونَ يَفْقَهُونَ حَدِيثًا [4:78]
17. لَوْلَا يَكَلِّمُنَا اللَّهُ [2:118]
18. لَوْلَا أُنْزِلَ عَلَيْهِ مَلَكٌ [6:8]
19. رَبَّنَا لَوْلَا أَرْسَلْتَ إِلَيْنَا رَسُولًا [20:134]
20. لَوْلَا تَشْكُرُونَ [56:70]
21. لَوْلَا تَسْتَغْفِرُونَ اللَّهَ [27:46]
22. لَوْلَا فَضْلُ اللَّهِ عَلَيْكُمْ وَرَحْمَتُهُ لَكُنْتُمْ مِنَ الْخَاسِرِينَ [2:64]
23. لَوْلَا كِتَابٌ مِنَ اللَّهِ سَبَقَ لَمَسَّكُمْ فِي مَا أَخَذْتُمْ عَذَابٌ عَظِيمٌ [8:68]
24. وَلَوْلَا أَجَلٌ مُسَمًّى لَجَاءَهُمُ الْعَذَابُ [29:53]
25. لَوْلَا نِعْمَةُ رَبِّي لَكُنْتُ مِنَ الْمُخْضَرِّينَ [37:57]

Lesson Thirty-Nine

The Energetic; Oaths and Exclamations

THE ENERGETIC

The Energetic is used in special circumstances to signify the future. Energetic forms are not common, but they occur often enough for it to be necessary to recognise them at sight. They are formed by adding the ending *-anna* or *-an* to the Jussive.^A In addition, a final *-ū/ī* before the suffix will be shortened to *u/i* with the suffix losing the initial *a*. Thus the jussive 3 m.p. يَقُولُوا *yaqūlū* has an energetic form يَقُولُنَّ *yaqūlunna* (as opposed to the 3 m.s. يَقُولَنَّ *yaqūlanna*). Similarly, *-ay* + the energetic ending becomes *-ayinna*: hence تَرَيْنَّ *tarayinna*, 2 f.s. energetic of رَأَى *ra'ā*. A third point is that final *u/i* followed by the energetic ending becomes *uw/iy* hence يُنْسِيَنَّ *yunsiyanna*, 3 m.s. Energetic of أَنْسى *ansā*; تَرَوُنَّ *tarawunna*, 2 m.p. of رَأَى *ra'ā* [102:7].

Forms of the Energetic in *-an* are rare, and somewhat confusingly they are normally written with the *-an* accusative ending.

The use of the Energetic is normally triggered in four ways. These are, in descending order of frequency:

1. after *la*:-

لَتُضِحَّ نَادِمِينَ [23:40]

you will be repentant

لَتُنَبِّئَهُمْ بِأَمْرِهِمْ هَذَا [12:15]

you will tell them about this affair of theirs

^A There are also Energetic forms of the Imperative, but these are very rare, and not found in the Qur'ān. For a fuller treatment of the Energetic see Wright, *Arabic Grammar*, I, p. 61 and the tables in I, pp. 298–316.

لَيَنْصُرَهُ اللَّهُ [22:40]

God will help him

2. in the *jawāb* to a *sharṭ* introduced by لَئِنْ *la-in*:

لَئِنْ جَاءَ نَصْرٌ مِنْ رَبِّكَ لَيَقُولُنَّ إِنَّا كُنَّا مَعَكُمْ [29:10]

if a victory comes to you from your Lord, they will say, 'We were with you.'

لَئِنْ لَمْ يَنْتَهِ لَنْسِفَعْنَا بِالنَّاصِيَةِ [96:15]

if he does not desist, We shall seize [him] by the forelock

لَئِنْ لَمْ يَفْعَلْ مَا أَمُرُهُ لَيُسْجَنَنَّ وَلَيَكُونًا مِنَ الصَّاغِرِينَ [12:32]

if he does not do what I tell him to do, he will be imprisoned and be one of those brought low

3. in the *sharṭ* after إِمَّا *immā*:

إِمَّا تَرِينَ مِنْ آتِشَرٍ أَحَدًا فَقُولِي إِنِّي نَذَرْتُ لِلرَّحْمَنِ صَوْمًا [19:26]

if you see any man, say, 'I have vowed a fast to the Merciful.'

إِمَّا نَذْهَبَنَّ بِكَ فَإِنَّا مِنْهُمْ مُنْتَقِمُونَ [43:41]

if We take you away, We shall take vengeance on them

4. after the negative لَا *lā*:

لَا تَمُوتُنَّ إِلَّا وَأَنْتُمْ مُسْلِمُونَ [2:132]

die only as Muslims

لَا تَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الْمُشْرِكِينَ [6:14]

do not be among the polytheists

Other categories may also trigger the use of the Energetic, but of these the only one found in the Qur'ān is the interrogative:

هَلْ يُذْهِبَنَّ كَيْدُهُ مَا يَغِيظُ [22:15]

will his trick remove what is enraging [him]?

OATHS

In general, oaths are most commonly introduced by the prepositions *wa-*, *bi-* or the rare *ta-*, all with the sense of 'by' and all taking the genitive. Thus *وَاللّٰهِ wa-llāhi*, *بِاللّٰهِ bi-llāhi* and *تَاللّٰهِ ta-llāhi* all mean 'by God'. However, in the Qur'ān *bi-llāhi* never stands on its own in an oath. Also, though the *wāw al-qasam* (*wa-* plus the genitive 'by') is quite common, particularly in early Meccan material, *wa-llāhi* occurs only once [6:23].

The general rules for the introduction of the complement to a prepositional oath apply in the Qur'ān, though the range of examples in it does not cover all possibilities that Arabic provides.

1. In a nominal sentence using *la-* or *inna*. . . *la-*:

وَالْقُرْآنِ الْحَكِيمِ إِنَّكَ لَمِنَ الْمُرْسَلِينَ [36:2-3]

by the decisive recitation, you are one of those who have been sent!

2. In a positive verbal sentence using *la-* and the energetic (present and future) or *laqad* (sometimes just *qad*) and the perfect (past), or by *inna*:

تَاللّٰهِ لَتُسْأَلُنَّ عَمَّا كُنتُمْ تَفْتَرُونَ [16:56]

by God you will be asked about what you concocted!

وَهَذَا الْبَلَدِ الْأَمِينِ لَقَدْ خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ [95:3-4]

by this secure territory, We have created man!

وَنَفْسٍ ... قَدْ أَفْلَحَ مَنْ زَكَّاهَا [91:7-9]

by a soul. . . the one who keeps it pure will prosper!

وَالْكِتَابِ الْمُبِينِ إِنَّا جَعَلْنَاهُ قُرْآنًا عَرَبِيًّا [43:2-3]

by the clear Scripture, We have made it an Arabic recitation!

3. In a negative sentence:

- a) with *mā* + the perfect or *lā* + the imperfect or *mā*^A with a nominal sentence:

^A The negative *in* is found in 86:4.

وَاللّٰهُ ... مَا كُنَّا مُشْرِكِينَ [6:23]

by God we were not polytheists!

وَالضُّحَىٰ ... مَا وَدَّعَكَ رَبُّكَ [93:1, 3]

by the forenoon. . . your Lord has not said farewell to you!

وَالْقَلَمِ ... مَا أَنْتَ بِمُجْنُونٍ [68:1-2]

by the pen. . . you are not possessed!

- b) With the absence of any particle, either positive or negative, as in:

تَاللّٰهِ تَفَتًا تَذْكُرُ يُوسُفَ [12:85]

by God, you do **not** cease remembering Yūsuf!

As oaths are prominent in rhetorical pieces, sometimes the rhetoric causes an interruption in the flow of the sentence, with words like *bal* and *hal* starting the main sentence, e.g.:

وَالْقُرْآنِ الْمَجِيدِ بَلْ عَجِبُوا [50:1-2]

by the glorious Qur'ān, no, they wondered!

Other rhetorical modifications occasionally appear:

وَشَٰهِدٍ وَمَشْهُودٍ قُتِلَ أَصْحَابُ الْأُخْدُودِ [85:3-4]

by that which witnesses and that which is witnessed,
slain were the men of the pit

The commentators are agreed that this is not an example of 3(b), but of the oath being followed by a strongly positive statement.

As indicated above, oaths may also be introduced by verbs such as *ḥalafa* *ḥalafa* and *aqsama* 'to swear'. Even *shahida*, 'to witness' can operate in the same way:

يَخْلِفُونَ بِاللّٰهِ إِنَّهُمْ لَمِنْكُمْ [9:56]

they swear by God that they are of you

يُقْسِمَانِ بِاللّٰهِ لَشَهَادَتُنَا اَحَقُّ مِنْ شَهَادَتِهِمَا [5:107]

let the two of them swear by God, 'Our testimony is truer than theirs.'

نَشْهَدُ اِنَّكَ لَرَسُوْلُ اللّٰهِ [63:1]

we bear witness that you are God's messenger

There is one very problematical usage: the phrase *لَا أُقْسِمُ* *lā uqsimu* that occurs in 56:75; 69:38; 70:40; 75:1; 75:2; 81:15; 84:16; and 90:1. The commentators are split on whether the phrase means 'No! I swear' or simply 'I swear', the second possibility being the converse of oaths where no particle is involved. On the basis of the other examples of *ḥalafa* and *aqsama*, I am inclined to think that the phrase means 'No! I swear'.

لَيْتَ *layta*

Layta, 'would that', acts like *inna*, *anna*, *la'alla*: it takes a noun in the accusative or a pronominal suffix. In the case of the 1st person singular this is *-nī*. In the Qur'ān all the examples of *layta* but one are preceded by *yā*. The exception is 25:28, where *وَيْلَتَا* *waylatā* (see below) is interposed.

يَا لَيْتَ قَوْمِي يَعْلَمُونَ [36:26] would that my people knew!

يَا لَيْتَنَا اطعنا الله [33:66] would that we had obeyed God!

يَا لَيْتَنِي مِتُّ قَبْلَ هَذَا [19:23] would that I had died before this!

وَيْلٌ *waylun*, وَيْلَةٌ *waylatun*

Waylun, 'woe', is most commonly found in the Qur'ān in the indefinite nominative, with *li-* to indicate those on whom the woe falls and *min* to indicate the cause of the woe:

وَيْلٌ لِّلْمُشْرِكِينَ [41:6]

woe to the polytheists!

وَيْلٌ لِّلْكَافِرِينَ مِنْ عَذَابٍ شَدِيدٍ [14:2]

woe to those who do not believe, because of a severe torment!

There is a rare example of the definite:

لَكُمْ الْوَيْلُ مِمَّا تَصِفُونَ [21:18]

woe to you for what you describe!

The accusative and a suffix is also found: *وَيْلَكَ wayla-ka*, *وَيْلَكُمْ wayla-kum*, *وَيْلَنَا wayla-nā*.

There are also four examples of the feminine *وَيْلَةٌ waylatun*. Three have the pausal form *وَيْلَتِي waylatā* after the *yā* of lamentation (see below) [5:31; 11:72; 25:28], and one is in the accusative followed by a suffix, *وَيْلَتْنَا waylata-nā* [18:49].

REGRET

The particle most used to express regret, *wā*, does not occur in the Qur'ān. However, its alternative, *yā*, does. At first sight it looks indistinguishable from the vocative *yā*, and in some cases, as in the examples with *layta* and *wayl* above, one might perhaps view the *yā* either way. However, only the *yā* of regret is followed by the pausal form in *-ā* mentioned under *waylatun* above. It is also found in such phrases as:

يَا أَسْفَىٰ عَلَىٰ يُونُسَ [12:84] Oh, how I grieve for Joseph

يَا حَسْرَتَا [39:56] Oh, woe is me!

It is also found with the accusative in such phrases as *yā ḥasratan* [36:30] and *yā ḥasrata-nā* [6:31].

VOCABULARY THIRTY-NINE

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
حَلَفَ	يُحْلِفُ	حِلْفٌ	to swear
رَجَمَ	يَرْجُمُ	رَجْمٌ	to stone
سَجَنَ	يَسْجُنُ	سَجْنٌ	to imprison
سَفَعَ	يَسْفَعُ	سَفْعٌ	to drag
شَهِدَ	يَشْهَدُ	شَهَادَةٌ	to witness
عَجِبَ	يَعْجَبُ	عَجَبٌ	to wonder
غَلَبَ	يَغْلِبُ	غَلَبٌ	to overcome
قَعَدَ	يَقْعُدُ	قُعُودٌ	to sit, lurk
نَذَرَ	يَنْذِرُ	نَذْرٌ	to vow
غَاظَ	يَغْضِظُ	غَيْظٌ	to enrage
زَكَّى ²	يُزَكِّي	تَزْكِيَةٌ	to purify, keep pure
وَدَّعَ ²	يُودِّعُ	يُودِيعٌ	to bid farewell to
أَقْسَمَ ⁴	يُقْسِمُ	إِقْسَامٌ	to swear
أَنْجَى ⁴	يُنْجِي	إِنْجَاءٌ	to save
أَنَسَى ⁴	يُنْسِي	إِنْسَاءٌ	to cause to forget
إِنْتَقَمَ ⁸	يَنْتَقِمُ	إِنْتِقَامٌ	to take revenge on (+ <i>min</i>)
إِنْتَهَى ⁸	يَنْتَهِي	إِنْتِهَاءٌ	to cease, desist
إِسْتَحَفَّ ¹⁰	يَسْتَحِفُّ	إِسْتِحْفَافٌ	to make unstable

SINGULAR	PLURAL	
أَسْفٌ		grief
حَسْرَةٌ		sorrow, anguish
صَوْمٌ		fast
ضُحًى		forenoon
نَاصِيَةٌ	نَوَاصٍ	forelock
أَجْمَعُ		all
صَاغِرٌ		humbled
قَدِيمٌ	قُدَمَاءُ	old, ancient
يَوْمَئِذٍ		on that day

EXERCISE THIRTY-NINE

1. وَيْلٌ لِلَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا مِنَ النَّارِ [38:27]
2. وَيْلٌ يَوْمَئِذٍ لِلْمُكَذِّبِينَ [52:11]
3. وَيْلٌ لِلَّذِينَ يَكْتُمُونَ الْكِتَابَ بِأَيْدِيهِمْ ثُمَّ يَقُولُونَ [2:79]
هَذَا مِنْ عِنْدِ اللَّهِ
4. وَيْلٌ لِلْمُشْرِكِينَ [41:6]
5. يَا وَيْلَنَا قَدْ كُنَّا فِي غَفْلَةٍ مِنْ هَذَا [21:97]
6. يَا لَيْتَنِي لَمْ أَشْرِكْ بِرَبِّي أَحَدًا [18:42]
7. يَا لَيْتَنَّا أَطْعَمْنَا اللَّهَ [33:66]
8. يَا لَيْتَ قَوْمِي يَعْلَمُونَ [36:26]
9. يَقُولُ الْكَافِرُ يَا لَيْتَنِي كُنْتُ تُرَابًا [78:40]

10. لَا أُقْسِمُ بِهَذَا الْبَلَدِ [90:1]
11. وَاللَّهُ يَشْهَدُ إِنَّهُمْ لَكَاذِبُونَ [9:107]
12. قَالُوا تَاللَّهِ إِنَّكَ لَفِي ضَلَالِكَ الْقَدِيمِ [12:95]
13. وَاللَّهُ رَبَّنَا مَا كُنَّا مُشْرِكِينَ [6:23]
14. فَوَرَبَّكَ لَنَسْأَلَنَّهُمْ أَجْمَعِينَ [15:92]
15. فَوَرَبَّكَ لَنَحْشُرَنَّهُمْ [19:68]
16. وَرَبِّي لَتَأْتِيََنَّكُمْ [34:3]
17. لئن سَأَلْتَهُمْ مَنْ خَلَقَهُمْ لَيَقُولُنَّ اللَّهُ [43:87]
18. كَتَبَ اللَّهُ لَأَغْلِبَنَّ أَنَا وَرُسُلِي [58:21]
19. لَنُخْرِجَنَّكُمْ مِنْ أَرْضِنَا [14:13]
20. لَيَجْمَعَنَّكُمْ إِلَى يَوْمِ الْقِيَامَةِ [4:87]
21. لَا يَصُدُّكُمْ الشَّيْطَانُ [43:62]
22. لَا تَحْسَبَنَّ اللَّهُ غَافِلًا عَمَّا يَعْمَلُ الظَّالِمُونَ [14:42]
23. لئن لم تَنْتَهِ لَأَرْجُمَنَّكَ [19:46]
24. لئن أَنجَانَا مِنْ هَذِهِ لَنَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الشَّاكِرِينَ [6:63]
25. إِمَّا يُنَسِيَنَّكَ الشَّيْطَانُ فَلَا تَقْعُدْ بَعْدَ الذِّكْرِى
مَعَ الْقَوْمِ الظَّالِمِينَ [6:68]
26. يَا بَنِي آدَمَ لَا يَفْتِنَنَّكُمُ الشَّيْطَانُ [7:27]
27. لئن لم يَهْدِنِي رَبِّي لَأَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الْقَوْمِ الضَّالِّينَ [6:77]
28. لَا يَسْتَخِفُّكَ الَّذِينَ لَا يُوقِنُونَ [30:60]

Lesson Forty

Special Uses of *mā kāna*; Verbs of Wonder, Praise and Blame

SPECIAL USES OF *mā kāna*

There are two idiomatic uses of *mā kāna* that are common enough to need explanation.

1. *Mā kāna* followed by a subject and then by *li-*. In this construction the subordinate clause introduced by *li-* is the equivalent of the predicate of *kāna*. The literal meaning is 'x [the nominative] is/was not one to', but it is often more satisfactory to translate the phrase as 'x would not', 'x should not' or even as 'x cannot' or 'x could not'.

مَا كَانَ اللَّهُ لِيُضَيِّعَ إِيمَانَكُمْ [2:143]

God is not one to see your faith wasted

مَا كَانَ رَبُّكَ لِيُهْلِكَ الْقُرَىٰ بِظُلْمٍ [11:117]

your Lord was not one to destroy the settlements unjustly

مَا كَانَ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ لِيَنْفِرُوا كَافَّةً [9:122]

the believers should not go out to fight all in one body

The only example without an explicit subject is:

مَا كَانَ لِيَأْخُذَ أَخَاهُ [12:76]

'He was not one to take his brother'

Here the subject Yūsuf is implicit from the previous verses.

2. *Mā kāna li-* [+ genitive] *an*: This is the more common construction. In meaning it is similar to 1, and again it is satisfactory to translate the phrase as 'x should not', etc.

مَا كَانَ لَنَا أَنْ نُشْرِكَ بِاللَّهِ [12:38]

it was not for us to associate anything with God

مَا كَانَ لِنَبِيٍّ أَنْ يَغُلَّ [3:161]

it is not for any prophet to deceive [the people]

مَا كَانَ لِلَّهِ أَنْ يَتَّخِذَ مِنْ وَلَدٍ [19:35]

God is not one to take to Himself any son

VERBS OF WONDER, PRAISE AND BLAME

The verbs classified by the Arab grammarians as 'verbs of wonder' are rare in the Qur'ān and barely deserve a mention. There are two forms.

1. The 3 m.s. of the perfect of the 4th form immediately after *mā*:

مَا أَكْفَرَهُ [80:17] how ungrateful he is

2. The 2 m.s. imperative of the 4th form, with the object attached by *bi*-:

أَبْصِرْ بِهِ وَأَسْمِعْ [18:26] how well He sees and hears

bi'sa and *ni'ma* are termed by the Arab grammarians 'the verbs of praise and blame', but they are fossilized verbs that do not conjugate. Both are relatively common in the Qur'ān, with 'the verb of blame' [*bi'sa* 'how bad'] being more than twice as frequent as 'the verb of praise' [*ni'ma* 'how good']. *bi'sa* and *ni'ma* are normally followed by a clause beginning with *mā* or a single noun in the nominative:

يُبْسِ مَا اشْتَرَوْا بِهِ أَنْفُسَهُمْ [2:93]

evil is what they have sold themselves/ their souls for

يُبْسِ الْمَصِيرُ [2:126]

evil is the journeying [to Hell]

لِنِعْمِ الْمُحْيُونَ [37:75]

how excellent are those who answer

نِعْمَ دَارُ الْمُتَّقِينَ [16:30]

how excellent is the dwelling of the God-fearing

Two verses, however, show different constructions.

يُبْسُ لِلظَّالِمِينَ بَدَلًا [18:50]

that is an evil exchange for the wrongdoers

Here an accusative takes the place of the nominative.

يُبْسُ الْإِسْمُ الْفُسُوقُ بَعْدَ الْإِيمَانِ [49:11]

evil is the term 'dissoluteness', after belief

Here we have the full construction with two nominatives, analogous to the example quoted in Wright (2, 290):

نِعْمَ الْمَرْأَةُ زَيْنَبُ how excellent a woman Zaynab is

The perfect of the verb سَاءَ *sā'a*, 'to be bad' has more or less the same force and constructions as *bi'sa*, with a similar predominance of the nominative over the accusative. However, *sā'a* does conjugate:

مَأْوَاهُمْ جَهَنَّمُ وَسَاءَتْ مَصِيرًا [4:97]

their abode in Jahannam, and it is an evil journey's end

سَاءَ صَبَاحُ الْمُنْذَرِينَ [37:177]

terrible will be the morning of those who have been warned

VOCABULARY FORTY

PERFECT	IMPERFECT	VERBAL NOUN	
صَنَعَ	يَصْنَعُ	صُنْعٌ	to make, work
نَفَرَ	يَنْفِرُ	نَفَرٌ	to go forth
غَلَّ	يَغُلُّ	غُلُولٌ	to deceive
عَمَرَ	يَعْمُرُ	عُمْرَةٌ	to visit
أَظْلَعَ ⁴	يُظْلِعُ	إِظْلَاعٌ	to acquaint
أَضَاعَ ⁴	يُضِيعُ	إِضَاعَةٌ	to cause to be wasted
آذَى ⁴	يُؤْذِي	إِذَاءٌ	to hurt, vex
اشْتَرَى	يَشْتَرِي	شِرَاءٌ	to buy

SINGULAR · PLURAL

مَأْوًى	shelter
بَدَلٌ	exchange
ثَمَنٌ	أَثْمَانٌ price, gain
خِيَرَةٌ	choice
مُرْتَفَقٌ	resting-place
مَسْجِدٌ	مَسَاجِدُ mosque, place of prayer
سُلْطَانٌ	authority, power
شَرَابٌ	drink
مَصِيرٌ	course, journey's end
فُسُوقٌ	dissoluteness
وَخًى	inspiration

EXERCISE FORTY

1. مَا كَانَ اللَّهُ لِيُظْلِمَهُمْ [29:40]
2. مَا كَانَ اللَّهُ لِيَذَرَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ عَلَىٰ مَا أَنتُمْ عَلَيْهِ [3:179]
3. مَا كَانَ اللَّهُ لِيُضِلَّ قَوْمًا بَعْدَ إِذْ هَدَاهُمْ [9:115]
4. مَا كَانَ اللَّهُ لِيُظْلِعَكُمْ عَلَى الْغَيْبِ [3:179]
5. مَا كَانَ لَهُمْ أَنْ يَدْخُلُوهَا [2:114]
6. مَا كَانَ لِنَفْسٍ أَنْ تَمُوتَ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ [3:145]
7. مَا كَانَ لِرَسُولٍ أَنْ يَأْتِيَ بِآيَةٍ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ [13:38]
8. مَا كَانَ لِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ أَنْ يَقْتُلَ مُؤْمِنًا [4:92]
9. مَا كَانَ لِلْمُشْرِكِينَ أَنْ يَعْمُرُوا مَسَاجِدَ اللَّهِ [9:17]
10. مَا كَانَ لَنَا أَنْ نَأْتِيَكُمْ بِسُلْطَانٍ [14:11]
11. مَا كَانَ لِنَبِّئِ أَنْ يُكَلِّمَهُ اللَّهُ إِلَّا وَحْيًا [42:51]
12. مَا كَانَ لِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَلَا الْمُؤْمِنَةِ أَنْ يَكُونَ لَهُمُ الْخَيْرَةُ [33:36]
13. مَا كَانَ لَكُمْ أَنْ تُؤْذُوا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ [33:53]
14. نِعَمَ النَّصِيرُ [8:40]
15. نِعَمَ أَجْرُ الْعَامِلِينَ [29:58]
16. نِعَمَ مَا يَعِظُكُمْ بِهِ [4:58]
17. سَاءَ مَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ [58:15]
18. سَاءَ سَبِيلًا [4:22]
19. بئسَ الشَّرَابُ وَسَاءَتْ مُرْتَفَقًا [18:29]
20. اشْتَرَوْا بِهِ ثَمَنًا قَلِيلًا فَبئسَ مَا يَشْتَرُونَ [3:187]

Exercise Forty

21. بُئْسَ مَا كَانُوا يَصْنَعُونَ [5:63]
22. بُئْسَ مَثَلُ الْقَوْمِ الَّذِينَ كَذَّبُوا بِآيَاتِ اللَّهِ [62:5]
23. مَاوَاهُمُ النَّارُ وَبُئْسَ مَثْوَى الظَّالِمِينَ [3:151]
24. مَاوَاهُ جَهَنَّمَ وَبُئْسَ الْمَصِيرُ [3:162]
25. نِعَمَ الْعَبْدُ [38:30]

Key to the Exercises

Exercise One

1. The clear book. 2. A clear book. 3. A noble book. 4. A clear recitation. 5. The glorious recitation. 6. A noble recitation. 7. A glorious recitation. 8. The mighty recitation. 9. An ample mercy. 10. Another sign. 11. The last day. 12. A great day. 13. The severe punishment. 14. A mighty day. 15. A severe punishment. 16. A great reward. 17. A noble reward. 18. A mighty punishment. 19. A great reward. 20. A faithful messenger. 21. A noble messenger. 22. The secure town. 23. Another god. 24. A clear messenger. 25. The first and the last. 26. The first and the last. 27. God is mighty. 28. God is strong. 29. God is strong and mighty. 30. The strong and faithful one.

Exercise Two

1. Other gods. 2. Many benefits. 3. Many fruits. 4. The first (previous) generations. 5. The settlements are doing wrong. 6. A wrongdoing settlement. 7. The Jews and the Christians. 8. The heavens and the earth. 9. Non-Arab and Arab. 10. The people who do wrong. 11. Unbelieving people. 12. A believer and an unbeliever. 13. Believing men. 14. The believing men and the believing women. 15. Believing men and believing women. 16. The first and the last. 17. God is relenting. 18. Honoured servants. 19. A believing man. 20. Other days. 21. Heaven and earth (the heaven and the earth). 22. The Muslim men and the Muslim women.

Exercise Three A

1. You are Muslims. 2. They are Muslims. 3. We are a temptation. 4. I am a warner. 5. A lofty garden. 6. You are the Relenting One. 7. You are wrongdoers. 8. You are the poor. 9. She is a wrongdoer. 10. He is a believer. 11. He is the gentle one. 12. You are believers. 13. I am God, the Mighty (the mighty God). 14. It is white. 15. He/it is strong. 16. You are the Mighty One. 17. It is a trial. 18. You are a warner. 19. You are ignorant ones. 20. I am the Relenting One.

Exercise Four

1. In the alms. 2. In manifest error. 3. Over the fire. 4. Between heaven and earth. 5. Among the believers. 6. Among the people. 7. With the people who do wrong. 8. With the believers. 9. With the messenger. 10. On a guidance. 11. On the messenger. 12. Against the unbelievers. 13. From a way. 14. To a town. 15. To a great punishment. 16. From the messengers. 17. From other days. 18. From a god. 19. By God. 20. In the next world. 21. In a valley. 22. Good news for the believers. 23. For the people who do wrong. 24. For the believing women. 25. To God belongs this world (the first world) and the next.

Exercise Five

1. My punishment is severe. 2. My Lord is merciful. 3. My Lord is near. 4. My protector is God. 5. God is my Lord. 6. My son is [one] of my family. 7. My punishment is the severe one. 8. My Lord is with me. 9. Between me and my brothers. 10. God is my reckoning. 11. God is guidance. 12. God is truth. 13. My Lord is gentle. 14. He is God, my Lord. 15. It is my stick. 16. God is the one who hears. 17. God is my Lord. 18. My messengers and I. 19. It is from the Book. 20. He is in manifest error. 21. My punishment is severe. 22. He remains for ever in the Fire. 23. He is the First and the Last. 24. I am [one] of the Muslims. 25. My reward is with God.

Exercise Six

1. That is the great bounty. 2. This is permissible and this is forbidden. 3. This (man) is a warner from the warners of old (first). 4. This is an Arabic tongue. 5. This is a mercy from my Lord. 6. That bounty is from God. 7. This is a straight path. 8. This life. 9. That is the next abode (world). 10. This is a strange thing. 11. Those have a guidance. 12. That is far-reaching error. 13. This is my way. 14. That is a difficult day. 15. Those men are the believers. 16. This is my Lord. 17. This is manifest magic. 18. That is easy for God. 19. Those men are of the righteous. 20. These are a sinful people. 21. Those men are honoured in gardens. 22. These are few. 23. That is in a book. 24. That is my path. 25. Those are God's signs. 26. My Lord is on a straight path. 27. The unbelievers will have a humiliating punishment.

Exercise Seven

1. In God's way. 2. The nieces (the daughters of the brother). 3. A few from the rest. 4. The way of the sinners. 5. Bounty is in God's hand. 6. The hands of the people. 7. The signs of the Merciful. 8. God's land is wide. 9. This is God's she-camel. 10. Before the day of reckoning. 11. Those are the party of the Devil. 12. God is possessed of great bounty. 13. Many of the people. 14. Those are the inhabitants (companions) of the Fire. 15. God is an enemy for the unbelievers. 16. The effect of God's mercy. 17. I am the first of the believers. 18. Lord of the heavens and the earth. 19. A party of the People of the Book. 20. A party of the Children of Israel. 21. God is the protector of the faithful. 22. The outcome of affairs is with God. 23. Mischief and great corruption on earth. 24. On the edge of a pit of the Fire. 25. Praise belongs to God, the Lord of all created beings.

Exercise Eight

1. He entered the city. 2. They entered a settlement. 3. He made the sun an illumination and the moon a light. 4. God has sent a messenger. 5. She carried a light load. 6. He created the heavens and the earth. 7. God created that. 8. We created man. 9. They remembered/mentioned God. 10. We returned to the city. 11. You returned. 12. God has coined a likeness. 13. You have journeyed in the way of God. 14. They lingered in humiliating punishment. 15. You have lingered in God's book until the Day of Resurrection. 16. We have written in the Psalms after the Reminder. 17. He found a people. 18. I found a woman. 19. They found God relenting. 20. God promised the believing men and women gardens. 21. He reached the place where the sun rises. 22. God's command was made manifest (appeared). 23. Corruption has appeared on land and sea. 24. We have sent a messenger to (into) each community.

Exercise Nine

1. From God and His Prophet. 2. They are their mothers. 3. You did your deed. 4. He put rivers between them. 5. They left their homes. 6. We went out with you. 7. The matter is between me and you. 8. My curse is on you. 9. We made the son of Mary and his mother a sign. 10. God helped you at Badr. 11. They returned to them. 12. The matter rests with you. 13. They lied against themselves. 14. He followed my guidance. 15. You asked them (f.p.). 16. By the permission of their Lord.

17. My blessing is on you. 18. You entered it. 19. By permission of their family/folk. 20. A people before you asked her. 21. My servants asked you about me. 22. He followed you. 23. He followed me. 24. God raised it to him. 25. Peace be upon you. Your Lord has prescribed mercy for Himself. 26. He entered his garden. 27. God seized them for their sins.

Exercise Ten

1. God did not wrong them. 2. God has not made any way for you against them. 3. That is not a great matter for God. 4. There is not a witness among us. 5. They have no helpers. 6. They did not do it. 7. They did not linger in the humiliating punishment. 8. Whatever reward I have asked you for. 9. There is no way against them. 10. I am merely a clear warner. 11. They have no knowledge of it. 12. We did not prescribe it for them. 13. We are not dead. 14. We found what he promised us. 15. Whatever proper thing (what of that which is recognised/regarded as proper) they did (f.p.) concerning themselves. 16. Concerning what you have taken. 17. This is what you hoarded for yourselves. 18. What God has ordered. 19. What is in front of us and what is behind us. 20. We know what we have ordained for them. 21. What their right hands have laboured [on]. 22. To God belongs the sovereignty of the heavens and the earth and what is in them. 23. The Saying has fallen on them for the wrong that they have done. 24. They found all that they had done. 25. Whatever is on land and in the sea. 26. Half of what you have settled on. 27. Corruption has appeared on land and sea because of what the hands of the people have gained.

Exercise Eleven

1. We have made some of you a test for others. 2. Each of you is an enemy of the other. 3. We have raised some of them above others. 4. Some suspicion is a sin. 5. Those are friends of one another. 6. We have left some of them. 7. They looked at one another. 8. The believers, male and female, are friends to one another. 9. God has power over everything. 10. You are witness over everything. 11. We opened for them the gates of everything. 12. We have appointed an enemy from among the sinners for every prophet. 13. Every community has [its] term. 14. Death [comes on] him from every side. 15. Each god took what it had created. 16. We have raised a messenger in every community. 17. Your Lord is guardian over everything. 18. Every soul is a hostage for what it has earned. 19. Everything little and great is recorded. 20. In it they will have some

of every kind of fruit and forgiveness from their Lord. 21. All you asked for. 22. We have tarried a day or part of a day. 23. They entered it the first time.

Exercise Twelve

1. They (f.p.) have children. 2. They were a sinful people. 3. They were like stubble. 4. We were Muslims. 5. You were in neglect of this. 6. God's command is done. 7. He was an enemy to God and His angels and His messengers. 8. It was with him. 9. He was aware of and saw His servants. 10. Your Lord was observant. 11. They were witnesses against him. 12. The people were a community. 13. You were the watcher over them. 14. We were not thieves. 15. You were sinners. 16. You were on the lip of a pit of the Fire. 17. He was from the generations before you. 18. They were an evil people. 19. That was easy for God. 20. She was from an unbelieving people. 21. There was no difficulty for the Prophet. 22. In the Messenger of God you have a good example. 23. He was in manifest error. 24. When the anger abated in Moses, he took the tablets. 25. When they opened their belongings they discovered their goods. 26. We were unaware of this.

Exercise Thirteen

1. From that which parents have left. 2. Two men said. 3. His hands are spread out. 4. Two other people. 5. Two young men entered the prison with him. 6. These two men are sorcerers. 7. He found two men in it. 8. These are two proofs from your Lord. 9. Two parties of the believers. 10. In the two of them are two springs. 11. These two daughters of mine (gen.). 12. He found, apart from them, two women. 13. They reached their confluence. 14. There is much sin in the two of them. 15. Between the two groups is a veil. 16. They assigned associates to Him. 17. We do not believe the two of you. 18. He created the heavens and the earth and what is between them. 19. He set cultivated land between them. 20. We only created them in truth. 21. In the two of them are fruits and palms and pomegranates. 22. We have appointed the night and the day as two signs.

Exercise Fifteen

1. He taught the recitation. 2. I taught you the book. 3. That is because of what your hands have forwarded. 4. What he has sent forward and left behind. 5. They denied the truth of Our signs. 6. He denied the

truth of the Hour. 7. They have striven in God's way. 8. The two have striven with you. 9. You have disputed with us. 10. God confound them! 11. They have fought you over religion. 12. We have sent it down as a recitation in Arabic. 13. God has sent down water from the sky. 14. God has not sent down anything to any mortal. 15. We destroyed them for their sins. 16. We have not destroyed any settlement without it having a known decree. 17. He has sent His Messenger with the guidance. 18. We sent Noah to his people. 19. You sent a messenger to us. 20. I have put my trust in God, my Lord and your Lord. 21. He has turned on his face. 22. They went back to their own people. 23. They have helped him and followed the light. 24. They have followed the truth from their Lord. 25. They have differed about the scripture. 26. The parties among them differed. 27. The Messenger sought forgiveness for them. 28. They have sought forgiveness for their sins. 29. You were haughty and were one of the unbelievers. 30. They were haughty and were a sinful people.

Exercise Sixteen

1. We shall raise up in every community a witness. 2. I will reach the confluence of the two seas. 3. We will place the two beneath our feet. 4. He eats what you eat and drinks what you drink. 5. She carries him. 6. They will not return. 7. They will go in through every gate to see them. 8. They will remember them. 9. God coins comparisons for men. 10. They write the document with their hands. 11. A punishment that is near will seize you. 12. He used to tell his people to pray and give alms. 13. They are not going out with them. 14. They ask you about the sacred month. 15. He hears the words of God. 16. He knows what each soul earns. 17. God will not speak to them nor look at them. 18. They will help you. 19. God witnesses what you do. 20. They put their trust in their Lord. 21. They will seek His forgiveness. God is forgiving and merciful. 22. He will teach you the Scripture and the Wisdom. 23. They are not proud. 24. We do not deny the truth of the signs of our Lord. 25. You strive in God's way with your possessions and your persons. 26. Those possessed of understanding are reminded. 27. I will send down the like of what God has sent down. 28. They destroy themselves. 29. They will not fight you. 30. They will see/observe.

Exercise Seventeen

1. Will you not be reminded? 2. We shall see whether you have spoken the truth or are one of the liars. 3. Shall We treat those who submit like

those who sin? 4. When will this promise [happen]? 5. How will they have the reminder? 6. What are the companions of the right? 7. What will give you knowledge of what the Day of Judgement is? 8. Have you found that which your Lord promised you? 9. Have you any knowledge? 10. Do they not know? 11. Has God sent a mortal as His messenger? 12. Truly, His is the judgement. 13. We see how you act. 14. Do you not understand? 15. Have you brought me good tidings? 16. Did you deny the truth of My signs? 17. Do they divide out your Lord's mercy? 18. Did you know what you had done? 19. Have you hastened the command of your Lord? 20. Do they seek to hasten Our punishment? 21. Do they hear you? 22. It was made clear to you how We dealt with them. 23. Do we not die? 24. Are you Muslims? 25. Truly that will be the clear loss. 26. What will give you knowledge of what the calamity is? 27. Can you make the deaf hear? 28. How can you take it? 29. Is it a wonder for mankind? 30. Do they not consider (look at) camels?

Exercise Eighteen

1. The People of the Scripture ask you to bring down a scripture for them from heaven. 2. We have made you a moderate community that you may be witnesses to the people. 3. They were averse to striving with their possessions and their persons in God's way. 4. Their recompense is that the curse of God will be upon them. 5. They offer allegiance to you on the basis that they will not associate anything with God. 6. Am I unable to be like this crow? 7. That will be because they have followed that which angers God. 8. Your sign will be that you cannot speak to people for three nights. 9. He has brought it down upon your heart, that you may be one of the warners. 10. We desire our Lord to cause us to enter with the people who are righteous. 11. God will not grant deferment to any soul. 12. God commands you to sacrifice a cow. 13. It is the truth from your Lord, that you may warn a people. 14. It gives good tidings to the believers that they shall have a great reward. 15. We made the night for them to rest in. 16. He is able to send a punishment against you. 17. It has become clear to them that they are companions of the Fire. 18. It has become clear to him that he was an enemy of God. 19. We prescribed in it: a soul for a soul. and an eye for an eye. 20. He has subjected the sea, so that you may eat [fresh fish] flesh from it. 21. That is their recompense because they did not believe in our signs. 22. We are eager for our Lord to forgive us our sins. 23. Does man not remember that We created him? 24. He sent down with them the Scripture with

the truth, that He might decide between the people. 25. May I follow you on condition that you teach me?

Exercise Nineteen

1. We shall return to him. 2. You are the gatherer of the people. 3. Thus we deal with the sinners. 4. They said, 'We are moving to our Lord.' 5. God enjoins justice and doing good. 6. We have made you a viceroy in the earth. 7. Hell will be your recompense. 8. You are possessed. 9. God is forgiving and merciful. 10. The unbelievers say, 'This man is a clear sorcerer.' 11. We will not enter it. 12. God is an enemy to the unbelievers. 13. We have sent down to you the Scripture with the truth. 14. He has a father who is a very old man indeed. 15. He was one of Our devoted servants. 16. This is a very strange thing. 17. Satan is a very clear enemy to man. 18. He is one of the righteous. 19. He sees what you do. 20. The earthquake of the Hour is a tremendous thing. 21. She is a yellow cow. 22. God has power over everything. 23. I have put my trust in God. 24. Many of the people are heedless of Our signs. 25. In the livestock there is a lesson for you. 26. Truly, to God belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth. 27. The hypocrites try to deceive God. 28. We have sent you with the truth, as a bearer of good tidings and a warner. 29. They said, 'We bear witness against ourselves.' 30. They said, 'We found our fathers serving them.'

Exercise Twenty

1. You did not warn them. 2. He will teach you what you did not know. 3. I did not associate anyone with my Lord. 4. He has no protector. 5. Did you not know that God knows all that is in heaven and earth? 6. He has no partner in sovereignty. 7. They have not reached puberty. 8. God has not made a light for him. 9. Did I not say to you...? 10. Do not seek to hasten. 11. He knew what you did not know. 12. Have they not looked at the heaven above them? 13. He has taught man that which he did not know. 14. They found no helpers apart from God. 15. Did We not assign to him two eyes? 16. Did We not destroy the ancients? 17. You were not believers. 18. He did not hear it. 19. Did your Lord not make you a fair promise? 20. Do not approach (dual) this tree. 21. There is no equal to Him. 22. Do not be sad. 23. Do not serve Satan. 24. Do not ask me about anything. 25. Do not be with the unbelievers. 26. Do not kill your ...children. 27. Do not break your oaths. 28. Do not enter by one gate.

Exercise Twenty-One

1. Is not this the truth? 2. There is nothing like Him. 3. They say with their tongues what is not in their hearts. 4. They shall not have any food. 5. He is not one of your family. 6. Is there not a lodging for the unbelievers in Hell? 7. There is no sin for you in any mistakes you have made. 8. He cannot emerge from it. 9. Do I not possess the kingdom of Egypt? 10. Lo, they sit on it. 11. Those who surrender their faces to God will have their reward with their Lord. 12. Amongst them were those whom We drowned. 13. Is there any of those you associate [with God] who can do any of that? 14. From the *jinn* there were those who worked before him by permission of his Lord. 15. You cannot make those in the graves hear. 16. Among them there are those who made a covenant with God. 17. Among the parties there are those who deny some of it. 18. Among the people are those who dispute about God without knowledge. 19. See them running from it! 20. Lo, they are two parties. 21. Behold, you are mortals. 22. Lo, a party of them associate others with their Lord. 23. [Recall] when Satan made their actions seem fair to them. 24. [Recall] when We appointed for Moses forty nights.

Exercise Twenty-Two

1. They drew near to one another, asking each other questions. 2. Those recite their Scripture. 3. He recited it to them. 4. The Merciful has given permission to him. 5. I shall not leave the land until my father gives me permission. 6. My servants asked you about Me. 7. They ask, 'When is the Day of Resurrection?' 8. The people ask you about the Hour. 9. He has produced you from a single soul. 10. Are you the ones who made its tree grow, or are We the One who causes [it] to grow? 11. After them We produced other generations. 12. He used to tell his people to pray and give alms. 13. He has believed in God and His angels and His scriptures and His messengers. 14. Shall we believe in two mortals like us? 15. Do they then believe in vanity and disbelieve in the blessing of God? 16. They prefer the life of this world. 17. God has preferred you over us. 18. He told them their names. 19. He will tell them what they have been doing. 20. Will you tell God what He does not know. 21. Who told you this? 22. They sought your permission to go out. 23. I have perceived a fire. 24. I will tell you what you should eat.

Exercise Twenty-Three

1. My blessing which I bestowed on you. 2. This is the fire which you used to deny. 3. The Fire, whose fuel is men and stones. 4. Do not kill the soul that God has made sacred [forbidden]. 5. My protector is God who has sent down the Scripture. 6. [It is] He who has subjected the sea, so that you may eat from it. 7. Is this the one whom God has sent as a messenger? 8. And whom I desire to forgive me my sins on the Day of Judgement. 9. Who is it that will lend God a fair loan? 10. Blessed is He in whose hand is sovereignty. 11. [It is] He who has driven out those who disbelieved. 12. He has made well everything that He has created. 13. Those whose works have failed in this world and the next. 14. Do not be like those who have split up and disagreed. 15. It gives good tidings to the believers who do righteous deeds that they will have a great reward. 16. He puts abomination on those who do not understand. 17. Those who do not believe say, 'You have not been sent as a messenger.' 18. It is a tree that comes out of the root of Hell. 19. We give you very good tidings of a son whose name shall be John. 20. Seven fat cows which were devoured by seven thin ones. 21. In that are signs for a people who understand. 22. They [were] youths who believed in their Lord. 23. A *sūra* which We have sent down. 24. We have brought forth green shoots from which We bring forth grain. 25. On the heights are men who recognize each by their marks. 26. He is from a people with whom you have a covenant. 27. We sent down iron, in which there is great strength and [many] benefits for the people. 28. Communities to whom We shall give enjoyment.

Exercise Twenty-Four

1. We shall inherit the earth and all who are on it. 2. It shall be inherited by My righteous servants. 3. Will you leave Moses and his people to make mischief in the land? 4. Do not leave me alone. 5. No laden soul bears the burden of another. 6. My Lord embraces everything in His knowledge. 7. Their tongues describe the lie. 8. From that which you describe. 9. They will not reach the two of you. 10. They will not reach you. 11. He has set the balance. 12. We shall set up the balances for the Day of Resurrection. 13. God has promised you a promise of truth. 14. Did your Lord not make you a fair promise? 15. I exhort you to one thing. 16. God admonishes you. 17. The truth came to pass, and what they were doing was in vain. 18. We gave them some of Our mercy.

19. My Lord gave me judgement. 20. Those despaired of My mercy. 21. They have despaired of the World to Come. 22. They are sure about the World to Come. 23. They were convinced by Our signs. 24. Do you take idols as gods? 25. He takes witnesses from among you. 26. They choose the unbelievers as their friends.

Exercise Twenty-Five

1. They asked Moses for something greater than that. 2. We have more wealth and children [than you]. 3. Do you know better, or God? 4. The wage of the world to come is greater. 5. They are like stones or harder. 6. The word of those who disbelieve is the lowest and the word of God is the highest. 7. The noblest of you in the sight of God are the most god-fearing. 8. The vilest men have followed you. 9. Which of you is fairer in conduct? 10. Is that better or the Garden of Eternity? 11. God is better and more enduring. 12. Who is further astray than the one who is in distant schism? 13. God is closer to the two of them. 14. Most of them do not understand. 15. The most hostile people. 16. You were on the nearest bank, and they were in the furthest part of the bank. 17. Who does greater wrong than those who deny the truth of God's signs? 18. Shall I tell you of [someone] worse than that? 19. He has the fairest names. 20. God knows best what is in their hearts. 21. On that day the companions of the Garden will be better in the place they stay and the place they rest at midday. 22. What is with God is better for the pious. 23. He is the best of providers. 24. Your Lord knows best how long you have tarried. 25. That is purer for them. 26. The creation of the heavens and the earth is greater than the creation of mankind, but most people do not know [that]. 27. They listen to the declaration and follow the best of it. 28. We are nearer to him than you.

Exercise Twenty-Six

1. God has made trading lawful, and He has forbidden usury. 2. They allow it one year and forbid it another year. 3. They will fight you until they turn you away from your religion. 4. We returned him to his mother. 5. Evil has touched him. 6. Adversity has touched man. 7. We will tell you their tidings in truth. 8. We have told you about them before. 9. We were a people who strayed. 10. They stray from the way of God. 11. God leads astray the wrongdoers. 12. They lead you astray without any knowledge. 13. Pharaoh said to him, 'I think that you are bewitched, O Moses.' 14. You thought that God would not know much of what you were

doing. 15. That which neither profits us nor harms us. 16. You cannot injure Him in any way. 17. Then I shall compel him to the torment of the Fire. 18. He has prepared a painful torment for the unbelievers. 19. God has prepared for them gardens. 20. We counted them amongst the wicked. 21. A day with your Lord is like a thousand years of your counting. 22. God does not love those who work mischief. 23. Why do you argue with us about that of which you have no knowledge? 24. Do you argue with us about God? 25. They will indeed turn them aside from the way. 26. How many a sign is there in the heavens and the earth that they pass by!

Exercise Twenty-Seven

1. Who but God can forgive sins? 2. They remember God only a little. 3. He is simply a clear warner. 4. Most of them follow only conjecture. 5. None of your people will believe unless they are already believers. 6. We shall postpone it only to a term that will be counted. 7. We testify only to that which we know. 8. We never sent any messenger except with the tongue of his people. 9. We did not create the heavens and the earth and all that is between them save with the truth. 10. We are only mortals like you. 11. They have followed him, save for a group of believers. 12. Most of them do not believe in God unless they associate others with Him. 13. They serve only [what they serve] as did their fathers before. 14. We send it down only in a known measure. 15. We have sent before you as messengers only men. 16. The unbelievers say, 'You are only following a man who is bewitched.' 17. We come down only by command of your Lord. 18. They are only like animals. 19. He tarried amongst them for a thousand years all but fifty years. 20. Only those with knowledge will understand them. 21. No female becomes pregnant or gives birth except with His knowledge. 22. There is no settlement but We shall destroy it before the Day of Resurrection. 23. None but the sinners eat it. 24. This is simply a lie. 25. Muḥammad is only a messenger. 26. There is no beast on the earth but that its sustenance depends on God.

Exercise Twenty-Eight

1. Do not fear nor grieve. 2. Have they not travelled in the land? 3. It is evil as a resting place. 4. What they have been doing is evil. 5. You will wish [so] only if God wishes. 6. We make Our mercy reach those whom We wish. 7. A painful torment will befall those of them who disbelieve. 8. They came to them with the clear proofs. 9. Have you come to us that

we should serve God alone? 10. Do you want to kill me as you killed a soul yesterday? 11. He has desired only the present life. 12. He wanted their Lord to give the two of them [one] better than him in exchange. 13. They could not hear a sound. 14. They said, 'We hear and obey.' 15. We will obey you in some of the affair. 16. [One] of His signs is that heaven stands. 17. Let a party of them stand with you. 18. We shall not assign any weight to them on the Day of Resurrection. 19. They shall taste neither cool nor drink in it. 20. It tasted the mischief of its affair. 21. He answers those who believe and do righteous deeds. 22. So his Lord answered him and turned their wives from him. 23. He will say, 'What answer did you give to the messengers?' 24. I have comprehended what you have not comprehended.

Exercise Twenty-Nine

1. Moses said to his people, 'O my people, you have done wrong.' 2. 'O Mary, God gives you good news of a word from Him. 3. O Moses, we will never enter it. 4. Children of Adam! We have sent down to you clothing. 5. 'O Noah, he is not one of your family.' 6. O people of the Scripture, why do you not believe in God's signs? 7. 'O David, We have made you a viceroy in the earth. 8. O My servants who believe, My land is wide. 9. 'O people of the book, you have no base.' 10. O Jesus, son of Mary, is your Lord able to send a table down to us? 11. O my people, there is no error in me. 12. He said, 'O my people, I conveyed to you a message of my Lord.' 13. O people of the Scripture, why do you turn those who believe from God's way? 14. My people, I am not asking you for any payment for this. 15. O my father, why do you worship something that cannot hear. 16. O my people, is my clan stronger against you than God? 17. O my people, these are my daughters. 18. Moses said, 'O Pharaoh, I am a messenger from the Lord of created beings.' 19. They said, 'O Noah, you have disputed with us, and disputed much with us.' 20. O people, a proof has come to you from your Lord. 21. O Messenger, let not those who vie with one another in unbelief grieve you. 22. O men, you are the ones who are in need of God. 23. O you who believe why do you say what you do not do? 24. O you who have disbelieved, make no excuses for yourselves today.

Exercise Thirty

1. She brought him to her own folk. 2. The hour will come upon them suddenly when they are unaware. 3. How many clear signs we gave them!

4. They perform prayer and pay the *zakāt*. 5. I see you and your people in manifest error. 6. Have you considered the water that you drink? 7. Those [can] hope for God's mercy. 8. I have summoned my people night and day. 9. God will reward the thankful. 10. He created you from clay and then fixed a term. 11. They walk on the earth. 12. He eats food and walks round the markets. 13. Today We forget them as they forgot that they would meet this day of theirs. 14. They fear no one else apart from God. 15. He has named you 'those who surrender'. 16. The angels called out to him whilst he was standing praying. 17. We guided them to a straight path. 18. God does not guide those who are lying and ungrateful. 19. He flung down his staff. 20. We will cast terror into the hearts of those who disbelieve. 21. We saved those who believed and were god-fearing. 22. He has fulfilled his covenant and feared God. 23. Have you considered the person who turns his back and gives little? 24. He turned from them and said, 'O my people, I conveyed to you the messages of my Lord.' 25. Then a group of them turns away and moves aside.

Exercise Thirty-One

1. To each one of them a sixth. 2. There is no private meeting of three men but He is the fourth of them. 3. The fourth of them [was] their dog. 4. You [receive] a quarter of what they leave. 5. A third [goes] to his mother. 6. Theirs is two-thirds of what he leaves. 7. Unbelievers are those who say, 'God is the third of three.' 8. I am first among the servants. 9. Do not be the first to disbelieve it. 10. This is in the ancient (first) scrolls. 11. Did not We destroy the first generations? 12. The promise of the first of the two came to pass. 13. They will say, 'Seven, and their dog the eighth of them.' 14. They receive one eighth of what you leave. 15. They have not attained a tenth of what we bestowed on them. 16. Your Lord knows that you stay up close to two-thirds of the night or a half or a third of it. 17. To you is half of what your wives leave. 18. God is pleased with them, and they with Him. 19. He showed him the greatest sign. 20. Thus God will show them their works. 21. Is it not sufficient for them that We have sent down to you the Book? 22. God is sufficient as a friend/protector. 23. God is a sufficient witness between you and us. 24. It is no sin for you to seek a bounty from your Lord.

Exercise Thirty-Two

1. Turn away from them and put your trust in God. 2. Take firm hold of what We have given you, and remember what is in it. 3. Dwell in

the Garden with your wife, and the two of you eat from it. 4. Order your people to pray and be steadfast in it. 5. Believe in God and His messenger. 6. Give the hypocrites the good tidings that they will have a painful doom. 7. Seek (f. s.) forgiveness for your sin. 8. Make your houses places to turn to, and perform prayer. 9. Satan is an enemy for you, so treat him as an enemy. 10. Warn your people before a painful punishment comes upon them. 11. Fear (pl.) God and be with the truthful. 12. O my Lord, make this a secure land and provide some of its fruits as sustenance for its people. 13. Refer it to God and the messenger. 14. Show me what part of the earth they have created. 15. Arise and warn. 16. Say, 'Enjoy your ingratitude for a little. You are one of the companions of the Fire.' 17. He said, 'My Lord, help me against the people who wreak mischief.' 18. Give us full measure and be charitable to us. 19. Do what you will. He is the Observer of what you do. 20. Expel the family of Lot from your settlement. 21. Bring a *sūra* like it, and call your witnesses. 22. They say, 'Peace be upon you. Enter the garden as a recompense for what you used to do.' 23. Say, 'Obey God and the Messenger.' 24. Endure patiently what they say, and withdraw from them politely. 25. Say, 'Journey in the land and see how He originated creation.'

Exercise Thirty-Three

1. They have been expelled from their homes. 2. They were seized from a nearby place. 3. You have been given only little knowledge. 4. We will not believe till we are given the same as God's messengers are given. 5. The prophets and witnesses are brought, and judgement will be decided between them. 6. You will be summoned against a people of great might. 7. Their faces were covered with pieces of night. 8. Then every soul will be paid in full what it has earned, and they will not be wronged. 9. We and our forefathers were promised this previously. 10. They see what they are promised. 11. It has been revealed to us that torment will be for those who deny the truth and turn their backs. 12. There was mockery of messengers before you. 13. Will any be destroyed apart from the people who do wrong? 14. Say, 'We believe in that which has been revealed to us.' 15. They will not be helped. 16. You do not do wrong, and you are not wronged. 17. They will be given sustenance without reckoning in it. 18. These are our goods returned to us. 19. Do not eat of that over which God's name has not been mentioned. 20. Are you being recompensed except for what you used to earn? 21. This is a message for men, that they may be warned by

it. 22. Those are called to from afar. 23. Messengers before you were said to lie, who came with the clear signs. 24. I convey to you that with which I have been sent. 25. There will be a blast on the trumpet. 26. Protect yourselves from the Fire that has been prepared for the unbelievers. 27. They thought that they are engulfed. 28. That is a thing to be desired.

Exercise Thirty-Four

1. On the day when their tongues testify against them. 2. On the day when We round them all up. 3. On the day that He created the heavens and the earth. 4. The day when they hear the Shout. 5. On a day when they are tormented over the fire. 6. On the day when there is a blast on the trumpet. 7. On the day when a man shall flee from his brother. 8. Our father is a very old man. 9. The hands of Abū Lahab will perish. 10. Return to your father and say, 'O our father, your son stole.' 11. He said to his father and his people, 'What are you worshipping?' 12. Your father was not a wicked man. 13. His parents were believers. 14. He caused your parents to leave the Garden. 15. Their brother Noah said to them, 'Will you not protect yourselves?' 16. We sent Moses and his brother Aaron with Our signs. 17. Shall I entrust him to you in any other way than I entrusted his brother to you? 18. Set things right between your two brothers. 19. Your Lord is wide in His forgiveness. 20. God is strong and severe in punishment. 21. The night does not outstrip the day. 22. The angels are stretching out their hands. 23. Today We seal their mouths. 24. O you who believe, do not enter houses other than your own. 25. Shall I seek any judge other than God? 26. You shall have an unbroken reward. 27. Peace be upon me the day I was born and the day that I die.

Exercise Thirty-Five

1. Are those who are hurled into the Fire better or those who come in security on the Day of Resurrection? 2. The Shout took them in the morning. 3. They came to Him abject. 4. So serve God, devoting [your] religion solely to him. 5. They fell down before him, prostrating themselves. 6. No one will overcome you today. 7. The only refuge from God is to turn to him. 8. The only knowledge we have is what You have taught us. 9. It is not a sin for you in what you may agree to with one another. 10. Let there be no wrangling during the Pilgrimage. 11. They have increased in their unbelief. 12. Say, 'God is swifter in plotting.' 13. God is stronger in might. 14. Which of them is best (better)

in deed. 15. They devise trickery. 16. They did other work. 17. You love wealth greatly. 18. It was not us you served. 19. We shall make provision for you and them. 20. Do not slay your children through fear of poverty. 21. You spend only to seek God's face. 22. [All] glory belongs to God. 23. He called on his Lord, turning to Him in penitence. 24. He departed in anger. 25. Return to your Lord, pleased and pleasing. 26. We gathered them together. 27. There is no doubt that theirs will be the Fire. 28. He will bring you forth [again].

Exercise Thirty-Six

1. If you are in doubt about what We have sent down to Our servant, then bring a *sūra* like it. 2. If you entrust him with a dinar, he will not pay it back to you. 3. If they say that you lie, messengers before you were said to lie. 4. If you avoid the serious things that you are forbidden, We will remit your evil deeds from you. 5. If you turn from them, they will do you no harm. 6. If they argue with you, say, 'God is well aware of what you are doing.' 7. If we revert, we shall be wrongdoers. 8. If We wish, We drown them. 9. Throw him into the recesses of the pit, and some caravan will pick him out. 10. Shake the trunk of the palm-tree towards you, and it will cause ripe dates to fall down to you. 11. Send him with us tomorrow, and he can enjoy himself and play. 12. Let her eat in God's land. 13. That is better for you, did you but know it. 14. Bring your proof, if you tell the truth. 15. When he turns away, he strives to make mischief in the land. 16. When you have performed prayer, remember God, standing or sitting. 17. When their term comes, they shall not delay it an hour or advance it an hour. 18. They fall down on their chins in prostration when it is recited to them. 19. Had God wished, He could have taken their hearing. 20. If they could find a place to flee to, or caves or a hiding place, they would turn straight for it. 21. You remained but a little, if you only knew. 22. Had they been with us, they would not have died [or] been slain. 23. Which of God's signs will you deny? 24. He is with them, wherever they may be. 25. Whenever they desire to leave it, they will be returned into it. 26. He who does a righteous deed does so for himself and he who does wrong does so against himself. 27. If you could see when the wrongdoers are in the floods of death. 28. Have you considered if it is from God and you do not believe in it? 29. He who purifies himself will prosper. 30. If there is a good deed He will double it.

Exercise Thirty-Seven

1. Beware of them lest they tempt you away from some of what God has sent down to you. 2. God admonishes you never to repeat the like of that. 3. I take refuge with God from being among the ignorant. 4. He has cast on to the earth firm mountains, lest it sway with you. 5. He holds back the heaven from falling on to the earth. 6. Do the people of the settlements feel secure that Our might will not come upon them? 7. We sent Noah to his people, saying 'Warn your people before a painful punishment comes upon them.' 8. We suggested to Moses, 'Strike the sea with your staff.' 9. Your Lord gave a message to the bees, 'Take for yourselves houses in the mountains.' 10. We called out to him, 'O Abraham, you have made [your] vision come true. 11. They cried out to one another in the morning, 'Go early to your field.' 12. A *sūra* has been sent down, saying, 'Believe in God and strive with His Messenger.' 13. The conclusion of their call will be, 'Praise belongs to God, Lord of created beings.' 14. He frowned and turned away, because the blind man came to him. 15. Shall We ignore you because you have been a profligate people? 16. Do not obey every contemptible swearer... because he has wealth and sons. 17. The mountains fall in ruins, because they have ascribed a son to the Merciful. 18. This is because your Lord would not destroy the settlements wrongfully. 19. Perhaps you are forsaking part of what is revealed to you... because they say. 20. He shows you His signs, so that you may understand. 21. Strive in His way so that you may prosper. 22. We have sent down to you the reminder that you may make clear to men what has been sent down to them and that they may reflect. 23. We have made it an Arabic recitation, so that you may understand. 24. It may be that you love a thing which is bad for you. 25. Perhaps your Lord will destroy your enemy. 26. It may be that God will bring them all to me. 27. Perhaps I shall not be unfortunate in my prayer to my Lord.

Exercise Thirty-Eight

1. Those who do not believe will continue to be in doubt. 2. Their calls continued. 3. You will continue to observe. 4. His face stayed black. 5. You will still jest. 6. They kept on mounting into it. 7. As long as they remained in them. 8. As long as you are in the sacred state. 9. I was a witness over them as long as I was among them. 10. They became repentant. 11. By His blessing you became brothers. 12. You are now among the losers. 13. The lightning almost snatches away their sight.

14. Its oil almost glows, even though no fire has touched it. 15. He scarcely makes [things] clear. 16. They scarcely understand any tidings. 17. Why does God not speak to us? 18. Why has an angel been not sent down to him? 19. O our Lord, why did You not send us a messenger? 20. Why do you not give thanks? 21. Why do you not seek forgiveness from God? 22. But for the bounty of your Lord to you and His mercy, you would have been among the losers. 23. Had it not been for an ordinance from God that has gone before, a mighty torment would have touched you on account of what you took. 24. But for a stated term the torment would have come to them. 25. But for the blessing of my Lord I would have been one of those haled [into Hell].

Exercise Thirty-Nine

1. Woe to the ungrateful because of the fire. 2. Woe on that day to those who deny the truth. 3. Woe to those who write the book with their own hands and then say, 'This is from God'. 4. Woe to those who associate partners with God. 5. Woe on us. We have been heedless of this. 6. Would that I had not associated anyone with my Lord. 7. Would that we had obeyed God! 8. Would that my people knew! 9. The unbeliever will say, 'Would that I were dust.' 10. No! I swear by this settlement. 11. God bears witness that they are liars. 12. They said, 'By God, you are in your ancient error.' 13. By God, our Lord, we did not associate others with God.' 14. By your Lord, We shall question them all. 15. By your Lord, We shall round them up. 16. By my Lord, it will certainly come to you. 17. If you ask them who created them, they will say, 'God'. 18. God has written, 'I shall conquer, along with My messengers.' 19. We will expel you from our land. 20. He will indeed gather you to the Day of Resurrection. 21. Let not Satan turn you aside. 22. Do not reckon that God is heedless of what the wrongdoers do. 23. If you do not desist, I shall surely stone you. 24. If He delivers us from this, we shall indeed be among the thankful. 25. If Satan causes you to forget, do not sit, after the reminder, with the people who do wrong. 26. Children of Adam! Let not Satan tempt you. 27. If my Lord does not guide me, I shall be one of the people who go astray. 28. Let not those who have no certainty make you unsteady.

Exercise Forty

1. God would not wrong them. 2. God is not one to leave the believers in the state in which you are. 3. God would never lead a people astray after

He had guided them. 4. God is not one to inform you of the unseen. 5. They should not enter them. 6. No soul may die except by God's permission. 7. It is not for a messenger to bring a sign save with God's leave. 8. A believer should not kill a believer. 9. It is not for the polytheists to visit God's places of worship. 10. It is not for us to bring you any authority. 11. It [has not been granted] to any mortal to be spoken to by God except by revelation. 12. It is not for any believing man or woman to have any choice in the affair. 13. It is not for you to annoy God's Messenger. 14. How excellent a helper! 15. Excellent is the reward of those who labour. 16. Excellent is the admonition which He gives you. 17. What they have been doing is truly evil. 18. It is an evil way. 19. How evil a drink; how evil a resting-place. 20. They bought a small gain with it. Evil is what they purchase. 21. What they have been doing is truly evil. 22. Evil is the likeness of the people who deny the truth of God's signs. 23. Their lodging will be the Fire. How evil is the lodging of the wrongdoers. 24. His abode is Hell—evil is [his] journey's end. 25. How excellent a servant!

Technical Terms

It is assumed that the reader will know the names of the letters of the Arabic alphabet.

ENGLISH

ACCUSATIVE: the Arabic case that indicates the direct object (and has many other uses).

ACTIVE: voice of the verb in which the subject performs the action of or is in the state of the verb.

ADJECTIVE: a word that gives information about a noun.

ADVERB: a word that gives information about a verb or adjective.

ANTECEDENT: the noun to which a pronoun refers back—an important feature in **RELATIVE SENTENCES**.

ASSONANCE: similarity of vowel and/or consonant at the end of a phrase.

CASE: the ending which indicates the role of a noun or its equivalent.

CLAUSE: a significant section of a sentence.

COLLECTIVE: a noun that is singular in form but refers to a group.

CONDITIONAL SENTENCES: sentences containing a clause introduced by 'if' or its equivalent.

CONJUGATION: the way in which verb forms change to show person, number and tense.

CONJUNCTION: a particle that joins sentences or clauses.

CO-ORDINATING CONJUNCTION: a particle, such as 'and', that joins two sentences.

SUBORDINATING CONJUNCTION: a particle, such as 'because' or 'when', that introduces a clause that would not normally be able to stand on its own.

CONTRACTION: in a **DOUBLED VERB** the dropping of a short vowel to enable the final two radicals to be pronounced together.

DECLENSION: the way in which nouns change to show number and case.

DEFINITE: an Arabic word is made definite by the prefixing of the definite article or by the attachment of a following genitive.

DEMONSTRATIVE: pronoun or adjective such as 'this' and 'that'.

DERIVED FORMS: forms of the verb other than the basic first form.

DUAL: see **NUMBER**.

ELATIVE: the form used in Arabic to express the English comparative and superlative.

ELLIPSE: the omission of a word or phrase.

ENERGETIC: special emphatic form of the verb, formed from the **JUSSIVE**.

EXCEPTIVE: a sentence in which a phrase or clause is introduced by 'except'.

FEMININE: one of the two **GENDERS** in Arabic.

GENDER: in this book **GENDER** refers to grammatical gender, which may or may not correspond to natural gender.

GENITIVE: the case used in Arabic to denote possession or to follow a preposition.

IDIOM: expression that is peculiar to a language and cannot be translated literally.

IMPERATIVE: the form of the verb used to give commands.

IMPERFECT: the Arabic tense that has the role of the English present or future.

IMPERFECT INDICATIVE: the imperfect mood indicating fact.

INDECLINABLE: a noun or pronoun that does not change for case.

INDEFINITE: a noun or adjective that is not definite.

INDIRECT QUESTION: a question that occurs after a verb, e.g. 'he asked where the book was'.

INFLECTED: having case endings, as opposed to **INDECLINABLE**.

INFIX: a syllable that is inserted into a root, in particular the *tā'* of the 8th form.

INTERROGATIVE: a particle or sentence of enquiry.

INTRANSITIVE: a verb that cannot take a **DIRECT OBJECT**.

JUSSIVE: the imperfect mood indicating indirect commands etc.

MASCULINE: one of the two **GENDERS** in Arabic.

NEGATION: making a word, phrase or clause negative.

NOMINAL SENTENCE: an Arabic sentence that does not have a verb.

NOMINATIVE: the Arabic case that indicates the subject/predicate of a sentence.

NOUN: words that name persons and things etc.

NUMBER: indication of whether a noun etc. represents 'one' (singular), 'two' (dual), or 'more than two' (plural).

NUMERALS, NUMBERS: the counting system of a language.

CARDINAL NUMBERS: numbers used for quantity.

ORDINAL NUMBERS: numbers used for order.

OBJECT: the noun or pronoun affected by the operation of the verb.

DIRECT OBJECT: an object put in the Arabic ACCUSATIVE.

OTIOSE: redundant, not having any obvious function.

PARTICLE: an uninflected function word.

PARTICIPLE: a verbal adjective.

PASSIVE: voice of the verb in which the subject is the recipient of the action of the verb.

PERFECT: verb tense that refers to a completed action or state in the past. The Arabic perfect covers various English tenses, e.g. 'she wrote', 'she did write', 'she has written'.

PLUPERFECT: the past of the past tense, e.g. 'she had written'.

PLURAL: see NUMBER.

PREDICATE: in Arabic the second half of a non-verbal sentence.

PREFIX: a syllable or syllables placed at the beginning of a word.

PREPOSITION: particle placed before a noun or pronoun to indicate position, time, direction etc.

PRONOUN: word that stands in place of a noun, such as 'me', 'this', 'who'.

PROSTHETIC: term used to describe a temporary vowel placed at the beginning of a word.

RADICALS: the root letters of Arabic words, other than particles, normally three or four in number.

RELATIVE SENTENCE: sentence or clause giving information about the ANTECEDENT.

SINGULAR: see NUMBER.

SUBJECT: the noun or pronoun that performs the action of the verb or is described by its state, or is followed by a non-verbal predicate.

SUBJUNCTIVE: the imperfect mood suggesting possibility.

SUFFIX: a syllable or syllables placed at the end of a word.

TENSE: the time of action represented in a verb form.

TRANSITIVE: a verb that takes a **DIRECT OBJECT**.

VERB: word expressing the action performed or state experienced by the subject of a sentence.

TRILITERAL VERB: a verb with three radicals.

QUADRILITERAL VERB: a verb with four radicals.

ASSIMILATED VERB: a verb with *wāw* or *yā'* as its first radical.

DOUBLED VERB: a verb with the same letter as second and third radicals.

HOLLOW VERB: a verb with *wāw* or *yā'* as its second radical.

DEFECTIVE VERB: a verb with *wāw* or *yā'* as its second radical.

AUXILIARY VERB: in Arabic an auxiliary verb combines with another verb to help form its **TENSE** or state. The basic auxiliary in Arabic is *kāna*.

VOCATIVE: the form used to introduce direct address.

ARABIC

أَخَوَات كَان [akhawāt kāna]: 'the sisters of kāna', verbs related to *kāna*.

أَلِف مَقْصُورَة [alif maqsūra]: *alif* written in the form of a *yā'* at the end of a word.

أَنَّ [an il-mufasssira]: the particle *an* when it introduces direct speech.

بِسْمَلَة [basmala]: the formula *bi-smi llāhi l-raḥmāni l-raḥīmi*.

تَاء مَرْبُوطَة [tā' marbūṭa]: the form of *tā'* used at the end of a noun or adjective to show the feminine ending, written as a *hā'* with two dots.

تَاء مَفْتُوحَة [tā' maftūḥa]: *tā'* written normally.

التَّمْيِيز [tamyīz]: the ACCUSATIVE of specification.

تَوْنِين [tanwīn]: the adding of an *n* sound to indicate that a noun or adjective is indefinite.

الْجَوَاب [al-jawāb]: the main clause in a conditional sentence.

أَلْحُرُوفُ الشَّمْسِيَّة [al-ḥurūf al-shamsiyya]: 'the sun letters', letters of the alphabet to which the definite article is assimilated.

أَلْحُرُوفُ الْقَمَرِيَّة [al-ḥurūf al-qamariyya]: 'the moon letters', letters of the alphabet to which the definite article is not assimilated.

الْحَال [al-ḥāl]: the ACCUSATIVE of circumstance.

سُكُون [sukūn]: the sign indicating that a consonant does not have a vowel.

شَدَّة [shadda]: the sign for a doubled consonant.

الشَّرْط [al-sharṭ]: the conditional clause in a conditional sentence.

ضَمِيرُ الْفَضْلِ [ḍamīr al-faṣl]: the pronoun used to separate phrases.

صَمَّة [ḍamma]: the vowel sign for *u*.

إِصَافَة [idāfa]: annexation, the construct state, the attachment of a GENITIVE of possession.

فَتْحَة [faṭḥa]: the vowel sign for *a*.

كَسْرَة [kasra]: the vowel sign for *i*.

لَا لِتَنْفِي الْجِنْسِ [lā li-nafyi l-jinsi]: the use of *lā* to negate a category.

مَا الْجَبَازِيَّةُ [mā l-ḥijāziyya]: Ḥijāzī *mā*, the negative *mā* that is followed by *bi-* and the GENITIVE or by the ACCUSATIVE.

الْمَاضِي [al-māḍī]: the basic Arabic past TENSE.

مُضَدَّر [maṣḍar]: the Arabic equivalent of the verbal noun.

مُضَدَّر مِيمِي [maṣḍar mīmī]: a *maṣḍar* that begins with a prefixed *mīm*.

الْمُضَارِع [al-muḍāriʿ]: the imperfect TENSE.

الْمُضَارِعُ الْمَرْفُوع [al-muḍāriʿ al-marfūʿ]: the indicative mood of the imperfect TENSE.

مَفْعُولٌ مُطْلَق [mafʿūl muṭlaq]: the cognate or absolute ACCUSATIVE.

الْمَفْعُولُ لَهُ [mafʿūl lahu]: the ACCUSATIVE of cause.

هَمْزَة [hamza]: the glottal stop sound.

هَمْزَة الْوَضَل [hamzat al-waṣl]: the temporary vowel prefixed to words beginning with a consonant without a vowel, always displaced by the final consonant of a previous word.

هَمْزَة الْقَطْع [hamzat al-qaṭʿ]: the true glottal stop.

وَإِوَالِ الْقَسَمِ [wāw al-qasam]: the particle *wa-* followed by the GENITIVE to introduce an oath.

وَضَلَة [waṣla]: the sign showing that a *hamzat al-waṣl* vowel has been removed.

General Vocabulary

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أَبَدًا		ever
[نَاقَةٌ]		إِبِلٌ she-camels
ابْنٌ		بَنُونَ / أَبْنَاءُ son
ابْنَةٌ		بَنَاتٌ daughter
أَبٌ		آبَاءُ father
أَتَى	يَأْتِي	إِثْنَانٌ to come
آتَى	يُؤْتِي	إِيتَاءٌ to give
آثَرُ	يُؤَثِّرُ	إِيْتَارٌ to prefer
أَثَرٌ		آثَارٌ track; effect
إِثْمٌ		آثَامٌ sin
أَجْرٌ		أُجُورٌ reward
أَجَلٌ		أَجَالٌ term
أَخَذَ	يَأْخُذُ	أَخَذَ to take, seize
اِتَّخَذَ	يَتَّخِذُ	اِتَّخَذَ to take, adopt
أَخَّرَ	يُؤَخِّرُ	تَأَخِيرٌ to defer
اِسْتَأْخَرَ	يَسْتَأْخِرُ	اِسْتِئْخَارٌ to postpone
آخِرٌ		آخِرُونَ last, [next]
آخَرُ		آخَرُونَ other

أُخْرَى f.		أُخْرُ	other
أَخْ		إِخْوَانٌ / إِخْوَةٌ	brother
أَذِنَ	يَأْذُنُ	إِذْنٌ	to permit, allow
إِسْتَأْذَنَ	يَسْتَأْذِنُ	إِسْتِئْذَانٌ	to seek permission
إِذْنٌ			permission
أَذَى	يُؤْذِي	إِذَاءٌ	to hurt, vex
أَرْضٌ		أَرْضٌ	earth
أَسْفَ			grief
أُسْوَةٌ			example
أَصْلٌ		أُصُولٌ	root
أَفَقٌ		أَفَاقٌ	horizon
إِفْكٌ			lie
أَلِيمٌ			painful
إِلَآهٌ		آِلَهَةٌ	a god
أَلِلهُ			God
[أُولَا]		أُولُو	possessors of
إِيتَلَى	يَأْتَلِي	إِيتِلَاءٌ	to swear
إِلَى			to (motion)
أُمٌّ		أُمّهَاتٌ	mother
أُمَّةٌ		أُمَّةٌ	community
أَمَرَ	يَأْمُرُ	أَمْرٌ	to order
أَمْرٌ		أُمُورٌ	affair, command

أَمِنْ	يَأْمَنْ	أَمَّنْ	to be secure; to trust in
أَمَرَ	يُؤْمِنُ	إِيمَانٌ	to believe
أَمِينٌ			faithful, secure
مُؤْمِنٌ		s.p.	believer
f. أَنْثَى		إِنَاثٌ	female
أَنْسَ	يُؤْنِسُ	إِنْيَاسٌ	to see
إِنْسَانٌ		النَّاسُ	man; (p.) people
أَهْلٌ		أَهْلُونَ / أَهَالٍ	people, family
أَوَّلٌ	f. أُولَى	أَوَّلُونَ	first, the ancient
آلٌ			family
[ذُو]		أُولُو	possessors of
مَأْوَى			shelter, refuge
آيَةٌ		آيَاتٌ	sign, verse

ب

بِ			in, at, by
بَأْسٌ			might
بَحْرٌ		بَحَارٌ	sea
بَدَأُ	يَبْدَأُ	بَدْءٌ	to begin
يَبْدَأُ			haste, anticipation
أَبْدَلَ	يُبْدِلُ	إِبْدَالٌ	to give in exchange
بَدَلٌ			exchange
بَرٌّ			land
بَرٌّ		أَبْرَارٌ	pious, god-fearing

بَرَحَ	يَذْخُ	بَرَحَ	to leave
بَرْدٌ			cold (noun)
بَرْقٌ			lightning
تَبَارَكَ	يَتَبَارَكُ	تَبَارَكَ	to be blessed
بُرْهَانٌ		بَرَاهِينُ	proof
بَسَطَ	يَبْسُطُ	بَسَطَ	to spread, extend
مَبْسُوطٌ			spread, extended
بَشَّرَ	يُبَشِّرُ	تَبَشِيرٌ	to bring good news
بَشْرٌ			(s.) human being; (pl.) men, human beings
بَشِيرٌ			bringer of good news
أَبْصَرَ	يُنْصِرُ	إِنْصَارٌ	(+bi-) to see, observe
بَصَرٌ		أَبْصَارٌ	sight; eye
بَصِيرٌ			observant, seeing
بِضَاعَةٌ		بَضَائِعُ	merchandise
بَطْشٌ			might
بَطَلَ	يَنْطُلُ	بَطْلٌ	to be worthless
بَاطِلٌ			false, worthless
بَعَثَ	يَبْعَثُ	بَعَثَ	to send, raise
بَعِيدٌ			distant
بَعْدَ			after (preposition)
بَعْدَ إِذٍ			after (conjunction)
بَغْتَةً			suddenly
بَغَى	يَنْغِي	بَغَى	to outrage; to seek
إِتْبَغَى	يُتْبَغَى	إِتْبَغَاءٌ	to seek
بَقَرَةٌ		s.p.	cow

أَبْقَى		[بَاقٍ]	more lasting
بَلَدٌ		بِلَادٌ	town, settlement
بَلَغَ	يَبْلُغُ	بُلُوغٌ	to reach
بَلَّغَ	يَبْلِغُ	تَبْلِيغٌ	to convey
أَبْلَغَ	يُبْلِغُ	إِبْلَاغٌ	to convey
بَلَاغٌ			message, conveyance
ابْنٌ		بُنُونَ / أَبْنَاءُ	son
بَابٌ		أَبْوَابٌ	door
بَيْتٌ		بُيُوتٌ	house
أَبْيَضُ	f. بَيْضَاءُ	بَيْضٌ	white
بَاعَ	يَبِيعُ	بَيْعٌ	to sell
بَايَعَ	يُبَايِعُ	مُبَايَعَةٌ	to do allegiance to
يَبِّنُ	يُبَيِّنُ	تَبْيَانٌ	to make clear
أَبَانَ	يُبينُ	إِبَانَةٌ	to make clear
تَبَيَّنَ	يَتَبَيَّنُ	تَبَيُّنٌ	to become clear
بَيِّنَةٌ		s.p.	clear proof
بَيْنٌ			between, among
مُبِينٌ			clear

ت

تَبَّ			to wither, perish
تَابُوتٌ			ark, casket
تَبِعَ	يَتَّبِعُ	تَبَعٌ	to follow
اتَّبَعَ	يَتَّبِعُ	إِتِّبَاعٌ	to follow
تَحْتُ			beneath

تُرَابٌ			earth, dust
تَرَكَ	يَتْرُكُ	تَرَكُ	to leave
تَلَا	يَتْلُو	تِلَاوَةٌ	to recite
تَوَّابٌ		s.p.	s. relenting, p. repenting

ث

ثُمَّ			then
ثَمَرَةٌ		s.p.	fruit
ثَمَنٌ			price, gain
مَثْوًى			lodging

ج

حُبٌّ			pit
جَائِمٌ		s.p.	crouching
جَادَلُ	يُجَادِلُ	مُجَادَلَةٌ	to dispute, contend with
جَدَلٌ			contention
جَذَعٌ			trunk of a palm-tree
لَا جَرَمَ			undoubtedly, certainly
مُحْرِمٌ		s.p.	sinner
جَارِيَةٌ		جَوَارٍ	ship (young woman)
جَزَى	يَجْزِي	جَزَاءٌ	to requite
جَزَاءٌ			recompense, reward
جَعَلَ	يَجْعَلُ	جَعْلٌ	to make, assign, appoint
جِلْدَةٌ			lash, stripe

جَمٌّ			much	
جَمَعَ	يَجْمَعُ	جَمَعَ	to gather, collect	
جَمِيعٌ			all	
أَجْمَعُ		s.p.	all	
جَمْعٌ			meeting, place	meeting-place
جِنٌّ			<i>Jinn</i>	
جَنَّةٌ		s.p.	garden	
مَجْنُونٌ		s.p.	possessed (by <i>Jinn</i>)	
إِخْتَنَبَ	يُخْتَنَبُ	إِجْتَنَابٌ	to avoid	
بُخْنَاخٌ			sin	
بَاهِدٌ	يُجَاهِدُ	جِهَادٌ	to strive	
بَاهِلٌ		s.p.	ignorant	
أَجَابَ	يُجِيبُ	جَوَابٌ	to answer	
إِسْتَجَابَ	يَسْتَجِيبُ	جَوَابٌ	to answer	
جَاءَ	يَجِيءُ		to come	

ح

أَحَبُّ	يُحِبُّ	حُبٌّ	to love	
حَبٌّ		حُبُوبٌ	grain	
حَبِطَ	يَحْبُطُ	حُبُوطٌ	to be useless	
حَاجٌ	يُحَاجُّ	حِجَابٌ	to argue about (<i>fi</i>)	
حُجَّةٌ		s.p.	proof	
حِجَّةٌ		حِجَجٌ	year	
حِجَابٌ			obstacle, partition	
حِجَارَةٌ		حَجَرٌ	stone	
حَدِيدٌ			iron	

حَرْثٌ			tillage
حَرْجٌ			trouble, difficulty
حَرَمٌ	يُحَرِّمُ	تَحْرِيمٌ	to forbid, prohibit
حَرَامٌ		حُرْمٌ	forbidden, sacred, in the sacred state
حِزْبٌ		أَحْزَابٌ	party
حِزَنٌ	يَحْزَنُ	حُزْنٌ	to be sad
حِسْبٌ	يَحْسِبُ	مَحْسَبَةٌ	to think, reckon
حَسْبٌ			reckoning
حِسَابٌ			reckoning
حَسْرَةٌ			sorrow, anguish
أَحْسَنُ	يُحْسِنُ	إِحْسَانٌ	to do good
حَسَنٌ			fine, good
حَشْرٌ	يَحْشُرُ	حَشْرٌ	to round up
مُخَضَّرٌ		s.p.	brought forward
حُفْرَةٌ			pit
حِفْظٌ	يَحْفَظُ	حِفْظٌ	to guard, preserve, keep
حَفِيطٌ			guardian
حَقٌّ			truth; true
حَكَمٌ	يَحْكُمُ	حُكْمٌ	to judge
حَكَمٌ			arbiter
حِكْمَةٌ			wisdom
حُكْمٌ			judgement
أَحَلَّ	يُحِلُّ	إِحْلَالٌ	to make lawful, permit
حَلْفٌ	يَحْلِفُ	حَلْفٌ	to swear

حَلَّافٌ			wont to swear
حُلُمٌ			puberty
حَمْدٌ			praise
حِمَارٌ		حَيْرٌ	donkey
حَمَلٌ	يَحْمِلُ	حَمْلٌ	to carry
حَنِيدٌ			roast
خَنِيفٌ		حُنَفَاءُ	of pure faith
أَحَاطَ	يُحِيطُ	إِحَاطَةً	to surround (+ bi)
حَيَاةٌ / حَيَوَةٌ		حَيَوَاتٌ	life
حَيٌّ		أَحْيَاءُ	alive

خ

خَبِيثٌ			bad
خَيْرٌ			aware
خَتَمٌ	يَخْتَمُ	خَتَمٌ	to seal
خَادِعٌ	يُخَادِعُ	خِدَاعٌ	to try to deceive
		أَخْدَانٌ	companions
خَرَّ	يَخِرُّ	خَرٌّ	to fall
خَرَجَ	يَخْرُجُ	خُرُوجٌ	to go out
خُسْرَانٌ			loss, ruin
خَشِيَ	يَخْشَى	خَشْيَةً	to fear
خَصَفَ	يَخْصِفُ		to cover oneself
خَضِرٌ			green crop
خَطِيئَةٌ		خَطَايَا / s.p.	sin
خَاطِئٌ		s.p.	sinner

أَخْطَأَ	يُخْطِئُ	إِخْطَاءً	to make a mistake
خَطِفَ	يَخْطِفُ	خَطْفٌ	to snatch
إِسْتَحَفَّ	يَسْتَحِفُّ	إِسْتِحْقَافٌ	to make unstable
خَفِيفٌ			light (adj.)
خِلَالٌ			through
خُلْدٌ			eternity
خَالِدٌ		s.p.	remaining in, everlasting
أَخْلَصَ	يُخْلِصُ	إِخْلَاصٌ	to be sincere
خَالِصٌ			pure
إِخْتَلَفَ	يُخْتَلِفُ	إِخْتِلَافٌ	to vary, differ
خَلِيفَةٌ		خُلَفَاءُ	successor
خَلْفٌ			behind
خَلَقَ	يَخْلُقُ	خَلْقٌ	to create
خَافَ	يَخَافُ	خَوْفٌ	to fear
خَيْرٌ			good, better, best
خِيَرَةٌ			choice

د

دَابَّةٌ		دَوَابٌ	beast
دَبَّرَ	يُدَبِّرُ	تَدْبِيرٌ	to manage, arrange
دَاخِرٌ			humble, lowly
دَخَلَ	يَدْخُلُ	دُخُولٌ	to enter
أَدْخَلَ	يُدْخِلُ	إِدْخَالٌ	to cause to enter
مَدْخَلٌ			place to enter
أَذْرَكَ	يُذْرِكُ	إِذْرَاكٌ	to overtake

دَعَى	يَدْعُو	دُعَاءٌ	to call, pray
f. دَارٌ		دُورٌ	abode
مَا دَامَ			as long as
دِينٌ		أَدْيَانٌ	religion

ذ

ذُبَابٌ			fly
ذَبَحَ	يَذْبَحُ	ذَبْحٌ	to sacrifice
ذُرِّيَّةٌ			seed, offspring, de- scendants
ذَقْنٌ		أَذْقَانٌ	chin
ذَكَرَ	يَذْكُرُ	ذِكْرٌ	to mention
ذِكْرَى			remembrance, re- minder
تَذَكَّرَ	يَتَذَكَّرُ	تَذَكُّرٌ	to remember, bear in mind
ذَنْبٌ		ذُنُوبٌ	sin
ذَهَبَ	يَذْهَبُ	ذَهَابٌ	to go away
ذُو		[أُولُو]	possessor of
ذَاقَ	يَذُوقُ	ذَوْقٌ	to taste

ر

رَأَى	يَرَى	رَأْيٌ	to see
أَرَى	يُرِي		to show
f. رُؤْيَا			dream
رَبٌّ		أَرْبَابٌ	lord

رِبَا، الرِّبَا			usury
رَتَعَ	يَزْتَعُ	رَتَعَ	to enjoy oneself
رَجَعَ	يَرْجِعُ	رُجُوعٌ	to return
رِجْسٌ			abomination
رَجُلٌ		رَجَالٌ	man
f. رِجْلٌ		أَرْجُلٌ	foot
رَجَمَ	يَرْجُمُ	رَجْمٌ	to stone
رَجِيمٌ			accursed
رَجَاءٌ	يَرْجُو	رَجَاءٌ	to hope
رَحْمَةٌ			mercy
الرَّحْمَنُ			the Merciful
رَحِيمٌ			compassionate
رَدٌّ	يَرُدُّ	رَدٌّ	to return, restore
مَرَدٌ			turning back
رَزَقَ	يَرْزُقُ	رِزْقٌ	to give sustenance to
رِزْقٌ			sustenance
رَازِقٌ			provider of sustenance
أَرْسَلَ	يُرْسِلُ	إِرسَالٌ	to send
رَسُولٌ		رُسُلٌ	messenger
رِسَالَةٌ		s.p.	message
		رَوَاسٍ	firm mountains
رَضِيَ	يَرْضَى	رِضْوَانٌ /	to be pleased with ('an)
		مَرْضَاةٌ	
رُطَبٌ			fresh, ripe dates
رُغَبٌ			terror
رَفَعَ	يَرْفَعُ	رَفَعَ	to raise

مُرْتَقٍ			resting-place
تَرَقَّبَ	يَتَرَقَّبُ	تَرَقَّبَ	to be vigilant
رَقِيبٌ			watcher
رَكَضٌ	يُرَكَضُ	رَكَضٌ	to run
رُمَّانٌ			pomegranates
رَهَبٌ	يَرْهَبُ	رَهْبَةٌ	to fear
رَهْطٌ			kin; person
رَهِيْنٌ			hostage
أَرَادَ	يُرِيدُ	إِرَادَةٌ	to want
رَيْبٌ			doubt

ز

الزُّبُورُ			the psalms
زَرْعٌ			cultivation; green crops
زَكَّى	يُزَكِّي	تَزَكَّى	to purify, keep pure
تَزَكَّى	يَتَزَكَّى	تَزَلَّ	to be purified
أَزَكَّى		[أَزَكَّى]	purger
زَكَاةٌ / زَكَاةٌ			alms
زَلْزَلَةٌ			earthquake
زَوْجٌ		أَزْوَاجٌ	spouse
زَيْتٌ			oil
زَادَ	يَزِيدُ	زِيَادَةٌ	to increase
إِزْدَادٌ	يُزْدَادُ	إِزْدِيَادٌ	to increase, grow
مَا زَالَ	لَا يَزَالُ		to continue
زَيْنٌ	يُزَيْنُ	تَزْيِينٌ	to cause to seem good

س

سَأَلَ	يَسْأَلُ	سُؤَالَ	to ask
تَسَاءَلُ	يَتَسَاءَلُ	تَسَاوُلُ	to ask one another
سَبَقَ	يَسْبِقُ	سَبْقُ	to precede
f. سَبِيلُ		سُبُلُ	way
سَجَدَ	يَسْجُدُ	سُجُودُ	to prostrate oneself
سَاجِدٌ		سُجَّدٌ	prostrating oneself
مَسْجِدٌ		مَسَاجِدُ	mosque, place of prayer
سَجَنَ	يَسْجُنُ	سَجْنٌ	to imprison
سَحَرَ	يَسْحَرُ	سِحْرٌ	to bewitch
سَحَرٌ			magic
سَاحِرٌ			magician
سَخَّرَ	يُسَخِّرُ	تَسْخِيرٌ	to subject
أَسْخَطَ	يُسْخِطُ	إِسْخَاطٌ	to vex
سِرٌّ		أَسْرَارٌ	secret
سَارَعَ	يُسَارِعُ	سِرَاعٌ	to vie in; race
سَرِيعٌ			quick, swift
أَسْرَفَ	يُسْرِفُ	إِسْرَافٌ	to be prodigal
سَرَقَ	يَسْرِقُ		to steal
سَارِقٌ		s.p.	thief
مُسْتَقَرٌّ			inscribed
سَعَى	يَسْعَى	سَعْيٌ	to strive, move, run
سَفَرٌ			journey
		أَسْفَارٌ	books
سَفَعَ	يَسْفَعُ	سَفْعٌ	to drag

أَسْفَلَ			lower, lowest
سَقَطَ	يَسْقُطُ	سُقُوطٌ	to fall
سَاقَطَ	يُسَاقِطُ	سِقَاطٌ	to cause to fall, bring down
سَقِيمٌ			sick, ill
سَكَتَ	يَسْكُتُ	سُكُوتٌ	to abate; (+ 'an) to leave
سَكَنَ	يَسْكُنُ	سُكُونٌ	to dwell, be at rest
سَكِينَةٌ			tranquility, reassurance
مِسْكِينٌ			poor, destitute
سَلَبَ	يَسْلُبُ	سَلْبٌ	to rob
سُلْطَانٌ			authority, power
أَسْلَمَ	يُسْلِمُ	إِسْلَامٌ	to submit
سَلَامٌ			peace
مُسْلِمٌ		s.p. Muslim	
سَمِعَ	يَسْمَعُ	سَمْعٌ	to hear
أَسْمَعَ	يُسمِعُ	إِسْمَاعٌ	to make hear
إِسْتَمَعَ	يَسْتَمِعُ	إِسْتِمَاعٌ	to listen to
سَمِيعٌ			hearing (adj.)
سَمِينٌ		سِمَانٌ	fat
سَمَّى	يُسَمِّي	تَسْمِيَةٌ	to name
سَمَاءٌ		سَمَاوَاتٌ	heaven, sky
إِسْمٌ		أَسْمَاءٌ	name
سَاءَ	يَسُوءُ	سُوءٌ	to be bad, wrong
أَسَاءَ	يُسيءُ	إِسَاءَةٌ	to do wrong
سُوءٌ			evil, wrong
سَوَاءٌ			evil, corpse

سَيِّئَةٌ		s.p.	evil, ill
أَسْوَدُ	f. سَوْدَاءُ	سُودٌ	black
مُسَوَّدٌ		s.p.	black
سُورَةٌ		سُورٌ	sūra
سَاعَةٌ		s.p.	hour
f. سُوقٌ		أَسْوَاقٌ	market
f. سَاقٌ		سُوقٌ	leg
سَارَ	يَسِيرُ	سَيْرٌ	to journey

ش

شَجَرَةٌ		شَجَرٌ	tree
شَدِيدٌ			strong, severe
شَرٌّ			bad, worse, worst
شَرِبَ	يَشْرَبُ	أَشْرَارٌ	evil men
شَرَابٌ		شُرْبٌ	to drink
أَشْرَكَ	يُشْرِكُ		drink
شَرِيكَ		إِشْرَاكٌ	to ascribe partners to
إِشْتَرَى	يَشْتَرِي	شُرَكَاءُ	partner
سَطَرَ		شِرَاءٌ	to buy
شَيْطَانٌ			towards
شَعَرَ	يَشْعُرُ	شَيَاطِينُ	devil
شَفَا		شُعُورٌ	to feel, perceive
شِقَاقٌ			lip, rim, edge
شَقِيٌّ			dissension
		أَشْقِيَاءُ	unfortunate, wretched

شَكٌّ		شُكُّوكُ	doubt
شَكَرَ	يَشْكُرُ	شُكْرٌ	to thank, be thankful
شَمْسٌ			sun
شِمَالٌ			left, left hand
شَهِدَ	يَشْهَدُ	شَهَادَةٌ	to witness
شَهِيدٌ		شُهِدَاءُ	witness
شَهْرٌ		أَشْهُرٌ	month
شَاءَ	يَشَاءُ		to wish
شَيْءٌ		أَشْيَاءُ	thing
شَيْخٌ		شُيُوخٌ / مَشَايِخُ	old man

ص

أَصْبَحَ	يُصْبِحُ	إِصْبَاحٌ	to become; to be in the morning
صَبَرَ	يَصْبِرُ	صَبْرٌ	to be patient
صَابِرٌ		s.p.	steadfast
صَاحِبٌ		أَصْحَابٌ	companion
		صُحُفٌ	sheets
صَدَّ	يَصُدُّ	صَدٌّ	to block, divert
صَدَقَ	يَصْدُقُ	صِدْقٌ	to tell the truth
تَصَدَّقَ	يَتَصَدَّقُ	تَصَدُّقٌ	to give alms
صَدَقَةٌ		صَدَقَاتٌ	alms
صِدِّيقٌ			truthful
صَرِيحٌ			help
صِرَاطٌ			way, path

صَرَفَ	يَصْرِفُ	صَرَفَ	to turn, turn away (trans.)
أَصْعَدَ	يُصْعِدُ	صُعُودٌ	to ascend
صَغِيرٌ			small
صَاغِرٌ			humbled
أَصْفَرُ	f. صَفْرَاءُ	صَفْرٌ	yellow
أَصْلَحَ	يُصْلِحُ	إِصْلَاحٌ	to put right
صَالِحٌ		s.p.	righteous
صَلَّى	يُصَلِّي	صَلَاةٌ	to pray
صَلَاةٌ / صَلَاةٌ		صَلَوَاتٌ	prayer
أَصَمُّ		صُمٌّ	deaf
صَنَعَ	يَصْنَعُ	صُنْعٌ	to make, work
صَمٌّ		أَصْنَامٌ	idol
أَصَابَ	يُصِيبُ	إِصَابَةٌ	to smite, befall
صُورٌ			trumpet
صُورَةٌ		صُورٌ	form, picture
صَوْمٌ			fast
صَنِعَةٌ			cry
مَصِيرٌ			course, journeying

ض

ضَمَى			forenoon
ضَرَّ	يَضُرُّ	ضُرٌّ	to harm
إِضْطَرَّ	يُضْطَرُّ	إِضْطِرَارٌ	to force, compel
ضَرَبَ	يَضْرِبُ	ضَرْبٌ	to strike, coin
ضَرَبَ	الَّذِي	ضَرَبَ	to neglect

ضَاعَفَ	يُضَاعِفُ	مُضَاعَفَةٌ	to multiply
ضَلَّ	يَضِلُّ	ضَلَالٌ	to stray, err
أَضَلَّ	يُضِلُّ	إِضْلَالٌ	to cause to stray
ضَلَالٌ			error
أَضَاءَ	يُضِيءُ	إِضَاءَةٌ	to give light
ضِيَاءٌ			light
أَصَاعَ	يُضِيعُ	إِضَاعَةٌ	to cause to be wasted
ضَيْفٌ			guest; guests

ط

طَعَامٌ		أَطْعِمَةٌ	food
أَطْلَعُ	يُطْلِعُ	إِطْلَاعٌ	to acquaint
تَطْلُعُ	يَتَطْلَعُ	تَطَلُّعٌ	to study
مَطْلَعٌ		مَطَالِغٌ	rising-place
طَمِعَ	يَطْمَعُ	طَمَعٌ	to desire
أَطَاعَ	يُطِيعُ	إِطَاعَةٌ	to obey
إِسْتِطَاعٌ	يَسْتَطِيعُ	إِسْتِطَاعَةٌ	to be able
طَائِفَةٌ			group, number
طِينٌ			clay

ظ

ظَلَّ	يَظَلُّ		to continue
ظَلَمَ	يَظْلِمُ	ظُلْمٌ	to do wrong
ظَالِمٌ		s.p.	wrong-doer
ظَنَّ	يَظُنُّ	ظَنٌّ	to think

ظَنُّ	ظُنُونٌ	thought, supposition
ظَهَرَ	يُظْهِرُ	to appear

ع

عَبَدَ	يَعْبُدُ	عِبَادَةٌ	to serve, worship
عَبْدٌ		عِبَادٌ	servant, slave
عَبَسَ	يَغْبِسُ		to frown
عِبْرَةٌ			lesson
عَجِبَ	يَعْجَبُ	عَجَبٌ	to wonder
عَجَبٌ			wonder
عَجِيبٌ			amazing, wonderful
عَجَزَ	يُعْجِزُ	عَجْزٌ	to be unable
أَعْجَزَ	يُفْجِزُ	إِعْجَازٌ	to frustrate
عَجِيفٌ		عِجَافٌ	thin
عَجَلَ	يَعْجَلُ	عَجَلٌ	to hasten to
إِسْتَعْجَلَ	يَسْتَعْجِلُ	إِسْتِعْجَالٌ	to hasten
عِجْلٌ			calf
أَعْجَمِيٌّ		s.p.	foreign
عَدَّ	يَعُدُّ	عَدٌّ	to count
أَعَدَّ	يُعِدُّ	إِعْدَادٌ	to prepare, make ready
عَدَدٌ			number
عَذْلٌ			justice
عَدَا	يَعْدُو	عَدُوٌّ	to transgress, turn away, run
عَدُوٌّ		أَعْدَاءٌ	enemy
عَدَاوَةٌ			enmity

عَذَابٌ			punishment
إِغْتَذَرَ	يَغْتَذِرُ	إِغْتِذَارٌ	to make excuses
عَرَبِيٌّ		s.p.	Arabic, Arab
عَرَجٌ	يَعْرُجُ	مِعْرَجٌ	to mount
عَرْشٌ			throne
مَعْرُوشٌ			in trellises
أَعْرَضَ	يُغْرِضُ	إِغْرَاضٌ	to turn away
عَرَفَ	يَعْرِفُ	مَعْرِفَةٌ	to know, recognize
عُرْفٌ		أُغْرَافٌ	crest, ridge, height
مَعْرُوفٌ			kindness
عُرْوَةٌ			handle
عِزَّةٌ			might, power
عَزِيزٌ			mighty
عُسْرٌ			difficulty
عَسِيرٌ			difficult
f. عَصَا		عِصِيٌّ	stick
أَعْطَى	يُعْطِي	إِعْطَاءٌ	to give
عَظِيمٌ			great
عَفَا	يَغْفُو	عَفْوٌ	to pardon (+ 'an)
عِقَابٌ			punishment, requital
عَاقِبَةٌ			end, consequence
عَقَلَ	يَنْقِلُ	عَقْلٌ	to understand
عَاكِفٌ		s.p.	devoted
	(gen. only)	الْعَالَمِينَ	created beings
عَلِمَ	يَعْلَمُ	عِلْمٌ	to know
مَعْلُومٌ			known

تَعْلِمُ	يُعَلِّمُ	عَلَّمَ	to teach
		عَلَى	on, against
	f. عَالِيَةً	عَالٍ	high, lofty
عَمَدٌ		عَمَادٌ	columns, supports
عَمَّرَ	يُعَمِّرُ	عَمَّرَ	to build, build up, visit
تَعْمِيرٌ	يُعَمِّرُ	عَمَّرَ	to build
عَمَلٌ	يَعْمَلُ	عَمِلَ	to do, work
		أَعْمَى	blind
		عَنْ	away from; concerning
		عِنْدَ	with, in the possession of
مُعَاهَدَةٌ	يُعَاهِدُ	عَاهَدَ	to make a covenant with
مَعَادٌ	يَعُودُ	عَادَ	to return; do again
إِعَادَةٌ	يُعِيدُ	أَعَادَ	to repeat, return (trans.)
	يَعُودُ	عَادَ	to seek refuge with
أَغْوَامٌ		عَامٌ	year
تَعَاوَنَ	يَتَعَاوَنُ	تَعَاوَنَ	to co-operate, help one another
إِسْتِعَانَةٌ	يَسْتَعِينُ	إِسْتَعَانَ	to ask for help
عُيُونٌ / أَغْيُنٌ		f. عَيْنٌ	spring; eye

غ

غَدُوٌّ	يَغْدُو	غَدَا	to be/do in the morning
مَغَارِبٌ		مَغْرِبٌ	settling-place
إِغْرَاقٌ	يُغْرِقُ	أَغْرَقَ	to drown

غَضِبَ	يَغْضَبُ	غَضَبَ	to be angry with (+ 'alā)
غَضِبَ			anger
مُغَاضِبٌ			angry
غَفَرَ	يَغْفِرُ	مَغْفِرَةٌ	to forgive
إِسْتَغْفَرَ	يَسْتَغْفِرُ	إِسْتِغْفَارٌ	to seek forgiveness
غُفُورٌ			forgiving
مَغْفِرَةٌ			forgiveness
غَفَلَ	يَغْفُلُ	غَفْلَةً	to be heedless, forget
غَفْلَةٌ			heedlessness
غَلَّ	يَغْلُ	غُلُولٌ	to deceive
غَلَبَ	يَغْلِبُ	غَلَبَ	to overcome
غَلِيظٌ			thick, rough, hard
غُلَامٌ		غِلْمَانٌ	boy
غَمْرَةٌ		غَمْرَاتٌ	pang
مَغَارَةٌ		s.p.	cave
الْغَيْبُ			the unseen, the invisible
غِيَابَةٌ		s.p.	bottom; recess
غَيْرٌ			other than
غَيْرٌ، بَغَيْرٍ، مِنْ غَيْرٍ			without

ف

فَتَحَ	يَفْتَحُ	فَتَحَ	to open
فَتَنَ	يَفْتِنُ	فِتْنَةٌ	to tempt, afflict, stir up
فِتْنَةٌ		فِتْنٌ	affliction
فَتًى		فَتِيَّةٌ	youth

فَرَّ	يَفِرُّ	فِرَارٌ	to flee
مَفَرٌّ			refuge
فَرِحَ	يَفْرَحُ	فَرَحٌ	to rejoice in
فَرْدٌ		أَفْرَادٌ	individual
فَرَادَى			singly
فَرَضَ	يَفْرِضُ	فَرَضٌ	to assign, prescribe
تَفَرَّقَ	يَتَفَرَّقُ	تَفَرُّقٌ	to be divided
فَرِيقٌ			party, company
أَفْسَدَ	يُفْسِدُ	إِفْسَادٌ	to cause mischief
فَسَادٌ			corruption
فُسُوقٌ			dissoluteness
فَضْلٌ			bounty
فَطَرَ	يَفْطُرُ	فَطْرٌ	to create
إِنْفَطَرَ	يَنْفَطِرُ	إِنْفِطَارٌ	to be split
فَعَلَ	يَفْعَلُ	فَعْلَةٌ	to do
مَفْعُولٌ			done
فَقِيرٌ		فُقَرَاءٌ	poor
فَقِهَ	يَفْقَهُ	فِقْهٌ	to understand
تَفَكَّرَ	يَتَفَكَّرُ	تَفَكُّرٌ	to think, reflect
فَكَهَ	يَفْكُهُ	فَكَاهَةٌ	to jest
تَفَكَّهَ	يَتَفَكَّهُ	تَفَكُّهٌ	to jest
أَفْلَحَ	يُفْلِحُ	إِفْلَاحٌ	to prosper
فَمٌّ		أَفْوَاهٌ	mouth
فَوْقَ			above, over
فِي			in, concerning

ق

قَبْرٌ		قُبُورٌ	grave
أَقْبَلَ	يُقْبَلُ	إِقْبَالَ	to advance
قِبْلَةٌ			direction, <i>qibla</i>
قَبْلَ			before
قَاتَلَ	يُقَاتِلُ	قِتَالٌ	to fight
قَدَرَ	يَقْدِرُ	قَدْرٌ	to measure carefully
قَدِيرٌ			having power over
قَدِمَ	يَقْدِمُ	قُدُومٌ	to come, advance on
قَدَّمَ	يَقْدِمُ	تَقْدِيمٌ	to send forward, to bring forward
إِسْتَقْدَمَ	يَسْتَقْدِمُ	إِسْتِقْدَامٌ	to bring forward
f. قَدَمٌ		أَقْدَامٌ	foot
قَدِيمٌ			old, ancient
مُسْتَقَرٌّ			abode
قَرَأَ	يَقْرَأُ	قُرْآنٌ	to recite
قُرْآنٌ			Qur'ān, recitation
قَرِبَ	يَقْرُبُ	قُرْبٌ	to come near, approach
قَرِيبٌ			near
قَارِعَةٌ			calamity
أَقْرَضَ	يُقْرِضُ	قَرْضٌ	to lend, make a loan
قَرْنٌ		قُرُونٌ	generation [horn]
قَرْيَةٌ		قَرْيٌ	village
قَسَمَ	يَقْسِمُ	قِسْمٌ	to divide

أَقْسَمَ	يُقْسِمُ	إِقْسَامٌ	to swear
قَسْوَةٌ			hardness
قَصَّ	يَقْصُ	قَصَصٌ	to tell
قَصَصٌ			story
قَضَى	يَقْضِي	قَضَاءٌ	to determine
قَعَدَ	يَقْعُدُ	قُعُودٌ	to sit, lurk
قَاعِدٌ		قُعُودٌ	seated
قَلِيلٌ		s.p.	few
قَلَبَ	يُقَلِّبُ	تَقْلِيْبٌ	to turn over, wring
إِنْقَلَبَ	يَنْقَلِبُ	إِنْقِلَابٌ	to turn back, return, be overturned
قَلْبٌ		قُلُوبٌ	heart
قَمَرٌ			moon
قَمِيصٌ			shirt
قَوْلٌ	p. أَقْوَالٌ p.p.	أَقَاوِيلُ	saying, words
قَامَ	يَقُومُ	قِيَامٌ	to stand, rise
أَقَامَ	يَقِيمُ	إِقَامٌ	to perform, uphold
قَوْمٌ		أَقْوَامٌ	people
مَقَامٌ			station
مُسْتَقِيمٌ			straight
تَقْوِيمٌ			form
قُوَّةٌ		قُوًى	power, force
مَقِيلٌ			noon resting-place

ك

كَ			like (preposition)
كَمَا			like (conjunction)
كَبُرَ	يَكْبُرُ	كَبُرَ	to grow up
اِسْتَكْبَرُ	يَسْتَكْبِرُ	اِسْتِكْبَارُ	to be haughty, insolent
كَبِيرٌ		s.p. / كِبَارٌ	big
كَبِيرَةٌ		كِبَائِرٌ	enormity
كَتَبَ	يَكْتُبُ	كِتَابَةٌ	to write
كِتَابٌ		كُتُبٌ	scripture, document
أَكْثَرَ	يُكْثِرُ	اِكْتِفَارٌ	to multiply, make much of
كَثِيرٌ		s.p. / كَثَارٌ	many
كَذَبَ	يَكْذِبُ	كِذْبٌ	to tell lies
كَذَّبَ	يُكَذِّبُ	تَكْذِيبٌ	to deny, give the lie to
أَكْرَمُ		[كَرِيمٌ]	nobler
مُكْرَمٌ		s.p.	honoured
كَرِهَ	يَكْرَهُ	كَرَاهَةٌ	to be reluctant, hate
كَسَبَ	يَكْسِبُ	كَسْبٌ	to acquire, earn
كَشَفَ	يَكْشِفُ	كَشْفٌ	to uncover, remove, relieve
f. كَفٌّ		أَكْفٌ	palm of the hand, hand
كَفَرَ	يَكْفُرُ	كَفْرٌ	to deny, not to believe in
كَفَّرَ	يُكَفِّرُ	تَكْفِيرٌ	to forgive, redeem
كُفُوٌ			equal
كَفَى	يَكْفِي	كَفَايَةٌ	to be sufficient

كَافِرٌ		s.p.	unbeliever, ungrateful
كَلْبٌ		كِلَابٌ	dog
كَلَّمَ	يُكَلِّمُ	تَكْلِيمٌ	to speak to, address
كَلَامٌ			speech, words
كَلِمَةٌ		s.p.	word
كِتْنٌ / كِتَانٌ		أَكِنَّةٌ	coverings
كَذَرٌ	يَكْذُرُ	كَثَرٌ	to store
كَادَ	يَكَادُ		'almost'; with negative 'scarcely'
كَوَّرَ	يُكَوِّرُ	تَكْوِيرٌ	to envelop
كَادَ	يَكِيدُ	كَيْدٌ	to strive, plot, outwit
كَيْدٌ			plotting, wiles
كَيْلٌ			measure

ل

لِ			to, for
لُبٌّ		الْأَبَابُ	heart, intellect
لَبِثُ	يَلْبِثُ	لَبِثٌ	to tarry, linger
لَبَسَ	يَلْبَسُ	لَبْسٌ	to confound
لِبَاسٌ		الْبِيسَةُ	clothing; garment
مَلَجَأٌ		مَلَاجِئٌ	refuge
لَحْمٌ		لُحُومٌ	flesh
لِسَانٌ		الْأَلْسِنَةُ	tongue
لَطِيفٌ			gentle, subtle
لَعِبَ	يَلْعَبُ		to play

لَعْنَةٌ		s.p.	curse
إِلْتَقَطَ	يَلْتَقِطُ	إِلْتِقَاطٌ	to pick up
لَقِيَ	يَلْقَى	لِقَاءٌ	to meet
أَلْقَى	يُلْقِي	إِلْقَاءٌ	to throw
لَوْحٌ		أَلْوَاخٌ	tablet
مَلُومٌ			blamed, blameworthy
لَيْلٌ		لَيَالٍ	night, night time

م

مَتَّعَ	يُمَتِّعُ	تَمَتُّعٌ	to let enjoy; make provision for
تَمَتَّعَ	يَتَمَتَّعُ	تَمَتُّعٌ	to enjoy, enjoy oneself
مَتَاعٌ		أَمْتِعَةٌ	goods, baggage
مِثْلٌ		أَمْثَالٌ	likeness, parallel
مِثْلٌ			like (preposition)
مُحِيدٌ			glorious
مَحَالٌ			might
مَدِينَةٌ		مُدُنٌ	city
مَرَّ	يَمُرُّ	مَرٌّ	to pass
مَرَّةٌ		s.p.	time, occasion
إِمْرَأٌ			man
إِمْرَأَةٌ		[نِسَاءٌ / نِسْوَةٌ]	woman
مَرَضٌ		أَمْرَاضٌ	illness, sickness
مَرِيضٌ		مَرَضَى	ill, sick
مِرْيَةٌ			doubt

مَسَّ	تَمَسَّ	مَسَّ	to touch
الْمَسِيحُ			the Anointed One
مِصْرُ			Egypt
أَمْسَكَ	يُمْسِكُ	إِمْسَاكَ	to hold fast; withhold
يَا لَأَمْسَ			yesterday
مَشَى	يَمْشِي	مَشَى	to walk
مَعَ			with
مَكَّةُ			Mecca
مَكْرَ			plot
مَكَانٌ		أَمْكِنَةٌ	place
مِلَّةٌ		مِلَلٌ	community, religion
إِمْلَاقٌ			poverty
مَلَكٌ		مَلَائِكَةٌ	angel
مُلْكٌ			possession, dominion
مِنْ			from, of
مَمْنُونٌ			broken, cut
مَنَعَ	يَمْنَعُ	مَنَعَ	to prevent
مَاءٌ		مِيَاءٌ	water
مَاتَ	يَمُوتُ	مُوتٌ	to die
مَوْتُ			death
مَيِّتٌ		مَوْتَى / s.p.	dead
مَالٌ		أَمْوَالٌ	property
مَادَ	يَمِيدُ		to shake
مَائِدَةٌ		مَوَائِدُ	table

ن

نَبَأٌ	يُنَبِّئُ	تَنْبِئَةٌ	to inform
أَنْبَاءٌ	يُنَبِّئُ	إِنْبَاءٌ	to inform
نَبَأٌ		أَنْبَاءٌ	news
نَبِيٌّ		أَنْبِيَاءٌ	prophet
أَنْجَى	يُنْجِي	إِنْجَاءٌ	to save
نَجْوَى			secret conference
نَحْلٌ			bees
نَحْلٌ			date-palms
نَادِمٌ		s.p.	repentant
نَادَى	يُنَادِي	نِدَاءٌ	to call out to
تَنَادَى	يَتَنَادَى	تَنَادٍ	to call out to one another
نَذَرٌ	يُنْذِرُ	نَذْرٌ	to vow
أَنْذَرُ	يُنْذِرُ	إِنْذَارٌ	to warn
نَذِيرٌ		نُذْرٌ	warner
نَزَعَ	يُنْزِعُ	نَزْعٌ	to cause strife
نَزَلَ	يُنْزِلُ	تَنْزِيلٌ	to send down
أَنْزَلَ	يُنْزِلُ	إِنْزَالٌ	to send down
تَنَزَّلَ	يَتَنَزَّلُ	تَنْزُلٌ	to descend
[امْرَأَة]		نِسَاءٌ / نِسْوَةٌ	woman
نَسِيَ	يَنْسِي	نَسْيٌ	to forget
أَنْسَى	يُنْسِي	إِنْسَاءٌ	to cause to forget

أَنْشَأَ	يُنْشِئُ	إِنْشَاءً	to raise, create
نَصَرَ	يَنْصُرُ	نَصْرٌ	to help
نَصْرَانِيٌّ		نَصَارَى	Christian
نَاصِرٌ / نَصِيرٌ		أَنْصَارٌ / s.p.	helper
نِصْفٌ			half
نَاصِيَةٌ		نَوَاصٍ	forelock
نَظَرَ	يَنْظُرُ	نَظْرٌ	to look at (<i>ilā</i>), into (<i>fī</i>)
أَنْعَمَ	يُنْعِمُ	إِنْعَامٌ	to bless, be gracious to
نِعْمَةٌ			blessing, bounty
نَعَمٌ		أَنْعَامٌ	animal, livestock
نَفَخَ	يَنْفُخُ	نَفْخٌ	to blow
نَفَدَ	يَنْفَدُ	نَفَادٌ	to be exhausted
نَفَرَ	يَنْفِرُ	نَفْرٌ	to go forth
f. نَفْسٌ		أَنْفُسٌ	soul, self
نَفَعَ	يَنْفَعُ	نَفْعٌ	to benefit
مَنْفَعَةٌ		مَنَافِعُ	benefit
أَنْفَقَ	يُنْفِقُ	إِنْفَاقٌ	to spend
مُنَافِقٌ		s.p.	hypocrite
نَقِيبٌ		نُقَبَاءُ	chief
أَنْقَذَ	يُنْقِذُ	إِنْقَادٌ	to save, rescue
إِسْتَنْقَذَ	يَسْتَنْقِذُ	إِسْتِنْقَادٌ	to save, rescue
نَقَضَ	يَنْقُضُ	نَقْضٌ	to break one's oath
إِتْتَمَعَ	يَتْتَمِعُ	إِتْتِمَامٌ	to take revenge on (+ <i>min</i>)

أَنْكَرَ	يُنْكِرُ	إِنْكَارٌ	to deny, disapprove; not to know
نَمْلٌ			ants
نَهْرٌ		أَنْهَارٌ	river
نَهَارٌ			day, daytime
نَهَى	يَنْهَى	نَهْيٌ	to forbid
إِثْمَهُ	يُثْمِئِهِ	إِثْمَاءٌ	to cease, desist
أَنَابَ	يُنِيبُ	إِنَابَةٌ	to come back to; re- pent
نُورٌ		أَنْوَارٌ	light
نَارٌ		نِيرانٌ	fire
نَاقَةٌ		[إِبِلٌ]	she-camel

٥

هَجَرَ	يَهْجُرُ	هَجْرٌ	to forsake, leave
هَدَّ			crash, destruction
هَدَى	يَهْدِي	هُدًى	to guide
هَدْيٌ			offering
هُدًى			guidance
هَزَّ	يَهْزُ	هَزٌّ	to shake
إِسْتَهْزَأَ	يَسْتَهْزِئُ	إِسْتِهْزَاءٌ	to mock (+ bi-)
هَشِيمٌ			dry twigs
هَلَكَ	يَهْلِكُ	هَلَاكٌ	to perish
أَهْلَكَ	يُهْلِكُ	إِهْلَاكٌ	to destroy
مُهِينٌ			humiliating, contemptible

و

وَبَالَ			mischievous
الْوَثْقَى		[وَيْثِق]	firmest
مِيثَاقٌ			covenant, pledge
وَجَدَ	يَجِدُ	وَجَدَ	to find
وَجَلَ	يُوجَلُ	وَجَلَ	to be in awe of
أَوْحَى	يُوحِي	إِيْحَاءٌ	to inspire, reveal
وَحْيٌ			inspiration
وَدَّعَ	يُودِّعُ	تَوْدِيعٌ	to bid farewell to
	يَذَرُ		to let, allow
وَرِثَ	يَرِثُ	إِرْثٌ	to inherit
وَرَقَةٌ		وَرَقٌ	leaf
وَزَرَ	يَزِرُ	وَزْرٌ	to carry a burden
وَاِزْرَةٌ			soul bearing a burden
وَزْنٌ			weight
مِيزَانٌ		مَوَازِينُ	balance
وَسْطٌ			middle
وَسِعَ	يَسِعُ	وُسْعٌ	to be wide; encompass
وَأَسِعَ			wide, ample
سَعَةٌ			wealth
وَصَفَ	يَصِفُ	وَضَفٌ	to describe
وَصَلَ	يَصِلُ	وُصُولٌ	to arrive
وَضَعَ	يَضَعُ	وَضْعٌ	to put down; give birth to
وَعَظَ	يَعِظُ	وَعْظٌ / عِظَةٌ	to exhort, admonish
وَعَدَ	يَعِدُ	وَعْدٌ	to promise

وَأَعَدَّ	يُوعِدُ	مُوعِدَةٌ	to make an agreement with
وَفَى	يُوفِي	تَوْفِيَةٌ	to pay, repay
أَوْفَى	يُوفِي	إِيفَاءٌ	to fulfil, give in full
تَوَفَّى	يَتَوَفَّى	تَوَفَّى	to take
وُقُودٌ			fuel
وَقَعَ	يَقَعُ	وُقُوعٌ	to fall, come to pass
إِنْتَقَى	يَنْتَقِي	إِنْتَاءٌ	to protect oneself; to be god-fearing
أَتَقَى		[تَقَى]	more pious
تَوَكَّلَ	يَتَوَكَّلُ	تَوَكَّلَ	to put one's trust in ('alā)
وُلِدَ	يُولَدُ	[passive]	to be born
وَلَدٌ		أَوْلَادٌ	child
وَالِدٌ			father; (dual) parents
وَلَّى	يُؤَلِّى	تَوَلَّى	to turn
تَوَلَّى	يَتَوَلَّى	تَوَلَّى	to turn away; to take on oneself
وَلِيٌّ		أَوْلِيَاءُ	friend, protector
أَوْلَى			nearer
وَهَبَ	يَهِبُ	هَبَةٌ	to give
وَهَابٌ			forgiving
أَوْهَنُ			frailest

ي

يَنْتَسُ	يَنْتَسُ	يَأْسُ	to despair
يَدٌ f.		أَيْدٍ	hand
يُسْرٌ			ease
يَسِيرٌ			easy
أَيْقَنَ	يُوقِنُ	إِيقَانٌ	to be certain
يَمِينٌ		أَيْمَانٌ	right, right hand; oath
يَهُودِيٌّ		يَهُودٌ	Jew
يَوْمٌ		أَيَّامٌ	day
يَوْمَئِذٍ			on that day